

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY

TEACHING MANUAL

Social Media Management

Session Roadmap · Lesson Notes · Concept Diagrams · Answer Keys

READY TO TEACH

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OVERVIEW

Course Roadmap

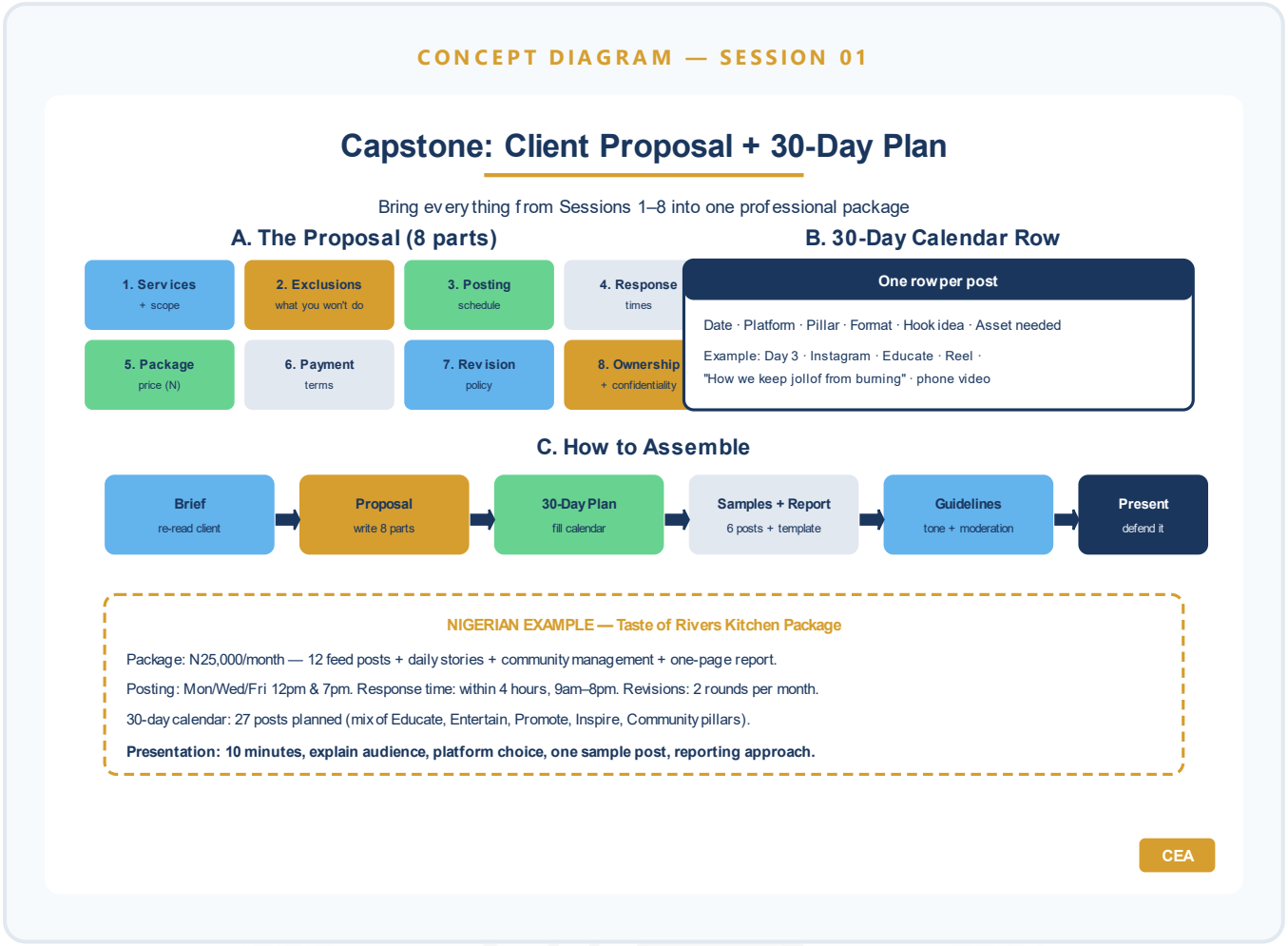
What we cover in every session

#	SESSION TOPIC	WEEK / MODULE	DURATION
01	What Social Media Management Is	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Strategy	105 minutes
02	Audience Goals and Platform Strategy	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Strategy	105 minutes
03	Content Strategy and Pillars	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Strategy	105 minutes
04	Creating and Sourcing Content for Clients	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Create and Manage	105 minutes
05	Community Management and Engagement	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Create and Manage	105 minutes
06	Scheduling Tools and Client Workflow	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Create and Manage	105 minutes
07	Analytics and Client Reporting	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Grow and Report	105 minutes
08	Paid Promotion Basics and Growth	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Grow and Report	105 minutes
09	Capstone Client Proposal and 30 Day Social Media Plan	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Grow and Report	105 minutes

How to use this book: Each session below is a complete, ready-to-teach lesson note. Section A tells you what to prepare, B lists the outcomes, D–F are the teaching content, G–H are your demos and practicals, and the knowledge check with answer key is at the end. The concept diagram for each session is embedded as a visual aid.

SESSION 01 OF 9

What Social Media Management Is



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

SESSION 1 â€" WHAT SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT IS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	1 of 9
Session title	What Social Media Management Is
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Strategy
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with social media management)
Prerequisite knowledge	Everyday smartphone use â€" scrolling Instagram, Facebook, TikTok or X, sending WhatsApp messages, taking photos. No marketing knowledge, no business experience and no existing

Item	Detail
	followers required. Learners who are not yet comfortable installing an app should be paired with a confident learner for the first practical.
Connection to previous work	This is the first session of the course. There is no previous session. It connects to everyday life: nearly every learner already uses social media for fun â€" today we turn that familiarity into a paid, professional skill.
Preparation before class	Projector connected and tested; the five fictional "who hires a manager" scenario cards (Section D) printed or ready on screen; the services-menu worksheet (Section H) printed per learner; a whiteboard or flipchart for the live services-menu build; the running client brief for *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* (below) printed for every learner; the ethics statement (Section F.6) read aloud and displayed; academy Wi-Fi confirmed working.

The running client for the whole course. Every session uses one fictional client so learners build real, connected work instead of random exercises. Read this aloud in Session 1 and keep it visible all course.

> ***CLIENT BRIEF â€" TASTE OF RIVERS KITCHEN (fictional).*** *Taste of Rivers Kitchen is a small food business in Rumuola, Port Harcourt, Rivers State. It sells local meals â€" jollof rice, fried rice, small chops, plantain and fish â€" for pickup and delivery within Port Harcourt. Prices run from â‚¦1,500 for a plate of jollof to â‚¦8,000 for a small-chops tray. The owner, "Chef Nkechi," cooks with two assistants and takes orders on one WhatsApp line. Her Instagram and Facebook pages exist but have been silent for about three months. She wants someone to post consistently for 30 days, reply to customers, and bring more WhatsApp orders â€" with* ***no advertising budget****. She is busy, not technical, and she has been burned before by someone who bought her fake followers. This client is invented for the course. No real business is contacted.*

Instructor note on tone. This session must feel *possible*, not overwhelming. Many learners believe social media management is "for people with big followings" or "for marketing graduates." Your job in the first 105 minutes is to prove, with naira figures and Nigerian examples, that this is a phone-based skill they can start this month â€" and that honesty is the whole business.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Define** social media management in their own words and explain the five core tasks of the job â€" planning, creating, posting, engaging and reporting.
2. **List** the services a social media manager sells and match each service to a realistic naira price for a small Port Harcourt client.
3. **Describe** what a client expects from a manager â€" consistency, prompt replies, professionalism, confidentiality and honest numbers â€" and explain why each expectation exists.
4. **Survey** the five main platforms (Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, X, LinkedIn) and state, in plain language, what each is mainly used for and who uses it in Nigeria.
5. **Explain** honest earning expectations for an entry-level manager in Nigeria, including what the course does and does not promise.
6. **Apply** the course ethics rules â€" no bought followers, no fake reviews, no inflated reports, respect privacy and consent, follow platform rules â€" and explain why each rule protects the client and the manager.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (Android or iPhone) with a working camera and enough free storage for photos and a few short videos.
- Academy computers (one per learner or one per pair) for Google Docs, Google Sheets and Canva later in the course.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.

- A whiteboard or flipchart and markers for the live services-menu build.

Software

- A notes app on every phone (Google Keep, Samsung Notes, Apple Notes, or Google Docs).
- A free Gmail address per learner (confirmed or created in class â€" see Section E).
- Free accounts on at least two platforms: Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, X or LinkedIn. Learners who prefer not to use their real name may create a practice account or work under a class alias â€" tell the instructor at the start.
- A free Canva account (email sign-up is enough â€" used from Session 4, but create it now so there is no delay later).

Sample files

- **Five "who hires a manager" scenario cards** (Section D) â€" printed or on screen.
- **The Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief** (Section A) â€" printed per learner.
- **Services-menu worksheet** (Section H) â€" a blank table with columns: *Service / What the client gets / How often / Price (â‚¦) / Why the client pays*.
- **Platform survey sheet** â€" a one-page table: *Platform / Main use / Who uses it in Nigeria / Good for which business*.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 1.1 â€" "What the Job Really Is" (five core tasks, matched to a day in the life of a manager).
- Worksheet 1.2 â€" "My Services and Packages Menu" (the assignment template, Section L).

Accounts

- Gmail, two social platforms, Canva â€" all free. No paid tool, no ad budget, no verification purchase.

Internet

- Academy Wi-Fi for account setup and demonstrations. The session works offline for the discussion parts if Wi-Fi fails â€" the scenario cards and worksheets are printed.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner without a smartphone may share a device for the account-check step and participate fully in every discussion, worksheet and the assignment â€" the core skill today is *understanding the role*, not the device.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor (read aloud at the start): Everything we discuss today is about *honest* work. We will never buy followers, likes, views, comments or reviews. We will never fake a report or pose as a customer. These are not just academy rules â€" they are what separate a professional from a cheat, and they are why clients trust us with their money and their name.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show five short scenario cards, one at a time. Each describes a real Nigerian situation where someone needs help with social media. Do not explain which is "right" â€" just read each and ask a show of hands.

Card 1 â€" The silent page. "*Chinedu runs a barbershop in Rumuokuta. His Instagram page has 400 followers and his last post was four months ago. He is good with customers but he does not know what to post or when.*"

Card 2 â€" The burned owner. "*Mama Put sells rice and beans in Diobu. Someone offered to 'grow her page' for â‚¦15,000. She paid. She got 2,000 followers in one week â€" and zero new customers. Now she does not trust anyone.*"

Card 3 â€" The busy professional. "*Dr. Ada sees patients all week. She wants to share health tips and grow her clinic, but she has no time to post or reply to messages.*"

Card 4 â€" The event that flopped. "*A friend is planning a birthday party for 200 people. She made a flyer, posted it once, and 30 people came. She does not know what went wrong.*"

Card 5 â€" The side hustle. "*Emeka is a corps member. He is good on his phone. He wants to earn extra naira during service year, but he does not know what people actually pay for.*"

What the instructor says:

> *"Hands up if you can see yourself in at least one of these five cards. â€¦ Almost everyone. Good. Here is the secret: every one of these five people has the same problem â€" not a phone problem, not a talent problem. They have a management problem. They need someone to plan what to post, post it consistently, reply to people, and show the owner whether it is working. That someone could be you. By the end of today, you will know exactly what that job is, what it pays, and why doing it honestly is the whole advantage."*

Expected learner response: Learners will nod, point at cards, say "that is my aunty," "that is my church," "I am Emeka." Accept all answers. Draw out the common thread: *someone has to do the work, and someone will pay for it.*

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"This course does not promise you followers, income or clients. It teaches you a real skill with free tools. Money comes after you do the work, build proof and deliver for real people. We say that in Session 1 and we will say it again in Session 9. Now â€" what exactly is the job?"*

Why this opener works: It uses situations every Nigerian learner recognises, it produces instant identification ("that is my aunty"), and it frames the entire course as a paid, professional skill â€" not a hobby â€" within the first six minutes.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector. Keep it moving â€" this is a confidence check, not a test.

Question 1: "Which social media apps do you already use, and what do you mainly use them for?"

- Expected answer: Instagram for photos and reels, Facebook for family and groups, TikTok for videos and comedy, X for news and arguments, LinkedIn for jobs. Accept anything honest.
- Common gap: some learners use only one app. Say: "Good â€" you already understand one platform deeply. Today we add the other four to your map."

Question 2: "Have you ever followed a business page â€" a restaurant, a salon, a phone seller? What made you follow it, or what made you unfollow it?"

- Expected answer: followed because the food looked good or they replied fast; unfollowed because they posted once in six months or never replied to comments.
- Common gap: learners think "posting" is the whole job. Clarify: "You just described the two things clients complain about most â€" inconsistency and silence. Remember those words."

Question 3: "If a customer sent your shop a WhatsApp message at 9 p.m. and you replied at 9 a.m. the next day, what would the customer think?"

- Expected answer: they would think you do not care, or they would have already gone somewhere else.
- Common gap: learners do not yet see response time as a professional standard. Say: "That â€" right there â€" is a service a manager sells. It is called community management, and we teach it properly in Session 5."

Question 4: "What is the difference between a personal account and a business account on Instagram or Facebook?"

- Expected answer: a business account shows a category, a contact button, and insights (numbers about who saw your post). A personal account does not.
- Common gap: many learners have never switched. Say: "We will do that together in Session 6. For now, just know: business accounts are free and they give you the numbers you need to prove your work."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You already know more than you think. You know what makes you follow a page, you know what makes you leave, and you know that slow replies feel bad. A social media manager is simply the person a business hires to do all of that â€" professionally, consistently, and with honest numbers. Let us now define the job properly."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 3 extra minutes asking learners to open one app they have never used and find one business page â€" just to see what a business page looks like.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What social media management actually is

The idea. Social media management is the job of running a business's or person's social media presence â€" planning what to post, creating the content, posting it on time, replying to the community, and reporting the results â€" so the owner can focus on their real work.

Plain-English definition. A social media manager is the person a business hires to be its voice and its eyes online. The owner makes the food; the manager makes sure people see the food, feel hungry, and know how to order.

Why it exists. Across Nigeria, customers now check Instagram or Facebook before they buy or visit. A 2024 survey by a Lagos market-research firm found that 6 out of 10 Nigerian consumers under 35 look at a business's social page before deciding to buy â€" and most small businesses post only when they remember, because nobody taught them how to keep it up and they cannot afford an agency. That gap is the job.

The five core tasks of the job. Every social media management job in Nigeria â€" from a church volunteer to a Lagos agency â€" is built from these five tasks:

Task	What it means	Example (Taste of Rivers Kitchen)
1. Planning	Deciding what to post, when, and why â€" before you post anything.	Choosing to post a jollof video on Friday evening because that is when people decide weekend food.
2. Creating	Writing captions, designing graphics, shooting photos and short videos.	Filming Chef Nkechi frying plantain and writing a caption with the price and order number.
3. Posting	Publishing the content on the right platform at the right time â€" consistently.	Scheduling the plantain video for Friday 5 p.m. on Instagram and Facebook.
4. Engaging	Replying to comments and direct messages quickly, warmly and in the brand's voice.	Replying to "Do you deliver to GRA?" with "Yes! We deliver to GRA in 45 minutes. Send us a DM to order."
5. Reporting	Measuring what worked and telling the owner honestly â€" numbers, insights and next steps.	Telling Chef Nkechi: "This month we reached 8,000 people, got 40 DMs, and 12 became orders. The jollof video worked best."

Real-life comparison. Think of a **restaurant**. The owner is the chef â€" they cook. The manager is the person who designs the menu, trains the waiters, greets customers, handles complaints, and counts the money at night. The chef cannot do all of that and cook well. A social media manager is that person for the online restaurant.

Important limitation / misconception. Social media management is not "posting and hoping." It is not buying followers and calling it growth. It is not making a business go viral once and disappearing. It is a *management* job â€" planning, doing, measuring, improving â€" repeated every week. The managers who earn well are the ones who are consistent and honest, not the ones who chase tricks.

F.2 Who hires a social media manager â€" and why

The idea. The manager's client is usually someone who is good at their real work but too busy, too technical or too inconsistent to run their own social media well.

The five main client types in Nigeria:

1. **Small-business owners** â€" restaurant owners, tailors, salon and barber shops, bakeshops, phone sellers, fashion designers, event vendors. They need orders and they need their page to look alive. They are the biggest market for an entry-level manager.
2. **Professionals** â€" doctors, lawyers, real estate agents, fitness coaches, faith leaders. They need trust and visibility, not necessarily daily posting.
3. **Churches, schools and NGOs** â€" they need announcements, event coverage and a consistent, respectful voice.

4. **Event planners and entertainers** â€" comedians, musicians, MCs. They need hype before an event and proof of reach after.
5. **Personal brands** â€" students, corps members, creators who want to grow honestly and maybe monetise later.

Why they hire instead of doing it themselves. Three reasons, every time:

- **Time.** The owner is busy doing the real job. A manager costs less than the owner's time.
- **Skill.** Good captions, clean graphics and consistent scheduling are learnable skills â€" most owners never learned them.
- **Honesty about results.** A good manager shows real numbers. Most owners cannot tell if their page is working â€" a manager can.

What the client expects â€" the five expectations. This is the heart of the job. A client hires a manager and expects five things:

Expectation	What it means	Why the client cares
Consistency	Posting regularly â€" not three posts in one day and nothing for three weeks.	A silent page looks closed. Consistency keeps the business visible and trusted.
Prompt replies	Answering comments and DMs quickly â€" same day, ideally within a few hours.	A slow reply feels like no reply. Customers go to the competitor who answers.
Professionalism	Clean grammar, correct prices, respectful tone, no drama, no arguing with customers.	The manager *is* the business online. One rude reply can cost the owner customers.
Confidentiality	Keeping the client's account access, customer details, sales numbers and strategy private.	The client handed over their reputation. Betraying that trust ends the relationship â€" and can end a career.
Honest numbers	Reporting real results â€" good and bad â€" never inflating, never hiding.	The client pays for results they can verify. A manager who fakes numbers will be caught and fired.

Say this to the class:

> *"A client is not buying posts. They are buying trust. They trust you with their account, their customers and their name. Every one of those five expectations is about keeping that trust. The moment you break it â€" a missed week, a rude reply, a fake number â€" you are not just a bad employee. You are a person who cannot be trusted with a business."*

F.3 The services a manager sells

The idea. A manager does not sell "social media." They sell specific, named services that solve specific problems. A client can buy one service or a package of several.

The core services menu:

Service	What the client gets	Typical frequency
Content creation	Photos, short videos, graphics and captions made for the client's pages.	Weekly or per post.
Scheduling and posting	Publishing content at the right times, consistently, without the owner lifting a finger.	Daily or several times a week.
Community management	Replying to comments and DMs, moderating, handling complaints professionally.	Daily.
Reporting	A monthly summary of numbers, what worked, what did not, and what to do next.	Monthly.
Basic paid promotion	Planning and running small boosts with the client's budget â€" only when it makes sense.	Occasionally, with written approval.
Strategy	Audience research, platform choice, content pillars, goals and a content calendar.	At the start, then reviewed monthly.

How services become packages. Most managers sell packages, not single services, because packages are easier to price and easier for a client to understand. A simple three-tier structure for a small Port Harcourt business:

Package	What is included	Realistic monthly price (â‚¦)
Starter	8 posts a month (2 per week), captions and graphics, scheduling, basic monthly report.	â‚¦15,000 â€“ â‚¦25,000
Growth	12 posts a month (3 per week), captions, graphics, scheduling, daily reply management, monthly report with insights.	â‚¦30,000 â€“ â‚¦50,000
Full Management	15â€“20 posts a month, all content, scheduling, daily community management, monthly report, one strategy review per month, basic boost planning.	â‚¦60,000 â€“ â‚¦100,000

Important honesty note on pricing. These are realistic *entry-level* prices for a small Nigerian client in 2026. A brand-new manager with no portfolio should expect to start at the lower end â€“ or even do one or two jobs at a reduced rate to build proof. A manager with a strong portfolio and real results can charge more. **Never quote a price you cannot deliver on.** The fastest way to lose a client â€“ and your reputation â€“ is to promise a Full Management package and deliver a Starter effort.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **salon**. A haircut costs one price, a full treatment costs more, and a monthly "maintenance" package costs the most. The salon does not charge for "hair" â€“ it charges for named services. A manager does the same.

F.4 The five platforms â€“ a plain-language survey

The idea. A manager does not need to be everywhere. They need to know what each platform is for, who uses it in Nigeria, and which one or two fit their client. Choosing a platform without a reason is how pages end up silent.

Platform	Main use	Who uses it in Nigeria	Good for which business
Instagram	Photos, short videos (Reels), stories, shopping. Visual and young.	Under-35s, urban, fashion, food, beauty, lifestyle.	Restaurants, salons, fashion, event vendors, any visual business.
Facebook	Community, groups, events, marketplace, longer posts, older users.	Broad â€“ 25 to 60+, families, churches, market traders.	Churches, schools, shops, local services, anything targeting parents and older customers.
TikTok	Short, fun, fast-moving video. Entertainment and discovery.	Young â€“ under-30, students, creators, comedians.	Entertainment, fashion, food (fun side), personal brands, anything that can be playful.
X (Twitter)	Text, news, arguments, real-time conversation, public figures.	Journalists, politicians, professionals, tech, news followers.	News, tech, professionals, anyone who wants to be part of public conversation.
LinkedIn	Professional networking, jobs, B2B, career branding.	Graduates, professionals, recruiters, companies.	Consultants, trainers, recruiters, anyone selling to other businesses or building a career.

The key lesson â€“ choose with reasons, not vibes. A manager should never say "let us be on TikTok because it is trendy." They should say "our client sells small chops to students, and TikTok is where students discover food â€“ so TikTok is our first platform." The platform choice comes from the audience, not from fashion. (We teach this properly in Session 2.)

Nigerian context to mention. WhatsApp is not a "social media platform" in the same sense, but in Nigeria it is where the money moves â€“ orders, payments and customer conversations happen on WhatsApp. A good manager always connects social media to WhatsApp, because that is where the client's revenue actually is. Also note: data costs matter. Many Nigerian users are on limited data, so heavy video content should be balanced with lighter images and text where possible.

F.5 Honest earning expectations â€“ what this course does and does not promise

The idea. Learners need a clear, honest picture of money â€“ not hype, not fear. This course teaches a real skill; the learner must still do the work to earn.

What the course promises:

- A real, in-demand skill that small businesses and organisations in Nigeria pay for.
- Free tools only â€" no subscription, no ad budget, no paid software needed to learn or to start.
- A complete client-ready package (the capstone) that proves the skill.
- An honest certificate that means something because it is backed by real work.

What the course does not promise:

- Followers, income or clients on graduation.
- That a certificate alone gets you hired â€" proof and delivery get you hired.
- That you will earn like a senior agency manager â€" you are entry-level, and that is fine.
- Any guarantee of viral content or instant results.

Realistic earning picture for an entry-level manager in Nigeria (2026):

- **One small client** on a Starter package: â‚¦15,000 â€" â‚¦25,000 per month.
- **Two to three small clients** on Growth packages: â‚¦60,000 â€" â‚¦120,000 per month â€" a realistic first-year goal for a dedicated beginner.
- **A full-time junior role** in a company or agency: â‚¦80,000 â€" â‚¦150,000 per month, depending on the city and the employer.
- **A senior agency or media-buyer role:** much more â€" but that requires years of experience and further study, and this course is the first step, not the last.

Say this to the class:

> *"Let me be honest with you, because a client will be honest with you too. After three weeks, you will not be a senior marketer. You will be a capable entry-level manager â€" someone who can take on one or two small clients and deliver honest, professional work. That is a real skill. That is worth real money. And if you keep learning â€" our Content Creation course, then digital marketing, then paid advertising â€" you can build a serious career. But it starts here, with doing the basics well."*

F.6 The ethics of real growth â€" the non-negotiable rules

The idea. A client hands over their brand, their account access and their reputation. Trust is the whole job. These rules are not suggestions â€" they are the difference between a professional and a cheat.

The eight ethics rules (read aloud, display, and return to them every session):

1. **No fake growth.** Never buy followers, likes, views, comments or reviews. Never use engagement pods, bots or fake giveaways. Real growth is slower and worth more.
2. **Honest reporting.** Report real numbers, good and bad. Never hide a bad month, never round a 3% engagement rate up to 30%, never screenshot someone else's results and call them yours.
3. **Privacy and consent.** Get permission before posting a person's face, a customer's message or a child's photo. Never publish a customer's contact or order details. Handle client access confidentially.
4. **Follow platform rules.** Post only original or properly licensed content. Never repost or rebrand another creator's work without credit and permission.
5. **No impersonation or deception.** Never create fake accounts to praise or defend a client, pose as a customer, or attack a competitor.
6. **Professional disagreement.** Reply calmly. Never argue publicly, insult or threaten a commenter, or rally others to attack someone.
7. **Clear money.** Quote honestly, deliver what was agreed, do not take on a client you cannot serve.
8. **Consequences.** Breaking these rules is a serious breach of academy conduct and may end participation.

Why each rule protects the manager too. Bought followers inflate the client's expectations and make real results look small by comparison â€" the manager looks bad. Fake reviews get the client's page flagged or banned â€" the manager loses the account. Inflated reports get caught the moment the client checks their own insights â€" the manager is fired and named. Honest work is not just right; it is the only sustainable business model.

Say it with the class (repeat together):

> *"No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof."*

Real-life comparison. Think of a **doctor**. A doctor who lies about a patient's results might make the patient happy for a week â€" but when the truth comes out, the doctor loses their licence and their reputation. A social media manager is the same. The client's trust is the licence.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **Social media management** is the job of planning, creating, posting, engaging and reporting for a business's social media â€" so the owner can focus on their real work.
- The **five core tasks** are planning, creating, posting, engaging and reporting.
- The **main clients** are small businesses, professionals, churches and schools, event vendors and personal brands.
- The **five client expectations** are consistency, prompt replies, professionalism, confidentiality and honest numbers.
- The **services** a manager sells are content creation, scheduling, community management, reporting, basic paid promotion and strategy â€" usually sold as packages.
- **Realistic entry-level pricing** for a small Port Harcourt client runs from â‚¦15,000 to â‚¦100,000 per month depending on the package.
- The **five platforms** each have a main use and a main audience â€" choose with reasons, not vibes.
- **Honest earning** is real but not instant â€" one or two small clients is a realistic first goal.
- The **ethics rules** are non-negotiable: no fakes, no inflated numbers, real work, real results, real proof.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Client] --> B[You: Social Media Manager]
    B --> C[Create content]
    B --> D[Schedule posts]
    B --> E[Engage community]
    B --> F[Report results]
    C --> G[More customers for client]
    D --> G
    E --> G
    F --> G
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through a complete "day in the life" of a social media manager for the running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*, so learners see the five tasks as one connected job â€" not five separate ideas.

Setup: On the projector, show a blank "Day in the Life" timeline with five time blocks: Morning, Midday, Afternoon, Evening, Night. Have the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief visible.

G.1 Demonstration 1 â€" The morning: plan and create (4 minutes)

Say: "It is 8 a.m. Chef Nkechi is in the kitchen. I am the manager. What do I do first?"

Walk through the morning block:

- **Check the calendar.** "I open my content calendar and see: today is Friday, and the plan says 'jollof video, 5 p.m., Instagram and Facebook.' I know exactly what to post â€" I am not guessing."
- **Create the content.** "Yesterday I filmed Chef Nkechi frying jollof â€" 30 seconds, phone, natural light. This morning I write the caption: hook, value, CTA. I design one graphic in Canva with the price â€" â‚¦1,500 a plate â€" and the WhatsApp order number. That is the *creating* task."
- **Prepare the post.** "I save the video and the graphic to a folder called 'Taste of Rivers â€" Friday.' I write the caption in a Google Doc so Chef Nkechi can read it before I post."

Point out: "Notice â€" I have not posted anything yet. A good manager does not post in the morning and hope. I plan, I create, I prepare. Posting is the *last* step, not the first."

G.2 Demonstration 2 â€” Midday: the approval step (3 minutes)

Say: "Before anything goes live, the client sees it. This is called the approval workflow, and it is what separates a professional from a poster."

Walk through the midday block:

- **Send for approval.** "I send Chef Nkechi the caption and the graphic on WhatsApp at 12 p.m. I say: 'This is Friday's post. Please check the price and the wording. I will post at 5 p.m. unless you tell me to change something.'"
- **Handle feedback.** "She replies: 'Change â‚¦1,500 to â‚¦1,600 â€” I changed the price this week.' I update the graphic and the caption. I confirm: 'Updated. Posting at 5 p.m.'"
- **Why this matters.** "If I had posted at 8 a.m. without checking, the page would show the wrong price for a whole day. The client would lose trust. The approval step takes ten minutes and prevents that."

G.3 Demonstration 3 â€” Afternoon: post and engage (4 minutes)

Say: "It is 5 p.m. The post is approved. Now I do the *posting* and *engaging* tasks."

Walk through the afternoon block:

- **Post.** "I open Meta Business Suite, upload the video, paste the caption, and schedule it for 5 p.m. on both Instagram and Facebook. It goes live automatically â€” I do not have to be online at 5 p.m."
- **Engage.** "By 6 p.m., the comments start. Someone writes: 'Do you deliver to GRA?' I reply: 'Yes! We deliver to GRA in 45 minutes. Send us a DM to order.' Someone else writes: 'This jollof looks fire.' I reply: 'Thank you! Come and taste it â€” â‚¦1,500 a plate.'"
- **The engagement rule.** "I reply to every real comment within a few hours. I never argue, I never ignore a question, and I never post a customer's private details. That is community management â€” and it is a service the client is paying for."

G.4 Demonstration 4 â€” Evening and night: measure and report (4 minutes)

Say: "The week ends. Now I do the *reporting* task â€” the one that makes the client trust me."

Walk through the evening and night blocks:

- **Pull the numbers.** "On Sunday night, I open Instagram and Facebook Insights. I write down: how many people saw our posts (reach), how many liked, commented, saved or shared (engagement), how many clicked the WhatsApp link (clicks), and how many new followers we gained."
- **Write the report.** "I fill in a one-page report: numbers against our goal, the top post, what worked, what did not, and one recommendation for next month. I send it to Chef Nkechi with screenshots."
- **The honest rule.** "If the month was bad, I say so. 'We reached 5,000 people but only got 8 orders. The jollof video worked; the plantain graphic did not. Next month we post more jollof content and try a different graphic style.' That honesty is why she keeps me."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "At what point did I post? Was it the first thing I did?" (No â€” planning and creating came first.)
- "Why did I send the caption to Chef Nkechi before posting?" (Approval â€” to catch mistakes and build trust.)
- "What did I do at 6 p.m. when the comments came?" (Engaged â€” replied quickly and warmly.)
- "What did I do on Sunday night?" (Reported â€” real numbers, honest insights.)

Expected result: Learners see the five tasks as one connected day â€” plan, create, approve, post, engage, report â€” and they see that the job is mostly *before* and *after* the post, not the post itself.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner completes a "Day in the Life" worksheet for the running client, mapping the five core tasks to a realistic Friday for *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*.

Starting materials: The printed "Day in the Life" worksheet (five time blocks with blank lines under each), the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief, a pen. No phone needed for this exercise â€” it is a thinking-and-mapping exercise.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name at the top of the worksheet. Read the client brief once.
2. **Morning block.** Write two things the manager does in the morning before posting anything. (Hint: check the calendar, create the content.)
3. **Midday block.** Write one thing the manager does to get the client's approval. (Hint: send the caption and graphic for checking.)
4. **Afternoon block.** Write two things the manager does when the post goes live. (Hint: schedule the post, reply to comments.)
5. **Evening block.** Write one thing the manager does to measure the results. (Hint: check insights, note the numbers.)
6. **Night block.** Write one thing the manager does to report to the client. (Hint: fill in the monthly report with honest numbers.)
7. **Pause and predict:** Cover your worksheet and ask yourself: "Which of the five tasks takes the most time â€" planning, creating, posting, engaging or reporting?" Write your answer at the bottom.
8. Compare your worksheet with the person beside you. If you wrote different things, explain your choices.

Expected result (model answers â€" instructor key):

Block	What the manager does
Morning	Checks the content calendar to see what is planned; creates the content (writes the caption, designs the graphic, prepares the video).
Midday	Sends the caption and graphic to Chef Nkechi for approval; updates anything she changes.
Afternoon	Schedules the post for 5 p.m. on Instagram and Facebook; replies to comments and DMs quickly and warmly.
Evening	Checks insights â€" notes reach, engagement, clicks and new followers.
Night	Fills in the monthly report with real numbers, what worked, what did not, and one recommendation.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "Did anyone write 'post the video' in the morning block? Why is that wrong?" (Posting is the last step â€" planning and creating come first.)
- After step 4: "What happens if the manager does not reply to comments?" (The client looks unresponsive; customers go elsewhere.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner writes "post" for every block â†' Prompt: "What must happen *before* the post can go live?"
- Learner leaves the midday block blank â†' Prompt: "Who sees the caption before the public does? Why?"
- Learner writes "buy followers" in any block â†' Stop and correct immediately. Remind the class of the ethics rule: no fake growth, ever.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ All five time blocks filled with realistic tasks
- ☐ The morning block shows planning and creating â€" not posting
- ☐ The midday block shows client approval
- ☐ The afternoon block shows posting and engaging
- ☐ The evening and night blocks show measuring and reporting
- ☐ No block mentions buying followers or faking numbers

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Build a **services and packages menu** for a new fictional client â€" *Glamour Touch Salon*, a hair and beauty salon in Port Harcourt â€" using the three-tier package structure from the lecture.

Scenario. *Glamour Touch Salon* does braids, weaves, natural hair care and make-up. It has 800 Instagram followers and posts rarely. The owner, "Aunty Funke," wants more bookings â€" people should see the salon's work, call to book, and find the salon

on Instagram. She can afford a small monthly budget. She does not want fake followers â€" she tried that before and it brought no customers.

Requirements:

1. Design **three packages** â€" Starter, Growth and Full Management â€" for the salon.
2. For each package, list: **what is included** (at least three services), **how often** (posts per week, reply frequency), and a **realistic monthly price in naira**.
3. Write **one sentence** for each package explaining who it is for (a new manager's first client, a growing salon, a busy salon that wants full help).
4. Add **one line** at the bottom: what you would *not* do for this client, and why.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Three packages with clear names and different levels of service.
- Each package has at least three services, a frequency and a naira price.
- Prices are realistic for a small Port Harcourt salon (not â‚¦500,000, not â‚¦500).
- The "what I would not do" line shows an ethics rule (no fake followers, no fake reviews, no inflated reports).

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Look at the three-tier example in the lecture â€" Starter, Growth, Full Management. Use the same structure.
- Hint 2: A realistic Starter price for a small salon is between â‚¦15,000 and â‚¦25,000 per month.
- Hint 3: The "what I would not do" line can be: "I will not buy followers or fake reviews â€" they bring no customers and they break the client's trust."

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Glamour Touch Salon â€" Services and Packages Menu

Starter Package â€" â‚¦20,000/month

- 8 posts per month (2 per week) â€" photos of braids, weaves and make-up looks.
- Captions written and designed in Canva.
- Scheduling and posting on Instagram.
- Basic monthly report.
- *For:* a new manager's first client, or a small salon testing social media.

Growth Package â€" â‚¦40,000/month

- 12 posts per month (3 per week) â€" photos, one Reel, one carousel.
- Captions, graphics, scheduling and posting.
- Daily reply management â€" comments and DMs answered within a few hours.
- Monthly report with insights and one recommendation.
- *For:* a growing salon that wants more bookings and can afford daily engagement.

Full Management Package â€" â‚¦75,000/month

- 16 posts per month (4 per week) â€" photos, Reels, a carousel, a story series.
- All content, scheduling and posting.
- Daily community management with a 2-hour response target during business hours.
- Monthly report, one strategy review per month, and basic boost planning (with the client's written approval and budget).
- *For:* a busy salon that wants complete, professional management without lifting a finger.

What I would not do: I will not buy followers, likes or reviews, and I will not inflate the monthly report. Fake growth brings no customers, and a fake report will be caught the moment Aunty Funke checks her own insights. Honest work is the only sustainable business.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Three packages with clear names and different levels (2)
- Each package has at least three services (2)
- Each package has a frequency (posts per week, reply time) (2)

- Prices are realistic for a small salon (2)
- The "what I would not do" line shows an ethics rule (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Blessing's Bakeshop* is a small bakery in Rumuokwuta, Port Harcourt. It makes small chops, meat pies, cakes and doughnuts. The owner, Blessing, is an excellent baker but she is not online. Her Instagram page has 350 followers â€" mostly friends â€" and her last post was two months ago. She gets orders by word of mouth and a handwritten note at her gate. A friend told her she needs "social media," so she paid a young man â‚¦10,000 to "handle her page." He posted three times in one week, then disappeared. He also bought her 1,000 followers. The page now has 1,350 followers, still no orders, and Blessing feels cheated.

Relevant facts.

- Blessing's products are genuinely good â€" her small chops sell out every Saturday.
- The 1,000 followers bought for her are fake â€" they never like, comment or order.
- The young man posted three times in one week and nothing for the next two months.
- Blessing has no content calendar, no caption plan and no way to know if social media is working.
- She is willing to pay â‚¦25,000 a month for someone she can trust.

Decision point. What should Blessing do now â€" and what should a honest manager do differently from the young man?

Possible approaches.

1. **Abandon social media entirely** â€" "it does not work, I tried it."
2. **Hire another cheap person** and hope for better results.
3. **Hire a professional manager** who plans, creates, posts consistently, engages and reports honestly â€" and who refuses to buy followers.

Recommended solution. Approach 3 â€" but with a specific, honest plan. A good manager would:

- Start with a **strategy session**: who is Blessing's customer (students, families, event planners), which platform (Instagram, because the food is visual), and what is the goal (more WhatsApp orders).
- Set a **realistic cadence**: 3 posts a week â€" a small-chops photo, a behind-the-scenes video, a customer testimonial â€" not three posts in one week and silence.
- **Create real content**: phone photos of the small chops, a short video of the doughnut glaze, captions with prices and the WhatsApp order number.
- **Engage daily**: reply to every comment and DM within a few hours.
- **Report monthly**: real numbers â€" reach, engagement, DMs, orders â€" with honest insights.
- **Refuse fake growth**: explain clearly that the 1,000 fake followers are worthless and that real growth, though slower, is what actually brings orders.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is safe but leaves Blessing invisible â€" her competitors are online and she is not.
- Approach 2 is cheap but likely to repeat the same failure â€" no plan, no consistency, no honesty.
- Approach 3 costs more than â‚¦10,000, but it is the only approach that builds something real: a page that looks alive, a community that trusts her, and a manager who can prove the results.

Professional connection. This is exactly the situation a new manager will face â€" a client who has been burned and is suspicious. The manager's first job is not to post; it is to *rebuild trust*. That means honest pricing, a clear plan, consistent delivery and real numbers. A manager who does that will never lack work, because a satisfied small-business owner tells her friends.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Thinking "posting" is the whole job

Symptoms: Learner believes a manager's job is to post content and nothing else. **Likely cause:** They have only ever been a social media *user*, not a manager â€" they see posts, not the work behind them. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What happens before a post goes live? What happens after?" **Corrective steps:** Walk through the five tasks again â€" planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting. Emphasise that posting is one of five. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can list all five tasks and give an example of each. **Prevention:** Use the "Day in the Life" demonstration in every session.

K.2 Believing bought followers are a shortcut

Symptoms: Learner asks "but what if we just buy a few followers to start?" **Likely cause:** They have seen pages with big followings and assumed the following was bought â€" and that it worked. **How to investigate:** Ask: "If you buy 1,000 followers, how many of them will ever buy from the client?" (None â€" they are fake.) **Corrective steps:** Explain that fake followers inflate the client's expectations, make real results look small, and get pages flagged. Real growth is slower and worth more. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can explain why bought followers hurt the client. **Prevention:** Repeat the ethics line every session: *No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof.*

K.3 Quoting a price without knowing what it costs to deliver

Symptoms: Learner quotes â‚¦100,000 for a Full Management package they have never delivered. **Likely cause:** They want to earn big quickly and have not thought about the hours involved. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How many posts is that? How many hours will that take you? What is your hourly rate?" **Corrective steps:** Walk through the pricing table â€" Starter, Growth, Full Management â€" and the realistic naira ranges. Emphasise: start at the lower end, deliver well, raise prices as you build proof. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can justify a price with the work involved. **Prevention:** Discuss pricing honestly in every session; never let a learner quote without a reason.

K.4 Promising results the manager cannot guarantee

Symptoms: Learner says "I will get you 10,000 followers in one month" or "I will make your post go viral." **Likely cause:** They want to win the client and do not know what is realistic. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Can you control the algorithm? Can you guarantee a viral post?" (No.) **Corrective steps:** Teach honest promises: "I will post consistently, engage daily, and report real numbers. I cannot guarantee followers or virality â€" no honest manager can." **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can state an honest promise and an honest limit. **Prevention:** Repeat the honest-promise line in Session 1 and Session 9.

K.5 Ignoring the client's real business

Symptoms: Learner designs a beautiful page that brings no orders. **Likely cause:** They focused on looks, not on the client's goal â€" which is usually orders, bookings or calls. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is the client's business goal? Does this post move toward it?" **Corrective steps:** Connect every post to a goal. A jollof video is not just a video â€" it is a tool to get WhatsApp orders. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can state the client's goal and explain how a post serves it. **Prevention:** Always ask "what is the goal?" before "what should we post?"

K.6 Treating all platforms the same

Symptoms: Learner wants to be on all five platforms at once for every client. **Likely cause:** They think more platforms = more results. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Who is the client's customer? Where do they spend time?" **Corrective steps:** Teach platform choice by audience â€" one or two platforms with reasons, not five by default. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can choose one or two platforms for a client and explain why. **Prevention:** The platform survey (Section F.4) and Session 2's strategy work.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" ask the learner to explain their reasoning, not just their answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Services and Packages Menu"

Purpose: To practise turning the job of social media management into clear, priced, honest services â€" the first thing a real client will ask for â€" and to build the services-and-pricing section of the capstone proposal.

Realistic scenario. You are a new social media manager in Port Harcourt. A friend's aunt, *Aunty Rehoboth*, runs *Rehoboth's Kitchen* â€" a small restaurant in Rumuola that sells local meals (jollof, fried rice, plantain, fish) for pickup and delivery. She has

500 Instagram followers, posts rarely, and wants more WhatsApp orders. She can pay â‚¦30,000 a month. She has been burned before by someone who bought her fake followers, so she wants honesty above everything.

Detailed instructions:

1. Design **three packages** â€" Starter, Growth and Full Management â€" for Rehoboth's Kitchen.
2. For each package, list: **what is included** (at least three services), **how often** (posts per week, reply frequency), and a **realistic monthly price in naira**.
3. Write **one sentence** for each package explaining who it is for.
4. Add **one line** at the bottom: what you would *not* do for this client, and why.
5. Write **one short paragraph** (4â€"6 sentences) explaining to Aunty Rehoboth, in plain language, why honest social media management is worth â‚¦30,000 a month â€" without promising followers or virality.

Required deliverables:

- A services and packages menu (three packages with services, frequency and prices).
- The one-line ethics statement.
- The short paragraph to the client.

Submission format: Save as `ServicesMenu_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`) and upload to `/Social-Media-Management/Week1/ServicesMenu/`. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 2.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Three packages with clear names and levels	3	Starter, Growth, Full Management â€" clearly different levels
Services listed per package	4	At least three services per package, clearly described
Frequency stated	3	Posts per week and reply frequency for each package
Realistic naira pricing	4	Prices suit a small Port Harcourt restaurant; justified by the work
Ethics statement	3	Clear refusal of fake followers, fake reviews or inflated reports
Client paragraph	3	Plain, honest language; no false promises; explains the value

Common mistakes to avoid: copying the lecture's Taste of Rivers Kitchen prices without adjusting for the new client; promising followers or virality; quoting prices with no reason; forgetting the ethics line; writing a client paragraph full of jargon Aunty Rehoboth would not understand.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Rehoboth's Kitchen â€" Services and Packages Menu

Starter Package â€" â‚¦18,000/month

- 8 posts per month (2 per week) â€" photos of meals, one short video.
- Captions written and designed in Canva.
- Scheduling and posting on Instagram.
- Basic monthly report.
- *For:* a small restaurant testing social media with a modest budget.

Growth Package â€" â‚¦35,000/month

- 12 posts per month (3 per week) â€" photos, one Reel, one carousel.
- Captions, graphics, scheduling and posting.
- Daily reply management â€" comments and DMs answered within a few hours.
- Monthly report with insights and one recommendation.
- *For:* a growing restaurant that wants more WhatsApp orders and can afford daily engagement.

Full Management Package â€" â‚¦70,000/month

- 16 posts per month (4 per week) â€" photos, Reels, a carousel, a story series.

- All content, scheduling and posting.
- Daily community management with a 2-hour response target during business hours.
- Monthly report, one strategy review per month, and basic boost planning (with written approval and budget).
- *For:* a busy restaurant that wants complete, professional management.

What I would not do: I will not buy followers, likes or reviews, and I will not inflate the monthly report. Fake growth brings no customers, and a fake report will be caught the moment Aunty Rehoboth checks her own insights.

Paragraph to Aunty Rehoboth: "Aunty Rehoboth, social media management is worth â‚¦30,000 a month because it turns your Instagram page from a silent noticeboard into a working shop. I will post your meals three times a week, reply to every customer who messages you, and show you at the end of each month exactly how many people saw your page and how many became orders. I cannot promise you thousands of followers or a viral video â€" no honest person can. But I can promise you consistent, professional work and real numbers you can check. That is worth more than fake followers that never buy your food."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. In your own words, what is social media management?

Q2. List. Name the five core tasks of a social media manager.

Q3. Multiple choice. Which of these is the most realistic monthly price for a Starter package for a small Port Harcourt restaurant? a) â‚¦500 b) â‚¦5,000 c) â‚¦20,000 d) â‚¦500,000

Q4. Explain. A client expects "consistency" from their manager. What does consistency mean, and why does the client care?

Q5. Scenario. A client says: "Just buy me 2,000 followers and we are done." Write three sentences you would say to explain why you will not do that â€" and what you will do instead.

Q6. Matching. Match each platform to its main use: Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, X, LinkedIn. a) Short, fun, fast-moving video for discovery b) Photos, Reels and stories â€" visual and young c) Community, groups, events and older users d) Text, news, arguments and public conversation e) Professional networking, jobs and career branding

Q7. True or false. A manager should promise a client "10,000 followers in one month" to win the job.

Q8. Ethics. Name two things a social media manager must never do, according to the course ethics rules.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q8)

A1. Social media management is the job of running a business's or person's social media presence â€" planning what to post, creating the content, posting it on time, replying to the community, and reporting the results â€" so the owner can focus on their real work. (Accept any answer covering planning, creating, posting, engaging and reporting.)

A2. Planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting.

A3. (c) â‚¦20,000. (â‚¦500 and â‚¦5,000 are too low to sustain the work; â‚¦500,000 is far beyond a small restaurant's budget.)

A4. Consistency means posting regularly â€" not three posts in one day and nothing for three weeks. The client cares because a silent page looks closed, and consistency keeps the business visible and trusted.

A5. Model answer: "I will not buy followers because fake followers never buy your food â€" they only make your page look big while bringing zero customers. Instead, I will post your meals consistently, reply to every customer, and show you real numbers each month. That is how you get orders that actually pay you." (Accept any answer that refuses fake growth and offers honest work instead.)

A6. Instagram = (b); Facebook = (c); TikTok = (a); X = (d); LinkedIn = (e).

A7. False. No honest manager can guarantee followers or virality â€" the algorithm cannot be controlled. Promising it is dishonest and will destroy trust when it fails.

A8. Any two: buying followers/likes/views/comments/reviews; faking or inflating reports; posting a customer's private details without permission; reposting another creator's work without credit; creating fake accounts to praise or defend a client; arguing publicly with a commenter.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned what social media management really is. It is not "posting and hoping" â€" it is a management job built on five tasks: **planning, creating, posting, engaging and reporting**. You learned who hires a manager (small businesses, professionals, churches, event vendors, personal brands), what clients expect (consistency, prompt replies, professionalism, confidentiality and honest numbers), and what services a manager sells (content creation, scheduling, community management, reporting, basic paid promotion and strategy). You surveyed the five platforms and learned to choose them with reasons, not vibes. You learned realistic naira pricing for a small Port Harcourt client, and you learned the honest earning picture â€" one or two small clients is a realistic first goal. Finally, you met the ethics rules that make the job trustworthy: no fakes, no inflated numbers, real work, real results, real proof.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Social media management = planning, creating, posting, engaging and reporting** â€" five tasks, one job.
2. **Clients buy trust** â€" consistency, prompt replies, professionalism, confidentiality and honest numbers.
3. **Services are sold as packages** â€" Starter, Growth and Full Management â€" with realistic naira prices.
4. **Choose platforms by audience, not vibes** â€" one or two platforms with written reasons.
5. **Honesty is the business model** â€" no bought followers, no fake reviews, no inflated reports.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain what a social media manager does, in my own words?
- Can I list the five core tasks and give an example of each?
- Can I name three services a manager sells and a realistic price for each?
- Can I explain why a client cares about consistency and prompt replies?
- Can I state two ethics rules and explain why they protect the client?

Connection to the next session. You now know what the job is. But a manager who does not know *who* they are talking to is just posting into the dark. Next session we learn to think before posting: how to research an audience with free tools, set measurable goals, choose one or two platforms with written reasons, scan competitors, and write a positioning statement. You will build a complete strategy sheet for our running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" and that sheet becomes part of your capstone.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner defines social media management using the five tasks â€" not just "posting."
- Learner lists realistic services and prices without being prompted.
- Learner explains why a client cares about consistency and prompt replies.
- Learner refuses fake growth automatically and gives a reason.
- Learner connects the platform choice to the audience, not to fashion.
- Learner states honest earning expectations â€" no promises of followers or income.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Posting is the job." â†' No â€" posting is one of five tasks; the work is mostly before and after.
- "Bought followers are a shortcut." â†' They bring no customers and destroy trust.
- "More platforms = more results." â†' Choose one or two with reasons.
- "A certificate guarantees clients." â†' Proof and delivery get you hired; the certificate confirms the skill.
- "I can promise followers to win a client." â†' No honest manager can; the promise will fail and end the relationship.
- "Social media management is for people with big followings." â†' It is a phone-based skill anyone can learn.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Five-task matching drill:** give five scenarios (a silent page, a rude reply, a wrong price, a bad month, a new client) and ask the learner to name which task each one belongs to.

2. **Pricing justification drill:** give a package price and ask the learner to list the work that justifies it â€" posts per week, hours, services.
3. **Ethics scenario drill:** give three situations (a client asks for fake followers, a client asks you to hide a bad month, a competitor's post goes viral) and ask the learner what they would do and why.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed services menu â€" package names and one service each â€" and ask the learner to add the remaining services, frequencies and prices.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written â€" three full packages for a new client.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write a short "honest pitch" to a skeptical client who has been burned before â€" explaining, in plain language, what the manager will do, what they will not do, and why the client should trust them. The pitch must include one ethics rule and one realistic price.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners understanding the *role* and the *ethics* (Sections F.1â€"F.6). If the room is slow, shorten the platform survey (F.4) to a quick overview and protect the guided practical (Section H) â€" the ability to map the five tasks to a real day is the core skill. If the room is fast, extend the case study discussion and let learners present their services menus to the class.

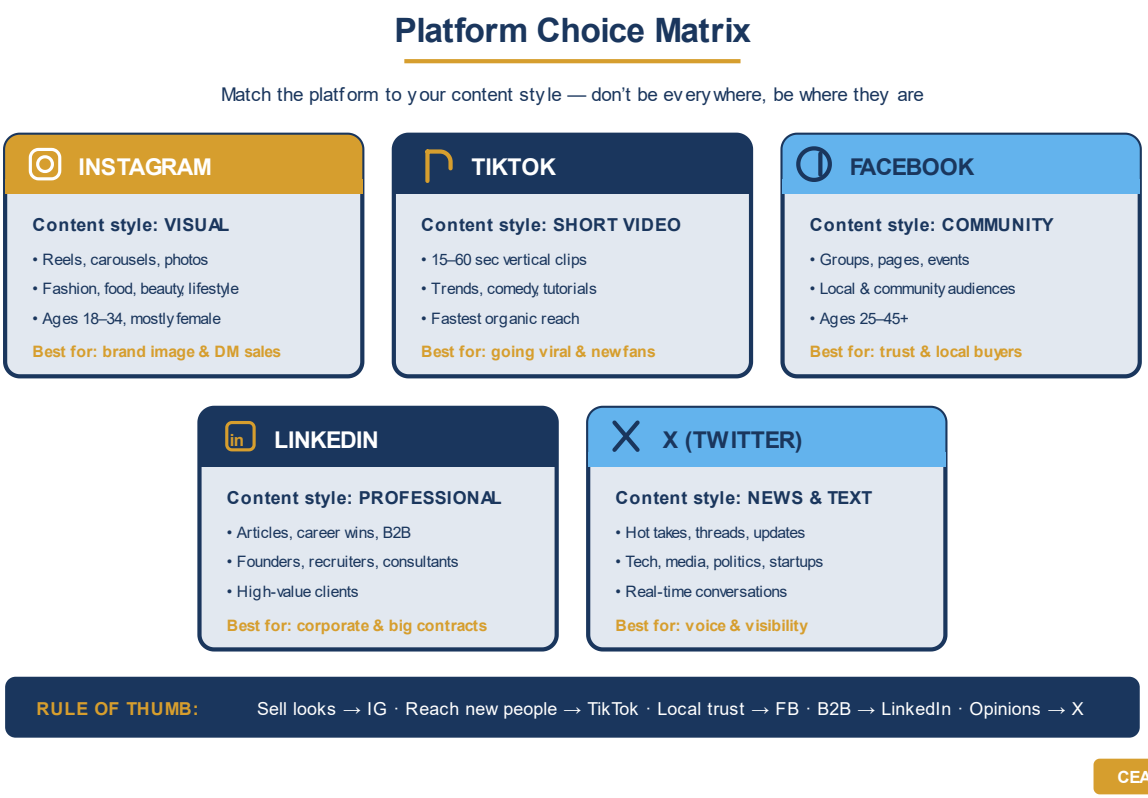
END OF SESSION 1

Next: Session 2 â€" Audience, Goals and Platform Strategy.

SESSION 02 OF 9

Audience Goals and Platform Strategy

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 02



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

SESSION 2 â€" AUDIENCE, GOALS AND PLATFORM STRATEGY

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	2 of 9
Session title	Audience, Goals and Platform Strategy
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Strategy
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with strategy)
Prerequisite knowledge	Session 1 â€" the learner can define social media management, list the five core tasks and explain the ethics rules. Everyday smartphone use assumed. No prior marketing or research

Item	Detail
	experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 1 we defined the job: planning, creating, posting, engaging and reporting. Today we do the *planning* properly â€" before anyone posts a single thing. We research the audience, set goals, choose platforms with reasons, scan competitors and write a positioning statement for our running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*.
Preparation before class	Projector connected and tested; the three fictional competitor pages (Section G) prepared as printed sheets or screenshots; the audience-profile worksheet (Section H) printed per learner; the goal-setting worksheet printed; the positioning-statement template printed; the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief available (from Session 1); a whiteboard for the live audience-profile build; academy Wi-Fi confirmed.

Running client reminder. *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" fictional small food business in Rumuola, Port Harcourt. Sells local meals (jollof, fried rice, small chops, plantain, fish) for pickup and delivery. Prices â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦8,000. Owner "Chef Nkechi" cooks with two assistants, takes orders on one WhatsApp line. Instagram and Facebook pages silent for three months. Wants consistent posting for 30 days and more WhatsApp orders â€" no advertising budget. Has been burned by someone who bought her fake followers.

Instructor note on tone. This session is where learners discover that strategy is not a big-word mystery â€" it is asking the right questions before posting. Keep the mood practical and confident. Many learners will want to skip to "what do I post?" â€" your job is to show them that the answers to *who, why and where* come first, and that skipping this step is why most small business pages fail.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why strategy comes before posting and what happens when a business skips it.
2. **Research** an audience using free methods (questions, observation, platform search) and write a simple audience profile that names a real obstacle â€" not "everyone."
3. **Set** two measurable goals using the SMART format and connect each goal to a specific action.
4. **Choose** one or two platforms for a client with written reasons tied to the audience and the goal.
5. **Run** a basic three-competitor scan and extract two useful lessons from it.
6. **Write** a one-sentence positioning statement that says who the client serves, what they offer and why they are different.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a notes app or Google Docs.
- Academy computers (one per learner or one per pair) for Google Sheets and research.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- A whiteboard or flipchart and markers.

Software

- A notes app on every phone (Google Keep, Samsung Notes, Apple Notes, or Google Docs).
- Google Sheets (free) for the competitor scan and the strategy sheet.
- Google Docs (free) for the positioning statement.
- The five free platforms (Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, X, LinkedIn) for the competitor scan â€" learners use their own accounts or browse without logging in.

Sample files

- **Three fictional competitor pages** (Section G) â€" prepared as printed sheets or screenshots. These are invented for the course: *Riverside Kitchen PH*, *Mama J's Small Chops*, and *The Hungry Student*. No real business is used.
- **Audience-profile worksheet** (Section H) â€" a blank table: *Who they are / Where they live / What they want / What stops them / Where they spend time online*.
- **Goal-setting worksheet** â€" a blank SMART goal table: *Goal / Specific / Measurable / Achievable / Relevant / Time-bound*.
- **Positioning-statement template** â€" a fill-in-the-blank sentence: "For [audience], [business] is the [category] that [benefit] because [reason]."

Worksheets

- Worksheet 2.1 â€" "Audience Profile Builder" (the audience-profile worksheet above).
- Worksheet 2.2 â€" "SMART Goal Setter" (the goal-setting worksheet above).
- Worksheet 2.3 â€" "Competitor Scan Sheet" (a table: *Platform / What they post / How often / What works / What I can do differently*).

Accounts

- Free social media accounts (from Session 1). No paid tools.

Internet

- Academy Wi-Fi for the competitor scan and research. If Wi-Fi fails, use the printed competitor sheets â€" the session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner without a device may work with a partner â€" one reads the competitor sheet, one records the observations. The skill today is *thinking*, not typing.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor: The competitor scan is a *learning* exercise. We look at what competitors post to learn â€" never to copy, never to attack, never to leave fake comments. Remind the class: we observe, we learn, we improve our own work. We do not impersonate, we do not spam, and we do not claim a competitor's content as our own.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two fictional Instagram pages side by side. Both are food businesses in Port Harcourt. Do not explain which is "better" yet.

Page A â€" "Random Posting Kitchen." The page has 1,200 followers. The last ten posts are: a random meme, a photo of the owner's car, a blurry photo of rice with no caption, a reposted news article, another meme, a photo of a wedding that has nothing to do with food, a blurry selfie, a "good morning" graphic, a photo of plantain with no price, and another meme. Posting times are random â€" 3 a.m., 11 p.m., 4 p.m. The bio says "We sell food."

Page B â€" "Planned Kitchen." The page has 800 followers. The last ten posts are: a clear jollof photo with price and order number, a 20-second reel of small chops being plated, a carousel of "3 reasons our jollof is different," a customer testimonial photo, a story asking "What should we cook this weekend?", a behind-the-scenes video of the kitchen, a fried rice photo with a weekend special price, a reel of plantain frying, a "how to order" graphic, and a customer repost with permission. Posting times are consistent â€" mostly 5 p.m. and 12 p.m. The bio says "Fresh local meals, delivered in Port Harcourt. Order on WhatsApp: 0803-XXX-XXXX."

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at these two pages. Page A has 1,200 followers. Page B has 800. Now tell me â€" which page would you order from? â€¦ Page B, by a mile. Why? Page A has more followers, but it looks like nobody is home. Page B looks like a real business that knows what it is doing. Here is the secret: Page B has fewer followers because it started later and has no money for ads. But it is winning â€" because someone planned it. Someone decided who they are talking to, what to post, where to post and why. That someone is a social media manager. Today you become that person."*

Expected learner response: Learners will point at Page B and say "it looks professional," "it has prices," "it looks like a real business," "Page A is just posting anything." Accept all answers. Draw out the difference: *planning vs. random posting*.

Then reveal the numbers: Say:

> *"Page A gets about 30 likes per post. Page B gets about 120 likes and 15 comments â€" and 5 of those comments become orders every week. Page B has half the followers and ten times the results. That is the power of strategy. And strategy is not a gift â€" it is a set of questions you can learn to ask. Let us learn them now."*

Why this opener works: It uses a visual, side-by-side comparison that makes the abstract idea of "strategy" concrete. Learners see immediately that planning beats random posting â€" and they want to know how to do it.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five core tasks of a social media manager?"

- Expected answer: Planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting.
- Common gap: learners mix up the order. Clarify: "Planning comes first â€" before you create anything."

Question 2: "What is the difference between a personal account and a business account?"

- Expected answer: A business account shows a category, a contact button and insights (numbers about who saw your post).
- Common gap: some learners have never switched. Say: "We will do that in Session 6. For now, just know: business accounts are free and they give you the numbers you need."

Question 3: "Name two things a client expects from a manager."

- Expected answer: Any two of â€" consistency, prompt replies, professionalism, confidentiality, honest numbers.
- Common gap: learners say "good content" or "more followers." Clarify: "Those are results. The expectations are about *how* you work â€" consistency, replies, professionalism, confidentiality, honest numbers."

Question 4: "Why must a manager never buy followers?"

- Expected answer: Fake followers never buy from the client, they inflate expectations, and they get the page flagged or banned.
- Common gap: learners think "a few fake followers won't hurt." Say: "Even a few â€" because the moment the client checks their insights and sees 2,000 followers but 3 likes, they know. Trust is gone."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"In Session 1 we learned the job. Today we learn the first task â€" planning. And planning starts with three questions: Who are we talking to? What are we trying to achieve? And where do these people spend time online? If you cannot answer those three questions, you are not ready to post. Let us learn to answer them properly."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 3 extra minutes writing the five tasks on the board with a one-line example of each before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why strategy comes before posting

The idea. Strategy is the plan that decides *who* you are talking to, *what* you are trying to achieve, *where* you will post and *why* each post exists. It comes before any content is created.

Plain-English definition. Strategy is thinking before posting. It is the difference between a page that looks like a real business and a page that looks like somebody's personal diary.

Why it exists. Most small business pages fail not because the food is bad or the product is poor â€" they fail because the owner posts randomly. A meme today, a blurry photo next week, a "good morning" graphic at 3 a.m. The page has no focus, no consistency and no connection to a goal. Customers scroll past because nothing speaks to them. Strategy fixes this by giving every post a reason to exist.

What happens without strategy:

- **Random posting** â€" no pattern, no focus, no goal.
- **Inconsistency** â€" three posts in one day, silence for three weeks.
- **Wrong audience** â€" posting student food content to a page followed by parents and professionals.
- **No measurement** â€" the owner cannot tell if the page is working because there is nothing to measure against.
- **Wasted effort** â€" hours of work that bring no orders, no bookings, no calls.

What happens with strategy:

- **Every post has a purpose** â€" it serves a goal and speaks to a specific audience.
- **Consistency** â€" a realistic cadence the business can sustain.
- **Right audience** â€" content that speaks to the people most likely to buy.
- **Clear measurement** â€" goals give you something to check against.
- **Efficient work** â€" no more guessing, no more wasted hours.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **market trader**. A trader who sets up her stall anywhere, sells anything, and changes her prices every hour will struggle. A trader who chooses the right corner, sells what the people passing want, keeps her prices clear and her stall open at the same time every day â€" that trader eats. Strategy is choosing the right corner and the right product before you open the stall.

Important limitation / misconception. Strategy is not a guarantee of success. A good strategy does not make a bad product sell. But a good strategy makes a good product *visible* to the right people â€" and that is the manager's job.

F.2 Researching the audience â€" who are we talking to?

The idea. The **audience** is the specific group of people most likely to buy from the client. Strategy starts by understanding them â€" not guessing, not assuming "everyone."

Plain-English definition. Audience research is finding out who your client's real customers are, what they want, what stops them from buying, and where they spend time online.

Why it exists. A page that tries to speak to everyone speaks to nobody. A jollof video aimed at "everyone" will not connect with a student looking for a cheap lunch, a mother ordering for a family, or a professional catering an event. But a page that knows its audience can speak directly to each group â€" and that is what gets orders.

Free research methods (no tools, no budget):

1. **Ask the client.** The owner knows their customers. Ask: "Who buys most often? What do they usually order? How old are they? Where do they live? What do they complain about?" Write down the answers.
2. **Ask the customers.** If the client has a WhatsApp chat list or regulars, ask a few: "Why do you order from us? What do you wish we did better? Where do you usually find food online?"
3. **Observe the platform.** Search the client's category on Instagram or Facebook. Look at the pages that are doing well. Who comments? What do they ask for? What do they complain about?
4. **Check the client's WhatsApp.** The order history is a goldmine. What is ordered most? At what times? From which areas?
5. **Use free platform search.** Type "Port Harcourt food" or "Rumuola restaurant" into Instagram or Facebook search. See what comes up, who posts it, and who engages.

The audience profile â€" a simple template. Once you have answers, write a profile. It does not need to be long â€" one page is enough. The key is that it names a *real obstacle*, not "everyone."

Profile element	Question to answer	Example (Taste of Rivers Kitchen)
Who they are	Age, role, situation	Students, young professionals, small families in Rumuola and GRA.
Where they live	Location	Port Harcourt â€" Rumuola, GRA, Rumuokwuta, Choba.
What they want	The benefit they are looking for	Fresh, hot, affordable local meals delivered fast.
What stops them	The real obstacle	They do not know the menu, the price, or that delivery exists.

Profile element	Question to answer	Example (Taste of Rivers Kitchen)
Where they spend time online	Platforms and habits	Instagram and Facebook, mostly 12 p.m. and 5â€“8 p.m.

The key lesson â€” name a real obstacle. A weak audience profile says "everyone in Port Harcourt loves food." A strong profile says "students and young professionals in Rumuola want fast, affordable local meals, but they do not know we deliver and they cannot find our menu online." The obstacle â€” *they do not know we deliver* â€” is what the content will solve.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **doctor's waiting room**. A doctor who treats "everyone" without asking what is wrong will give the same pill to every patient. A good doctor asks questions first â€” where does it hurt, how long, what have you tried â€” and then treats the actual problem. Audience research is the manager asking questions before prescribing content.

F.3 Setting measurable goals â€” what are we trying to achieve?

The idea. A **goal** is a specific, measurable result the client wants to achieve. Goals give the manager something to aim at and something to measure against.

Plain-English definition. A goal is a clear target â€” not "get more followers" but "get 30 WhatsApp orders in 30 days."

Why it exists. Without a goal, a manager cannot know if their work is working. "Post more" is not a goal â€” it is an activity. "Get 30 WhatsApp orders in 30 days" is a goal â€” it is specific, measurable and time-bound. Goals turn social media from a guessing game into a job with results.

The SMART goal format. A good goal is SMART:

Letter	Meaning	Example
S â€” Specific	Clear and precise, not vague	"Get WhatsApp orders" not "get more customers"
M â€” Measurable	You can count it	"30 orders" not "more orders"
A â€” Achievable	Realistic for a small business	30 orders in 30 days is realistic for a busy kitchen
R â€” Relevant	Connected to the real business goal	Orders are the business goal â€” not followers
T â€” Time-bound	Has a deadline	"In 30 days" not "someday"

Worked example â€” two goals for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

1. **Goal 1 (orders):** "Get 30 WhatsApp orders from social media in the next 30 days."
    - Specific: WhatsApp orders from social media.
    - Measurable: 30 orders.
    - Achievable: The kitchen already gets word-of-mouth orders; 30 from social media in a month is realistic.
    - Relevant: Orders are the business.
    - Time-bound: 30 days.
2. **Goal 2 (awareness):** "Reach 5,000 unique people on Instagram and Facebook in the next 30 days."
    - Specific: unique people reached on Instagram and Facebook.
    - Measurable: 5,000.
    - Achievable: With 3 posts a week and consistent engagement, 5,000 reach is realistic for a small page.
    - Relevant: Awareness supports orders â€” people cannot order from a page they have never seen.
    - Time-bound: 30 days.

The key lesson â€” connect every post to a goal. A post that does not serve a goal is a waste. Before posting, ask: "Does this post move us toward Goal 1 or Goal 2?" If the answer is no, do not post it â€” or change it so it does.

Common misconception. "Followers are a goal." No â€” followers are a *metric*, not a goal. A goal is a business result: orders, bookings, calls, visits. Followers matter only if they lead to the business result. A page with 10,000 followers and no orders is failing; a page with 500 followers and 30 orders a month is succeeding.

F.4 Choosing platforms â€” where do these people spend time?

The idea. A manager does not need to be on every platform. They need to choose one or two platforms where the client's audience actually spends time â€” and they need to be able to explain why.

Plain-English definition. Platform choice is deciding which social media platform(s) to use for a client, based on where the audience is and what the goal is â€" not on what is trendy.

Why it exists. A small business cannot be everywhere at once. A manager who tries to run Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, X and LinkedIn for a small client will do all of them badly. A manager who chooses one or two and does them well will get better results with less stress.

The platform choice process â€" three questions:

1. **Where does the audience spend time?** If the client's customers are students and young professionals, Instagram and TikTok. If they are parents and older customers, Facebook. If they are professionals and recruiters, LinkedIn.
2. **What format does the content need?** If the business is visual â€" food, fashion, beauty â€" Instagram or TikTok. If it is community and events â€" Facebook. If it is text and conversation â€" X.
3. **What can the business realistically sustain?** A kitchen with one phone and one person cannot make TikTok videos every day. It can post photos and short reels three times a week. Choose what is sustainable.

Worked example â€" platform choice for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

Question	Answer	Reasoning
Where is the audience?	Instagram and Facebook	Students and young professionals are on Instagram; families and older customers are on Facebook. Both are active in Port Harcourt.
What format does the content need?	Photos and short videos	Food is visual â€" photos of jollof, reels of small chops, stories of the kitchen.
What can the business sustain?	3 posts a week on Instagram, 3 on Facebook	One person with one phone can manage this. TikTok would be a stretch â€" save it for later.

Decision: Instagram (primary) and Facebook (secondary). TikTok is a future option once the kitchen has more content and more time.

The key lesson â€" write the reasons. A manager should never say "we are on Instagram because everyone is." They should say "we are on Instagram because our audience â€" students and young professionals in Port Harcourt â€" spends time there, and food content performs well in photos and reels." Written reasons make the choice professional and defensible.

Common misconception. "We need to be on TikTok because it is trendy." Maybe â€" but only if the audience is there and the business can sustain it. A trendy platform that does not fit the audience or the capacity is a waste of time.

F.5 Scanning competitors â€" what can we learn?

The idea. A **competitor scan** is a quick, honest look at three businesses similar to the client's â€" what they post, how often, what works and what does not. The goal is to learn, not to copy.

Plain-English definition. A competitor scan is studying three similar businesses to see what they do well, where they are weak, and how the client can do better.

Why it exists. Competitors are free research. They show you what the audience responds to, what content formats work, and where the gaps are â€" the things they do not do that the client can do better.

The three-competitor scan process:

1. **Choose three competitors.** Pick businesses that are similar to the client â€" same category, same area, same audience. Not the biggest brand in Nigeria â€" a realistic local competitor.
2. **Look at their last 10â€"15 posts.** What do they post? How often? What format â€" photos, videos, text?
3. **Note what works.** Which posts get the most likes, comments and shares? What do people say in the comments?
4. **Note what does not work.** Which posts get little response? What do they never post? What do customers complain about?
5. **Extract two lessons.** What can the client do better? What gap can the client fill?

Worked example â€" three fictional competitors for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

Competitor	What they post	How often	What works	What I can do differently
Riverside Kitchen PH	Photos of meals, no prices	3â€"4 times a week	Clear food photos	Add prices and order numbers to every post â€" make ordering easy.
Mama J's Small Chops	Reels of small chops, customer videos	Daily	Fun, fast reels	Post behind-the-scenes kitchen content â€" show the freshness and hygiene.
The Hungry Student	Memes, food photos, student discounts	5 times a week	Student-focused content	Target students with a specific "student meal" post â€" â‚¦1,000 jollof and plantain.

The key lesson â€" learn, do not copy. A competitor scan tells you what the audience wants and where the gaps are. It does not give you permission to copy captions, photos or ideas. The client's content must be original â€" that is what makes it worth following.

Ethics reminder. We scan competitors to learn â€" never to attack, never to leave fake comments, never to claim their content. We observe, we learn, we improve our own work.

F.6 Writing a positioning statement â€" who are we, and why us?

The idea. A **positioning statement** is one sentence that says who the client serves, what they offer and why they are different. It is the clearest possible answer to "why should someone choose this business?"

Plain-English definition. A positioning statement is a single sentence that captures what makes the client the right choice for their specific audience.

Why it exists. A positioning statement keeps the manager focused. Every post, every caption, every decision can be checked against it: "Does this fit who we are and why we are different?" If not, it does not belong on the page.

The positioning-statement template:

> *"For [audience], [business] is the [category] that [benefit] because [reason]."*

Worked example â€" Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

> *"For students and young professionals in Port Harcourt, Taste of Rivers Kitchen is the local meals spot that delivers fresh, hot jollof and small chops to your door in 45 minutes because we cook every morning and deliver ourselves."*

Break it down:

- **Audience:** students and young professionals in Port Harcourt.
- **Category:** local meals spot.
- **Benefit:** delivers fresh, hot jollof and small chops to your door in 45 minutes.
- **Reason:** we cook every morning and deliver ourselves.

The key lesson â€" be specific. A weak positioning statement says "we sell good food." A strong one says "we deliver fresh, hot jollof to your door in 45 minutes because we cook every morning." The specific version tells the customer exactly why to choose you â€" and it gives the manager something to post about.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **bus conductor** who calls out "Ojuelegba! Ojuelegba! Ojuelegba!" â€" that is not positioning. A conductor who calls out "Ojuelegba! Last bus! Air-conditioned! Leaving now!" â€" that is positioning. He tells you the destination, the benefit and the urgency. A positioning statement does the same for the client.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **Strategy comes before posting** â€" thinking before posting is the difference between a real business page and a personal diary.
- **Audience research** finds out who the real customers are, what they want, what stops them and where they spend time online â€" using free methods: asking the client, asking customers, observing the platform, checking WhatsApp and using free search.

- **A good audience profile names a real obstacle** â€" not "everyone."
- **Goals are SMART** â€" Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound â€" and every post connects to a goal.
- **Platform choice is based on the audience and the goal** â€" one or two platforms with written reasons, not five by default.
- **A competitor scan** looks at three similar businesses to learn what works and where the gaps are â€" never to copy.
- **A positioning statement** is one sentence that says who the client serves, what they offer and why they are different.

Key concept diagram:

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flowchart LR
    A[Who is your audience?] --> B{Age & interest?}
    B -->|Young, visual| C[Instagram + TikTok]
    B -->|Professional| D[LinkedIn]
    B -->|Community, older| E[Facebook]
    B -->|News, opinions| F[X/Twitter]
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G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through a complete strategy build for the running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" audience profile, two SMART goals, platform choice, competitor scan and positioning statement â€" so learners see how the pieces fit together.

Setup: On the projector, show a blank strategy sheet with five sections: Audience Profile / Goals / Platform Choice / Competitor Scan / Positioning Statement. Have the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief visible.

G.1 Demonstration 1 â€" Build the audience profile live (4 minutes)

Say: "We know Chef Nkechi's business. Now let us find her audience. I will ask the questions a manager asks â€" and you call out the answers."

Walk through the profile:

Question	Instructor writes on the board
Who buys most often?	"Students, young professionals, small families."
Where do they live?	"Rumuola, GRA, Rumuokwuta, Choba â€" all within delivery range."
What do they want?	"Fresh, hot, affordable local meals â€" fast."
What stops them?	"They do not know we deliver, they cannot find our menu, they do not know the price."
Where do they spend time online?	"Instagram and Facebook, mostly 12 p.m. and 5â€"8 p.m."

Say: "Now look at that. We are not saying 'everyone in Port Harcourt.' We are saying 'students and young professionals in Rumuola and GRA who want fast, affordable local meals but do not know we deliver.' That is an audience. And look at the obstacle â€" *they do not know we deliver.* That is what our content will fix."

G.2 Demonstration 2 â€" Set two SMART goals (3 minutes)

Say: "Now we set goals. Not 'get more followers' â€" real goals."

Write on the board:

> ***Goal 1:*** *Get 30 WhatsApp orders from social media in the next 30 days.* ***Goal 2:*** *Reach 5,000 unique people on Instagram and Facebook in the next 30 days.*

Check each goal against SMART:

- **Specific?** Yes â€" WhatsApp orders from social media; unique people reached on Instagram and Facebook.
- **Measurable?** Yes â€" 30 orders; 5,000 people.
- **Achievable?** Yes â€" the kitchen already gets word-of-mouth orders; 30 from social media in a month is realistic. 5,000 reach is realistic with 3 posts a week.

- **Relevant?** Yes â€" orders are the business; awareness supports orders.
- **Time-bound?** Yes â€" 30 days.

Say: "Every post we make will serve one of these two goals. If a post does not help us get orders or reach people, we do not post it. That is how goals keep us focused."

G.3 Demonstration 3 â€" Choose platforms with reasons (3 minutes)

Say: "Now â€" where do we post? Not everywhere. Let us choose."

Walk through the three questions:

1. **Where is the audience?** "Students and young professionals are on Instagram. Families and older customers are on Facebook. Both are active in Port Harcourt."
2. **What format does the content need?** "Food is visual â€" photos of jollof, reels of small chops, stories of the kitchen."
3. **What can the business sustain?** "One person, one phone. Three posts a week on Instagram and three on Facebook is sustainable. TikTok would be a stretch â€" we save it for later."

Write the decision on the board:

> ***Platform choice:*** *Instagram (primary) and Facebook (secondary).* ***Reasons:*** *Our audience is there; food content works in photos and reels; 3 posts a week on each is sustainable for one person with one phone.*

Say: "Notice â€" I did not say 'because TikTok is trendy.' I said 'because our audience is there and we can sustain it.' That is a professional reason."

G.4 Demonstration 4 â€" Run a quick competitor scan (3 minutes)

Say: "Now let us learn from competitors. I have three fictional pages. Let us scan them."

Show the three competitor sheets (Riverside Kitchen PH, Mama J's Small Chops, The Hungry Student) and walk through the scan:

Competitor	What works	What I can do differently
Riverside Kitchen PH	Clear food photos	Add prices and order numbers â€" make ordering easy.
Mama J's Small Chops	Fun, fast reels	Post behind-the-scenes kitchen content â€" show freshness.
The Hungry Student	Student-focused content	Target students with a specific "student meal" post.

Say: "We are not copying them. We are learning. They show us what the audience wants â€" clear photos, fast reels, student content. And they show us the gaps â€" no prices, no behind-the-scenes, no specific student offer. That is where we win."

G.5 Demonstration 5 â€" Write the positioning statement (2 minutes)

Say: "Last piece â€" the positioning statement. One sentence that says who we are and why us."

Write on the board:

> *"For students and young professionals in Port Harcourt, Taste of Rivers Kitchen is the local meals spot that delivers fresh, hot jollof and small chops to your door in 45 minutes because we cook every morning and deliver ourselves."*

Break it down:

- **Audience:** students and young professionals in Port Harcourt.
- **Category:** local meals spot.
- **Benefit:** delivers fresh, hot jollof and small chops to your door in 45 minutes.
- **Reason:** we cook every morning and deliver ourselves.

Say: "That one sentence will guide every post we make. If a post does not fit that sentence, it does not belong on the page. That is strategy."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What is the obstacle we named in the audience profile?" (They do not know we deliver.)
- "Which goal does a jollof video serve?" (Both â€" it reaches people and it can get orders.)
- "Why did we choose Instagram and Facebook, not TikTok?" (Audience and sustainability.)
- "What is one thing we learned from the competitors?" (Any â€" prices, behind-the-scenes, student content.)

Expected result: Learners see the five strategy pieces as one connected plan â€" audience, goals, platforms, competitors, positioning â€" and they see that each piece answers a specific question.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner completes a full strategy sheet for a new fictional client â€" *Chinedu's Barbershop* â€" covering audience profile, two SMART goals, platform choice, competitor scan and positioning statement.

Starting materials: The printed strategy sheet (five sections), the Chinedu's Barbershop client brief (below), a pen. No phone needed for the first part â€" it is a thinking exercise.

CLIENT BRIEF â€" CHINEDU'S BARBERSHOP (fictional). *Chinedu's Barbershop* is a small barbershop in Rumuokuta, Port Harcourt. It offers haircuts, beard trims, and kids' haircuts. Prices run from â‚¦1,000 for a basic cut to â‚¦3,000 for a premium cut with beard trim. The shop has 600 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Chinedu is good with customers but he is not online. He wants more walk-in customers â€" people should see his work, know his prices, and find his shop. He can pay â‚¦20,000 a month. He does not want fake followers.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name at the top of the strategy sheet. Read the client brief once.
2. **Audience profile.** Fill in the five rows: Who they are / Where they live / What they want / What stops them / Where they spend time online. Name a real obstacle â€" not "everyone."
3. **Two SMART goals.** Write two goals â€" one for walk-in customers, one for awareness. Check each against SMART: Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound.
4. **Platform choice.** Choose one or two platforms. Write the reasons â€" where the audience is, what format the content needs, what the business can sustain.
5. **Competitor scan.** Look at the three competitor sheets (provided by the instructor â€" *Sharp Cuts PH*, *The Gentleman's Chair*, *Kiddie Kuts*). For each, note what works and what you can do differently.
6. **Positioning statement.** Write one sentence using the template: "For [audience], [business] is the [category] that [benefit] because [reason]."
7. **Pause and predict:** Cover your sheet and ask yourself: "If I post a photo of a fresh haircut, which goal does it serve?" Write your answer at the bottom.
8. Compare your sheet with the person beside you. If you chose different platforms, explain your reasons.

Expected result (model answers â€" instructor key):

Audience profile:

- Who they are: Men and boys in Rumuokuta â€" students, young professionals, fathers.
- Where they live: Rumuokuta, Rumuoma, Choba â€" within walking or short driving distance.
- What they want: A clean, fresh haircut at a fair price â€" fast.
- What stops them: They do not know the prices, they do not see examples of Chinedu's work, they do not know the shop's location.
- Where they spend time online: Instagram and Facebook, mostly evenings and weekends.

Two SMART goals:

- Goal 1: Get 20 new walk-in customers from social media in the next 30 days.
- Goal 2: Reach 3,000 unique people on Instagram in the next 30 days.

Platform choice:

- Instagram (primary) and Facebook (secondary).
- Reasons: Men and boys in Rumuokuta are on Instagram; haircut work is visual â€" photos and short videos; 3 posts a week on each is sustainable for one person with one phone.

Competitor scan (example):

- Sharp Cuts PH: posts clear before/after photos â€" works well. I can do the same but add prices to every post.
- The Gentleman's Chair: posts beard trim videos â€" works well. I can post a weekly "beard of the week" photo.
- Kiddie Kuts: posts kids' haircut photos â€" works well. I can post a "kids' cut" special to attract fathers.

Positioning statement:

- "For men and boys in Rumuokuta, Chinedu's Barbershop is the barbershop that gives you a clean, fresh cut at a fair price because we have been cutting hair in this community for five years."

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "What obstacle did you name? Is it specific â€" or did you write 'everyone'?"
- After step 4: "Why did you choose that platform? Can you give a reason â€" not just 'it is popular'?"
- After step 6: "Read your positioning statement. Does it say who, what and why â€" or is it just 'we sell good haircuts'?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner writes "everyone" as the audience â†' Prompt: "Who actually walks into a barbershop? Men and boys. Where do they live? What do they want?"
- Learner sets a goal of "get 1,000 followers" â†' Prompt: "Is that a business goal? What does Chinedu actually want? Walk-in customers. How can we measure that?"
- Learner chooses all five platforms â†' Prompt: "Can one person with one phone sustain five platforms? What can Chinedu realistically manage?"
- Learner copies a competitor's caption â†' Prompt: "We scan to learn, not to copy. What can you do differently?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Audience profile names a real obstacle â€" not "everyone"
- ☐ Two goals written in SMART format
- ☐ Each goal is connected to the business â€" not just followers
- ☐ One or two platforms chosen with written reasons
- ☐ Competitor scan completed for three competitors
- ☐ Positioning statement written with audience, category, benefit and reason
- ☐ The pause-and-predict answer connects a post to a goal

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Build a complete strategy sheet for a third fictional client â€" *Adaeze's Fashion* â€" without copying the instructor's Taste of Rivers Kitchen or Chinedu's Barbershop examples.

Scenario. *Adaeze's Fashion* is a small fashion business in Port Harcourt that sells ankara dresses, ready-to-wear outfits and does custom sewing. Prices run from â‚¦5,000 for a simple dress to â‚¦30,000 for a custom ankara gown. The business has 900 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Adaeze is a skilled tailor but she is not online. She wants more customers â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and order from her. She can pay â‚¦35,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Requirements:

1. Write an **audience profile** â€" five rows, naming a real obstacle.
2. Set **two SMART goals** â€" one for orders, one for awareness.
3. Choose **one or two platforms** with written reasons.
4. Run a **competitor scan** â€" three fictional competitors: *Naija Threads PH*, *The Ankara Queen*, *Stitch by B*. For each, note what works and what you can do differently.
5. Write a **positioning statement** â€" one sentence with audience, category, benefit and reason.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Audience profile names a real obstacle â€" not "everyone."
- Two goals in SMART format, connected to the business.

- One or two platforms chosen with written reasons.
- Competitor scan completed for three competitors.
- Positioning statement with all four parts.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the audience, think â€" who buys ankara dresses? Women, students, professionals, event planners. Where do they live? What do they want? What stops them?
- Hint 2: For the goals, think â€" what does Adaeze actually want? Orders. How can we measure that? How many orders in how many days?
- Hint 3: For the positioning statement, use the template: "For [audience], [business] is the [category] that [benefit] because [reason]."

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Audience profile:

- Who they are: Women in Port Harcourt â€" students, young professionals, event planners, mothers.
- Where they live: Port Harcourt â€" Rumuola, GRA, Rumuokwuta, Choba, Diobu.
- What they want: Beautiful, well-fitted ankara dresses and custom outfits at a fair price.
- What stops them: They do not see examples of Adaeze's work, they do not know her prices, they do not know she does custom sewing.
- Where they spend time online: Instagram and Facebook, mostly evenings and weekends.

Two SMART goals:

- Goal 1: Get 15 dress orders from social media in the next 30 days.
- Goal 2: Reach 4,000 unique people on Instagram in the next 30 days.

Platform choice:

- Instagram (primary) and Facebook (secondary).
- Reasons: Women in Port Harcourt are on Instagram; fashion is visual â€" photos and reels of dresses; 3 posts a week on each is sustainable for one person with one phone.

Competitor scan:

- Naija Threads PH: posts clear dress photos with prices â€" works well. I can do the same but add a "custom order" post to show Adaeze's sewing skill.
- The Ankara Queen: posts reels of dresses on models â€" works well. I can post a weekly "dress of the week" reel.
- Stitch by B: posts behind-the-sewing content â€" works well. I can post a "from fabric to finished dress" video to show the craft.

Positioning statement:

- "For women in Port Harcourt, Adaeze's Fashion is the fashion shop that makes beautiful, well-fitted ankara dresses and custom outfits at a fair price because Adaeze has been sewing for eight years and every dress is made to fit you."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Audience profile names a real obstacle (2)
- Two goals in SMART format, connected to the business (2)
- One or two platforms chosen with written reasons (2)
- Competitor scan completed for three competitors (2)
- Positioning statement with all four parts (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Mama Put's Rice and Beans* is a small food business in Diobu, Port Harcourt. It sells rice, beans, plantain and fish â€" a full plate for â‚¦1,200. The owner, Mama Put, is a excellent cook but she is not online. Her daughter created an Instagram page two years ago and posted a few times, then stopped. The page has 200 followers â€" mostly family. Mama Put gets orders by word of mouth and a regular customer who calls to place bulk orders for events. She wants more customers â€" especially

students and office workers near Diobu. She can pay â‚¦15,000 a month. She has never heard of "strategy" and does not know what a "content pillar" is.

Relevant facts.

- Mama Put's food is genuinely good â€” her rice and beans sell out by 2 p.m. most days.
- The Instagram page has 200 followers, no posts in eight months, and the bio says "We sell food."
- Mama Put's daughter posted a few blurry photos with no prices and no order information.
- The business is near a busy market and several offices â€” students and office workers pass by every day.
- Mama Put does not have a smartphone â€” her daughter has one and helps with the page.

Decision point. A new social media manager has been hired. What should the manager do first â€” and what should they avoid?

Possible approaches.

1. **Post immediately** â€” "let us start posting today, we will figure it out as we go."
2. **Buy followers first** â€” "let us get the page to look popular, then post."
3. **Build a strategy first** â€” research the audience, set goals, choose platforms, scan competitors and write a positioning statement â€” then post.

Recommended solution. Approach 3 â€” strategy first. The manager should:

- **Research the audience:** Who buys from Mama Put? Students and office workers near Diobu. What do they want? A fast, affordable, filling lunch. What stops them? They do not know the menu, the price or that the business is there.
- **Set two SMART goals:** Get 20 new customers from social media in 30 days; reach 2,000 unique people on Instagram in 30 days.
- **Choose platforms:** Instagram (primary) â€” because students and office workers are there, and food is visual. Facebook (secondary) â€” because some office workers and older customers are there.
- **Scan competitors:** Look at three other food businesses near Diobu. What do they post? What works? What can Mama Put do differently?
- **Write a positioning statement:** "For students and office workers in Diobu, Mama Put's Rice and Beans is the food spot that serves a full, hot plate of rice and beans for â‚¦1,200 because we cook fresh every morning and we are right here in Diobu."
- **Then post:** Three times a week â€” a clear photo of the rice and beans with the price, a short video of the food being served, a "how to order" graphic with the phone number.

What the manager should avoid:

- **Posting randomly** â€” no plan, no goal, no consistency.
- **Buying followers** â€” fake followers bring no customers and break trust.
- **Using jargon with Mama Put** â€” she does not know "content pillars" or "engagement rate." The manager must explain in plain language.
- **Promising results** â€” "I will get you 1,000 followers" is a lie. "I will post consistently, engage daily, and show you real numbers" is honest.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is fast but wastes time â€” posting without a plan brings no results and frustrates the client.
- Approach 2 is cheap but destructive â€” fake followers make the page look big while bringing zero customers.
- Approach 3 takes a few hours of work before the first post, but it sets up a month of focused, effective content â€” and it gives the manager a way to prove the results.

Professional connection. This is exactly what a professional manager does â€” and it is what separates a professional from someone who "just posts." A professional does not guess. A professional asks questions, writes a plan, and then executes. That is why a professional can charge â‚¦15,000 a month and a "poster" cannot.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Skipping strategy and posting immediately

Symptoms: Learner wants to post before researching the audience or setting goals. **Likely cause:** They think strategy is a waste of time â€" "just post and see what happens." **How to investigate:** Ask: "Who are you posting for? What goal does this post serve?" **Corrective steps:** Walk through the strategy process â€" audience, goals, platforms, competitors, positioning. Show that a few hours of planning saves days of wasted posting. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can explain why strategy comes before posting. **Prevention:** Always ask "what is the goal?" before "what should we post?"

K.2 Writing "everyone" as the audience

Symptoms: Audience profile says "everyone in Port Harcourt" or "all Nigerians." **Likely cause:** The learner has not thought about who actually buys from the client. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Who walks into the shop? Who calls to order? What do they have in common?" **Corrective steps:** Use the five-row profile template â€" who, where, what they want, what stops them, where they spend time online. Name a real obstacle. **How to confirm resolved:** The profile names a specific group and a specific obstacle. **Prevention:** Remind the class â€" a page that speaks to everyone speaks to nobody.

K.3 Setting vague goals

Symptoms: Goals say "get more followers" or "increase engagement." **Likely cause:** The learner does not know how to make a goal measurable. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How will you know if you achieved it? What number? By when?" **Corrective steps:** Use the SMART format â€" Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound. Turn "get more followers" into "reach 5,000 unique people in 30 days." **How to confirm resolved:** Each goal has a number and a deadline. **Prevention:** Check every goal against SMART before accepting it.

K.4 Choosing platforms by trend, not by audience

Symptoms: Learner chooses TikTok because "it is trendy" even when the audience is not there. **Likely cause:** They think more platforms = more results. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Where does the client's customer spend time? Can the business sustain this platform?" **Corrective steps:** Use the three-question process â€" where is the audience, what format does the content need, what can the business sustain. **How to confirm resolved:** The platform choice has written reasons tied to the audience and the goal. **Prevention:** Always ask "why this platform?" before "should we be on it?"

K.5 Copying competitors instead of learning from them

Symptoms: Learner copies a competitor's caption, photo style or content idea. **Likely cause:** They think copying is the same as learning. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did you change anything? Is this original content?" **Corrective steps:** Explain the difference â€" we scan to learn what works and where the gaps are, but the client's content must be original. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain what they learned and what they will do differently. **Prevention:** Remind the class â€" we observe, we learn, we improve our own work. We never copy.

K.6 Writing a vague positioning statement

Symptoms: Positioning statement says "we sell good food" or "we are the best." **Likely cause:** The learner has not thought about what makes the client different. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Why should someone choose this business over the one next door?" **Corrective steps:** Use the template â€" "For [audience], [business] is the [category] that [benefit] because [reason]." Make it specific. **How to confirm resolved:** The statement names the audience, the benefit and the reason. **Prevention:** A weak positioning statement is a sign the learner does not yet understand the client â€" go back to the audience profile.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" ask the learner to explain their reasoning, not just their answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Client Strategy Sheet â€" Audience, Goals and Platforms"

Purpose: To practise building a complete strategy for a real small business â€" the core planning skill of social media management â€" and to produce the strategy summary that goes into the capstone proposal.

Realistic scenario. You are a social media manager in Port Harcourt. A friend's uncle, *Mr. Okafor*, runs *Okafor's Electronics* â€" a small phone and accessories shop in Rumuokwuta. The shop sells phones, chargers, earphones, power banks and phone accessories. Prices run from â‚¦500 for a charger to â‚¦80,000 for a phone. The shop has 400 Instagram followers and posts rarely.

Mr. Okafor is good with customers but he is not online. He wants more customers â€" people should see his products, know his prices, and visit his shop. He can pay â‚¦25,000 a month. He does not want fake followers.

Detailed instructions:

1. Write an **audience profile** â€" five rows: Who they are / Where they live / What they want / What stops them / Where they spend time online. Name a real obstacle â€" not "everyone."
2. Set **two SMART goals** â€" one for shop visits or sales, one for awareness. Check each against SMART.
3. Choose **one or two platforms** with written reasons â€" where the audience is, what format the content needs, what the business can sustain.
4. Run a **competitor scan** â€" three fictional competitors: *Gadget Hub PH*, *The Phone Doctor*, *Accessory World*. For each, note what works and what you can do differently.
5. Write a **positioning statement** â€" one sentence with audience, category, benefit and reason.
6. Write **one short paragraph** (4â€"6 sentences) explaining to Mr. Okafor, in plain language, why this strategy will bring him more customers â€" without promising followers or virality.

Required deliverables:

- A complete strategy sheet (audience profile, two goals, platform choice, competitor scan, positioning statement).
- The short paragraph to the client.

Submission format: Save as `StrategySheet_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`) and upload to `/Social-Media-Management/Week1/StrategySheet/`. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 3.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Audience profile with real obstacle	3	Five rows filled; names a specific group and a specific obstacle
Two SMART goals	4	Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound; connected to the business
Platform choice with reasons	3	One or two platforms; written reasons tied to audience and goal
Competitor scan	4	Three competitors; what works and what to do differently
Positioning statement	3	One sentence with audience, category, benefit and reason
Client paragraph	3	Plain, honest language; no false promises; explains the value

Common mistakes to avoid: writing "everyone" as the audience; setting vague goals like "get more followers"; choosing platforms by trend; copying competitors; writing a vague positioning statement; using jargon Mr. Okafor would not understand.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Okafor's Electronics â€" Strategy Sheet

Audience profile:

- Who they are: Students, young professionals and families in Rumuokwuta and nearby areas.
- Where they live: Rumuokwuta, Choba, Rumuola, GRA â€" within short driving distance.
- What they want: Quality phones and accessories at fair prices â€" with trust.
- What stops them: They do not know the shop's prices, they do not see examples of the products, they do not know the shop exists.
- Where they spend time online: Instagram and Facebook, mostly evenings and weekends.

Two SMART goals:

- Goal 1: Get 25 new customers from social media in the next 30 days.
- Goal 2: Reach 3,500 unique people on Instagram in the next 30 days.

Platform choice:

- Instagram (primary) and Facebook (secondary).

- Reasons: Students and young professionals are on Instagram; phones and accessories are visual â€" photos and short videos; 3 posts a week on each is sustainable for one person with one phone.

Competitor scan:

- Gadget Hub PH: posts clear product photos with prices â€" works well. I can do the same but add a "product of the week" post to highlight one item.
- The Phone Doctor: posts phone repair tips â€" works well. I can post a "tip of the week" to build trust and show expertise.
- Accessory World: posts customer reviews â€" works well. I can post a "customer pick" photo with permission.

Positioning statement:

- "For students and young professionals in Rumuokwuta, Okafor's Electronics is the phone shop that sells quality phones and accessories at fair prices because we have been in this community for six years and we stand behind every product we sell."

Paragraph to Mr. Okafor: "Mr. Okafor, this strategy will bring you more customers because it turns your Instagram page from a silent noticeboard into a working shop. I will post your products three times a week with clear prices, reply to every customer who messages you, and show you at the end of each month exactly how many people saw your page and how many became customers. I cannot promise you thousands of followers or a viral video â€" no honest person can. But I can promise you consistent, professional work and real numbers you can check. That is how you get customers that actually walk into your shop."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. Why does strategy come before posting?

Q2. List. Name the five rows of an audience profile.

Q3. Multiple choice. Which of these is a SMART goal? a) "Get more followers." b) "Reach 5,000 unique people on Instagram in the next 30 days." c) "Post more often." d) "Be the best food business in Port Harcourt."

Q4. Explain. What is a real obstacle in an audience profile, and why is it important?

Q5. Scenario. A client says: "Let us be on TikTok because it is trendy." The client's customers are mostly parents and professionals over 40. Write two sentences explaining why TikTok may not be the right choice.

Q6. Matching. Match each platform to its main use: Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, X, LinkedIn. a) Short, fun, fast-moving video for discovery b) Photos, Reels and stories â€" visual and young c) Community, groups, events and older users d) Text, news, arguments and public conversation e) Professional networking, jobs and career branding

Q7. True or false. A competitor scan means copying a competitor's captions and photos.

Q8. Fill in the blank. Complete the positioning statement template: "For [***],*** ***[***] is the [***]*** ***that*** ***[***] because [_____]."

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q8)

A1. Strategy comes before posting because thinking before posting is the difference between a real business page and a personal diary. Without strategy, a business posts randomly â€" no focus, no consistency, no connection to a goal. Strategy gives every post a reason to exist.

A2. Who they are / Where they live / What they want / What stops them / Where they spend time online.

A3. (b) "Reach 5,000 unique people on Instagram in the next 30 days." (It is Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant and Time-bound. The others are vague.)

A4. A real obstacle is the specific thing that stops the audience from buying â€" for example, "they do not know we deliver" or "they cannot find our menu." It is important because it tells the manager what the content must solve. A page that does not address the real obstacle will not get orders.

A5. Model answer: "TikTok may not be the right choice because your customers are mostly parents and professionals over 40, and they are more likely to be on Facebook. Also, TikTok requires frequent video content, which may be hard to sustain. Let us choose the platform where your customers actually spend time." (Accept any answer that questions the platform choice based on the audience.)

A6. Instagram = (b); Facebook = (c); TikTok = (a); X = (d); LinkedIn = (e).

A7. False. A competitor scan means studying what competitors do to learn what works and where the gaps are â€" never to copy. The client's content must be original.

A8. "For [audience], [business] is the [category] that [benefit] because [reason]."

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that strategy comes before posting. You learned to research an audience with free methods â€" asking the client, asking customers, observing the platform, checking WhatsApp and using free search â€" and to write an audience profile that names a real obstacle, not "everyone." You learned to set SMART goals â€" Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound â€" and to connect every post to a goal. You learned to choose one or two platforms with written reasons, not by trend. You learned to run a three-competitor scan to learn what works and where the gaps are â€" never to copy. And you learned to write a positioning statement â€" one sentence that says who the client serves, what they offer and why they are different.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Strategy comes before posting** â€" thinking before posting is the difference between a real business page and a personal diary.
2. **A good audience profile names a real obstacle** â€" not "everyone."
3. **Goals are SMART** â€" and every post connects to a goal.
4. **Choose platforms by audience, not vibes** â€" one or two with written reasons.
5. **A positioning statement keeps you focused** â€" one sentence that says who, what and why.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain why strategy comes before posting?
- Can I write an audience profile that names a real obstacle?
- Can I set a SMART goal and check it against all five letters?
- Can I choose a platform and give a written reason?
- Can I write a positioning statement with all four parts?

Connection to the next session. You now know who the client is talking to, what they are trying to achieve and where to post. But a strategy without content is just a plan on paper. Next session we learn to design the content itself â€" content pillars, formats, posting cadence and a two-week content calendar. You will build the first half of the 30-day calendar that becomes part of your capstone.

Say it with us: *No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof.*

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner explains why strategy comes before posting â€" not just "it is important."
- Learner writes an audience profile that names a real obstacle â€" not "everyone."
- Learner sets SMART goals and checks them against all five letters.
- Learner chooses platforms with written reasons tied to the audience and the goal.
- Learner runs a competitor scan and extracts lessons â€" not copies.
- Learner writes a positioning statement with all four parts.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Strategy is a waste of time â€" just post." â†' No â€" strategy gives every post a reason to exist.
- "Everyone is the audience." â†' A page that speaks to everyone speaks to nobody.
- "Followers are a goal." â†' Followers are a metric; orders, bookings and calls are goals.
- "More platforms = more results." â†' Choose one or two with reasons.

- "Copying competitors is learning." â†’ We scan to learn what works â€” never to copy.
- "A positioning statement is just a slogan." â†’ It is a decision-making tool â€” every post is checked against it.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Audience obstacle drill:** give five weak audience profiles ("everyone," "all Nigerians," "people who love food") and ask the learner to rewrite each with a specific group and a real obstacle.
2. **SMART goal drill:** give five vague goals ("get more followers," "increase engagement," "be the best") and ask the learner to rewrite each in SMART format.
3. **Platform reason drill:** give five platform choices with no reasons and ask the learner to write a reason for each â€” or explain why the platform does not fit.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed strategy sheet â€” audience profile and goals already filled in â€” and ask the learner to complete the platform choice, competitor scan and positioning statement.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written â€” a complete strategy sheet for a new client.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write a short "strategy defence" â€” three sentences explaining to a skeptical client why each part of the strategy (audience, goals, platforms, competitors, positioning) matters and how it will bring results. The defence must be in plain language, not jargon.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners completing a full strategy sheet (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the competitor scan demonstration (G.4) and protect the guided practical â€” the ability to build a strategy is the core skill. If the room is fast, extend the case study discussion and let learners present their strategy sheets to the class.

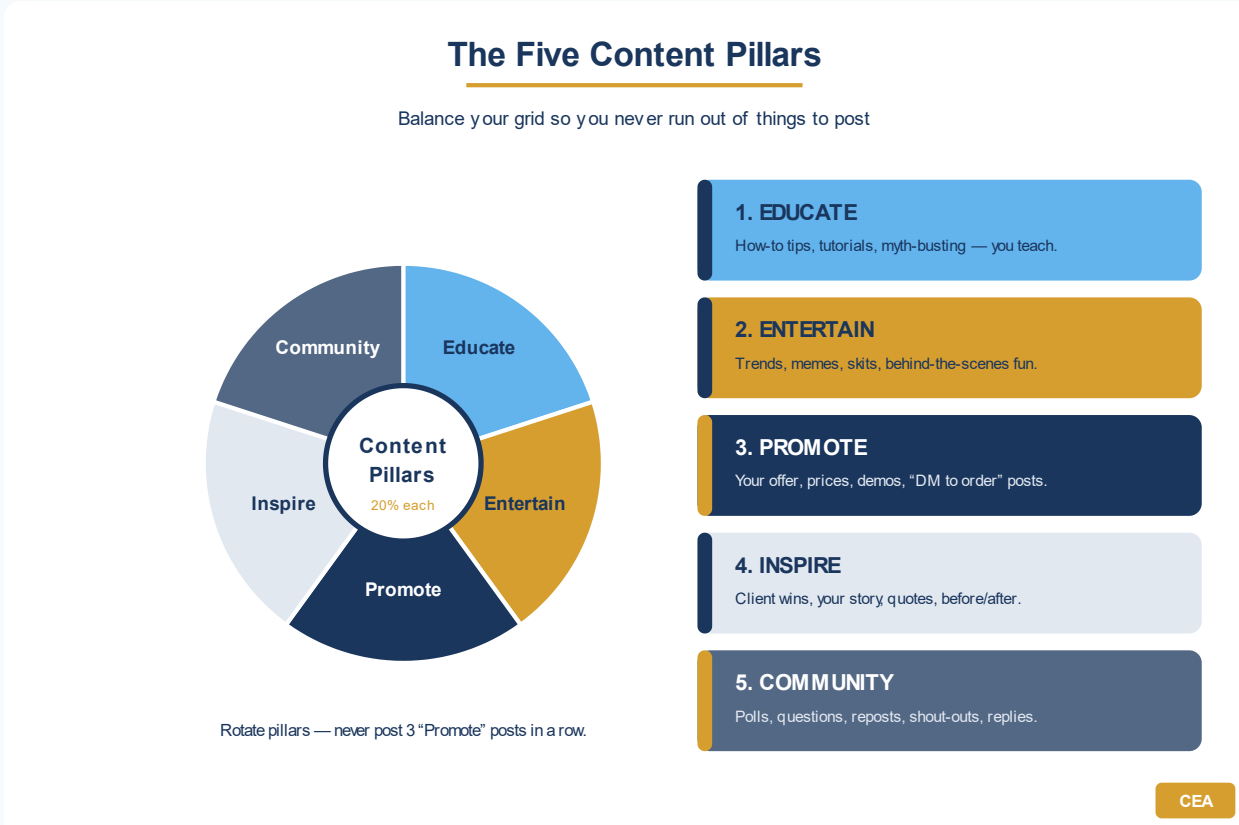
END OF SESSION 2

Next: Session 3 â€" Content Strategy and Pillars.

SESSION 03 OF 9

Content Strategy and Pillars

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 03



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

SESSION 3 â€" CONTENT STRATEGY AND PILLARS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	3 of 9
Session title	Content Strategy and Pillars
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Strategy
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with content planning)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1 and 2 â€" the learner can define social media management, list the five core tasks, explain the ethics rules, research an audience, set SMART goals, choose platforms with reasons

Item	Detail
	and write a positioning statement. Everyday smartphone use assumed. No prior content planning experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 2 we built the strategy â€" audience, goals, platforms, competitors and positioning. Today we turn that strategy into a *content plan*: content pillars, formats, posting cadence and a two-week content calendar. That calendar becomes the first half of the capstone's 30-day plan.
Preparation before class	Projector connected and tested; the five content pillars example (Section F.2) ready on screen; the two-week calendar template (Section H) printed per learner; the pillar-selection worksheet printed; the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief available; a whiteboard for the live calendar build; academy Wi-Fi confirmed.

Running client reminder. *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" fictional small food business in Rumuola, Port Harcourt. Sells local meals (jollof, fried rice, small chops, plantain, fish) for pickup and delivery. Prices â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦8,000. Owner "Chef Nkechi" cooks with two assistants, takes orders on one WhatsApp line. Instagram and Facebook pages silent for three months. Wants consistent posting for 30 days and more WhatsApp orders â€" no advertising budget. Has been burned by someone who bought her fake followers.

Instructor note on tone. This session is where planning becomes practical. Learners often think "content strategy" is something only agencies do â€" your job is to show them that it is simply deciding *what* to post, *when* to post it and *why* â€" and that a simple calendar is the tool that makes it real. Keep the mood energetic and practical. By the end of the session, every learner must have a two-week calendar in front of them.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why random posting fails and how content pillars fix it.
2. **Select** four to five content pillars for a client and explain how each one serves a goal.
3. **Match** content formats (Reel, carousel, image, story, text) to platforms and purposes.
4. **Set** a realistic posting cadence that one person can sustain.
5. **Build** a two-week content calendar with a pillar, format and caption idea for every post.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a notes app or Google Docs.
- Academy computers (one per learner or one per pair) for Google Sheets.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- A whiteboard or flipchart and markers.

Software

- A notes app on every phone.
- Google Sheets (free) for the content calendar â€" learners may use a printed template if computers are limited.
- Google Docs (free) for the pillar-selection worksheet.

Sample files

- **Five content pillars example** (Section F.2) â€" ready on screen.
- **Two-week calendar template** (Section H) â€" a blank table with columns: *Date / Platform / Pillar / Format / Caption or hook idea / Asset needed*.
- **Pillar-selection worksheet** â€" a blank table: *Pillar / What it includes / Which goal it serves / Example post idea*.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 3.1 â€" "My Five Pillars" (the pillar-selection worksheet above).

- Worksheet 3.2 â€" "Two-Week Content Calendar" (the calendar template above).

Accounts

- Free social media accounts (from Session 1). No paid tools.

Internet

- Academy Wi-Fi for Google Sheets. If Wi-Fi fails, use the printed calendar template â€" the session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app or a printed worksheet works. A learner without a device may work with a partner â€" one reads the client brief, one fills in the calendar. The skill today is *planning*, not typing.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor: The content calendar is a planning tool. Remind the class that every post must be original, honest and connected to a goal. No copying competitors, no reposting without permission, no fake claims. The calendar is where good habits start.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two fictional content calendars side by side. Both cover two weeks for the same business â€" a small restaurant in Port Harcourt. Do not explain which is "better" yet.

Calendar A â€" "Random Posting."

Day	Post
Monday	Meme about food
Tuesday	(nothing)
Wednesday	"Good morning" graphic
Thursday	(nothing)
Friday	Blurry photo of rice, no caption
Saturday	(nothing)
Sunday	Random news article
Monday	(nothing)
Tuesday	Photo of owner's car
Wednesday	(nothing)
Thursday	"Good morning" graphic
Friday	(nothing)
Saturday	Meme about hunger
Sunday	(nothing)

Calendar B â€" "Planned Posting."

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea
Monday	Menu & prices	Image	"This week's menu â€" jollof â‚¦1,500, fried rice â‚¦1,800"
Wednesday	Behind the scenes	Reel	"Watch Chef Nkechi fry plantain â€" fresh every morning"
Friday	Customer love	Image	"Customer photo: 'Best jollof in Rumuola!' â€" order yours"
Saturday	Special offer	Story	"Weekend special: small chops tray â‚¦8,000 â€" order by 4 p.m."
Monday	Menu & prices	Image	"Monday fuel: jollof and plantain, â‚¦1,500"

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea
Wednesday	Behind the scenes	Reel	"From kitchen to door â€" 45-minute delivery"
Friday	Customer love	Carousel	"3 reasons our customers keep coming back"
Saturday	Special offer	Story	"Saturday small chops â€" order early, they sell out"

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at these two calendars. Calendar A posts whenever the owner remembers â€" a meme, a 'good morning,' a blurry photo. No plan, no pattern, no purpose. Calendar B posts three times a week â€" always a clear photo with a price, always a behind-the-scenes video, always a customer post. Same business, same two weeks. Which calendar would you rather run? â€¦ Calendar B, obviously. And here is the secret: Calendar B was not made by a big agency. It was made by asking four simple questions â€" What do we post? How often? What does each post do? And what does it look like? Those four questions are content strategy. Today you learn to answer them."*

Expected learner response: Learners will point at Calendar B and say "it is organised," "it has a pattern," "it looks professional." Accept all answers. Draw out the difference: *planned vs. random.*

Then reveal the hook: Say:

> *"Calendar B is not magic. It is built on something called **content pillars** â€" a small set of topics that a business posts about again and again. Once you have your pillars, the calendar almost builds itself. Let us learn how."*

Why this opener works: It uses a visual, side-by-side comparison that makes the abstract idea of "content strategy" concrete. Learners see immediately that a planned calendar beats random posting â€" and they want to know how to build one.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five core tasks of a social media manager?"

- Expected answer: Planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting.
- Common gap: learners mix up the order. Clarify: "Today we go deeper into the *planning* task â€" specifically, planning the content."

Question 2: "What is an audience profile, and what does it name?"

- Expected answer: A profile of who the client's customers are â€" who they are, where they live, what they want, what stops them and where they spend time online. It names a real obstacle.
- Common gap: learners say "it is a list of followers." Clarify: "No â€" it is a description of the people most likely to buy, not the people who already follow."

Question 3: "What does SMART stand for?"

- Expected answer: Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound.
- Common gap: learners remember some letters but not all. Write them on the board and give a quick example of each.

Question 4: "What is a positioning statement?"

- Expected answer: One sentence that says who the client serves, what they offer and why they are different.
- Common gap: learners confuse it with a slogan. Clarify: "A slogan is 'Taste of Rivers â€" the best food in PH.' A positioning statement is 'For students and young professionals in Port Harcourt, Taste of Rivers Kitchen is the local meals spot that delivers fresh, hot jollof to your door in 45 minutes because we cook every morning and deliver ourselves.' One is a claim â€" the other is a decision-making tool."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"In Session 2 we built the strategy â€" who we are talking to, what we are trying to achieve and where to post. Today we turn that strategy into a content plan. We will choose our content pillars â€" the topics we post about again and again â€" match formats to platforms, set a posting cadence we can actually sustain, and build a two-week content calendar. That calendar is the first half of your capstone's 30-day plan. Let us start."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 3, spend 3 extra minutes writing SMART on the board with a one-line example of each before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why random posting fails

The idea. Random posting is posting without a plan â€" whatever comes to mind, whenever you remember. It is the most common reason small business pages fail.

Plain-English definition. Random posting is posting without a strategy â€" no pattern, no purpose, no connection to a goal.

Why it fails:

- **No focus** â€" the page jumps from memes to food photos to news articles. Customers do not know what the business is.
- **No consistency** â€" three posts in one day, silence for three weeks. The page looks abandoned.
- **No connection to goals** â€" a meme might get likes, but it does not get orders. A "good morning" graphic does not build trust.
- **Wasted effort** â€" hours of work that bring no customers, no bookings, no calls.
- **Frustration** â€" the owner sees no results, loses interest, and concludes "social media does not work."

What replaces random posting:

- **Content pillars** â€" a small set of topics the business posts about again and again.
- **A cadence** â€" a realistic posting schedule the business can sustain.
- **A calendar** â€" a plan that says what to post, when and why.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **radio station**. A station that plays whatever the DJ feels like â€" rock, then gospel, then news, then silence â€" will lose listeners. A station that plays music in the morning, news at noon, talk in the evening and keeps that schedule every day â€" that station builds an audience. Content pillars are the station's schedule.

Important limitation / misconception. A content plan does not guarantee viral posts or instant results. It guarantees *consistency, focus and purpose* â€" and those are what build trust and orders over time.

F.2 Content pillars â€" the topics you post about again and again

The idea. Content pillars are the three to five main topics a business posts about. They are the categories that give a page its focus and personality.

Plain-English definition. A content pillar is a main topic or theme that a business returns to again and again â€" like the columns that hold up a building.

Why they exist. Pillars solve the "what do I post?" problem forever. Instead of staring at a blank screen every day, a manager with pillars knows: "This week I need one post from each pillar." The pillars keep the page focused, varied and connected to the client's goals.

How to choose pillars â€" the four rules:

1. **Connected to the client's business** â€" every pillar must relate to what the client sells.
2. **Connected to the audience's interests** â€" every pillar must be something the audience cares about.
3. **Connected to a goal** â€" every pillar must serve at least one of the client's goals (orders, awareness, etc.).
4. **Sustainable** â€" the client must be able to create content for each pillar regularly.

Worked example â€" five pillars for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

Pillar	What it includes	Which goal it serves	Example post idea
1. Menu & prices	Clear photos of meals with prices and the WhatsApp order number.	Orders	"This week's menu â€" jollof â‚¦1,500, fried rice â‚¦1,800, small chops tray â‚¦8,000."
2. Behind the scenes	Short videos of the kitchen, cooking, delivery and the team.	Awareness & trust	"Watch Chef Nkechi fry plantain â€" fresh every morning."
3. Customer love	Customer photos, reviews and testimonials (with permission).	Trust & orders	"Customer photo: 'Best jollof in Rumuola!' â€" order yours."
4. Special offers	Limited-time deals, weekend specials, event packages.	Orders	"Weekend special: small chops tray â‚¦8,000 â€" order by 4 p.m."
5. Tips & local flavour	Food tips, kitchen hygiene, Port Harcourt food culture, "did you know?" posts.	Awareness & engagement	"Did you know? Our jollof rice is cooked with smoked fish â€" that is the Rivers State way."

The key lesson â€" every pillar serves a goal. A pillar that does not serve a goal is a waste. If a "fun memes" pillar does not help get orders or build awareness, it does not belong on a business page. (It might belong on a personal page â€" but that is different.)

Common misconception. "More pillars = more content." No â€" three to five pillars is enough. Too many pillars dilute the focus and make the calendar confusing. A small page with three clear pillars beats a big page with ten unclear ones.

F.3 Matching formats to platforms and purposes

The idea. A **format** is the shape of a post â€" a photo, a video, a carousel, a story, a text post. Different formats work better on different platforms and for different purposes.

Plain-English definition. Format is what the post looks like â€" a single image, a multi-image carousel, a short video, a text-only post or a disappearing story.

The five main formats:

Format	What it is	Best for	Best on
Image	One photo with a caption.	Menus, products, customer photos, quotes.	Instagram, Facebook
Reel / short video	A 15â€"60 second video, usually vertical.	Behind the scenes, cooking, tutorials, quick tips.	Instagram, TikTok, Facebook
Carousel	A multi-image post (2â€"10 slides).	Lists, before/after, step-by-step, "3 reasonsâ€¦"	Instagram, Facebook
Story	A photo or video that disappears after 24 hours.	Quick updates, polls, "what do you think?", limited-time offers.	Instagram, Facebook
Text post	Words only â€" no image.	Announcements, tips, questions, community conversation.	Facebook, X

Worked example â€" matching formats to pillars for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

Pillar	Best format	Why
Menu & prices	Image	A clear photo with the price is easy to read and save.
Behind the scenes	Reel	Video shows the cooking, the steam, the freshness â€" it feels alive.
Customer love	Image or carousel	A customer photo with a short review builds trust.
Special offers	Story	A 24-hour story creates urgency â€" "today only."
Tips & local flavour	Text or carousel	A short text tip or a 3-slide carousel of "did you know?" facts.

The key lesson â€" match the format to the purpose, not the trend. A Reel is not automatically better than a photo. If the goal is to show a clear menu with prices, a photo is better. If the goal is to show the cooking process, a Reel is better. Choose the format that serves the post's purpose.

Common misconception. "We need to make Reels because they get more reach." Maybe â€" but a blurry Reel with no purpose will not get reach. A clear, honest photo with a price and an order number will get orders. Purpose first, format second.

F.4 Setting a realistic posting cadence

The idea. Cadence is how often the client posts â€" daily, three times a week, once a week. The key is choosing a cadence the business can actually sustain.

Plain-English definition. Cadence is the posting schedule â€" how many posts per week, on which days, at what times.

Why it matters. A cadence that is too ambitious will collapse within two weeks. A cadence that is too sparse will make the page look abandoned. The right cadence is the most the business can sustain without burning out.

The sustainability test â€" three questions:

1. **Who is creating the content?** One person? Two? A team?
2. **How much time do they have?** An hour a day? A few hours a week?
3. **How much content can they realistically make?** Photos are quick. Videos take longer. Carousels take design time.

Realistic cadences for a small Port Harcourt business:

Cadence	Posts per week	Who can sustain it	Risk
Light	1â€"2	A very busy owner with no help.	The page may look quiet.
Steady	3	One owner with a phone and a little time.	Sustainable and professional.
Active	4â€"5	An owner with help or a manager.	Good for growth, but needs planning.
Intense	6â€"7	A dedicated creator or team.	High risk of burnout for a small business.

Worked example â€" cadence for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

- **Who creates the content?** Chef Nkechi (the owner) with help from the manager.
- **How much time?** A few hours a week â€" filming while cooking, photographing while plating.
- **What can they realistically make?** 3 posts a week â€" two photos and one short video.

Decision: Steady cadence â€" 3 posts per week, on Monday, Wednesday and Friday, at 12 p.m. or 5 p.m. (when people decide what to eat).

The key lesson â€" start steady, grow later. A business that starts with 3 posts a week and keeps it up for a month is better than a business that starts with 7 posts a week and collapses in two weeks. Consistency beats intensity.

Common misconception. "We need to post every day to grow." No â€" you need to post *consistently* to grow. Three posts a week, every week, beats seven posts one week and nothing the next.

F.5 Building a two-week content calendar

The idea. A **content calendar** is a plan that says what to post, when, on which platform, in which format, with which caption idea. It is the tool that turns pillars and cadence into actual posts.

Plain-English definition. A content calendar is a simple table â€" one row per post, with columns for the date, platform, pillar, format, caption idea and asset needed.

Why it exists. A calendar removes the daily "what do I post?" panic. The manager knows on Monday morning exactly what to post on Monday, Wednesday and Friday. The client can see the plan and approve it. Nothing is forgotten, nothing is rushed.

The calendar template:

Date	Platform	Pillar	Format	Caption or hook idea	Asset needed
Mon 12 p.m.	Instagram + Facebook	Menu & prices	Image	"This week's menu â€" jollof â‚¦1,500, fried rice â‚¦1,800"	Photo of jollof with price graphic

Date	Platform	Pillar	Format	Caption or hook idea	Asset needed
Wed 5 p.m.	Instagram + Facebook	Behind the scenes	Reel	"Watch Chef Nkechi fry plantain â€" fresh every morning"	20-second video of plantain frying
Fri 12 p.m.	Instagram + Facebook	Customer love	Image	"Customer photo: 'Best jollof in Rumuola!' â€" order yours"	Customer photo with permission
Sat 4 p.m.	Instagram Story	Special offers	Story	"Weekend special: small chops tray â‚¦8,000 â€" order by 4 p.m."	Story graphic with price
Mon 12 p.m.	Instagram + Facebook	Menu & prices	Image	"Monday fuel: jollof and plantain, â‚¦1,500"	Photo of jollof and plantain
Wed 5 p.m.	Instagram + Facebook	Behind the scenes	Reel	"From kitchen to door â€" 45-minute delivery"	20-second video of delivery
Fri 12 p.m.	Instagram + Facebook	Customer love	Carousel	"3 reasons our customers keep coming back"	3-slide carousel
Sat 4 p.m.	Instagram Story	Special offers	Story	"Saturday small chops â€" order early, they sell out"	Story graphic with price

The key lesson â€" every row has a pillar, a format and a caption idea. A calendar row that says "post something about food" is useless. A row that says "Menu & prices / Image / 'This week's menu â€" jollof â‚¦1,500'" is a plan.

How to build a calendar in 30 minutes:

1. Choose your pillars (from F.2).
2. Choose your cadence (from F.4).
3. Open the calendar template.
4. For each posting day, pick a pillar and a format.
5. Write a caption idea â€" just the hook, not the full caption.
6. Note the asset needed â€" a photo, a video, a graphic.
7. Repeat for two weeks.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **school timetable**. A teacher without a timetable teaches whatever comes to mind â€" chaos. A teacher with a timetable knows exactly what to teach, when and in which classroom. A content calendar is the manager's timetable.

Important limitation / misconception. A calendar is a plan, not a prison. If a post is not ready, move it â€" do not post something rushed and bad. If a special event comes up, add it â€" the calendar is flexible. The point is to plan, not to be rigid.

F.6 Summary of the lecture

- **Random posting fails** because it has no focus, no consistency and no connection to goals.
- **Content pillars** are the three to five main topics a business posts about again and again â€" connected to the business, the audience and the goals.
- **Formats** (image, Reel, carousel, story, text) are matched to platforms and purposes â€" not to trends.
- **Cadence** is how often the business posts â€" the most it can sustain without burning out.
- **A content calendar** is a simple table â€" one row per post, with a pillar, format and caption idea â€" that turns the plan into action.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Your brand] --> B[Educate 30%]
    A --> C[Entertain 25%]
    A --> D[Promote 20%]
    A --> E[Inspire 15%]
    A --> F[Community 10%]
    B --> G[Consistent posting]
    C --> G
    D --> G
```

```
E --> G
F --> G
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through building a complete two-week content calendar for the running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*, so learners see how pillars, cadence and formats come together in a real plan.

Setup: On the projector, show the blank calendar template. Have the five pillars and the cadence decision (3 posts per week â€" Monday, Wednesday, Friday) visible.

G.1 Demonstration 1 â€" Set the cadence (2 minutes)

Say: "First â€" how often do we post? Chef Nkechi has one phone and a few hours a week. She cannot post every day. Let us choose a cadence she can sustain."

Write on the board:

> ***Cadence:*** *3 posts per week â€" Monday, Wednesday, Friday, at 12 p.m. or 5 p.m.* ***Plus:*** *One Instagram Story on Saturday for special offers.*

Say: "Three posts a week is steady. It is enough to stay visible, and it is sustainable for one person with one phone. We also add a Saturday Story â€" stories are quick and they create urgency for weekend orders."

G.2 Demonstration 2 â€" Assign pillars to days (4 minutes)

Say: "Now we assign pillars to days. We have five pillars â€" Menu & prices, Behind the scenes, Customer love, Special offers, Tips & local flavour. We do not need all five every week. Let us pick three for the week."

Fill in the first week:

Day	Pillar	Format	Why
Monday	Menu & prices	Image	Start the week with the menu â€" people plan meals on Monday.
Wednesday	Behind the scenes	Reel	Mid-week â€" show the kitchen is alive and fresh.
Friday	Customer love	Image	Friday evening â€" people decide weekend food; a customer photo builds trust.
Saturday	Special offers	Story	Weekend special â€" create urgency.

Say: "Notice â€" each pillar serves a purpose. Monday's menu post serves orders. Wednesday's behind-the-scenes video serves awareness and trust. Friday's customer photo serves trust and orders. Saturday's story serves urgency. Every post has a job."

G.3 Demonstration 3 â€" Write caption ideas (4 minutes)

Say: "Now we write caption ideas â€" not full captions, just the hook. We will write full captions in Session 4."

Fill in the caption idea column:

Day	Caption or hook idea
Monday	"This week's menu â€" jollof â‚¦1,500, fried rice â‚¦1,800, small chops tray â‚¦8,000. Order on WhatsApp."
Wednesday	"Watch Chef Nkechi fry plantain â€" fresh every morning. Order yours today."
Friday	"Customer photo: 'Best jollof in Rumuola!' â€" order yours and tell us what you think."
Saturday	"Weekend special: small chops tray â‚¦8,000 â€" order by 4 p.m. today only."

Say: "Each caption idea has a hook and a CTA. We are not writing full captions yet â€" that is Session 4. But notice â€" every idea tells the reader what to do. That is the habit."

G.4 Demonstration 4 â€" Note the assets (3 minutes)

Say: "Last column â€" what asset do we need? A photo, a video, a graphic?"

Fill in the asset column:

Day	Asset needed
Monday	Photo of jollof with price graphic (Canva)
Wednesday	20-second video of plantain frying
Friday	Customer photo (with permission)
Saturday	Story graphic with the weekend price

Say: "Now Chef Nkechi knows exactly what to photograph and film this week. She does not have to think â€" she just follows the calendar. That is the power of planning."

G.5 Demonstration 5 â€" Repeat for week two (2 minutes)

Say: "Week two follows the same pattern â€" but we vary the pillars and formats so the page does not feel repetitive."

Fill in week two quickly:

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea
Monday	Menu & prices	Image	"Monday fuel: jollof and plantain, â‚¦1,500"
Wednesday	Behind the scenes	Reel	"From kitchen to door â€" 45-minute delivery"
Friday	Customer love	Carousel	"3 reasons our customers keep coming back"
Saturday	Special offers	Story	"Saturday small chops â€" order early, they sell out"

Say: "Two weeks, planned. Every post has a pillar, a format, a caption idea and an asset. That is a content calendar. And this is the first half of your capstone's 30-day plan."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Why did we choose 3 posts a week, not 7?" (Sustainability â€" one person, one phone.)
- "What job does Wednesday's Reel do?" (Shows the kitchen is alive â€" builds trust and awareness.)
- "What would happen if we did not have a calendar?" (Random posting â€" no focus, no consistency.)
- "Can we change the calendar if something comes up?" (Yes â€" the calendar is a plan, not a prison.)

Expected result: Learners see a complete two-week calendar built from pillars, cadence and formats â€" and they see that the calendar is a practical tool, not a mysterious document.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner builds a complete two-week content calendar for a new fictional client â€" *Glamour Touch Salon* â€" covering pillars, cadence, formats, caption ideas and assets.

Starting materials: The printed two-week calendar template, the Glamour Touch Salon client brief (below), a pen. No phone needed â€" it is a planning exercise.

CLIENT BRIEF â€" GLAMOUR TOUCH SALON (fictional). *Glamour Touch Salon* is a hair and beauty salon in Port Harcourt. It offers braids, weaves, natural hair care and make-up. Prices run from â‚¦1,000 for a basic braid to â‚¦15,000 for a full weave installation. The salon has 800 Instagram followers and posts rarely. The owner, "Aunty Funke," wants more bookings â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and call to book. She can pay â‚¦20,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name at the top of the calendar template. Read the client brief once.
2. **Choose four pillars.** Pick four topics the salon will post about again and again. Each must connect to the business, the audience and a goal. (Hint: think â€" what does a salon want people to see?)
3. **Set a cadence.** Choose a posting schedule Aunty Funke can sustain. (Hint: one person, one phone â€" what is realistic?)
4. **Fill in week one.** For each posting day, pick a pillar, a format and a caption idea. Note the asset needed.
5. **Fill in week two.** Repeat â€" but vary the pillars and formats so the page does not feel repetitive.
6. **Pause and predict:** Cover your calendar and ask yourself: "If I post a photo of a braid style, which pillar does it belong to, and what goal does it serve?" Write your answer at the bottom.
7. Compare your calendar with the person beside you. If you chose different pillars, explain your choices.

Expected result (model answers â€" instructor key):

Four pillars:

- Portfolio (photos and videos of braid, weave and make-up styles)
- Prices & booking (clear price lists and how to book)
- Behind the scenes (the salon, the stylists, the process)
- Customer love (customer photos, reviews, before/after)

Cadence: 3 posts per week â€" Tuesday, Thursday, Saturday â€" at 12 p.m. or 6 p.m.

Week one (example):

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea	Asset
Tue	Portfolio	Image	"Fresh box braids â€" â‚¦5,000. Call to book your slot."	Photo of box braids
Thu	Prices & booking	Carousel	"Our price list â€" braids from â‚¦1,000 to â‚¦15,000. Book today."	3-slide price carousel
Sat	Behind the scenes	Reel	"Watch the stylist work â€" fresh weave, installed with care."	20-second video
Sat	Customer love	Story	"Customer of the week â€" say hi to Adaeze!"	Customer photo with permission

Week two (example):

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea	Asset
Tue	Portfolio	Reel	"Before and after â€" this weave took 3 hours. Worth it."	20-second before/after video
Thu	Prices & booking	Image	"Weekend special: make-up application â‚¦3,000 â€" Saturday only."	Photo with price graphic
Sat	Behind the scenes	Reel	"From consultation to finished look â€" the full process."	20-second video
Sat	Customer love	Story	"Customer review: 'Best salon in Port Harcourt!'"	Screenshot of review or customer photo

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "Do your four pillars each serve a goal? Which goal â€" bookings or awareness?"
- After step 4: "Does every row have a pillar, a format and a caption idea â€" or did you leave any blank?"
- After step 6: "Can you explain which goal a portfolio post serves?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner chooses "memes" as a pillar â†' Prompt: "Does a meme help a salon get bookings? What would the salon's customers actually want to see?"
- Learner sets a cadence of 7 posts a week â†' Prompt: "Can Aunty Funke, working alone, really make 7 posts every week? What is sustainable?"
- Learner leaves the asset column blank â†' Prompt: "What will Aunty Funke actually photograph or film for this post?"

- Learner writes "post something about hair" as a caption idea â†' Prompt: "That is not a caption idea. What is the hook? What is the price? What is the CTA?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Four pillars chosen, each connected to the business and a goal
- ☐ Cadence set â€" realistic for one person with one phone
- ☐ Week one filled â€" every row has a pillar, format, caption idea and asset
- ☐ Week two filled â€" varied pillars and formats
- ☐ The pause-and-predict answer connects a post to a goal

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Build a complete two-week content calendar for a third fictional client â€" *Chinedu's Barbershop* â€" without copying the instructor's Taste of Rivers Kitchen or the Glamour Touch Salon examples.

Scenario. *Chinedu's Barbershop* is a small barbershop in Rumuokuta, Port Harcourt. It offers haircuts, beard trims, and kids' haircuts. Prices run from â‚¦1,000 for a basic cut to â‚¦3,000 for a premium cut with beard trim. The shop has 600 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Chinedu is good with customers but he is not online. He wants more walk-in customers â€" people should see his work, know his prices, and find his shop. He can pay â‚¦20,000 a month. He does not want fake followers.

Requirements:

1. Choose **four content pillars** â€" each connected to the business and a goal.
2. Set a **cadence** â€" realistic for Chinedu, one person with one phone.
3. Fill in **week one** â€" every row has a pillar, format, caption idea and asset.
4. Fill in **week two** â€" varied pillars and formats.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Four pillars, each connected to the business and a goal.
- Cadence is realistic â€" not 7 posts a week.
- Every row has a pillar, format, caption idea and asset.
- Week two varies the pillars and formats from week one.
- Caption ideas have a hook and a CTA.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For pillars, think â€" what would a barbershop's customers want to see? Fresh cuts, prices, the shop, happy customers?
- Hint 2: For cadence, think â€" Chinedu is busy cutting hair all day. He can realistically make 2â€"3 posts a week.
- Hint 3: For caption ideas, use the hookâ€"valueâ€"CTA structure: "Fresh fade â€" â‚¦1,500. Call to book your slot."

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Four pillars:

- Fresh cuts (photos and videos of haircuts and beard trims)
- Prices & booking (clear price lists and how to book)
- Behind the scenes (the barbershop, the tools, the process)
- Customer love (customer photos, reviews, before/after)

Cadence: 3 posts per week â€" Monday, Wednesday, Friday â€" at 12 p.m. or 6 p.m.

Week one:

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea	Asset
Mon	Fresh cuts	Image	"Fresh skin fade â€" â‚¦1,500. Call to book your slot."	Photo of a fresh fade

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea	Asset
Wed	Prices & booking	Carousel	"Our price list â€" cuts from â‚¦1,000 to â‚¦3,000. Book today."	3-slide price carousel
Fri	Behind the scenes	Reel	"Watch the barber work â€" precision fade in 20 minutes."	20-second video
Fri	Customer love	Story	"Customer of the week â€" say hi to Emeka!"	Customer photo with permission

Week two:

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea	Asset
Mon	Fresh cuts	Reel	"Before and after â€" this fade took 30 minutes. Sharp."	20-second before/after video
Wed	Prices & booking	Image	"Weekend special: kids' haircut â‚¦1,000 â€" Saturday only."	Photo with price graphic
Fri	Behind the scenes	Reel	"From consultation to finished cut â€" the full process."	20-second video
Fri	Customer love	Story	"Customer review: 'Best barber in Rumuokuta!'"	Customer photo with permission

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Four pillars, each connected to the business and a goal (2)
- Cadence is realistic (2)
- Every row has a pillar, format, caption idea and asset (3)
- Week two varies from week one (2)
- Caption ideas have a hook and a CTA (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *The Hungry Student* is a small food business near the University of Port Harcourt. It sells jollof rice, fried rice, plantain and fish â€" a full plate for â‚¦1,000. The owner, a young woman named Blessing, started the business six months ago. She posts on Instagram â€" but randomly. Some days she posts three times, some days she does not post for a week. Her photos are sometimes clear, sometimes blurry. Her captions are sometimes "Good morning" and sometimes a full description with prices. She has 1,200 followers but only gets about 10 orders a week â€" and she cannot tell which posts bring orders. She is frustrated. She thinks "social media does not work for food."

Relevant facts.

- Blessing's food is genuinely good â€" students love her jollof.
- Her posting is completely random â€" no pattern, no plan, no consistency.
- Her photos and captions are inconsistent â€" sometimes professional, sometimes not.
- She has no content pillars, no calendar and no way to measure results.
- She posts from her phone, usually late at night when she is tired.

Decision point. A social media manager has been hired. What should the manager do first â€" and what should they avoid?

Possible approaches.

1. **Post more often** â€" "let us post every day, that will fix it."
2. **Buy followers** â€" "let us get the page to 5,000 followers, then orders will come."
3. **Build a content strategy** â€" choose pillars, set a cadence, build a calendar and post consistently for 30 days.

Recommended solution. Approach 3 â€" a content strategy. The manager should:

- **Choose four pillars:** Menu & prices, Behind the scenes, Customer love, Student specials.

- **Set a cadence:** 3 posts a week â€" Monday, Wednesday, Friday â€" at 12 p.m. (when students decide lunch).
- **Build a two-week calendar:** Every post has a pillar, format, caption idea and asset.
- **Post consistently for 30 days:** No random posting, no gaps, no "good morning" graphics.
- **Measure results:** At the end of 30 days, check which posts got the most orders â€" and do more of that.

What the manager should avoid:

- **Posting more often without a plan** â€" seven random posts a week will not fix a planning problem.
- **Buying followers** â€" fake followers bring no orders.
- **Using jargon with Blessing** â€" she does not know "content pillars" or "cadence." The manager must explain in plain language.
- **Expecting instant results** â€" consistency takes 30 days to show results. The manager should set that expectation from day one.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is easy but ineffective â€" more random posting will not fix a planning problem.
- Approach 2 is cheap but destructive â€" fake followers make the page look big while bringing zero orders.
- Approach 3 takes a few hours of planning, but it sets up a month of focused, effective content â€" and it gives the manager a way to prove the results.

Professional connection. This is exactly what a professional manager does â€" and it is what separates a professional from someone who "just posts." A professional does not guess. A professional plans, executes and measures. That is why a professional can charge â‚¦15,000 a month and a "poster" cannot.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Choosing too many pillars

Symptoms: Learner chooses seven or eight content pillars. **Likely cause:** They think more pillars = more content = more results. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Can the client realistically create content for every one of these pillars every week?" **Corrective steps:** Limit to three to five pillars. Each must be sustainable â€" if the client cannot create content for it regularly, it does not belong. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has three to five pillars, each sustainable. **Prevention:** Remind the class â€" three clear pillars beat ten unclear ones.

K.2 Choosing pillars that do not serve a goal

Symptoms: Learner chooses pillars like "memes" or "motivational quotes" that do not connect to the business or a goal. **Likely cause:** They think entertaining content is the same as effective content. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Does this pillar help the client get orders, bookings or awareness? How?" **Corrective steps:** Every pillar must serve at least one goal. If it does not, remove it or replace it with one that does. **How to confirm resolved:** Each pillar is connected to a goal. **Prevention:** Always ask "what goal does this pillar serve?" before adding it.

K.3 Setting an unsustainable cadence

Symptoms: Learner sets a cadence of 7 posts a week for a client who is one person with one phone. **Likely cause:** They think more posting = faster growth. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Who is creating this content? How much time do they have? Can they really do this every week?" **Corrective steps:** Use the sustainability test â€" who, how much time, how much content. Choose a cadence the client can sustain. **How to confirm resolved:** The cadence is realistic for the client's capacity. **Prevention:** Start steady, grow later. Three posts a week, every week, beats seven posts one week and nothing the next.

K.4 Leaving the calendar incomplete

Symptoms: Calendar rows are missing a pillar, format, caption idea or asset. **Likely cause:** The learner rushed or did not understand the template. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What does this post look like? What is the caption? What do you need to create it?" **Corrective steps:** Every row must have all five columns filled. A row that says "post something about food" is useless. **How to confirm resolved:** Every row is complete. **Prevention:** Walk the room and check each row as learners fill it in.

K.5 Posting the same thing every week

Symptoms: Calendar repeats the exact same post every week â€" same pillar, same format, same caption. **Likely cause:** The learner thinks repetition is consistency. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Is this post different from last week's? Why should someone see the same thing again?" **Corrective steps:** Vary the pillars and formats across weeks. Consistency means showing up regularly â€" not posting the identical thing. **How to confirm resolved:** Week two varies from week one. **Prevention:** Remind the class â€" consistency is about regularity, not repetition.

K.6 Writing vague caption ideas

Symptoms: Caption ideas say "post about the menu" or "share a photo." **Likely cause:** The learner does not yet understand hookâ€"valueâ€"CTA. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is the hook? What is the price? What is the CTA?" **Corrective steps:** Every caption idea must have a hook and a CTA. "This week's menu â€" jollof â‚¦1,500. Order on WhatsApp." Not "post about the menu." **How to confirm resolved:** Every caption idea has a hook and a CTA. **Prevention:** Remind the class â€" a caption idea is not a topic, it is a plan for the words.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" ask the learner to explain their reasoning, not just their answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Two-Week Content Calendar"

Purpose: To practise building a complete content plan for a small business â€" the core planning skill that turns strategy into action â€" and to produce the first half of the capstone's 30-day calendar.

Realistic scenario. You are a social media manager in Port Harcourt. A friend's sister, *Adaeze*, runs *Adaeze's Fashion* â€" a small fashion business that sells ankara dresses, ready-to-wear outfits and does custom sewing. Prices run from â‚¦5,000 for a simple dress to â‚¦30,000 for a custom ankara gown. The business has 900 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Adaeze is a skilled tailor but she is not online. She wants more customers â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and order from her. She can pay â‚¦35,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Detailed instructions:

1. Choose **four content pillars** for Adaeze's Fashion â€" each connected to the business and a goal.
2. Set a **cadence** â€" realistic for Adaeze, one person with one phone.
3. Build a **two-week content calendar** â€" every row has a pillar, format, caption idea and asset.
4. Write a **short paragraph** (4â€"6 sentences) explaining to Adaeze, in plain language, why a planned calendar will bring her more customers â€" without promising followers or virality.

Required deliverables:

- A two-week content calendar (four pillars, cadence, every row complete).
- The short paragraph to the client.

Submission format: Save as `ContentCalendar_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`) and upload to `/Social-Media-Management/Week1/ContentCalendar/`. You may also copy the calendar into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 4.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Four pillars connected to business and goals	3	Each pillar serves a purpose and is sustainable
Realistic cadence	3	Sustainable for one person with one phone
Every row complete (pillar, format, caption, asset)	5	No blank cells; every post is fully planned
Week two varies from week one	3	Different pillars and formats; not repetitive
Caption ideas have hook and CTA	3	Each idea tells the reader what to do

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Client paragraph	3	Plain, honest language; no false promises

Common mistakes to avoid: choosing too many pillars; choosing pillars that do not serve a goal; setting an unsustainable cadence; leaving calendar rows incomplete; posting the same thing every week; writing vague caption ideas; using jargon Adaeze would not understand.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Adaeze's Fashion â€" Two-Week Content Calendar

Four pillars:

- Portfolio (photos and videos of dresses and custom work)
- Prices & booking (clear price lists and how to order)
- Behind the scenes (Adaeze sewing, fabric selection, the process)
- Customer love (customer photos, reviews, before/after)

Cadence: 3 posts per week â€" Tuesday, Thursday, Saturday â€" at 12 p.m. or 6 p.m.

Week one:

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea	Asset
Tue	Portfolio	Image	"Fresh ankara dress â€" â‚¦8,000. DM 'DRESS' to order."	Photo of an ankara dress
Thu	Prices & booking	Carousel	"Our price list â€" dresses from â‚¦5,000 to â‚¦30,000. Order today."	3-slide price carousel
Sat	Behind the scenes	Reel	"Watch Adaeze sew â€" from fabric to finished dress."	20-second video
Sat	Customer love	Story	"Customer of the week â€" say hi to Chisom!"	Customer photo with permission

Week two:

Day	Pillar	Format	Caption idea	Asset
Tue	Portfolio	Reel	"Before and after â€" this custom gown took 5 hours. Stunning."	20-second before/after video
Thu	Prices & booking	Image	"Weekend special: ready-to-wear dress â‚¦5,000 â€" Saturday only."	Photo with price graphic
Sat	Behind the scenes	Reel	"From consultation to finished dress â€" the full process."	20-second video
Sat	Customer love	Story	"Customer review: 'Best tailor in Port Harcourt!'"	Customer photo with permission

Paragraph to Adaeze: "Adaeze, a planned calendar will bring you more customers because it turns your Instagram page from a silent noticeboard into a working shop. I will post your dresses three times a week with clear prices, reply to every customer who messages you, and show you at the end of each month exactly how many people saw your page and how many became orders. I cannot promise you thousands of followers or a viral video â€" no honest person can. But I can promise you consistent, professional work and real numbers you can check. That is how you get customers that actually order from you."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. Why does random posting fail?

Q2. List. Name the four rules for choosing a content pillar.

Q3. Multiple choice. How many content pillars should a small business page have? a) 1â€“2 b) 3â€“5 c) 8â€“10 d) As many as possible

Q4. Explain. What is a content calendar, and why does every row need a pillar, a format and a caption idea?

Q5. Scenario. A client says: "Let us post every day â€” seven posts a week." The client is one person with one phone and a busy business. Write two sentences explaining why this may not be a good idea.

Q6. Matching. Match each format to its best use: Image, Reel, Carousel, Story, Text post. a) A multi-image post for a list or "3 reasonsâ€¦" b) A 15â€“60 second video for behind the scenes or tutorials c) A single photo for menus, products or customer photos d) A disappearing post for quick updates or limited-time offers e) Words only for announcements or questions

Q7. True or false. A content calendar is a plan, not a prison â€” you can move a post if it is not ready.

Q8. Fill in the blank. A caption idea must have a _____ and a _____.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q8)

A1. Random posting fails because it has no focus, no consistency and no connection to goals. The page jumps from one thing to another, looks abandoned, and does not serve the client's business goals.

A2. Connected to the client's business; connected to the audience's interests; connected to a goal; sustainable (the client can create content for it regularly).

A3. (b) 3â€“5. (Too few limits variety; too many dilutes the focus and is hard to sustain.)

A4. A content calendar is a simple table â€” one row per post, with columns for the date, platform, pillar, format, caption idea and asset needed. Every row needs a pillar, a format and a caption idea because a row that says "post something about food" is useless â€” the manager needs to know exactly what to post, what it looks like and what the words say.

A5. Model answer: "Seven posts a week may not be sustainable for one person with a busy business â€” you may start strong and burn out within two weeks. A steady cadence of 3 posts a week, kept up for a month, will get better results than 7 posts one week and nothing the next." (Accept any answer that questions sustainability.)

A6. Image = (c); Reel = (b); Carousel = (a); Story = (d); Text post = (e).

A7. True. A calendar is a plan â€” if a post is not ready, move it; if a special event comes up, add it. The point is to plan, not to be rigid.

A8. A caption idea must have a **hook** and a **CTA**.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned why random posting fails and how content pillars fix it. You learned to choose four to five content pillars â€” each connected to the business, the audience and a goal. You learned to match formats (image, Reel, carousel, story, text) to platforms and purposes â€” not to trends. You learned to set a realistic posting cadence â€” the most the business can sustain without burning out. And you learned to build a two-week content calendar â€” a simple table where every row has a pillar, a format, a caption idea and an asset. That calendar is the first half of your capstone's 30-day plan.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Random posting fails** â€” no focus, no consistency, no connection to goals.
2. **Content pillars** are the three to five topics you post about again and again â€” each connected to the business and a goal.
3. **Match formats to purposes** â€” an image for menus, a Reel for behind the scenes, a story for urgency.
4. **Cadence is sustainability** â€” three posts a week, every week, beats seven posts one week and nothing the next.
5. **A content calendar** turns the plan into action â€” every row has a pillar, a format, a caption idea and an asset.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain why random posting fails?
- Can I choose four content pillars and explain how each serves a goal?
- Can I match a format to a purpose â€” and explain why?
- Can I set a cadence that one person can sustain?
- Can I build a two-week calendar where every row is complete?

Connection to the next session. You now have a plan â€" but a plan without content is just a calendar with blank rows. Next session we learn to create the content itself: writing a creative brief, repurposing one idea into four post formats, designing a clean Canva graphic, and sourcing photos and video honestly. You will take one idea from your calendar and turn it into four finished posts.

Say it with us: *No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof.*

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner explains why random posting fails â€" not just "it is bad."
- Learner chooses four pillars, each connected to the business and a goal.
- Learner matches formats to purposes â€" and explains why.
- Learner sets a cadence that is realistic for the client's capacity.
- Learner builds a calendar where every row is complete.
- Learner writes caption ideas with a hook and a CTA.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "More pillars = more content." â†' No â€" three to five clear pillars beat ten unclear ones.
- "Post every day to grow." â†' Consistency beats intensity â€" three posts a week, every week.
- "A Reel is always better than a photo." â†' Match the format to the purpose, not the trend.
- "A calendar is a prison." â†' It is a plan â€" flexible, but essential.
- "Consistency means posting the same thing." â†' Consistency is regularity, not repetition.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Pillar audit:** give five weak pillars ("memes," "motivational quotes," "good morning") and ask the learner to explain why each one does not serve a business goal.
2. **Cadence check:** give three client scenarios (a busy owner with no help, a owner with an assistant, a team of three) and ask the learner to set a cadence for each.
3. **Calendar completion:** give a calendar with five incomplete rows and ask the learner to fill in the missing pillar, format, caption idea or asset.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed calendar â€" pillars and cadence already chosen â€" and ask the learner to fill in the formats, caption ideas and assets.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written â€" a complete two-week calendar for a new client.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to build a four-week calendar and write a short "content strategy summary" â€" one paragraph explaining the pillars, cadence and how the calendar serves the client's goals. The summary must be in plain language, not jargon.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners completing a full two-week calendar (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the formats section (F.3) and protect the guided practical â€" the ability to build a calendar is the core skill. If the room is fast, extend the case study discussion and let learners present their calendars to the class.

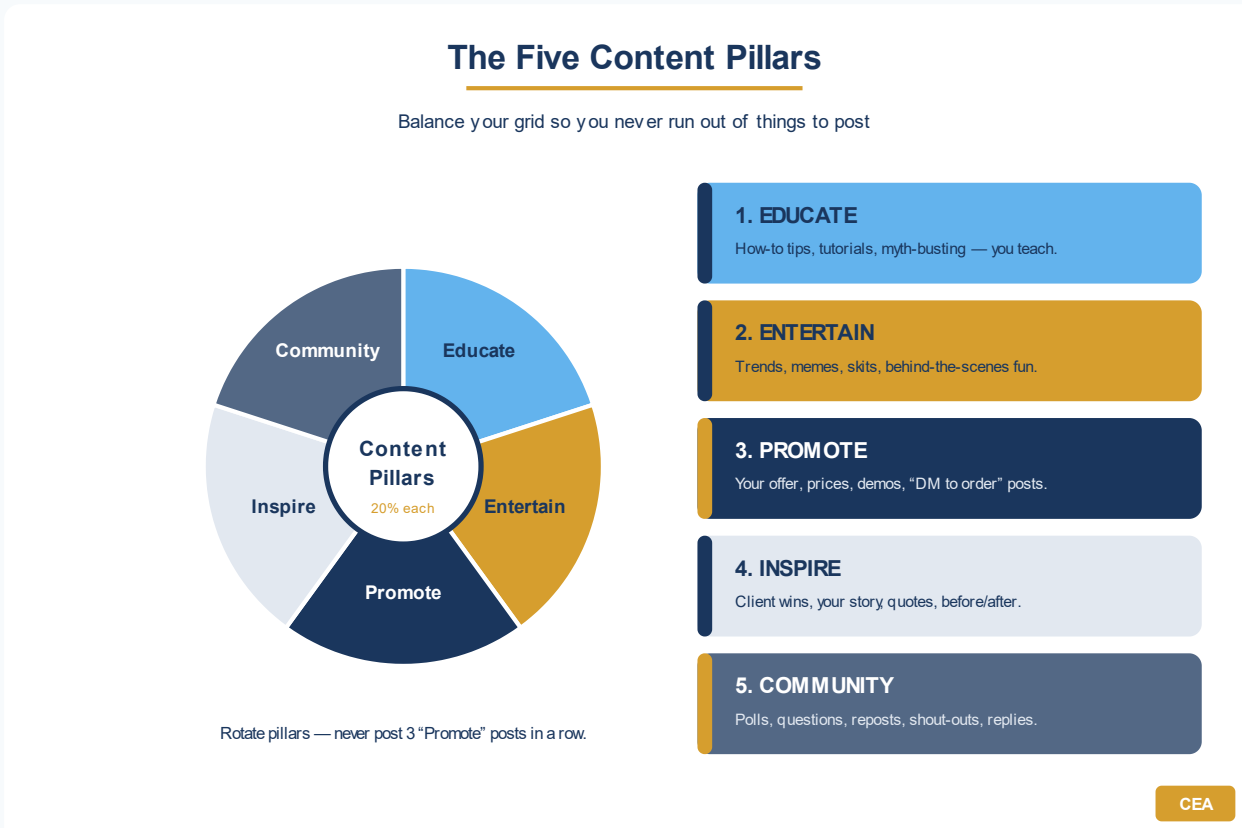
END OF SESSION 3

Next: Session 4 â€" Creating and Sourcing Content for Clients.

SESSION 04 OF 9

Creating and Sourcing Content for Clients

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 04



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

SESSION 4 â€" CREATING AND SOURCING CONTENT FOR CLIENTS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	4 of 9
Session title	Creating and Sourcing Content for Clients
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Create and Manage
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first hands-on content creation)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"3 â€" the learner can define social media management, list the five core tasks, build a strategy (audience, goals, platforms, pillars, cadence and calendar) and explain the

Item	Detail
	ethics rules. Basic smartphone photography assumed. No design or video editing experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 3 we built a two-week content calendar with pillars, formats and caption ideas. Today we fill those calendar rows with real content. We write a creative brief, repurpose one idea into four post formats, design a clean Canva graphic, and learn to source photos and video honestly â€" own shots, client photos with permission, and free stock within licence.
Preparation before class	Projector connected and tested; the free Canva account ready on academy computers; the creative brief template (Section F.2) printed per learner; the repurposing worksheet printed; the Canva brand-kit example ready on screen; sample phone photos of food (prepared by the instructor â€" no copyrighted images); the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief and the Session 3 calendar available; academy Wi-Fi confirmed.

Running client reminder. *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" fictional small food business in Rumuola, Port Harcourt. Sells local meals (jollof, fried rice, small chops, plantain, fish) for pickup and delivery. Prices â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦8,000. Owner "Chef Nkechi" cooks with two assistants, takes orders on one WhatsApp line. Instagram and Facebook pages silent for three months. Wants consistent posting for 30 days and more WhatsApp orders â€" no advertising budget. Has been burned by someone who bought her fake followers.

Instructor note on tone. This is the session where learners make real things. Many will say "I am not creative" â€" your job is to show them that content creation is a process, not a gift. A creative brief, a phone camera, Canva and a clear goal are all they need. Keep the mood hands-on and encouraging. Walk the room constantly during the practical â€" this is where learners need you most.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Write** a creative brief that turns a calendar row into a clear content instruction.
2. **Repurpose** one idea into four post formats â€" a Reel, a carousel, a story and a caption set.
3. **Design** one readable, on-brand Canva post at the correct size with consistent colours, fonts and a logo.
4. **Source** photos and video honestly â€" own shots, client photos with permission, and free stock within licence.
5. **Explain** how to work with editors and photographers â€" brief, references, feedback, deadlines, payment and credit.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera and enough storage for photos and a few short videos.
- Academy computers (one per learner or one per pair) with Canva loaded.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- Free natural light and a phone stand or improvised support (a stack of books works) for the asset-shooting exercise.

Software

- Canva (free plan) â€" the core design tool. Every learner needs a free account (created in Session 1).
- A notes app or Google Docs for the creative brief.
- Optional: a free video editor (CapCut free tier or Canva's built-in editor) for the Reel exercise.

Sample files

- **Creative brief template** (Section F.2) â€" printed per learner.
- **Repurposing worksheet** â€" a table: *One idea / Reel / Carousel / Story / Caption set*.
- **Sample phone photos** of food â€" prepared by the instructor (own shots or clearly credited). No copyrighted images.
- **Canva brand-kit example** â€" colours, fonts and a logo ready on screen.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 4.1 â€" "Creative Brief Builder" (the template above).
- Worksheet 4.2 â€" "One Idea, Four Posts" (the repurposing worksheet above).

Accounts

- Free Canva account per learner. Free social media accounts. No paid tools.

Internet

- Academy Wi-Fi for Canva. If Wi-Fi fails, the creative brief and repurposing worksheets still work offline â€" the Canva design can be demonstrated and done as a paper sketch.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a camera works. A learner without a device may work with a partner â€" one shoots, one directs. The skill today is the *process*, not the device.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor: Every photo, video and graphic used in this session must be original, properly licensed or clearly credited. No copyrighted images without permission. No posting a person's face without consent. No reposting another creator's work without credit. This is the session where good sourcing habits are built â€" model them explicitly.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two versions of the same Instagram post for the running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*. Both promote the same thing â€" jollof rice, â‚¦1,500 a plate. Do not explain which is "better" yet.

Post A â€" "No brief." A blurry photo of jollof, taken in dim light, with a hand partially covering the frame. The caption says: "Our jollof is available. Order now." No price visible in the image. No WhatsApp number. The hashtags are #food #jollof #rice #yummy #instagood #photooftheday #love.

Post B â€" "With a brief." A clear, well-lit photo of jollof in a clean bowl, with a simple Canva price graphic â€" "Jollof Rice â€" â‚¦1,500" â€" and the WhatsApp order number. The caption reads: "Smoky jollof, cooked fresh every morning ðŸ□² â‚¦1,500 a plate. Free delivery in Port Harcourt. ðŸ'‰ DM 'JOLLOF' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order. #TasteOfRiversKitchen #PortHarcourtFood #PHJollof"

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at these two posts. Same business, same dish, same price. Post A was made without a plan â€" a quick snap, a vague caption, random hashtags. Post B was made with a plan â€" a clear photo, a designed price graphic, a caption with a hook, a value and a CTA. Which post would you order from? â€¦ Post B, obviously. Now here is the question: was Post B made by someone more talented than the person who made Post A? No. It was made by someone who followed a **process**. Today you learn that process. It is called a creative brief, and it turns 'post something about jollof' into a clear instruction that anyone can follow."*

Expected learner response: Learners will point at Post B and say "it looks professional," "it has the price," "it looks clean." Accept all answers. Draw out the difference: *process vs. no process.*

Then reveal the hook: Say:

> *"Post B was not luck. Before anyone picked up a phone or opened Canva, someone wrote down five things: the goal of the post, the audience, the message, the format and the CTA. That is a creative brief â€" and it takes ten minutes. Today you will write one, then use it to create four posts from a single idea. That is the skill: one idea, many posts, all planned."*

Why this opener works: It uses a side-by-side comparison that makes the abstract idea of "a creative brief" concrete. Learners see immediately that planning beats luck â€" and they want to know the process.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five core tasks of a social media manager?"

- Expected answer: Planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting.
- Common gap: learners say "posting" is the main task. Clarify: "Today we go deeper into the *creating* task."

Question 2: "What is a content pillar?"

- Expected answer: A main topic a business posts about again and again â€" connected to the business, the audience and a goal.
- Common gap: learners say "a type of post." Clarify: "Close â€" but a pillar is a *topic*, not a format. 'Menu & prices' is a pillar. 'Image' is a format."

Question 3: "What is a content calendar?"

- Expected answer: A plan that says what to post, when, on which platform, in which format, with which caption idea.
- Common gap: learners say "a list of posts." Clarify: "It is more than a list â€" every row has a pillar, a format, a caption idea and an asset."

Question 4: "What are the three parts of a caption?"

- Expected answer: Hook, value, CTA â€" plus relevant hashtags.
- Common gap: learners say "words and hashtags." Clarify: "The three parts are hook, value and CTA. Hashtags help discovery â€" they are important, but they are not one of the three parts."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"In Session 3 we planned the content â€" pillars, cadence and a calendar. Today we make it. We will write a creative brief, repurpose one idea into four post formats, design a clean Canva graphic, and learn to source photos and video honestly. By the end of this session, you will have four finished posts from a single idea â€" and that is the skill that makes a manager valuable."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 2, spend 3 extra minutes reviewing pillars with a quick example before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 From calendar row to creative brief

The idea. A calendar row says "Menu & prices / Image / 'This week's menu â€" jollof â‚¦1,500.'" That is a plan â€" but it is not yet an instruction anyone can execute. A **creative brief** turns that row into a clear, step-by-step instruction.

Plain-English definition. A creative short document that says exactly what a post should achieve, who it is for, what it should say, what it should look like and what action it should drive.

Why it exists. Without a brief, content is guesswork. The creator does not know the goal, the audience or the CTA â€" so they make something that looks nice but does not work. With a brief, every decision is already made: the goal, the message, the format, the look and the action. The creator just executes.

What a creative brief contains â€" the six parts:

Part	What it says	Example (Taste of Rivers Kitchen)
1. Goal	What the post should achieve.	Get WhatsApp orders for jollof.
2. Audience	Who the post is talking to.	Students and young professionals in Rumuola and GRA.
3. Message	The one thing the audience should know.	Jollof is â‚¦1,500 a plate, cooked fresh every morning, delivered free in Port Harcourt.

Part	What it says	Example (Taste of Rivers Kitchen)
4. Format	What the post looks like.	A single image with a price graphic.
5. Look	The visual style â€" colours, fonts, brand.	Warm colours (orange and brown), the brand font, the Taste of Rivers logo.
6. CTA	What the audience should do.	DM 'JOLLOF' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order.

Worked example â€" a complete creative brief for one post:

> ***Creative Brief â€" Taste of Rivers Kitchen, Monday Menu Post***
>
> 1. ***Goal:*** *Get 10 WhatsApp orders for jollof this week.*
> 2. ***Audience:*** *Students and young professionals in Rumuola and GRA who want a fast, affordable lunch.*
> 3. ***Message:*** *Jollof is â‚¦1,500 a plate, cooked fresh every morning, delivered free in Port Harcourt.*
> 4. ***Format:*** *One Instagram image (1080 x 1080 px) with a price graphic.*
> 5. ***Look:*** *Warm orange and brown, the brand font (Montserrat), the Taste of Rivers logo in the top corner.*
> 6. ***CTA:*** *DM 'JOLLOF' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order.*

The key lesson â€" a brief takes ten minutes and prevents ten mistakes. Without it, the creator might photograph the jollof in dim light, forget the price, use the wrong colours and end the caption with "hope you like it." With it, every decision is already made.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **building plan**. A builder who starts without a plan will build a wall in the wrong place, run out of blocks and argue with the owner about the roof. A builder with a plan knows exactly how many blocks, where the walls go and what the roof looks like. A creative brief is the content creator's building plan.

F.2 Repurposing â€" one idea, four posts

The idea. Repurposing is taking one piece of content â€" one idea, one photo shoot, one video â€" and turning it into several posts for different formats and platforms. It is how a small business creates a week of content from one hour of work.

Plain-English definition. Repurposing is using one idea to make multiple posts, each adapted to a different format or platform, instead of creating from scratch every time.

Why it exists. A small business cannot shoot and edit new content every day. Repurposing multiplies the value of one idea, saves time and keeps the page consistent. It is the difference between a page that posts three times a week from one shoot, and a page that needs three shoots to post three times.

The four repurposing formats â€" one idea, four posts:

Take one idea: *"Jollof is â‚¦1,500 a plate, cooked fresh every morning."*

Format	What it is	How the idea becomes this post
Reel	A 15â€"30 second video.	Film the jollof being cooked â€" steam rising, being plated. Add on-screen text: "Fresh jollof â€" â‚¦1,500." Add a CTA: "DM 'JOLLOF' to order."
Carousel	A multi-image post (3â€"5 slides).	Slide 1: "Our jollof â€" â‚¦1,500." Slide 2: "Cooked fresh every morning." Slide 3: "Free delivery in Port Harcourt." Slide 4: "DM 'JOLLOF' to order."
Story	A disappearing photo or video.	A photo of the jollof with a "Order now" sticker and the WhatsApp link. Runs for 24 hours â€" creates urgency.
Caption set	A caption written for each platform.	Instagram: "Smoky jollof, cooked fresh every morning ðŸ² â‚¦1,500 a plate..." WhatsApp Status: "Fresh jollof â€" â‚¦1,500. Free delivery in PH. Call 0803-XXX-XXXX."

Worked example â€" one photo shoot, four posts:

Chef Nkechi plates a bowl of jollof. The manager:

1. **Takes 5 photos** of the jollof from different angles.
2. **Films a 20-second video** of the jollof being plated.
3. **Uses one photo** for the Instagram image post (with a price graphic).

4. **Uses three photos** for the carousel (menu, cooking, delivery).
5. **Uses the video** for the Reel.
6. **Uses one photo** for the Story (with an "Order now" sticker).
7. **Writes a caption set** â€” one for Instagram, one for WhatsApp Status.

One hour of work. Four posts. That is repurposing.

The key lesson â€” repurpose the idea, not the copy-paste. Repurposing does not mean posting the identical caption everywhere. It means adapting the message to each format and platform. The Instagram caption can be longer; the WhatsApp Status must be shorter. The Reel needs on-screen text; the image needs a price graphic. Same idea, different clothes.

Common misconception. "Repurposing is lazy." No â€” it is efficient. Creating four separate ideas for four posts is what is exhausting. Repurposing is how professionals keep a page consistent without burning out.

F.3 Designing a clean Canva post

The idea. Canva is a free design tool that runs in a browser or on a phone. It is how a manager without design training creates clean, on-brand graphics for a client.

Plain-English definition. Canva gives you templates, colours, fonts, images and simple editing tools â€” so anyone can make a post that looks professional.

Why it exists. A small business cannot afford a designer for every post. Canva's free plan is enough to create a consistent, readable brand look â€” and it is the tool this course uses from today onward.

The five rules of a clean Canva post:

1. **Correct size.** Instagram image: 1080 x 1080 px (square). Instagram Story: 1080 x 1920 px (vertical). Reel cover: 1080 x 1920 px. Use the right size for the format.
2. **Readable text.** Big enough to read on a phone. A good rule: if you have to squint, it is too small. Use 2â€“3 colours maximum for text.
3. **Consistent brand.** Use the same 2â€“3 colours, the same 2 fonts and the same logo on every post. Consistency is what makes a page look professional.
4. **One message per post.** One price, one offer, one CTA. Do not cram five things into one graphic.
5. **Clean background.** A simple photo or a solid colour. Do not clutter the background â€” the message must stand out.

Worked example â€” designing the jollof price graphic in Canva:

1. Open Canva. Search "Instagram Post" â€” choose 1080 x 1080 px.
2. Choose a warm background â€” a soft orange or a photo of the jollof.
3. Add a text box: "Jollof Rice â€” â‚¦1,500." Make it big â€” at least 72 pt.
4. Add a second text box: "Free delivery in Port Harcourt." Smaller â€” 36 pt.
5. Add the Taste of Rivers logo in the top corner.
6. Add a CTA box: "DM 'JOLLOF' to order." At the bottom.
7. Save and download as a PNG.

The key lesson â€” a clean post is readable at phone size. Before finishing any design, zoom out and look at it on a phone. If the price is hard to read, make it bigger. If the colours clash, simplify. If the message is unclear, cut words. A clean post is not fancy â€” it is clear.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **signboard**. A signboard with ten colours, five fonts and three messages is ignored. A signboard with one clear message, big readable text and the shop's colours is noticed. A Canva post is a signboard.

F.4 Sourcing content honestly â€” own shots, client photos, free stock

The idea. Every image and video a manager uses must be **legally and ethically sourced**. There are three honest sources: your own shots, the client's photos (with permission), and free stock within licence.

Plain-English definition. Sourcing is where the content comes from. Honest sourcing means you have the right to use everything you post.

The three honest sources:

Source	What it is	When to use it	Rules
Own shots	Photos and videos you take yourself with your phone.	The best source â€" always prefer this.	You own the content. Make sure any person in the photo has given permission for it to be posted.
Client photos	Photos provided by the client â€" of their products, shop or team.	Useful when the client has good shots already.	Get written permission (a WhatsApp message is enough). Credit the client if they ask. Do not edit their photos in a way that misrepresents the product.
Free stock	Images and videos from free libraries â€" Canva's built-in library, Pexels, Pixabay, Unsplash.	Useful for backgrounds, textures or generic images.	Check the licence. Most free stock allows commercial use with no attribution, but always read the licence. Never use a copyrighted image found on Google.

What is NOT honest sourcing:

- **Taking images from Google** â€" most are copyrighted. Using them without permission is theft.
- **Reposting another creator's content** without credit and permission â€" this violates platform rules and copyright.
- **Using a customer's photo or message** without asking â€" this violates privacy.
- **Editing a photo to misrepresent the product** â€" making food look better than it is with filters that change the colour or adding items that are not included.

Worked example â€" sourcing for the jollof post:

- **Own shots:** The manager photographs the jollof with their phone. This is the main image. âœ"
- **Client photos:** Chef Nkechi sends a photo of her kitchen. The manager asks: "Can I use this on the page?" She says yes. âœ"
- **Free stock:** The manager needs a warm background texture for the Canva graphic. They use one from Canva's free library. âœ"
- **Not okay:** The manager finds a beautiful jollof photo on Google and uses it. âœ˜ (Copyrighted.)

The key lesson â€" when in doubt, shoot it yourself. The best content is the content you create from the client's real business. It is honest, it is original, and it is what makes the page trustworthy.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **market trader**. A trader who sells her own tomatoes is honest. A trader who takes tomatoes from another stall and sells them as her own is a thief. A manager who uses their own shots is honest. A manager who steals images from Google is a thief â€" and they will be caught.

F.5 Working with editors and photographers

The idea. Sometimes a client needs more than a phone photo â€" a professional video, a portrait, a product shoot. A manager may hire an editor or a photographer. Doing that well is a skill.

Plain-English definition. Working with editors and photographers means giving them a clear brief, useful references, honest feedback, a fair deadline, agreed payment and proper credit.

The six rules for working with creatives:

1. **Brief.** Tell them exactly what you need â€" the goal, the style, the format, the deadline. Use the creative brief from Section F.2.
2. **References.** Show them 2â€"3 examples of the style you want. "Something like this, but with our colours."
3. **Feedback.** Be specific and kind. "The colours are too dark â€" can you brighten them?" not "I do not like it."
4. **Deadline.** Agree on a date and stick to it. Do not rush a creative with an impossible deadline.
5. **Payment.** Agree on a price before the work starts. Pay on time. A creative who is not paid will not work with you again.
6. **Credit.** If you publish their work, credit them â€" "Video by @name" or "Photo by @name." It is honest and it builds relationships.

Worked example â€" hiring a videographer for a Reel:

- **Brief:** "I need a 20-second vertical video of jollof being cooked and plated, for Instagram Reels. Warm colours, natural light, the Taste of Rivers logo visible."
- **References:** "Something like this Reel from a Lagos food page â€" but with our kitchen and our branding."
- **Feedback:** "The steam shot is perfect. The plating shot is a little dark â€" can we brighten it?"

- **Deadline:** "I need it by Friday evening for a Saturday post."
- **Payment:** "â‚¦5,000 for the edited video. I will pay 50% now, 50% on delivery."
- **Credit:** "Video by @ChineduFilms" in the caption or on the video.

The key lesson â€” treat creatives as partners, not tools. A photographer or editor who is treated well will do great work for you again. One who will not. The relationships a manager builds with creatives are part of their professional value.

F.6 Summary of the lecture

- A **creative brief** turns a calendar row into a clear instruction â€” goal, audience, message, format, look and CTA.
- **Repurposing** is using one idea to make multiple posts, each adapted to a different format or platform.
- A **clean Canva post** is readable at phone size, uses consistent brand colours and fonts, and has one message.
- **Honest sourcing** means own shots, client photos with permission, or free stock within licence â€” never copyrighted images.
- **Working with editors and photographers** means a clear brief, useful references, honest feedback, a fair deadline, agreed payment and proper credit.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Client brief] --> B[Ideate]
    B --> C[Create in Canva/CapCut]
    C --> D[Write caption]
    D --> E[Get client approval]
    E --> F[Schedule or post]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through a complete content creation process â€” from creative brief to four finished posts â€” for the running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*, so learners see the whole workflow in action.

Setup: On the projector, show a blank creative brief template. Have a sample phone photo of food ready (the instructor's own shot). Have Canva open on the academy computers.

G.1 Demonstration 1 â€” Write the creative brief live (3 minutes)

Say: "Before we create anything, we plan. Let us write a creative brief for Monday's menu post."

Fill in the brief on the projector:

> ***Creative Brief â€” Taste of Rivers Kitchen, Monday Menu Post***
>
> 1. ***Goal:*** *Get 10 WhatsApp orders for jollof this week.*
> 2. ***Audience:*** *Students and young professionals in Rumuola and GRA.*
> 3. ***Message:*** *Jollof is â‚¦1,500 a plate, cooked fresh every morning, delivered free in Port Harcourt.*
> 4. ***Format:*** *One Instagram image (1080 x 1080 px) with a price graphic.*
> 5. ***Look:*** *Warm orange and brown, Montserrat font, Taste of Rivers logo.*
> 6. ***CTA:*** *DM 'JOLLOF' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order.*

Say: "Six lines. Ten minutes. Every decision is already made. Now we execute."

G.2 Demonstration 2 â€” Design the Canva graphic (5 minutes)

Say: "Now we make the post. I have a photo of jollof â€” my own shot, taken this morning. Let us design the graphic in Canva."

Walk through the Canva steps on the projector:

1. Open Canva. Choose "Instagram Post" â€” 1080 x 1080 px.
2. Upload the jollof photo. Set it as the background.
3. Add a semi-transparent warm overlay so the text is readable.

4. Add a text box: "Jollof Rice â€" â‚¦1,500." Make it big â€" 96 pt.
5. Add a second text box: "Free delivery in Port Harcourt." 40 pt.
6. Add the CTA: "DM 'JOLLOF' to order." At the bottom.
7. Show the finished design.

Say: "One photo, one clear message, one price, one CTA. That is a clean post. Now â€" could we use this same photo to make a carousel, a Reel and a story? Yes. That is repurposing."

G.3 Demonstration 3 â€" Repurpose the idea into four posts (5 minutes)

Say: "We have one idea â€" jollof, â‚¦1,500, fresh every morning. Let us turn it into four posts."

Show the four posts on the projector:

Format	What we make
Image	The Canva graphic we just designed.
Carousel	Slide 1: "Our jollof â€" â‚¦1,500." Slide 2: "Cooked fresh every morning." Slide 3: "Free delivery in Port Harcourt." Slide 4: "DM 'JOLLOF' to order."
Reel	A 20-second video of jollof being plated â€" with on-screen text and a CTA.
Story	The jollof photo with an "Order now" sticker and the WhatsApp link.

Caption set:

> ***Instagram:*** *"Smoky jollof, cooked fresh every morning ðŸ□² â‚¦1,500 a plate. Free delivery in Port Harcourt. ðŸ'‰ DM 'JOLLOF' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order. #TasteOfRiversKitchen #PortHarcourtFood #PHJollof"* ***WhatsApp Status:*** *"Fresh jollof â€" â‚¦1,500. Free delivery in PH. Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order."*

Say: "One idea. Four posts. One caption set. That is how a small business creates a week of content from one hour of work."

G.4 Demonstration 4 â€" Source honestly (2 minutes)

Say: "Last â€" where did the photo come from? My own phone, this morning. I did not take it from Google. I did not repost someone else's content. If I wanted to use a customer photo, I would ask first. If I needed a background texture, I would use Canva's free library. Honest sourcing is not hard â€" it is a habit."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What is the first thing we did before creating anything?" (Wrote the creative brief.)
- "How many posts did we make from one idea?" (Four.)
- "Why did we not take the photo from Google?" (Copyright â€" it is not ours to use.)
- "What would we do before posting a customer's photo?" (Ask for permission.)

Expected result: Learners see the complete content creation process â€" brief, design, repurpose, source â€" and they see that it is a process they can follow, not a talent they need to be born with.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner writes a creative brief, designs one Canva post and plans a repurposing set for a new fictional client â€" *Mama Chika's Kitchen*.

Starting materials: The printed creative brief template, the printed repurposing worksheet, a pen, a phone with a camera, and Canva open on the academy computers.

CLIENT BRIEF â€" MAMA CHIKA'S KITCHEN (fictional). *Mama Chika's Kitchen* is a small food business in Diobu, Port Harcourt. It sells small chops, meat pies, doughnuts and zobo. Prices run from â‚¦200 for a meat pie to â‚¦8,000 for a small-chops tray. The business has 400 Instagram followers and posts rarely. The owner, "Mama Chika," wants more customers â€" especially students and office workers near Diobu. She can pay â‚¦15,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name at the top of the creative brief template. Read the client brief once.
2. **Write a creative brief** for one post â€" a photo of small chops. Fill in all six parts: goal, audience, message, format, look, CTA.
3. **Take a photo** of something on your desk or in the room â€" a notebook, a cup, a phone. Pretend it is the small chops. Use natural light if possible.
4. **Open Canva.** Create an Instagram post (1080 x 1080 px). Upload your photo. Add a text box with a price and a CTA. Use two colours and one font.
5. **Fill in the repurposing worksheet.** Take your one idea (small chops, â‚¦8,000 tray) and plan four posts: Reel, carousel, story, caption set.
6. **Pause and predict:** Cover your worksheet and ask yourself: "What is the first thing I did before designing anything?" Write your answer at the bottom.
7. Compare your brief and worksheet with the person beside you. If you chose different CTAs, explain your choices.

Expected result (model answers â€" instructor key):

Creative brief:

- Goal: Get 8 WhatsApp orders for small-chops trays this week.
- Audience: Students and office workers in Diobu.
- Message: Small-chops trays are â‚¦8,000, made fresh, delivered free in Diobu.
- Format: One Instagram image (1080 x 1080 px) with a price graphic.
- Look: Bright colours, bold font, Mama Chika's Kitchen logo.
- CTA: DM 'CHOPS' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order.

Repurposing worksheet:

- Reel: A 20-second video of small chops being packed â€" "Fresh small chops â€" â‚¦8,000 a tray. Order yours."
- Carousel: Slide 1: "Small-chops tray â€" â‚¦8,000." Slide 2: "Made fresh this morning." Slide 3: "Free delivery in Diobu." Slide 4: "DM 'CHOPS' to order."
- Story: A photo of the small chops with an "Order now" sticker.
- Caption set: Instagram caption and a shorter WhatsApp Status version.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "Does your brief have all six parts? Is the CTA specific?"
- After step 4: "Is your text readable at phone size? How many colours did you use?"
- After step 5: "Did you adapt the caption for each format â€" or did you copy-paste the same words everywhere?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner writes "post about small chops" as the message â†' Prompt: "What is the one thing the audience should know? Price? Freshness? Delivery?"
- Learner uses five colours and three fonts in Canva â†' Prompt: "How many colours does a clean post use? Two or three. Simplify."
- Learner copies the same caption for every format â†' Prompt: "How is a Reel caption different from a WhatsApp Status? Adapt the words."
- Learner searches Google for a photo â†' Prompt: "Take your own photo. It is honest and it is yours."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Creative brief has all six parts
- ☐ Photo taken with own phone
- ☐ Canva post designed â€" readable, on-brand, one message
- ☐ Repurposing worksheet filled â€" four posts from one idea
- ☐ Caption set adapted for each platform
- ☐ Pause-and-predict answer: "We planned before creating"

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write a creative brief, design one Canva post and plan a repurposing set for a third fictional client â€" *Emeka's Gadgets* â€" without copying the instructor's or the guided exercise's examples.

Scenario. *Emeka's Gadgets* is a small phone and accessories shop in Rumuokwuta, Port Harcourt. It sells phones, chargers, earphones, power banks and phone accessories. Prices run from â‚¦500 for a charger to â‚¦80,000 for a phone. The shop has 600 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Emeka wants more customers â€" people should see his products, know his prices, and visit his shop. He can pay â‚¦25,000 a month. He does not want fake followers.

Requirements:

1. Write a **creative brief** for one post â€" a photo of a power bank. All six parts.
2. Take a **photo** of something on your desk (pretend it is the power bank).
3. Design one **Canva post** â€" 1080 x 1080 px, readable, on-brand, one message.
4. Fill in the **repurposing worksheet** â€" Reel, carousel, story, caption set.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Creative brief has all six parts.
- Photo taken with own phone.
- Canva post is readable, on-brand and has one message.
- Repurposing worksheet has four posts from one idea.
- Caption set is adapted for each platform.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the message, think â€" what does Emeka want customers to know about the power bank? Price? Capacity? Warranty?
- Hint 2: For the Canva design, use two colours and one font. Keep it simple.
- Hint 3: For the caption set, write a longer Instagram caption and a shorter WhatsApp Status version.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Creative brief:

- Goal: Get 5 orders for power banks this week.
- Audience: Students and young professionals in Rumuokwuta.
- Message: 20,000mAh power bank is â‚¦15,000, charges your phone 4 times, comes with a 6-month warranty.
- Format: One Instagram image (1080 x 1080 px) with a price graphic.
- Look: Black and blue colours, bold font, Emeka's Gadgets logo.
- CTA: DM 'POWER' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order.

Repurposing worksheet:

- Reel: A 20-second video of the power bank charging a phone â€" "This 20,000mAh power bank charges your phone 4 times. â‚¦15,000."
- Carousel: Slide 1: "20,000mAh power bank â€" â‚¦15,000." Slide 2: "Charges your phone 4 times." Slide 3: "6-month warranty." Slide 4: "DM 'POWER' to order."
- Story: A photo of the power bank with an "Order now" sticker.
- Caption set: Instagram caption and a shorter WhatsApp Status version.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Creative brief has all six parts (3)
- Photo taken with own phone (1)
- Canva post readable, on-brand, one message (3)
- Repurposing worksheet has four posts (2)
- Caption set adapted for each platform (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ada's Ankara* is a small fashion business in Port Harcourt that sells ankara dresses and does custom sewing. The owner, Ada, is a skilled tailor. She posts on Instagram â€" but the photos are inconsistent. Some are clear, well-lit shots of dresses. Some are dark, blurry selfies. Some are photos she found on Google of other people's dresses. Her captions are sometimes "New dress available" and sometimes a full description with prices. She has 1,500 followers but only gets about 5 orders a month. She is frustrated. She thinks "Instagram does not work for fashion."

Relevant facts.

- Ada's dresses are genuinely beautiful â€" her customers love them.
- Her photos are inconsistent â€" some professional, some not.
- Some of her photos are taken from Google â€" they are not her dresses.
- Her captions are inconsistent â€" sometimes no price, sometimes no CTA.
- She has no creative brief, no plan and no way to know which posts bring orders.

Decision point. A social media manager has been hired. What should the manager do first â€" and what should they avoid?

Possible approaches.

1. **Post more often** â€" "let us post every day, that will fix it."
2. **Buy followers** â€" "let us get the page to 10,000 followers, then orders will come."
3. **Build a content creation process** â€" creative briefs, own shots, clean Canva designs, repurposing and honest sourcing.

Recommended solution. Approach 3 â€" a content creation process. The manager should:

- **Write a creative brief for every post** â€" goal, audience, message, format, look, CTA.
- **Take own shots** of Ada's dresses â€" clear, well-lit photos with her phone.
- **Stop using Google photos** â€" they are not her dresses, and they are copyrighted.
- **Design clean Canva graphics** â€" consistent colours, fonts and logo.
- **Repurpose one shoot into four posts** â€" image, carousel, Reel, story.
- **Adapt captions for each platform** â€" Instagram, WhatsApp Status.
- **Measure results** â€" which posts bring orders? Do more of that.

What the manager should avoid:

- **Posting more often without a process** â€" seven inconsistent posts a week will not fix a process problem.
- **Buying followers** â€" fake followers bring no orders.
- **Using copyrighted images** â€" this is theft and it will damage Ada's page when she is caught.
- **Expecting instant results** â€" a consistent process takes 30 days to show results.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is easy but ineffective â€" more inconsistent posting will not fix a process problem.
- Approach 2 is cheap but destructive â€" fake followers make the page look big while bringing zero orders.
- Approach 3 takes planning and discipline, but it builds a page that actually brings orders â€" and it gives the manager a process they can use for every client.

Professional connection. This is exactly what a professional manager does â€" and it is what separates a professional from someone who "just posts." A professional does not guess. A professional briefs, shoots, designs, repurposes and measures. That is why a professional can charge â‚¦25,000 a month and a "poster" cannot.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Creating without a brief

Symptoms: Learner designs a post without writing a creative brief first. **Likely cause:** They think a brief is unnecessary â€" "I know what I want to make." **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is the goal of this post? Who is it for? What is the CTA?"

Corrective steps: Write the brief first. Six lines. Ten minutes. Then design. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner writes a brief before creating. **Prevention:** Always ask "what is the goal?" before "what should we make?"

K.2 Copy-pasting the same caption everywhere

Symptoms: Learner writes one caption and uses it for every format and platform. **Likely cause:** They think one caption fits all. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Is this caption right for a Reel? For a WhatsApp Status? How is it different?" **Corrective steps:** Adapt the caption for each format and platform. Instagram can be longer; WhatsApp Status must be shorter. Reels need on-screen text; images need a price graphic. **How to confirm resolved:** The caption set has different versions for different platforms. **Prevention:** Remind the class â€" repurpose the *idea*, not the copy-paste.

K.3 Using copyrighted images from Google

Symptoms: Learner uses a photo found on Google. **Likely cause:** They think "if it is on the internet, it is free to use." **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did you take this photo? Do you have permission to use it?" **Corrective steps:** Use own shots, client photos with permission, or free stock within licence. Never use a copyrighted image from Google. **How to confirm resolved:** Every image is original, credited or properly licensed. **Prevention:** Remind the class â€" when in doubt, shoot it yourself.

K.4 Designing a cluttered post

Symptoms: Canva post has too many colours, fonts or messages. **Likely cause:** They think more = better. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is the one message of this post? Can you read the price on a phone?" **Corrective steps:** Two or three colours, one or two fonts, one message, big readable text. **How to confirm resolved:** The post is readable at phone size with one clear message. **Prevention:** A clean post is not fancy â€" it is clear.

K.5 Not repurposing

Symptoms: Learner creates one post from one idea and stops there. **Likely cause:** They do not yet see the value of repurposing. **How to investigate:** Ask: "You have one photo and one video. How many posts can you make from them?" **Corrective steps:** Plan four posts from one idea â€" image, carousel, Reel, story. **How to confirm resolved:** The repurposing worksheet has four posts. **Prevention:** Remind the class â€" one hour of work, four posts.

K.6 Not crediting creatives

Symptoms: Learner uses an editor's or photographer's work without credit. **Likely cause:** They think credit is optional. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Whose work is this? Did you agree on credit?" **Corrective steps:** Credit the creative â€" "Video by @name" â€" unless they agreed otherwise. **How to confirm resolved:** Every creative's work is credited. **Prevention:** Credit is honest and it builds relationships.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" ask the learner to explain their reasoning, not just their answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Creative Brief and Repurposing Set"

Purpose: To practise turning a content idea into a clear creative brief and a set of four posts â€" the core creation skill of social media management â€" and to produce the sample posts that go into the capstone.

Realistic scenario. You are a social media manager in Port Harcourt. A friend's cousin, *Adaeze*, runs *Adaeze's Fashion* â€" a small fashion business that sells ankara dresses, ready-to-wear outfits and does custom sewing. Prices run from â‚¦5,000 for a simple dress to â‚¦30,000 for a custom ankara gown. The business has 900 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Adaeze is a skilled tailor but she is not online. She wants more customers â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and order from her. She can pay â‚¦35,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Detailed instructions:

1. Write a **creative brief** for one post â€" a photo of an ankara dress. All six parts: goal, audience, message, format, look, CTA.
2. Take a **photo** of something on your desk (pretend it is the ankara dress). Use natural light if possible.
3. Design one **Canva post** â€" 1080 x 1080 px, readable, on-brand, one message.
4. Fill in the **repurposing worksheet** â€" Reel, carousel, story, caption set.

5. Write a **short paragraph** (4â€"6 sentences) explaining to Adaeze, in plain language, why a planned content process will bring her more customers â€" without promising followers or virality.

Required deliverables:

- A creative brief, a Canva post (or a sketch if no computer), a repurposing worksheet.
- The short paragraph to the client.

Submission format: Save as `CreativeBrief_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`) and upload to `/Social-Media-Management/Week2/CreativeBrief/`. You may also copy the brief into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 5.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Creative brief complete	4	All six parts filled; CTA is specific
Photo taken with own phone	2	Original shot; not from Google
Canva post readable and on-brand	4	One message; big text; consistent colours and fonts
Repurposing worksheet complete	4	Four posts from one idea; adapted for each format
Caption set adapted	3	Different versions for different platforms
Client paragraph	3	Plain, honest language; no false promises

Common mistakes to avoid: creating without a brief; copy-pasting the same caption everywhere; using copyrighted images; designing a cluttered post; not repurposing; not crediting creatives; using jargon Adaeze would not understand.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Creative brief:

- Goal: Get 10 dress orders this month.
- Audience: Women in Port Harcourt â€" students, young professionals, event planners.
- Message: Ankara dresses from â‚¦5,000, custom sewing available, delivered in Port Harcourt.
- Format: One Instagram image (1080 x 1080 px) with a price graphic.
- Look: Bold ankara colours, elegant font, Adaeze's Fashion logo.
- CTA: DM 'DRESS' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order.

Repurposing worksheet:

- Reel: A 20-second video of a dress being sewn â€" "From fabric to finished dress. Order yours."
- Carousel: Slide 1: "Ankara dresses â€" from â‚¦5,000." Slide 2: "Custom sewing available." Slide 3: "Delivery in Port Harcourt." Slide 4: "DM 'DRESS' to order."
- Story: A photo of a dress with an "Order now" sticker.
- Caption set: Instagram caption and a shorter WhatsApp Status version.

Paragraph to Adaeze: "Adaeze, a planned content process will bring you more customers because it turns your Instagram page from a silent noticeboard into a working shop. I will post your dresses with clear prices, reply to every customer who messages you, and show you at the end of each month exactly how many people saw your page and how many became orders. I cannot promise you thousands of followers or a viral video â€" no honest person can. But I can promise you consistent, professional work and real numbers you can check. That is how you get customers that actually order from you."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is a creative brief, and what are its six parts?

Q2. List. Name the three honest sources of photos and video.

Q3. Multiple choice. What is the correct size for an Instagram image post in Canva? a) 500 x 500 px b) 1080 x 1080 px c) 1920 x 1080 px d) 1080 x 1920 px

Q4. Explain. What is repurposing, and why is it valuable for a small business?

Q5. Scenario. A client says: "Just find nice photos on Google and post them." Write two sentences explaining why you will not do that â€" and what you will do instead.

Q6. Matching. Match each format to its best use: Image, Reel, Carousel, Story, Text post. a) A multi-image post for a list or "3 reasonsâ€¦" b) A 15â€"60 second video for behind the scenes or tutorials c) A single photo for menus, products or customer photos d) A disappearing post for quick updates or limited-time offers e) Words only for announcements or questions

Q7. True or false. A clean Canva post uses as many colours and fonts as possible to stand out.

Q8. Fill in the blank. Before posting a customer's photo, you must ask for their _____.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q8)

A1. A creative brief is a short document that says exactly what a post should achieve, who it is for, what it should say, what it should look like and what action it should drive. The six parts are: goal, audience, message, format, look, CTA.

A2. Own shots (photos and videos you take yourself), client photos (with permission), and free stock (within licence).

A3. (b) 1080 x 1080 px. (That is the square Instagram image size. 1080 x 1920 px is for Stories and Reels.)

A4. Repurposing is taking one idea â€" one photo shoot, one video â€" and turning it into several posts for different formats and platforms. It is valuable because it multiplies the value of one idea, saves time and keeps a small business consistent without burning out.

A5. Model answer: "I will not use photos from Google because most are copyrighted â€" using them without permission is theft and it will damage your page. Instead, I will take clear photos of your products with my phone, and I will use free stock from Canva's library for backgrounds. That is honest and it is yours." (Accept any answer that refuses copyrighted images and offers honest sourcing.)

A6. Image = (c); Reel = (b); Carousel = (a); Story = (d); Text post = (e).

A7. False. A clean Canva post uses two or three colours and one or two fonts â€" consistency and readability, not variety, make a post look professional.

A8. Before posting a customer's photo, you must ask for their **permission**.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned how to create content for a client. You learned to write a **creative brief** â€" six lines that turn a calendar row into a clear instruction: goal, audience, message, format, look, CTA. You learned to **repurpose** one idea into four post formats â€" Reel, carousel, story and caption set â€" so one hour of work becomes a week of content. You learned to design a **clean Canva post** â€" readable at phone size, consistent colours and fonts, one message. You learned to **source honestly** â€" own shots, client photos with permission, free stock within licence, never copyrighted images from Google. And you learned to **work with editors and photographers** â€" brief, references, feedback, deadlines, payment, credit.

Five important takeaways:

1. **A creative brief prevents ten mistakes** â€" goal, audience, message, format, look, CTA.
2. **Repurposing multiplies your work** â€" one idea, four posts, each adapted.
3. **A clean Canva post is readable at phone size** â€" two colours, one font, one message.
4. **Honest sourcing is a habit** â€" own shots, permission, free stock within licence.
5. **Treat creatives as partners** â€" brief, feedback, deadline, payment, credit.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I write a creative brief with all six parts?
- Can I repurpose one idea into four posts?
- Can I design a clean, readable Canva post?
- Can I source photos and video honestly?

- Can I explain the rules for working with an editor or photographer?

Connection to the next session. You now know how to create content â€" but content without a community is a shout into the void. Next session we learn what happens after you press "post": replying to comments and DMs quickly and warmly, moderating a community, handling negative comments without arguing, and building a reply bank. You will produce ten replies and a moderation policy â€" and that becomes part of your capstone's community guidelines.

Say it with us: *No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof.*

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner writes a complete creative brief before creating.
- Learner takes own photos rather than searching Google.
- Learner designs a clean, readable Canva post.
- Learner repurposes one idea into four adapted posts.
- Learner sources images honestly and credits creatives.
- Learner explains the rules for working with editors and photographers.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A brief is unnecessary â€" I know what to make." â† A brief prevents ten mistakes.
- "One caption fits all platforms." â† Adapt the words for each format.
- "Google images are free to use." â† Most are copyrighted â€" use own shots or licensed stock.
- "More colours and fonts = better." â† Two or three colours, one or two fonts, one message.
- "Repurposing is lazy." â† It is how professionals stay consistent without burning out.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Brief fill-in:** give a partially completed creative brief and ask the learner to fill in the missing parts.
2. **Repurposing drill:** give one idea and ask the learner to plan four posts in five minutes.
3. **Canva clean-up:** give a cluttered Canva design and ask the learner to simplify it to two colours, one font and one message.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed creative brief and a pre-selected Canva template; the learner fills in the blanks and customises the design.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written â€" a complete brief, a Canva post and a repurposing set.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to create a complete repurposing set for two different ideas (eight posts total) and write a short "content creation guide" â€" one paragraph explaining the process to a new manager who has never created content before.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners completing a creative brief and a repurposing set (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the Canva demonstration (G.2) and protect the guided practical â€" the ability to plan and repurpose is the core skill. If the room is fast, extend the sourcing discussion (F.4) and let learners share their Canva designs with the class.

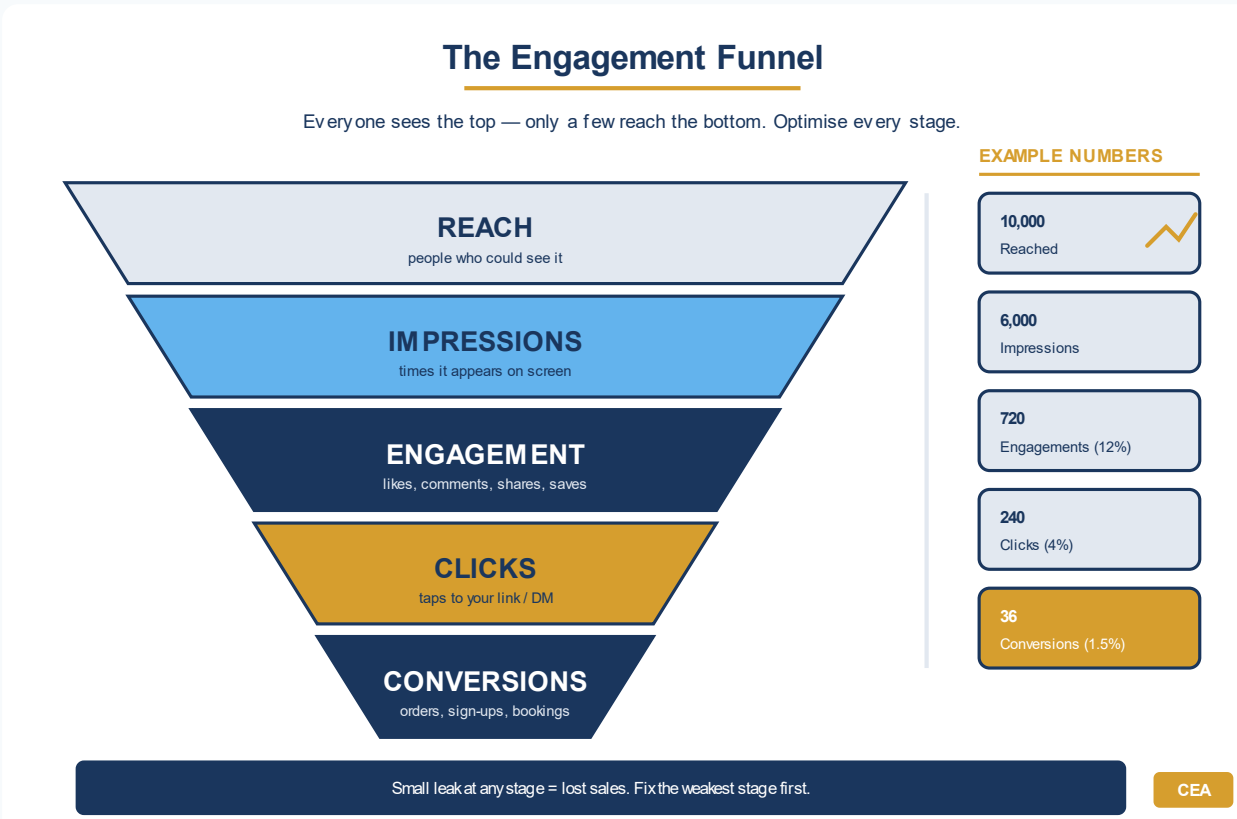
END OF SESSION 4

Next: Session 5 â€" Community Management and Engagement.

SESSION 05 OF 9

Community Management and Engagement

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 05



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

SESSION 5 â€" COMMUNITY MANAGEMENT AND ENGAGEMENT

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	5 of 9
Session title	Community Management and Engagement
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Create and Manage
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with community management)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"4 â€" the learner can define social media management, list the five core tasks, build a strategy, design a content calendar, write a creative brief and create content. Everyday

Item	Detail
	social media use assumed. No prior customer service or moderation experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 4 we created content â€" briefs, Canva posts, repurposing sets. Today we do the work that happens *after* the post goes live. We reply to comments and DMs quickly and warmly, moderate a community, handle negative comments without arguing, and build a ten-reply bank with a moderation policy. That reply bank becomes part of the capstone's community-management guidelines.
Preparation before class	Projector connected and tested; the ten comment and DM scenarios (Section H) printed per learner; the moderation-policy template printed; the tone-of-voice worksheet printed; the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief available; a whiteboard for the live reply build; academy Wi-Fi confirmed.

Running client reminder. *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" fictional small food business in Rumuola, Port Harcourt. Sells local meals (jollof, fried rice, small chops, plantain, fish) for pickup and delivery. Prices â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦8,000. Owner "Chef Nkechi" cooks with two assistants, takes orders on one WhatsApp line. Instagram and Facebook pages silent for three months. Wants consistent posting for 30 days and more WhatsApp orders â€" no advertising budget. Has been burned by someone who bought her fake followers.

Instructor note on tone. This session is where learners discover that community management is not "just replying" â€" it is the skill that turns a page into a business. Many learners will say "I already know how to reply to comments" â€" your job is to show them that professional replies are different from personal replies: they are warm, correct, on-brand, prompt and never defensive. Keep the mood practical and role-play friendly. The scenario exercise is where learners will do their best work â€" protect that time.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why community management is a paid service and what happens when a business ignores its comments and DMs.
2. **Define** a brand's tone of voice and write replies that match it consistently.
3. **Reply** to comments and DMs quickly, warmly and usefully â€" using the brand's tone.
4. **Apply** a moderation rule â€" delete spam and abuse, keep legitimate criticism, block only real troublemakers.
5. **Respond** to a negative comment without arguing, insulting or deleting legitimate criticism.
6. **Build** a ten-reply bank covering common scenarios â€" questions, orders, compliments, complaints and spam.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a notes app or Google Docs.
- Academy computers (one per learner or one per pair) for Google Docs.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- A whiteboard or flipchart and markers.

Software

- A notes app on every phone.
- Google Docs (free) for the reply bank and moderation policy.

Sample files

- **Ten comment and DM scenarios** (Section H) â€" printed per learner. These are invented for the course: questions, orders, compliments, complaints, spam and a difficult customer.
- **Moderation-policy template** â€" a blank table: *What happens / What I do / Why*.
- **Tone-of-voice worksheet** â€" a table: *Taste of Rivers voice / This means / Example*.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 5.1 â€" "Tone of Voice Builder" (the worksheet above).
- Worksheet 5.2 â€" "My Ten-Reply Bank" (a table: *Scenario / My reply / Tone check*).
- Worksheet 5.3 â€" "My Moderation Policy" (the template above).

Accounts

- Free social media accounts (from Session 1). No paid tools.

Internet

- Academy Wi-Fi for Google Docs. If Wi-Fi fails, the scenarios and worksheets are printed â€" the session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app or a printed worksheet works. A learner without a device may work with a partner â€" one reads the scenario, one writes the reply. The skill today is the *reply*, not the device.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor: Community management involves real emotional situations â€" complaints, anger, conflict. Remind the class: we never argue publicly, we never insult a commenter, we never post a customer's private details, and we never delete legitimate criticism. We handle conflict with calm professionalism. Role-play the difficult scenarios with care â€" no learner should feel attacked or humiliated.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two fictional Instagram comment threads under the same post â€" a photo of jollof rice from *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*. Do not explain which is "better" yet.

Thread A â€" "The Silent Business."

> ***Customer 1:*** *"Do you deliver to GRA?" (No reply. Posted 3 days ago.)* ***Customer 2:*** *"How much is the small chops tray?" (No reply. Posted 2 days ago.)* ***Customer 3:*** *"This jollof looks fire ðŸ"¥" (No reply. Posted 1 day ago.)* ***Customer 4:*** *"I ordered last week and the food was cold. Disappointed." (No reply. Posted 5 hours ago.)*

Thread B â€" "The Managed Business."

> ***Customer 1:*** *"Do you deliver to GRA?"* ***Taste of Rivers:*** *"Yes! We deliver to GRA in about 45 minutes. Send us a DM and we'll get your order started. ðŸ□²"* ***Customer 2:*** *"How much is the small chops tray?"* ***Taste of Rivers:*** *"The small-chops tray is â,¦8,000 and it serves 4â€"6 people. Want me to save one for you?"* ***Customer 3:*** *"This jollof looks fire ðŸ"¥"* ***Taste of Rivers:*** *"Thank you! Come and taste it â€" it's cooked fresh every morning. ðŸ□²"* ***Customer 4:*** *"I ordered last week and the food was cold. Disappointed."* ***Taste of Rivers:*** *"I'm really sorry about that â€" that is not the standard we want. Please send us a DM with your order details and we will make it right. Thank you for telling us."*

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at these two threads. Same post, same customers. Thread A is silent â€" the business never replied. Thread B replied to every single comment â€" quickly, warmly and professionally. Now tell me: which business would you order from? â€¦ Thread B, obviously. And here is the secret: Thread B was not lucky. Someone was paid to sit and reply to those comments. That someone is a social media manager, and what they do is called community management. It is one of the most valuable services a manager sells â€" because it turns followers into customers and customers into regulars. Today you learn to do it."*

Expected learner response: Learners will point at Thread B and say "they replied," "they were nice," "they handled the complaint well." Accept all answers. Draw out the difference: *silence vs. engagement.*

Then reveal the hook: Say:

> *"Thread A is the most common small business page in Nigeria â€" post and silence. Thread B is a business that understands that the comment section is not a noticeboard â€" it is a shop floor. Every comment is a customer standing in front of you. Reply well, and they buy. Ignore them, or reply badly, and they leave. Today you learn to reply like Thread B."*

Why this opener works: It uses a side-by-side comparison that makes the value of community management immediate and emotional. Learners see that silence loses customers and good replies win them â€" and they want to learn the skill.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five core tasks of a social media manager?"

- Expected answer: Planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting.
- Common gap: learners forget "engaging." Clarify: "Today is all about the *engaging* task â€" community management."

Question 2: "What is a creative brief?"

- Expected answer: A short document that says what a post should achieve â€" goal, audience, message, format, look, CTA.
- Common gap: learners say "a plan for a post." Clarify: "Close â€" but it has six specific parts. What are they?" (Goal, audience, message, format, look, CTA.)

Question 3: "What are the three parts of a caption?"

- Expected answer: Hook, value, CTA â€" plus relevant hashtags.
- Common gap: learners say "words and hashtags." Clarify: "The three parts are hook, value and CTA."

Question 4: "What is repurposing?"

- Expected answer: Using one idea to make multiple posts for different formats and platforms.
- Common gap: learners say "posting the same thing everywhere." Clarify: "No â€" repurposing is adapting the same *idea* to different formats. The words change."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"In Session 4 we created the content. Today we manage the community â€" the people who respond to that content. We will define the brand's tone of voice, practise replying to comments and DMs, learn to moderate, handle a negative comment without arguing, and build a ten-reply bank. That reply bank is one of the most practical things you will leave this course with."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 3 extra minutes writing the five tasks on the board with a one-line example of each before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why community management is a paid service

The idea. Community management is the work of replying to comments and DMs, moderating conversations and keeping a page's comment section healthy. It is one of the five core tasks â€" and one of the most valuable services a manager sells.

Plain-English definition. Community management is being present and responsive on a client's page â€" answering questions, thanking customers, handling complaints and keeping the conversation professional.

Why it exists. A post is not the end of the job â€" it is the beginning. When a post goes live, customers respond. They ask questions, place orders, give feedback and sometimes complain. A business that replies quickly and well turns those responses into orders and loyalty. A business that does not reply loses customers to competitors who do.

What happens without community management:

- **Questions go unanswered** â€" "Do you deliver to GRA?" sits for days. The customer orders from somewhere else.
- **Complaints go unhandled** â€" a frustrated customer posts publicly, sees no response, and tells their friends the business does not care.
- **Spam accumulates** â€" scammers and bots fill the comment section with fake links and offers.
- **The page looks abandoned** â€" even regular followers stop commenting because they know no one will reply.
- **The competitor wins** â€" the business next door that replies within the hour gets the orders.

What happens with good community management:

- **Questions become orders** â€" a quick reply turns "Do you deliver?" into "Yes â€" send us a DM."
- **Complaints become loyalty** â€" a customer who is handled well often becomes a regular.
- **The comment section stays clean** â€" spam is removed, abuse is blocked, and legitimate criticism is kept and answered.
- **The page looks alive** â€" followers comment more because they know they will be heard.
- **The business grows** â€" word of mouth and repeat customers are built one reply at a time.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **shop attendant**. A shop with no attendant â€" customers walk in, look around, ask questions to no one, and leave. A shop with a good attendant â€" greets customers, answers questions, handles complaints, keeps the shop tidy â€" that shop builds a loyal clientele. A social media manager is the shop attendant for the online shop.

Important limitation / misconception. Community management cannot fix a bad product or a dishonest business. If the food is genuinely bad, no reply will save it. But for a good business, community management is the difference between a page that looks alive and a page that looks dead.

F.2 Defining the brand's tone of voice

The idea. A brand's **tone of voice** is how it sounds when it speaks online â€" friendly, formal, playful, warm, professional. A manager must define it and use it consistently, so every reply sounds like it comes from the same business.

Plain-English definition. Tone of voice is the personality of the brand's words. Is it warm and casual? Formal and respectful? Fun and playful? The tone must match the business and its audience.

Why it exists. A brand that sounds different every day is confusing. One day formal, one day slangy, one day angry â€" customers do not know what to expect. A consistent tone builds trust. Customers feel they are talking to the same business every time.

How to define the tone â€" the three questions:

1. **What is the business like in person?** A warm, friendly kitchen has a warm, friendly tone. A luxury salon has a polished, professional tone.
2. **Who is the audience?** Students respond to casual warmth. Professionals may expect more polish.
3. **What does the brand never sound like?** No brand sounds angry, sarcastic or dismissive.

Worked example â€" tone of voice for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

Tone rule	This means	Example
Warm and friendly	Like a neighbour who cooks well â€" not a corporation.	"Thank you so much! Come and taste it â€" you'll love it."
Always polite	Never sarcastic, never dismissive, never angry â€" even when the customer is rude.	"I understand your concern. Let me check and get back to you."
Clear and helpful	Answer the question directly â€" no jargon, no confusion.	"Yes, we deliver to GRA in about 45 minutes."
Never defensive	A complaint is a chance to fix a problem, not a fight.	"I'm really sorry about that. Let me make it right."
Never private	Never share a customer's order details, phone number or personal information.	"Please send us a DM and we'll sort this out privately."

The key lesson â€" consistency is the tone. The manager is not "being themselves" â€" they are being the brand. A reply that sounds like Chef Nkechi would say it, every time. If a learner would not say it to a customer's face in the shop, they should not say it in the comments.

Common misconception. "I'll just reply however I feel." No â€" a personal reply is emotional and inconsistent. A professional reply is planned, on-brand and consistent. The tone of voice is the brand's personality, not the manager's mood.

F.3 Replying to comments and DMs

The idea. A reply is a mini-conversation â€" the manager's chance to answer a question, thank a customer, handle a complaint or turn a comment into an order. Good replies are quick, warm, correct and on-brand.

Plain-English definition. A reply is a response to a comment or DM that matches the brand's tone, answers the question and moves the conversation toward a result.

Why it exists. Every comment is a customer raising their hand. A good reply makes them feel heard and guides them to the next step â€" an order, a DM, a visit. A bad reply â€" or no reply â€" makes them feel ignored.

The four rules of a good reply:

1. **Quick.** Reply within a few hours â€" same day if possible. A reply after three days feels like no reply.
2. **Warm.** Thank the customer, use their name if you know it, match the brand's tone.
3. **Correct.** Answer the actual question â€" the price, the delivery area, the opening hours. No guessing, no wrong information.
4. **Action-oriented.** Move the conversation to the next step â€" "Send us a DM," "Call to order," "Visit us today."

Worked example â€" five common scenarios and good replies:

Scenario	Good reply	Why it works
Question: "Do you deliver to GRA?"	"Yes! We deliver to GRA in about 45 minutes. Send us a DM and we'll get your order started. ðŸ²"	Quick, warm, correct, action-oriented.
Order: "I want to order jollof for 4 people."	"Great choice! Jollof is â‚¦1,500 a plate, so 4 plates is â‚¦6,000 with free delivery. Shall I book it for you?"	Confirms the order, gives the total, asks for confirmation.
Compliment: "This jollof looks fire ðŸ”¥"	"Thank you so much! Come and taste it â€" it's cooked fresh every morning. ðŸ²"	Warm, appreciative, invites a visit.
Complaint: "I ordered last week and the food was cold."	"I'm really sorry about that â€" that is not the standard we want. Please send us a DM with your order details and we will make it right."	Apologetic, non-defensive, moves to a private channel.
Spam: "Follow my page for cheap followers!"	*(Delete the comment. Do not reply.)*	Spam is removed, not engaged with.

The key lesson â€" every reply has a job. A reply is not just being polite â€" it is moving the customer toward a result. A question becomes an order. A compliment becomes a visit. A complaint becomes loyalty. Spam becomes nothing.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **waiter in a restaurant**. A good waiter does not just take the order â€" they greet the table, answer questions about the menu, check that the food is satisfactory and handle any problems calmly. A bad waiter disappears. A manager is the online waiter.

F.4 Moderation â€" keeping the comment section healthy

The idea. Moderation is managing the comment section â€" removing what should not be there, keeping what should, and blocking only the people who truly need to be blocked.

Plain-English definition. Moderation is keeping a page's comment section clean, respectful and useful â€" by removing spam and abuse, keeping legitimate criticism and blocking real troublemakers.

Why it exists. A comment section with spam, abuse and fake links looks unprofessional and can drive customers away. A clean comment section builds trust. Moderation is what keeps it healthy.

The moderation rules â€" the four categories:

Category	What it is	What the manager does
Spam	Fake links, "follow for follow," cheap followers, scams.	**Delete.** Do not reply.
Abuse	Insults, threats, hate speech, harassment.	**Delete and block.** Do not engage.
Legitimate criticism	"The food was cold," "Delivery took too long," "Service was slow."	**Keep and respond.** This is feedback â€" handle it well.
Trolling	Deliberately provocative comments designed to start an argument.	**Do not engage.** Delete if it crosses into abuse; block if it continues.

The key lesson â€" never delete legitimate criticism. A manager who deletes every negative comment is hiding from problems â€" and customers notice. A good manager keeps the criticism, responds to it professionally and uses it to improve the business. The only things that get deleted are spam and abuse â€" never honest feedback.

Worked example â€" five comments and what to do:

Comment	Category	Action
"Do you deliver to GRA?"	Question	Reply: "Yes! We deliver in about 45 minutes."
"This is the best jollof in PH! ðŸ"¥"	Compliment	Reply: "Thank you! Come and taste it."
"The food was cold when it arrived."	Legitimate criticism	Reply: "I'm really sorry. Please DM us and we'll make it right."
"Follow my page for cheap followers! #growth"	Spam	Delete. Do not reply.
"You people are scammers, I will report you!"	Trolling / abuse	Do not reply. If it continues, block.

Common misconception. "Delete anything negative." No â€" legitimate criticism is valuable. Delete spam and abuse only. Keep and respond to honest feedback.

F.5 Handling negative comments without arguing

The idea. A negative comment is not an attack â€" it is a customer with a problem. A manager who argues publicly loses the argument in front of everyone. A manager who responds calmly and professionally wins the room.

Plain-English definition. Handling a negative comment means responding without arguing, insulting or deleting legitimate criticism â€" and moving the problem to a private channel where it can be solved.

Why it exists. A negative comment is public. Everyone can see it â€" not just the complainer, but every other customer reading the comments. A bad reply (arguing, insulting, being dismissive) convinces everyone that the business is difficult. A good reply (calm, apologetic, solution-focused) convinces everyone that the business cares.

The four-step response to a negative comment:

1. **Acknowledge.** "I'm really sorry to hear that." â€" Show that you have read and understood the problem.
2. **Apologise (if it is warranted).** "That is not the standard we want." â€" Do not make excuses.
3. **Move to private.** "Please send us a DM with your order details." â€" Take the problem off the public stage.
4. **Fix it.** Resolve the issue in the DM â€" a refund, a replacement, a discount. Then (with the customer's permission) update the public thread: "We've sorted this out â€" thank you for letting us make it right."

Worked example â€" the cold food complaint:

> ***Customer:*** *"I ordered last week and the food was cold. Very disappointed. I won't order again."* ***Bad reply:*** *"That's not true. Our food is always hot. You probably waited too long to eat it." (Arguing, defensive, dismissive â€" everyone sees this.)*
> ***Good reply:*** *"I'm really sorry about that â€" cold food is not what we want for you. Please send us a DM with your order details and we'll make it right. Thank you for telling us." (Calm, apologetic, solution-focused.)*

The key lesson â€" you are not defending yourself; you are protecting the brand. A negative comment is not about you personally. It is about the customer's experience. Your job is to solve the problem, not to win an argument. The moment you argue, you have lost â€" even if you are right.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **market trader**. A customer says "this fish is not fresh." A bad trader argues: "Of course it is fresh, are you blind?" A good trader says: "I'm sorry, let me get you a fresh one â€" and I'll add an extra piece for the trouble." The good trader keeps the customer and wins everyone watching.

Important limitation / misconception. Not every complaint is legitimate. Some people are abusive, some are trolls, some are scammers. The rule is: legitimate criticism gets a calm, solution-focused reply; abuse gets deleted and blocked. The difference is whether the comment is raising a real problem or just trying to cause trouble.

F.6 Building a ten-reply bank

The idea. A **reply bank** is a document with ready-written replies for the ten most common scenarios a business faces. It saves time, keeps the tone consistent and ensures no comment goes unanswered.

Plain-English definition. A reply bank is a collection of prepared replies for common situations â€" questions, orders, compliments, complaints and spam â€" so the manager can respond quickly and consistently.

Why it exists. A manager who writes every reply from scratch will be slow and inconsistent. A reply bank means the manager can find the right reply in seconds, adapt it to the specific comment and send it â€" quickly, warmly and on-brand.

The ten common scenarios â€" and a model reply for each:

#	Scenario	Model reply
1	"Do you deliver to [area]?"	"Yes! We deliver to [area] in about [time]. Send us a DM and we'll get your order started. ðŸ□²"
2	"How much is [item]?"	"[Item] is â‚¦[price]. Want me to save one for you?"
3	"What are your opening hours?"	"We're open [days], [hours]. Come and see us!"
4	"I want to order [item]."	"Great choice! [Item] is â‚¦[price]. Shall I book it for you?"
5	"This looks delicious! ðŸ"¥"	"Thank you so much! Come and taste it â€" it's cooked fresh every morning. ðŸ□²"
6	"Where are you located?"	"We're at [address], [area]. Come and visit us!"
7	"The food was cold / the order was wrong."	"I'm really sorry about that â€" that is not the standard we want. Please send us a DM with your order details and we'll make it right."
8	"I'm a regular customer â€" you people are the best!"	"Thank you so much! Customers like you keep us going. We appreciate you! â□¤ï¸□"
9	"Follow my page for cheap followers! #growth"	*(Delete. Do not reply.)*
10	"You people are scammers!"	"I'm sorry you feel that way. If there's a problem with an order, please send us a DM and we'll sort it out. We want to make it right."

The key lesson â€" adapt, do not copy-paste blindly. A reply bank is a starting point, not a script. The manager should adapt each reply to the specific comment â€" use the customer's name, the specific item, the specific area. The structure stays; the details change.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **customer service desk**. A good customer service team has answers prepared for the most common questions â€" but they adapt each answer to the specific customer. A reply bank is the manager's customer service desk.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **Community management** is the paid service of replying to comments and DMs, moderating and keeping a page's comment section healthy.
- **Tone of voice** is the brand's personality â€" defined by three questions: what is the business like, who is the audience, what does the brand never sound like.
- **Good replies** are quick, warm, correct and action-oriented.
- **Moderation** means deleting spam and abuse, keeping legitimate criticism and blocking only real troublemakers.
- **Handling negative comments** means acknowledging, apologising, moving to private and fixing â€" never arguing.
- **A ten-reply bank** saves time, keeps the tone consistent and ensures no comment goes unanswered.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Comment/DM arrives] --> B{Type?}
    B -->|Positive| C[Thank + engage]
    B -->|Question| D[Answer helpfully]
    B -->|Complaint| E[Apologise + DM]
    B -->|Troll| F[Ignore or hide]
    E --> G[Resolve offline]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through a complete community management session for the running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" reading ten real comments, deciding what to do with each, and writing the replies live.

Setup: On the projector, show a fictional Instagram comment section under a jollof post. There are ten comments. Have a blank reply bank template and a blank moderation policy template visible.

G.1 Demonstration 1 â€" Read and categorise (3 minutes)

Say: "It is Monday morning. I am the manager for Taste of Rivers Kitchen. I open Instagram and see ten comments under Friday's jollof post. Let me read them and decide what to do with each."

Show the ten comments on the projector:

1. "Do you deliver to GRA?"
2. "How much is the small chops tray?"
3. "This jollof looks fire ðŸ"¥"
4. "I want to order jollof for 4 people."
5. "Where are you located?"
6. "I ordered last week and the food was cold. Disappointed."
7. "Follow my page for cheap followers! #growth"
8. "You people are scammers, I will report you!"
9. "This is the best jollof in PH! Thank you!"
10. "What are your opening hours?"

Ask the class: "What category is each comment? Question, order, compliment, complaint, spam, abuse?"

Write the categories on the board:

1. Question â†' Reply
2. Question â†' Reply
3. Compliment â†' Reply
4. Order â†' Reply
5. Question â†' Reply
6. Legitimate complaint â†' Reply
7. Spam â†' Delete
8. Abuse â†' Do not reply; block if it continues
9. Compliment â†' Reply
10. Question â†' Reply

G.2 Demonstration 2 â€" Write the replies live (6 minutes)

Say: "Now let me write the replies. I will use the brand's tone â€" warm, friendly, always polite, clear, never defensive."

Write each reply on the projector:

1. "Do you deliver to GRA?" â†' "Yes! We deliver to GRA in about 45 minutes. Send us a DM and we'll get your order started. ðŸ□²"

2. "How much is the small chops tray?" â†’ "The small-chops tray is â‚¦8,000 and it serves 4â€“6 people. Want me to save one for you?"
3. "This jollof looks fire ðŸ”¥" â†’ "Thank you so much! Come and taste it â€” it's cooked fresh every morning. ðŸ˜Š"
4. "I want to order jollof for 4 people." â†’ "Great choice! Jollof is â‚¦1,500 a plate, so 4 plates is â‚¦6,000 with free delivery. Shall I book it for you?"
5. "Where are you located?" â†’ "We're at Rumuola, Port Harcourt â€” right near the market. Come and visit us!"
6. "I ordered last week and the food was cold. Disappointed." â†’ "I'm really sorry about that â€” cold food is not what we want for you. Please send us a DM with your order details and we'll make it right. Thank you for telling us."
7. "This is the best jollof in PH! Thank you!" â†’ "Thank you so much! Customers like you keep us going. We appreciate you! ðŸ¤—"
8. "What are your opening hours?" â†’ "We're open Monday to Saturday, 8 a.m. to 8 p.m. Come and see us!"

Say: "Eight replies. Two actions â€” delete the spam, do not engage with the abuse. Every reply is quick, warm, correct and on-brand. That is community management."

G.3 Demonstration 3 â€” Build the moderation policy (4 minutes)

Say: "Now let me write a simple moderation policy â€” a set of rules I follow every time I moderate."

Write the policy on the projector:

> ***Taste of Rivers Kitchen â€” Moderation Policy***
>
> - ***Spam*** *(fake links, "follow for follow," cheap followers): Delete. Do not reply.*
> - ***Abuse*** *(insults, threats, hate speech): Delete and block. Do not engage.*
> - ***Legitimate criticism*** *(cold food, slow delivery, wrong order): Keep and respond. Move to DM to fix.*
> - ***Trolling*** *(deliberately provocative): Do not engage. Delete if it crosses into abuse; block if it continues.*
> - ***Never share private details****: Never post a customer's order details, phone number or personal information.*
> - ***Never argue publicly****: A complaint is a chance to fix a problem, not a fight.*

Say: "Six rules. That is a moderation policy. It keeps the comment section clean and the brand protected."

G.4 Demonstration 4 â€” The reply bank (2 minutes)

Say: "Last â€” I save these replies in a reply bank. Next time someone asks 'Do you deliver to GRA?' I do not start from scratch. I find the reply in the bank, adapt it and send it. That is how a manager is fast and consistent."

Show the reply bank template with the ten scenarios and the model replies filled in.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Which comments did I reply to, and which did I delete?" (Replied to 8, deleted 1, did not engage with 1.)
- "How did I handle the cold food complaint?" (Acknowledged, apologised, moved to DM, fixed.)
- "What would happen if I argued with the complaint?" (Everyone would see it â€” the brand would look bad.)
- "What is the reply bank for?" (Speed and consistency.)

Expected result: Learners see a complete community management session â€” read, categorise, reply, moderate, build a policy and a reply bank â€— and they see that it is a process they can follow, not a personality trait they need to be born with.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner builds a ten-reply bank and a moderation policy for a new fictional client â€” *Glamour Touch Salon*.

Starting materials: The printed ten-scenario worksheet, the printed moderation-policy template, the printed tone-of-voice worksheet, a pen. No phone needed â€” it is a writing exercise.

CLIENT BRIEF â€” GLAMOUR TOUCH SALON (fictional). *Glamour Touch Salon* is a hair and beauty salon in Port Harcourt. It offers braids, weaves, natural hair care and make-up. Prices run from â‚¦1,000 for a basic braid to â‚¦15,000 for a full weave

installation. The salon has 800 Instagram followers and posts rarely. The owner, "Aunty Funke," wants more bookings â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and call to book. She can pay â¦20,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name at the top of the reply bank worksheet. Read the client brief once.
2. **Define the tone of voice.** Fill in the tone-of-voice worksheet â€" what is the salon's voice, and what does it never sound like?
3. **Write ten replies.** For each of the ten scenarios, write a reply that matches the tone of voice. (The scenarios: delivery question, price question, opening hours, order, compliment, location, complaint, regular customer, spam, abuse.)
4. **Build the moderation policy.** Fill in the moderation-policy template â€" what happens to spam, abuse, legitimate criticism and trolling.
5. **Pause and predict:** Cover your worksheets and ask yourself: "If a customer complains that their braid came loose after one week, what do I do?" Write your answer at the bottom.
6. Compare your reply bank with the person beside you. If you wrote different replies, explain your choices.

Expected result (model answers â€" instructor key):

Tone of voice:

- Warm and professional â€" like a skilled stylist who treats every customer with care.
- Always polite, never sarcastic, never dismissive.
- Clear and helpful â€" answer the question directly.
- Never defensive â€" a complaint is a chance to fix a problem.
- Never share private details.

Ten replies (example):

1. "Do you do home service?" â† "Yes! We do home service within Port Harcourt. Send us a DM and we'll arrange it."
2. "How much is a full weave installation?" â† "A full weave installation is â¦15,000. Want me to book you a slot?"
3. "What are your opening hours?" â† "We're open Monday to Saturday, 9 a.m. to 6 p.m. Come and see us!"
4. "I want to book a braid appointment." â† "Great! What style and what day works for you? Send us a DM and we'll confirm."
5. "This braid looks stunning! ðŸ"¥" â† "Thank you! Our stylists are the best. Come and let them do yours."
6. "Where are you located?" â† "We're in the shopping plaza, Rumuola. Come and visit us!"
7. "My braid came loose after one week. Disappointed." â† "I'm really sorry about that â€" that is not the standard we want. Please send us a DM and we'll fix it for free. Thank you for telling us."
8. "I've been coming here for two years â€" you people are the best!" â† "Thank you so much! Customers like you keep us going. We appreciate you! â¤ï¸"
9. "Follow my page for cheap followers!" â† *(Delete. Do not reply.)*
10. "You people are scammers!" â† "I'm sorry you feel that way. If there's a problem with your appointment, please send us a DM and we'll sort it out."

Moderation policy:

- Spam: Delete. Do not reply.
- Abuse: Delete and block. Do not engage.
- Legitimate criticism: Keep and respond. Move to DM to fix.
- Trolling: Do not engage. Delete if it crosses into abuse.
- Never share private details.
- Never argue publicly.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "Does every reply match the tone of voice? Read one aloud â€" does it sound like the brand?"
- After step 5: "What did you write for the braid complaint? Did you argue â€" or did you fix?"
- After step 6: "Compare your replies. Are they different? Why?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner writes "That's not true" for the complaint â† Prompt: "Is that how the brand sounds? What does the tone of voice say?"

- Learner writes a reply to the spam comment â†' Prompt: "Do we reply to spam? What do we do?"
- Learner deletes the legitimate complaint â†' Prompt: "Is that spam or abuse? No â€" it is a real problem. What do we do with it?"
- Learner writes a reply that is too long â†' Prompt: "A reply is short and clear. Can you cut it to two lines?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Tone of voice defined â€" warm, professional, never defensive
- ☐ Ten replies written â€" each matches the tone
- ☐ Spam deleted, not replied to
- ☐ Legitimate complaint kept and answered calmly
- ☐ Moderation policy filled in â€" four categories
- ☐ Pause-and-predict answer: complaint handled, not argued

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Build a ten-reply bank and a moderation policy for a third fictional client â€" *Chinedu's Barbershop* â€" without copying the instructor's or the guided exercise's examples.

Scenario. *Chinedu's Barbershop* is a small barbershop in Rumuokwuta, Port Harcourt. It offers haircuts, beard trims, and kids' haircuts. Prices run from â‚¦1,000 for a basic cut to â‚¦3,000 for a premium cut with beard trim. The shop has 600 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Chinedu is good with customers but he is not online. He wants more walk-in customers â€" people should see his work, know his prices, and find his shop. He can pay â‚¦20,000 a month. He does not want fake followers.

Requirements:

1. Define the **tone of voice** â€" what is the barbershop's voice, and what does it never sound like?
2. Write **ten replies** â€" for the ten common scenarios (question, price, opening hours, booking, compliment, location, complaint, regular customer, spam, abuse).
3. Build the **moderation policy** â€" four categories: spam, abuse, legitimate criticism, trolling.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Tone of voice defined and consistent across all replies.
- Ten replies written â€" each matches the tone.
- Spam deleted, not replied to.
- Legitimate complaint kept and answered calmly.
- Moderation policy covers four categories.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the tone, think â€" a barbershop is friendly, casual and professional. Not too formal, not too slangy.
- Hint 2: For the complaint, use the four-step response: acknowledge, apologise, move to private, fix.
- Hint 3: For the moderation policy, use the four categories: spam, abuse, legitimate criticism, trolling.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Tone of voice:

- Friendly and casual â€" like a skilled barber who treats every customer with respect.
- Always polite, never sarcastic, never dismissive.
- Clear and helpful â€" answer the question directly.
- Never defensive â€" a complaint is a chance to fix a problem.
- Never share private details.

Ten replies (example):

1. "Do you do kids' cuts?" â†' "Yes! We do kids' cuts from â‚¦1,000. Bring your little one â€" we'll take good care of them."
2. "How much is a premium cut with beard trim?" â†' "A premium cut with beard trim is â‚¦3,000. Want me to book you a slot?"

3. "What are your opening hours?" â†’ "We're open Monday to Saturday, 9 a.m. to 7 p.m. Walk in anytime!"
4. "I want to book an appointment for Saturday." â†’ "Great! What time works for you? Send us a DM and we'll confirm."
5. "That fade is sharp! ðŸ”¥" â†’ "Thanks! Our barbers are the best. Come and let them work on you."
6. "Where are you located?" â†’ "We're on the main road, Rumuokwuta â€" right by the filling station. Come and see us!"
7. "My cut was uneven. Disappointed." â†’ "I'm really sorry about that â€" that is not the standard we want. Please send us a DM and we'll fix it for free. Thank you for telling us."
8. "I've been coming here for three years â€" best barber in Rumuokwuta!" â†’ "Thank you so much! Customers like you keep us going. We appreciate you! â□¤ï¸□"
9. "Follow my page for cheap followers!" â†’ *(Delete. Do not reply.)*
10. "You people are scammers!" â†’ "I'm sorry you feel that way. If there's a problem with your cut, please send us a DM and we'll sort it out."

Moderation policy:

- Spam: Delete. Do not reply.
- Abuse: Delete and block. Do not engage.
- Legitimate criticism: Keep and respond. Move to DM to fix.
- Trolling: Do not engage. Delete if it crosses into abuse.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Tone of voice defined and consistent (2)
- Ten replies written â€" each matches the tone (3)
- Spam deleted, not replied to (1)
- Legitimate complaint handled calmly (2)
- Moderation policy covers four categories (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Mama J's Small Chops* is a small food business in Port Harcourt that sells small chops, meat pies and doughnuts. The owner, Mama J, posts on Instagram â€" but she does not reply to comments. She thinks "the food will speak for itself." Her comment section is full of unanswered questions: "Do you deliver to GRA?" "How much is the tray?" "What are your opening hours?" She also has several spam comments â€" "Follow my page for cheap followers!" â€" that she does not know how to remove. One frustrated customer posted: "I ordered and nobody even replied to my message. I went somewhere else." That comment is still there, unanswered, three weeks later.

Relevant facts.

- Mama J's small chops are genuinely good â€" they sell out every Saturday.
- She has 1,500 Instagram followers but only gets about 10 orders a week.
- Her comment section has 20+ unanswered questions.
- She has 5 spam comments she does not know how to remove.
- She lost at least 3 customers who posted complaints and got no reply.
- She is willing to pay â‚¦15,000 a month for someone to manage her comments.

Decision point. A social media manager has been hired. What should the manager do first â€" and what should they avoid?

Possible approaches.

1. **Post more often** â€" "let us post every day, that will fix it."
2. **Buy followers** â€" "let us get the page to 5,000 followers, then orders will come."
3. **Manage the community** â€" reply to every comment, moderate the spam, handle complaints professionally and build a reply bank.

Recommended solution. Approach 3 â€" manage the community. The manager should:

- **Reply to every comment** â€" questions, orders, compliments â€" within a few hours.
- **Delete the spam** â€" remove the "follow my page for cheap followers" comments.
- **Handle the complaints** â€" acknowledge, apologise, move to DM, fix.

- **Build a reply bank** â€" ten ready replies for the most common scenarios.
- **Write a moderation policy** â€" clear rules for spam, abuse, criticism and trolling.
- **Set a response-time target** â€" reply within 2 hours during business hours.

What the manager should avoid:

- **Arguing with the complaint** â€" "I ordered and nobody replied" is a real problem. Arguing will make it worse.
- **Deleting the complaint** â€" legitimate criticism should be kept and answered.
- **Ignoring the spam** â€" spam makes the page look unprofessional.
- **Promising to reply instantly, 24/7** â€" a realistic target is a few hours during business hours.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is easy but ineffective â€" more posts will not fix a reply problem.
- Approach 2 is cheap but destructive â€" fake followers bring no orders.
- Approach 3 takes time and discipline, but it turns the comment section into a sales channel â€" and it builds the kind of loyalty that word of mouth cannot buy.

Professional connection. This is exactly what a professional manager does â€" and it is what separates a professional from someone who "just posts." A professional understands that the comment section is not a noticeboard â€" it is a shop floor. Every comment is a customer standing in front of you. Reply well, and they buy. Ignore them, or reply badly, and they leave.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Replying slowly or not at all

Symptoms: Comments sit for days without a reply. **Likely cause:** The manager does not check the page regularly, or does not understand that speed matters. **How to investigate:** Ask: "When did you last check the comments? How long did it take you to reply?" **Corrective steps:** Set a daily routine â€" check comments at least twice a day (morning and evening). Reply within a few hours. Use a reply bank to be faster. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can explain the daily routine and the response-time target. **Prevention:** Remind the class â€" a reply after three days feels like no reply.

K.2 Arguing with a negative comment

Symptoms: The manager writes "That's not true" or "You are wrong" in response to a complaint. **Likely cause:** They take the complaint personally. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Are you defending yourself or protecting the brand? Who can see this reply?" **Corrective steps:** Use the four-step response â€" acknowledge, apologise, move to private, fix. Never argue publicly. **How to confirm resolved:** The reply is calm, apologetic and solution-focused. **Prevention:** The moment you argue, you have lost â€" even if you are right.

K.3 Deleting legitimate criticism

Symptoms: The manager deletes every negative comment. **Likely cause:** They think negative comments are bad for the page. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Is this spam or abuse? No â€" it is a real problem. What should we do with it?" **Corrective steps:** Keep legitimate criticism. Respond to it professionally. Use it to improve the business. **How to confirm resolved:** The complaint is kept and answered calmly. **Prevention:** Delete spam and abuse only â€" never honest feedback.

K.4 Replying to spam

Symptoms: The manager replies to spam comments â€" "Stop spamming!" or "Who are you?" **Likely cause:** They want to confront the spammer. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What happens when you reply to spam? Does it stop â€" or does it encourage more?" **Corrective steps:** Delete spam. Do not reply. Replying to spam signals that the page is active and encourages more spam. **How to confirm resolved:** Spam is deleted silently. **Prevention:** Spam is removed, not engaged with.

K.5 Using an inconsistent tone

Symptoms: One reply is formal, the next is slangy, the next is angry. **Likely cause:** The manager has not defined the brand's tone of voice. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is the brand's voice? Read your last three replies â€" do they sound like the same business?" **Corrective steps:** Define the tone of voice â€" three questions: what is the business like, who is the audience, what

does the brand never sound like. Apply it to every reply. **How to confirm resolved:** All replies sound like the same brand. **Prevention:** The tone of voice is the brand's personality, not the manager's mood.

K.6 Sharing private details publicly

Symptoms: The manager posts a customer's order details or phone number in the comments. **Likely cause:** They are trying to be helpful â€" "Look, this customer ordered 4 plates." **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did the customer give permission for this information to be public?" **Corrective steps:** Never share private details publicly. Move order details and personal information to DM. **How to confirm resolved:** No private details in public comments. **Prevention:** Privacy is a trust rule â€" break it once and the client loses confidence.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" ask the learner to explain their reasoning, not just their answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Ten-Reply Bank and Moderation Policy"

Purpose: To practise replying to real community scenarios professionally â€" the core skill of community management â€" and to produce the reply bank and moderation policy that go into the capstone's community-management guidelines.

Realistic scenario. You are a social media manager in Port Harcourt. A friend's sister, *Adaeze*, runs *Adaeze's Fashion* â€" a small fashion business that sells ankara dresses, ready-to-wear outfits and does custom sewing. Prices run from â‚¦5,000 for a simple dress to â‚¦30,000 for a custom ankara gown. The business has 900 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Adaeze is a skilled tailor but she is not online. She wants more customers â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and order from her. She can pay â‚¦35,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Detailed instructions:

1. Define the **tone of voice** â€" what is Adaeze's Fashion's voice, and what does it never sound like?
2. Write **ten replies** â€" for the ten common scenarios: home delivery question, price question, opening hours, order/booking, compliment, location, complaint, regular customer, spam, abuse.
3. Build the **moderation policy** â€" four categories: spam, abuse, legitimate criticism, trolling.
4. Write a **short paragraph** (4â€"6 sentences) explaining to Adaeze, in plain language, why replying to comments will bring her more customers â€" without promising specific results.

Required deliverables:

- A tone-of-voice definition, a ten-reply bank and a moderation policy.
- The short paragraph to the client.

Submission format: Save as `ReplyBank_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`) and upload to `/Social-Media-Management/Week2/ReplyBank/`. You may also copy the reply bank into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 6.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Tone of voice defined	2	Clear, consistent, matches the business
Ten replies written	6	Each matches the tone; quick, warm, correct, action-oriented
Complaint handled calmly	3	Acknowledged, apologised, moved to private, fixed
Spam deleted, not replied to	2	Deleted silently
Moderation policy	4	Four categories covered
Client paragraph	3	Plain, honest language; no false promises

Common mistakes to avoid: replying slowly; arguing with complaints; deleting legitimate criticism; replying to spam; using an inconsistent tone; sharing private details publicly; using jargon Adaeze would not understand.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Tone of voice:

- Warm and elegant â€" like a skilled tailor who treats every customer with care.
- Always polite, never sarcastic, never dismissive.
- Clear and helpful â€" answer the question directly.
- Never defensive â€" a complaint is a chance to fix a problem.
- Never share private details.

Ten replies (example):

1. "Do you do home service?" â†' "Yes! We do home service within Port Harcourt. Send us a DM and we'll arrange a consultation."
2. "How much is a custom ankara gown?" â†' "A custom ankara gown starts at â‚¦30,000, depending on the fabric and style. Want to discuss your design?"
3. "What are your opening hours?" â†' "We're open Monday to Saturday, 10 a.m. to 6 p.m. Come and see our collection!"
4. "I want to order a dress." â†' "Great! What style and size? Send us a DM and we'll guide you through the process."
5. "This dress is stunning! ðŸ"¥" â†' "Thank you! Adaeze's craftsmanship is the best. Come and let her make one for you."
6. "Where are you located?" â†' "We're in Rumuola, Port Harcourt â€" near the market. Come and visit our shop!"
7. "The dress I ordered doesn't fit. Disappointed." â†' "I'm really sorry about that â€" that is not the standard we want. Please send us a DM and we'll alter it for free. Thank you for telling us."
8. "I've been buying from you for two years â€" best tailor in PH!" â†' "Thank you so much! Customers like you keep us going. We appreciate you! â□¤ï¸□"
9. "Follow my page for cheap followers!" â†' *(Delete. Do not reply.)*
10. "You people are scammers!" â†' "I'm sorry you feel that way. If there's a problem with your order, please send us a DM and we'll sort it out."

Moderation policy:

- Spam: Delete. Do not reply.
- Abuse: Delete and block. Do not engage.
- Legitimate criticism: Keep and respond. Move to DM to fix.
- Trolling: Do not engage. Delete if it crosses into abuse.

Paragraph to Adaeze: "Adaeze, replying to comments will bring you more customers because every comment is someone raising their hand. When someone asks 'Do you do home service?' and you reply quickly and warmly, they become a customer. When someone complains and you handle it professionally, they become a loyal regular. And when other people read those replies, they see a business that cares. I cannot promise you a specific number of orders â€" no honest person can. But I can promise you that every comment will be answered, every complaint will be handled, and the page will look alive. That is how trust is built."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is community management, and why is it a paid service?

Q2. List. Name the four rules of a good reply.

Q3. Multiple choice. A customer posts: "The food was cold when it arrived." What should the manager do? a) Delete the comment. b) Reply: "That's not true. Our food is always hot." c) Reply: "I'm really sorry. Please send us a DM and we'll make it right." d) Ignore the comment.

Q4. Explain. What is a tone of voice, and why must it be consistent?

Q5. Scenario. A comment says: "Follow my page for cheap followers! #growth" What do you do â€" and why?

Q6. Matching. Match each category to the right action: Spam, Abuse, Legitimate criticism, Trolling. a) Delete and block. Do not engage. b) Delete. Do not reply. c) Do not engage. Delete if it crosses into abuse. d) Keep and respond. Move to DM to fix.

Q7. True or false. A manager should delete every negative comment to protect the brand.

Q8. Fill in the blank. The four-step response to a negative comment: _____, _____, move to _____, and _____.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q8)

A1. Community management is the work of replying to comments and DMs, moderating conversations and keeping a page's comment section healthy. It is a paid service because it turns followers into customers and customers into regulars â€” and because a business that ignores its comments loses customers to competitors who reply.

A2. Quick, warm, correct, action-oriented.

A3. (c) "I'm really sorry. Please send us a DM and we'll make it right." (Deleting hides the problem; arguing makes it worse; ignoring it loses the customer.)

A4. A tone of voice is the brand's personality â€” how it sounds when it speaks online. It must be consistent because a brand that sounds different every day is confusing, and customers feel they are talking to the same business every time when the tone is consistent.

A5. Delete the comment. Do not reply. Spam is removed, not engaged with â€” replying to spam signals that the page is active and encourages more spam.

A6. Spam = (b); Abuse = (a); Legitimate criticism = (d); Trolling = (c).

A7. False. A manager should delete spam and abuse only â€” never legitimate criticism. Honest feedback should be kept and answered professionally.

A8. The four-step response: acknowledge, apologise, move to private, and fix.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that community management is a paid service â€” the work of replying to comments and DMs, moderating conversations and keeping a page's comment section healthy. You learned to define a brand's tone of voice â€” warm, polite, clear, never defensive. You learned the four rules of a good reply â€” quick, warm, correct, action-oriented. You learned to moderate â€” delete spam and abuse, keep legitimate criticism, block only real troublemakers. You learned to handle negative comments without arguing â€” acknowledge, apologise, move to private, fix. And you learned to build a ten-reply bank â€” ten ready replies for the most common scenarios â€” so you can respond quickly and consistently.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Community management is a paid service** â€” silence loses customers; good replies win them.
2. **Tone of voice is the brand's personality** â€” defined, consistent, never defensive.
3. **Good replies are quick, warm, correct and action-oriented.**
4. **Moderation means deleting spam and abuse â€” never legitimate criticism.**
5. **A ten-reply bank saves time and keeps the tone consistent.**

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain why community management is a paid service?
- Can I define a brand's tone of voice and write replies that match it?
- Can I reply to a question, an order, a compliment and a complaint?
- Can I handle a negative comment without arguing?
- Can I build a ten-reply bank and a moderation policy?

Connection to the next session. You now know how to manage the community â€” but community management is only one part of the workflow. Next session we learn the tools and the process: how to connect Instagram and Facebook in Meta Business Suite, schedule posts, use free schedulers for TikTok, X and LinkedIn, run a draftâ€“reviewâ€“approve workflow, onboard a client and draft a working agreement. You will schedule three posts and produce a draft agreement â€” and that becomes part of your capstone.

Say it with us: *No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof.*

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner explains why community management is a paid service â€" not just "replying."
- Learner defines a tone of voice and writes replies that match it consistently.
- Learner replies quickly, warmly and correctly to all scenario types.
- Learner handles a negative comment without arguing.
- Learner deletes spam and abuse but keeps legitimate criticism.
- Learner builds a complete ten-reply bank and a moderation policy.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "The food will speak for itself â€" no need to reply." â†' Silence loses customers; good replies win them.
- "I'll reply however I feel." â†' A professional reply is planned, on-brand and consistent.
- "Delete anything negative." â†' Keep and answer legitimate criticism; delete spam and abuse only.
- "Arguing with a complaint shows strength." â†' Arguing publicly loses the room â€" calm professionalism wins it.
- "A reply bank is a script to copy-paste blindly." â†' Adapt the reply to the specific comment; the structure stays, the details change.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Tone check:** give five replies with inconsistent tones and ask the learner to rewrite them in one defined tone.
2. **Complaint response drill:** give three complaint scenarios and ask the learner to write a reply using the four-step response.
3. **Moderation sort:** give ten comments (spam, abuse, criticism, trolling, questions) and ask the learner to categorise each and state the action.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed reply bank â€" five replies already written â€" and ask the learner to write the remaining five and the moderation policy.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written â€" a complete ten-reply bank and moderation policy for a new client.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write a "community management guide" â€" a one-page document explaining the tone of voice, the reply rules, the moderation policy and the response-time target to a new manager who has never managed a community before. The guide must be in plain language, not jargon.

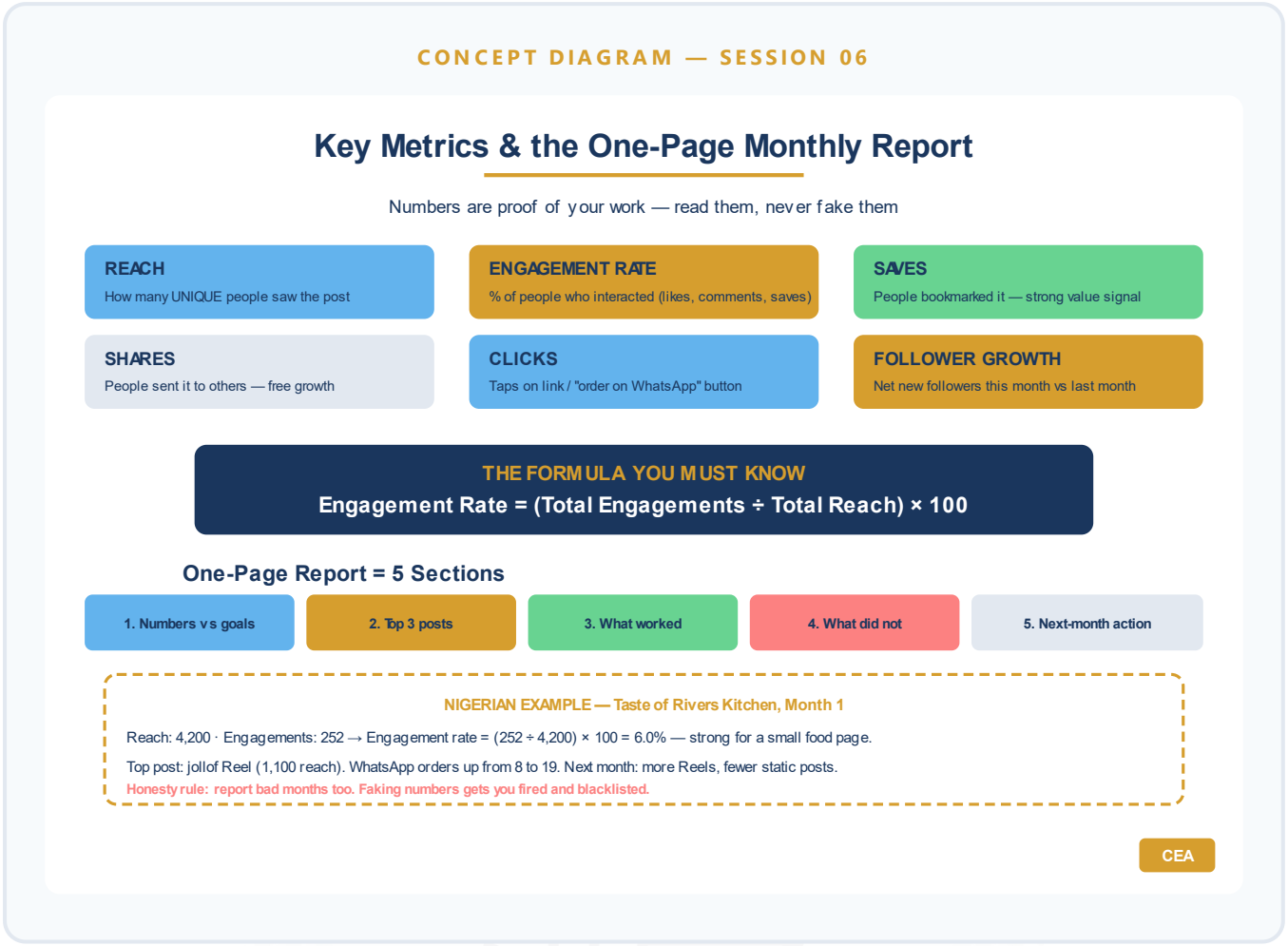
Timing guidance. The priority is learners completing a ten-reply bank and a moderation policy (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the tone-of-voice section (F.2) and protect the guided practical â€" the ability to write professional replies is the core skill. If the room is fast, extend the case study discussion and let learners role-play the difficult complaint scenarios in pairs.

END OF SESSION 5

Next: Session 6 â€" Scheduling, Tools and Client Workflow.

SESSION 06 OF 9

Scheduling Tools and Client Workflow



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

SESSION 6 â€" SCHEDULING, TOOLS AND CLIENT WORKFLOW

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	6 of 9
Session title	Scheduling, Tools and Client Workflow
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Create and Manage
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first hands-on tool setup)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"5 â€" the learner can define social media management, list the five core tasks, build a strategy, design a content calendar, create content, manage a community and build a

Item	Detail
	reply bank. Basic smartphone and computer use assumed. No prior tool setup or client management experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 5 we learned to manage the community â€" replying, moderating and building a reply bank. Today we learn the tools and the workflow that make everything run smoothly: connecting Instagram and Facebook in Meta Business Suite, scheduling posts, using free schedulers for TikTok, X and LinkedIn, running a draftâ€"reviewâ€"approve workflow, onboarding a client and drafting a working agreement.
Preparation before class	Academy computers with Meta Business Suite loaded and a test Instagram + Facebook connection ready; projector connected and tested; the working agreement template (Section F.5) printed per learner; the scheduling worksheet printed; the onboarding checklist printed; the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief available; academy Wi-Fi confirmed.

Running client reminder. *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" fictional small food business in Rumuola, Port Harcourt. Sells local meals (jollof, fried rice, small chops, plantain, fish) for pickup and delivery. Prices â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦8,000. Owner "Chef Nkechi" cooks with two assistants, takes orders on one WhatsApp line. Instagram and Facebook pages silent for three months. Wants consistent posting for 30 days and more WhatsApp orders â€" no advertising budget. Has been burned by someone who bought her fake followers.

Instructor note on tone. This session is where the course becomes operational. Learners have been building skills for five sessions â€" today they learn the tools and the process that tie it all together. Many learners will be nervous about the tools â€" your job is to show them that Meta Business Suite, Google tools and free schedulers are simple once you know where to click. Walk slowly, step by step, and let learners follow on their own devices. The goal is not perfection today â€" it is confidence that they can do this on their own.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Connect** Instagram and Facebook in Meta Business Suite and explain why a manager uses it.
2. **Schedule** three posts in Meta Business Suite or another free tool, with the correct format, caption and time.
3. **Run** a draft â†' review â†' approve â†' schedule workflow that keeps the client involved and mistakes out.
4. **Onboard** a client professionally â€" collecting access, information and expectations safely and honestly.
5. **Draft** a one-page working agreement covering scope, deliverables, payment, revisions and account ownership.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with the Meta Business Suite app installed (or access via a browser).
- Academy computers (one per learner or one per pair) with Meta Business Suite loaded.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- A whiteboard or flipchart and markers.

Software

- **Meta Business Suite** (free) â€" the core tool. Connect Instagram + Facebook, schedule posts, use the unified inbox, read insights.
- **Buffer or Later** (free tier) â€" for scheduling TikTok, X and LinkedIn posts.
- **Google Sheets** (free) â€" content calendars and report tables.
- **Google Docs** (free) â€" briefs, proposals, working agreements.
- **Google Drive** (free) â€" storing assets and sharing drafts with a client.
- **WhatsApp Business** (free) â€" the normal client-communication channel in Nigeria.

Sample files

- **Working agreement template** (Section F.5) â€" printed per learner.
- **Scheduling worksheet** â€" a table: *Post / Platform / Date / Time / Caption / Asset*.
- **Onboarding checklist** â€" a list: *Account access / Brand assets / Client information / Expectations / Communication channel*.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 6.1 â€" "My Scheduling Plan" (the scheduling worksheet above).
- Worksheet 6.2 â€" "My Working Agreement" (the template above).
- Worksheet 6.3 â€" "My Onboarding Checklist" (the checklist above).

Accounts

- Meta Business Suite connected to a practice Instagram and Facebook account. Free Buffer or Later account. Free Google accounts. No paid tools.

Internet

- Academy Wi-Fi for Meta Business Suite and Google tools. If Wi-Fi fails, the scheduling worksheet and working agreement template still work offline â€" the concepts are the priority.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any smartphone or computer with a browser works. A learner without a device may work with a partner â€" one operates the tool, one follows the steps on paper. The skill today is the *process*, not the device.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor: Account access is a trust issue. When onboarding a client, a manager must handle login details securely, never share them, and always return them if the relationship ends. Remind the class: account access is a privilege, not a right. Also remind them â€" never schedule posts that are not approved, never use a client's money without written approval, and always keep a record of what was agreed.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two fictional "week in the life" scenarios for the same manager â€" one using tools and a workflow, one doing everything manually. Do not explain which is "better" yet.

Scenario A â€" "The Organised Manager."

- Monday: Opens Meta Business Suite. Sees three posts already scheduled for the week â€" Monday, Wednesday, Friday, with captions and images ready. Checks the inbox â€" five comments from last week, all already replied to. Spends 15 minutes reviewing the week.
- Wednesday: Checks the scheduled post â€" it goes live at 12 p.m. automatically. Replies to three new comments within an hour.
- Friday: Pulls the week's insights â€" reach, engagement, DMs. Fills in the monthly report. Sends it to the client with a WhatsApp message: "Here is this week's report. The jollof video did best â€" 500 views and 12 DMs. Next week we post more of that."

Scenario B â€" "The Chaotic Manager."

- Monday: Realises no posts are scheduled. Rushes to write a caption and find a photo. Posts at 3 p.m. â€" no plan, no approval. Forgets to post on Wednesday. Posts twice on Friday.
- Wednesday: Opens Instagram â€" 15 unanswered comments. Replies to three, forgets the rest. Does not know how to check insights.
- Friday: Realises the client asked for a report two weeks ago. Rushes to find screenshots. Cannot find the numbers. Sends a message: "The page is doing well. Lots of engagement." No specifics.

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at these two managers. Same job, same client, same week. Manager A is calm, consistent and professional â€" because they use tools and a workflow. Manager B is stressed, inconsistent and unprofessional â€" because they do everything manually and hope. Here is the secret: Manager A is not smarter or more talented. Manager A just knows three things â€" what tools to use, how to schedule posts, and how to run a workflow that keeps the client involved. Today you learn those three things. By the end of this session, you will be Manager A."*

Expected learner response: Learners will point at Scenario A and say "they are organised," "they have a system," "they are not stressed." Accept all answers. Draw out the difference: *tools + workflow vs. chaos.*

Then reveal the hook: Say:

> *"Manager A uses Meta Business Suite â€" a free tool that connects Instagram and Facebook, schedules posts and shows the inbox in one place. They also use a simple workflow â€" draft, review, approve, schedule â€" so the client sees everything before it goes live. These are not expensive tools or complicated systems. They are free and simple. But using them is the difference between a professional and an amateur. Let us learn to use them."*

Why this opener works: It uses a side-by-side comparison that makes the value of tools and workflow immediate and emotional. Learners see that organisation is not a personality trait â€" it is a set of tools and a process they can learn.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five core tasks of a social media manager?"

- Expected answer: Planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting.
- Common gap: learners forget "posting." Clarify: "Today we go deeper into the *posting* task â€" specifically, scheduling posts in tools."

Question 2: "What is a content calendar?"

- Expected answer: A plan that says what to post, when, on which platform, in which format, with which caption idea.
- Common gap: learners say "a list of posts." Clarify: "It is a table â€" one row per post, with a pillar, format, caption idea and asset."

Question 3: "What is a reply bank?"

- Expected answer: A collection of prepared replies for the ten most common scenarios.
- Common gap: learners say "a list of comments." Clarify: "It is a list of *replies* â€" for questions, orders, compliments, complaints and spam."

Question 4: "What are the four rules of a good reply?"

- Expected answer: Quick, warm, correct, action-oriented.
- Common gap: learners say "be nice." Clarify: "Be specific â€" quick, warm, correct, action-oriented."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"In the last three sessions we planned content, created it and managed the community. Today we learn the tools and the workflow that make it all run smoothly. We will connect Instagram and Facebook in Meta Business Suite, schedule three posts, run a draftâ€"reviewâ€"approve workflow, onboard a client and draft a working agreement. By the end of this session, you will have the operational skills to run a client's social media professionally."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 2, spend 3 extra minutes reviewing the content calendar structure before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why tools matter â€" the manager's toolkit

The idea. A professional manager does not work from memory and hope. They use a small set of free tools that handle scheduling, communication, storage and reporting. Knowing these tools is part of the job.

Plain-English definition. The manager's toolkit is the set of free tools a social media manager uses to schedule posts, communicate with the client, store assets and produce reports.

Why it exists. A manager who tries to run a client's social media from their personal Instagram app will miss messages, forget to post and lose track of what was agreed. The tools solve these problems â€" and they are all free.

The five core tools:

Tool	What it does	Why the manager uses it
Meta Business Suite	Connects Instagram + Facebook; schedules posts; shows the inbox; shows insights.	The core tool â€" one place for Instagram and Facebook.
Buffer or Later (free tier)	Schedules posts for TikTok, X and LinkedIn.	Covers the platforms Meta Business Suite does not.
Google Sheets	Content calendars and report tables.	Free, shareable, always accessible.
Google Docs	Briefs, proposals, working agreements.	Free, shareable, easy to edit.
Google Drive	Stores photos, videos and brand assets.	Free, shareable, organised.
WhatsApp Business	Client communication â€" the normal channel in Nigeria.	Where the client actually is.

The key lesson â€" tools are free and simple. A manager does not need paid software, a laptop or a big team. A phone, a free Meta Business Suite account and Google tools are enough to run a small client professionally.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **market trader**. A trader who keeps all their stock in their head will forget what they have, lose sales and run out of the right items. A trader with a notebook, a stall and a scale â€" simple tools â€" runs a better business. A manager's tools are the notebook and the scale.

Important limitation / misconception. Tools do not replace skill. A manager who does not know what to post will schedule the wrong content just as fast as they post it manually. The tools make the workflow efficient â€" the strategy and the content are still the manager's job.

F.2 Meta Business Suite â€" the core tool

The idea. Meta Business Suite is Meta's free tool for managing Instagram and Facebook from one place. It is the most important tool a manager learns in this course.

Plain-English definition. Meta Business Suite connects a client's Instagram and Facebook accounts so the manager can post to both, reply to messages from both and see the numbers for both â€" from one dashboard.

Why it exists. Without it, the manager has to switch between the Instagram app and the Facebook app, post twice, reply twice and check insights twice. With it, everything is in one place â€" faster, more consistent and more professional.

The four main features:

1. **Connect accounts.** Link the client's Instagram and Facebook pages to Meta Business Suite. (The client must give permission â€" see Section F.4.)
2. **Schedule posts.** Write a caption, upload a photo or video, choose a date and time, and the post goes live automatically â€" on both platforms if needed.
3. **Unified inbox.** See and reply to comments and DMs from Instagram and Facebook in one place.
4. **Insights.** See reach, engagement, clicks and follower growth â€" the numbers needed for the monthly report.

Worked example â€" scheduling a post in Meta Business Suite:

1. Open Meta Business Suite (app or browser).
2. Click "Create Post."
3. Choose Instagram and Facebook (or just one).
4. Upload the jollof photo.
5. Write the caption: "Smoky jollof, cooked fresh every morning ðŸ²â,¦1,500 a plate. Free delivery in Port Harcourt. ðŸ‘‰ DM 'JOLLOF' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order. #TasteOfRiversKitchen #PortHarcourtFood"
6. Choose the date and time: Friday, 12 p.m.
7. Click "Schedule."

8. The post goes live automatically at Friday 12 p.m. â€" no one needs to be online.

The key lesson â€" scheduling is setting it and forgetting it. A manager who schedules a week of posts on Monday does not have to think about posting for the rest of the week. They can focus on engaging, creating and reporting.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **timer on a rice cooker**. A cook who sets the timer does not have to watch the pot â€" they can do other things. Scheduling posts is setting the timer for the content.

F.3 Free schedulers for TikTok, X and LinkedIn

The idea. Meta Business Suite covers Instagram and Facebook â€" but not TikTok, X and LinkedIn. For those platforms, a manager uses a free scheduler like Buffer or Later.

Plain-English definition. Buffer and Later are free tools that let a manager schedule posts for TikTok, X and LinkedIn â€" so all platforms are covered.

Why it exists. A client who wants to be on four platforms needs a way to schedule all of them. Meta Business Suite covers two; Buffer or Later covers the rest.

The free tier limits â€" and how to work within them:

- **Buffer free tier:** Up to 3 channels, 10 scheduled posts per channel. Enough for one client on TikTok, X and LinkedIn.
- **Later free tier:** Up to 1 social set, 30 scheduled posts per platform. Enough for one client on the three platforms.

Worked example â€" scheduling a TikTok post in Buffer:

1. Open Buffer.
2. Connect the TikTok account.
3. Click "Create Post."
4. Upload the 20-second jollof video.
5. Write the caption: "Fresh jollof â€" â‚¦1,500 a plate ðŸ² #TasteOfRiversKitchen #PortHarcourtFood"
6. Choose the date and time: Wednesday, 5 p.m.
7. Click "Schedule."
8. The post goes live automatically at Wednesday 5 p.m.

The key lesson â€" free tiers are enough for one client. A manager with one client does not need a paid plan. The free tiers of Meta Business Suite, Buffer and Later are sufficient. A manager with multiple clients may eventually upgrade â€" but not on day one.

Common misconception. "I need a paid scheduler." No â€" the free tiers are enough for one or two clients. Start free, upgrade only when the workload demands it.

F.4 The draftâ€"reviewâ€"approveâ€"schedule workflow

The idea. A **workflow** is the process a manager follows to get a post from idea to live â€" with the client involved at the right moment. The standard workflow is: draft â†' review â†' approve â†' schedule.

Plain-English definition. The approval workflow is a four-step process: the manager drafts the post, the client reviews it, the client approves it (or requests changes), and the manager schedules it.

Why it exists. A manager who posts without approval risks publishing wrong prices, off-brand content or mistakes the client did not see. A manager who waits for approval on everything is slow. The workflow balances speed and safety â€" the client sees everything, but the manager keeps moving.

The four steps:

Step	Who does it	What happens
1. Draft	Manager	Write the caption, design the graphic, prepare the post.
2. Review	Client	The manager sends the draft to the client (WhatsApp, email or Google Docs). The client reads it, checks the price and wording.
3. Approve	Client	The client says "approved" or requests changes. If changes are needed, the manager updates and resends.

Step	Who does it	What happens
4. Schedule	Manager	Once approved, the manager schedules the post in Meta Business Suite or another tool.

Worked example â€” the workflow for a Friday post:

- **Monday:** The manager drafts the Friday post â€” caption, photo, Canva graphic. Sends it to Chef Nkechi on WhatsApp: "This is Friday's post. Please check the price and wording. I'll schedule it for Friday 12 p.m. unless you tell me to change something."
- **Tuesday:** Chef Nkechi replies: "Change â‚¦1,500 to â‚¦1,600 â€” I changed the price this week." The manager updates the graphic and caption. Confirms: "Updated. Scheduling for Friday 12 p.m."
- **Friday 12 p.m.:** The post goes live automatically. The manager checks that it posted correctly and replies to the first comments.

The key lesson â€” the workflow protects both sides. The client is protected because they see everything before it goes live. The manager is protected because they have written approval â€” if the client later says "I never saw that," the manager has the message.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **building inspector**. A builder who builds without inspection may make expensive mistakes. An inspection before the wall is closed catches problems early. The approval workflow is the content inspection.

Important limitation / misconception. The workflow does not mean the client controls every word. The manager is the professional â€” they write the captions, design the graphics and make the decisions. The client reviews and approves â€” they do not rewrite. A manager who lets the client rewrite everything is not managing; they are typing.

F.5 Client onboarding â€” the first week

The idea. Onboarding is the process of starting work with a new client â€” collecting access, information and expectations so the manager can do the job properly. It sets the tone for the whole relationship.

Plain-English definition. Onboarding is the first week of a client relationship â€” where the manager collects what they need, sets expectations and establishes how the two will work together.

Why it exists. A manager who starts without onboarding will miss passwords, post the wrong content, misunderstand the client's goals and frustrate the client within a month. Onboarding prevents that â€” it is the foundation of a professional relationship.

The onboarding checklist â€” what to collect in the first week:

Item	What it is	Why the manager needs it
Account access	Instagram and Facebook login details (handled securely).	To connect accounts and schedule posts.
Brand assets	Logo, brand colours, fonts, any existing photos.	To create consistent, on-brand content.
Client information	Business name, address, phone number, opening hours, prices.	To write correct captions and answer customer questions.
Expectations	What the client wants â€” orders, bookings, awareness â€” and how often.	To set realistic goals and deliverables.
Communication channel	The client's preferred way to communicate â€” WhatsApp, email, phone.	To keep the client informed and get approvals.
Login security	How the client will share passwords securely â€” and how they will be returned if the relationship ends.	To build trust and protect the client's accounts.

The key lesson â€” onboarding is a trust exercise. A client is handing over their business's online presence. The manager must handle that with care â€” collect what is needed, explain why, and never share or misuse access. A manager who is careless with access will lose the client â€” and their reputation.

Worked example â€” the first week with a new client:

- **Day 1:** Call or meet the client. Explain the process. Collect the onboarding checklist items.

- **Day 2:** Connect the accounts in Meta Business Suite. Set up the brand assets in Canva.
- **Day 3:** Write the strategy (audience, goals, platforms, pillars â€" from Sessions 2 and 3). Send it to the client for feedback.
- **Day 4:** Build the first week's content calendar. Send it to the client for approval.
- **Day 5:** Draft the first three posts. Send them for review. Schedule once approved.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **new employee's first week**. A good employer does not hand a new employee a desk and say "get to work." They show them around, introduce the team, explain the rules and set expectations. Onboarding is the manager doing that for themselves â€" professionally and clearly.

F.6 The working agreement â€" the rules of the relationship

The idea. A **working agreement** is a one-page document that says exactly what the manager will do, what the client will do, how much it costs and how the two will work together. It is not a legal contract â€" it is a professional understanding in writing.

Plain-English definition. A working agreement is a simple document that covers scope, deliverables, payment, revisions and account ownership â€" so both sides know what to expect.

Why it exists. A manager and client who work from a verbal agreement will disagree within a month â€" about prices, about how many posts, about who owns the account. A working agreement prevents that by putting everything in writing before the work starts.

The seven parts of a working agreement:

Part	What it says	Example
1. Scope	What the manager will do â€" and what they will not do.	"I will create and schedule 12 posts per month, manage comments and DMs, and provide a monthly report. I will not run paid ads, create videos, or manage other platforms."
2. Deliverables	What the client will receive â€" posts, replies, report.	"12 scheduled posts, daily reply management, one monthly report."
3. Payment	How much, when and how.	"â‚¦35,000 per month, payable by the 5th of each month via bank transfer."
4. Revisions	How many rounds of changes are included.	"Two rounds of revisions per post. Additional revisions at â‚¦2,000 each."
5. Account ownership	Who owns the accounts and content.	"The client owns the Instagram and Facebook accounts and all content created. The manager will return all access if the agreement ends."
6. Communication	How and how often the two will communicate.	"WhatsApp for daily communication. Weekly update every Friday. Monthly review call."
7. Termination	How either side can end the agreement.	"Either side may end the agreement with 14 days' notice. All access and content will be returned within 7 days."

The key lesson â€" put it in writing. A verbal agreement is a memory. A written agreement is a record. It does not mean the manager expects a fight â€" it means the manager is professional enough to prevent one.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **rent agreement**. A tenant and landlord who shake hands on a rent will disagree about repairs, increases and notice periods. A written agreement prevents that. A working agreement is the rent agreement for social media management.

Important limitation / misconception. A working agreement is not a substitute for trust â€" it is a foundation for trust. The manager still has to deliver, communicate and be honest. The agreement just makes the expectations clear so both sides can succeed.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **Tools matter** â€" Meta Business Suite, Buffer or Later, Google Sheets, Google Docs, Google Drive and WhatsApp Business are the free toolkit.
- **Meta Business Suite** connects Instagram and Facebook, schedules posts, shows the inbox and shows insights â€" the core tool.

- **Free schedulers** cover TikTok, X and LinkedIn â€" Buffer or Later free tiers are enough for one client.
- **The draftâ€"reviewâ€"approveâ€"schedule workflow** keeps the client involved and mistakes out.
- **Onboarding** is the first week â€" collecting access, information and expectations safely.
- **A working agreement** is a one-page document covering scope, deliverables, payment, revisions and account ownership.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Plan content] --> B[Create drafts]
    B --> C[Send to client]
    C --> D{Approved?}
    D -->|Yes| E[Schedule]
    D -->|No| F[Revise]
    F --> C
    E --> G[Auto-publish]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through a complete operational setup â€" connecting accounts, scheduling three posts, running the approval workflow and drafting a working agreement â€" for the running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*.

Setup: On the projector, show Meta Business Suite with a practice Instagram and Facebook connection. Have the working agreement template visible.

G.1 Demonstration 1 â€" Connect accounts (3 minutes)

Say: "First â€" we connect Instagram and Facebook in Meta Business Suite. This is the foundation."

Walk through the steps:

1. Open Meta Business Suite.
2. Go to Settings â†' Accounts.
3. Click "Add Account" and connect Instagram.
4. Click "Add Account" and connect Facebook.
5. Confirm both accounts are linked.

Say: "Now I can post to both platforms from one place, reply to messages from both and see the numbers for both. That is the power of Meta Business Suite."

G.2 Demonstration 2 â€" Schedule three posts (5 minutes)

Say: "Now we schedule three posts for the week â€" Monday, Wednesday, Friday."

Schedule each post:

Post	Platform	Date	Time	Caption
1	Instagram + Friday	Friday	12 p.m.	"Smoky jollof, cooked fresh every morning ðŸ²â¦1,500 a plate. Free delivery in Port Harcourt. ðŸ'‰ DM 'JOLLOF' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order. #TasteOfRiversKitchen #PortHarcourtFood"
2	Instagram + Wednesday	Wednesday	5 p.m.	"Watch Chef Nkechi fry plantain â€" fresh every morning. Order yours today. ðŸ²"
3	Instagram + Monday	Monday	12 p.m.	"Monday fuel: jollof and plantain, â¦1,500. Free delivery in PH. Order now."

Walk through the scheduling steps for each post:

1. Click "Create Post."
2. Choose the platform(s).
3. Upload the photo.
4. Write the caption.

5. Choose the date and time.
6. Click "Schedule."

Say: "Three posts scheduled. They will go live automatically â€" I do not have to be online at those times. That is scheduling."

G.3 Demonstration 3 â€" Run the approval workflow (4 minutes)

Say: "But before I scheduled those, I ran the approval workflow. Let me show you how it works."

Walk through the workflow:

1. **Draft:** "I wrote the caption and designed the graphic on Monday morning."
2. **Review:** "I sent it to Chef Nkechi on WhatsApp: 'This is Friday's post. Please check the price and wording. I'll schedule it for Friday 12 p.m. unless you tell me to change something.'"
3. **Approve:** "She replied: 'Change â‚¦1,500 to â‚¦1,600 â€" I changed the price this week.' I updated the graphic. She confirmed: 'Approved.'"
4. **Schedule:** "I scheduled the post. It goes live Friday 12 p.m."

Say: "Four steps. The client saw it, approved it, and I have the message to prove it. That is the workflow â€" and it protects both sides."

G.4 Demonstration 4 â€" Draft the working agreement (3 minutes)

Say: "Last â€" the working agreement. This is what I send to a new client before we start."

Walk through the template on the projector:

> ***Working Agreement â€" Taste of Rivers Kitchen***
>
> 1. ***Scope:*** *I will create and schedule 12 posts per month, manage comments and DMs, and provide a monthly report. I will not run paid ads or create videos.*
> 2. ***Deliverables:*** *12 scheduled posts, daily reply management, one monthly report.*
> 3. ***Payment:*** *â‚¦35,000 per month, payable by the 5th of each month via bank transfer.*
> 4. ***Revisions:*** *Two rounds of revisions per post. Additional revisions at â‚¦2,000 each.*
> 5. ***Account ownership:*** *The client owns the accounts and all content. The manager will return all access if the agreement ends.*
> 6. ***Communication:*** *WhatsApp for daily communication. Weekly update every Friday.*
> 7. ***Termination:*** *Either side may end the agreement with 14 days' notice.*

Say: "Seven parts. One page. Everything is clear. The client knows what they are getting, and I know what I am delivering. That is a professional relationship."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What does Meta Business Suite connect?" (Instagram and Facebook.)
- "What are the four steps of the approval workflow?" (Draft, review, approve, schedule.)
- "Why do we need a working agreement?" (To prevent misunderstandings â€" and to look professional.)
- "What does the client own?" (The accounts and all content.)

Expected result: Learners see the complete operational setup â€" connect, schedule, approve, agree â€" and they see that it is a process they can follow, not a mystery.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner schedules three posts, runs the approval workflow and drafts a working agreement for a new fictional client â€" *Mama Chika's Kitchen*.

Starting materials: The printed scheduling worksheet, the printed working agreement template, a smartphone or computer with Meta Business Suite, a pen.

CLIENT BRIEF â€" MAMA CHIKA'S KITCHEN (fictional). *Mama Chika's Kitchen* is a small food business in Diobu, Port Harcourt. It sells small chops, meat pies, doughnuts and zobo. Prices run from â‚¦200 for a meat pie to â‚¦8,000 for a small-chops tray. The business has 400 Instagram followers and posts rarely. The owner, "Mama Chika," wants more customers â€" especially students and office workers near Diobu. She can pay â‚¦15,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name at the top of the scheduling worksheet. Read the client brief once.
2. **Schedule three posts** in Meta Business Suite (or plan them on the worksheet if no device). Use the three post ideas below.
3. **Run the approval workflow.** Write a message to Mama Chika â€" "This is [day]'s post. Please check the price and wording. I'll schedule it for [date] unless you tell me to change something." Then write her reply â€" "Change [price] to [new price]." Then write your confirmation â€" "Updated. Scheduling for [date]."
4. **Draft the working agreement.** Fill in the template â€" scope, deliverables, payment, revisions, account ownership, communication, termination.
5. **Pause and predict:** Cover your worksheets and ask yourself: "What are the four steps of the approval workflow?" Write your answer at the bottom.
6. Compare your worksheets with the person beside you. If you chose different platforms or prices, explain your choices.

Three post ideas:

Post	Platform	Date	Time	Caption idea
1	Instagram	Friday	12 p.m.	"Fresh small chops â€" â‚¦8,000 a tray. Free delivery in Diobu. DM 'CHOPS' to order."
2	Instagram	Wednesday	5 p.m.	"Watch the small chops being packed â€" fresh, hot, ready for you."
3	Instagram	Monday	12 p.m.	"Monday fuel: meat pie and zobo â€" â‚¦400. Order now."

Expected result (model answers â€" instructor key):

Scheduling worksheet:

- Post 1: Instagram, Friday 12 p.m., caption as above, asset: photo of small chops.
- Post 2: Instagram, Wednesday 5 p.m., caption as above, asset: 20-second video.
- Post 3: Instagram, Monday 12 p.m., caption as above, asset: photo of meat pie and zobo.

Approval workflow:

- Message to Mama Chika: "This is Friday's post. Please check the price and wording. I'll schedule it for Friday 12 p.m. unless you tell me to change something."
- Mama Chika's reply: "Change â‚¦8,000 to â‚¦8,500 â€" the price went up this week."
- Confirmation: "Updated. Scheduling for Friday 12 p.m."

Working agreement:

- Scope: 12 posts per month, daily reply management, monthly report. No paid ads, no videos.
- Deliverables: 12 scheduled posts, daily reply management, one monthly report.
- Payment: â‚¦15,000 per month, payable by the 5th of each month via bank transfer.
- Revisions: Two rounds of revisions per post. Additional revisions at â‚¦1,000 each.
- Account ownership: Mama Chika owns the accounts and all content. The manager will return all access if the agreement ends.
- Communication: WhatsApp for daily communication. Weekly update every Friday.
- Termination: Either side may end the agreement with 14 days' notice.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "Are your three posts scheduled for different days? Do they have captions and assets?"
- After step 3: "Does your approval workflow have all four steps â€" draft, review, approve, schedule?"
- After step 4: "Does your working agreement have all seven parts?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner schedules all three posts on the same day â†’ Prompt: "What is the cadence? Three posts a week â€" spread across different days."
- Learner writes "Message us" as the CTA â†’ Prompt: "What is the specific CTA? DM 'CHOPS' or call a number."
- Learner skips the approval workflow â†’ Prompt: "What happens if you post without the client seeing it first?"
- Learner leaves parts of the working agreement blank â†’ Prompt: "What is the payment? What is the scope? What happens if the agreement ends?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Three posts scheduled â€" different days, with captions and assets
- ☐ Approval workflow has all four steps
- ☐ Working agreement has all seven parts
- ☐ Pause-and-predict answer: draft, review, approve, schedule

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I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Schedule three posts, run the approval workflow and draft a working agreement for a third fictional client â€" *Emeka's Gadgets* â€" without copying the instructor's or the guided exercise's examples.

Scenario. *Emeka's Gadgets* is a small phone and accessories shop in Rumuokwuta, Port Harcourt. It sells phones, chargers, earphones, power banks and phone accessories. Prices run from â‚¦500 for a charger to â‚¦80,000 for a phone. The shop has 600 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Emeka wants more customers â€" people should see his products, know his prices, and visit his shop. He can pay â‚¦25,000 a month. He does not want fake followers.

Requirements:

1. Schedule **three posts** â€" different days, with captions and assets.
2. Run the **approval workflow** â€" draft, review, approve, schedule.
3. Draft a **working agreement** â€" all seven parts.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Three posts scheduled â€" different days, with captions and assets.
- Approval workflow has all four steps.
- Working agreement has all seven parts â€" scope, deliverables, payment, revisions, account ownership, communication, termination.
- Payment is realistic for a small shop.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the posts, think â€" what would Emeka's customers want to see? Products, prices, the shop.
- Hint 2: For the approval workflow, write the message to Emeka, his reply and your confirmation.
- Hint 3: For the working agreement, use the template â€" fill in all seven parts.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Three posts:

- Post 1: Instagram, Friday 12 p.m., "20,000mAh power bank â€" â‚¦15,000. Charges your phone 4 times. DM 'POWER' to order." Asset: photo of power bank.
- Post 2: Instagram, Wednesday 5 p.m., "Watch this power bank charge 2 phones at once. Order yours today." Asset: 20-second video.
- Post 3: Instagram, Monday 12 p.m., "Monday deal: phone charger â€" â‚¦1,000. While stocks last." Asset: photo of charger.

Approval workflow:

- Message to Emeka: "This is Friday's post. Please check the price and wording. I'll schedule it for Friday 12 p.m. unless you tell me to change something."
- Emeka's reply: "Change â‚¦15,000 to â‚¦14,500 â€" I want to run a special this week."
- Confirmation: "Updated. Scheduling for Friday 12 p.m."

Working agreement:

- Scope: 12 posts per month, daily reply management, monthly report. No paid ads, no videos.
- Deliverables: 12 scheduled posts, daily reply management, one monthly report.
- Payment: â‚¦25,000 per month, payable by the 5th of each month via bank transfer.
- Revisions: Two rounds of revisions per post. Additional revisions at â‚¦2,000 each.
- Account ownership: Emeka owns the accounts and all content. The manager will return all access if the agreement ends.
- Communication: WhatsApp for daily communication. Weekly update every Friday.
- Termination: Either side may end the agreement with 14 days' notice.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Three posts scheduled â€" different days, with captions and assets (3)
- Approval workflow has all four steps (2)
- Working agreement has all seven parts (4)
- Payment is realistic (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ada's Ankara* is a small fashion business in Port Harcourt. The owner, Ada, hired a social media manager three months ago. The manager posts regularly â€" but there is no workflow. The manager writes captions and posts them immediately, without Ada seeing them. The manager uses a personal Instagram account to post â€" Ada's account is not connected to any business tool. There is no written agreement â€" they agreed on "â‚¦20,000 a month" verbally. Last week, Ada saw a post with the wrong price â€" â‚¦5,000 instead of â‚¦8,000. A customer ordered at the wrong price and demanded a refund. Ada is frustrated. She does not know if she can trust the manager anymore.

Relevant facts.

- The manager posts regularly â€" but without approval.
- The manager uses a personal account â€" Ada's account is not connected to Meta Business Suite.
- There is no written agreement â€" just a verbal understanding.
- A wrong price was posted â€" a customer ordered at â‚¦5,000 instead of â‚¦8,000.
- Ada had to refund the customer and apologise.
- Ada does not know how many posts were scheduled, what the manager is paid, or who owns the content.

Decision point. What went wrong â€" and what should Ada do now?

Possible approaches.

1. **Fire the manager immediately** â€" "they are unprofessional."
2. **Continue as before** â€" "it was just one mistake."
3. **Fix the workflow** â€" connect accounts, run an approval process and sign a written agreement.

Recommended solution. Approach 3 â€" fix the workflow. Ada should:

- **Connect the accounts** in Meta Business Suite â€" so the manager posts from the right account.
- **Run the approval workflow** â€" the manager drafts, Ada reviews, Ada approves, the manager schedules.
- **Sign a written working agreement** â€" scope, deliverables, payment, revisions, account ownership, communication, termination.
- **Set clear expectations** â€" what the manager will do, what they will not do, and how they will communicate.

What Ada should have done from the start:

- **Onboarded properly** â€" collected access, information and expectations in the first week.
- **Used tools** â€" connected accounts in Meta Business Suite.
- **Run the approval workflow** â€" no post goes live without Ada seeing it.
- **Signed a working agreement** â€" everything in writing before the work started.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is understandable but wasteful â€” the manager posts regularly, which is valuable. The problem is the process, not the person.
- Approach 2 is passive and risky â€” without a workflow, the same mistake will happen again.
- Approach 3 takes a few hours of work, but it sets up a professional relationship where both sides know what to expect â€” and it prevents the next mistake.

Professional connection. This is exactly what a professional manager does â€” and it is what separates a professional from someone who "just posts." A professional does not rely on memory and hope. A professional uses tools, runs a workflow and puts everything in writing. That is why a professional can charge â‚¹20,000 a month and a "poster" cannot.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Posting without approval

Symptoms: The manager posts without the client seeing it first. **Likely cause:** They think approval slows them down â€” or they do not know the workflow. **How to investigate:** Ask: "When did the client last see a post before it went live?" **Corrective steps:** Run the draftâ€”reviewâ€”approveâ€”schedule workflow. No post goes live without written approval. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can describe the four steps and show an approval message. **Prevention:** The workflow protects both sides â€” make it a habit from day one.

K.2 Using a personal account instead of the client's

Symptoms: The manager posts from their personal Instagram instead of the client's account. **Likely cause:** They have not connected the client's accounts to Meta Business Suite. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Which account are you posting from? Is it connected to Meta Business Suite?" **Corrective steps:** Connect the client's accounts in Meta Business Suite. Post from the client's accounts only. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can show the connected accounts. **Prevention:** The client's accounts are the business â€” never post from a personal account.

K.3 Working without a written agreement

Symptoms: The manager and client have only a verbal understanding. **Likely cause:** They think a written agreement is too formal â€” or they do not know what it should contain. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What was agreed? Can you both describe it the same way?" **Corrective steps:** Draft a one-page working agreement â€” scope, deliverables, payment, revisions, account ownership, communication, termination. **How to confirm resolved:** Both sides have signed or confirmed the agreement. **Prevention:** A verbal agreement is a memory â€” a written agreement is a record.

K.4 Handling account access carelessly

Symptoms: The manager shares login details over text, stores them in an unsecured place, or does not return them when the relationship ends. **Likely cause:** They do not understand that account access is a trust issue. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How did the client share their password? How do you store it? What happens if the agreement ends?" **Corrective steps:** Handle access securely â€” use a password manager or a secure note. Never share access with anyone else. Return all access promptly if the agreement ends. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can explain how they handle access securely. **Prevention:** Account access is a privilege â€” treat it with care.

K.5 Not using a scheduler

Symptoms: The manager posts manually every day â€” opening the app, writing the caption, uploading the photo. **Likely cause:** They do not know about scheduling â€” or they think it is complicated. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How long does it take you to post each day? Have you tried Meta Business Suite's scheduling?" **Corrective steps:** Schedule posts in advance â€” a week at a time. Use Meta Business Suite for Instagram and Facebook, Buffer or Later for other platforms. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager has scheduled at least three posts in advance. **Prevention:** Scheduling saves time and keeps the page consistent.

K.6 Not keeping records

Symptoms: The manager does not keep records of what was posted, what was agreed or what was paid. **Likely cause:** They think memory is enough. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Can you show me what was posted last week? What was agreed? What was paid?" **Corrective steps:** Keep a simple record â€" a Google Sheet with posts, approvals and payments. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can show a record of posts and payments. **Prevention:** Records protect both sides â€" make them a habit.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" ask the learner to explain their reasoning, not just their answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Scheduling Plan and Working Agreement"

Purpose: To practise the operational skills of social media management â€" scheduling, workflow and agreements â€" and to produce the workflow and terms sections that go into the capstone.

Realistic scenario. You are a social media manager in Port Harcourt. A friend's cousin, *Adaeze*, runs *Adaeze's Fashion* â€" a small fashion business that sells ankara dresses, ready-to-wear outfits and does custom sewing. Prices run from â‚¦5,000 for a simple dress to â‚¦30,000 for a custom ankara gown. The business has 900 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Adaeze is a skilled tailor but she is not online. She wants more customers â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and order from her. She can pay â‚¦35,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Detailed instructions:

1. Schedule **three posts** â€" different days, with captions and assets.
2. Run the **approval workflow** â€" draft, review, approve, schedule.
3. Draft a **working agreement** â€" all seven parts: scope, deliverables, payment, revisions, account ownership, communication, termination.
4. Write a **short paragraph** (4â€"6 sentences) explaining to Adaeze, in plain language, why a clear workflow and agreement will make the work run smoothly.

Required deliverables:

- A scheduling plan (three posts, approval workflow).
- A working agreement (all seven parts).
- The short paragraph to the client.

Submission format: Save as `SchedulingAgreement_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`) and upload to `/Social-Media-Management/Week2/SchedulingAgreement/`. You may also copy the agreement into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 7.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Three posts scheduled	4	Different days, with captions and assets
Approval workflow complete	4	All four steps â€" draft, review, approve, schedule
Working agreement â€" scope and deliverables	3	Clear about what is and is not included
Working agreement â€" payment and revisions	3	Realistic payment; clear revision policy
Working agreement â€" ownership and termination	3	Client owns accounts; clear termination terms
Client paragraph	3	Plain, honest language; no false promises

Common mistakes to avoid: posting without approval; using a personal account; working without a written agreement; handling access carelessly; not scheduling; not keeping records; using jargon Adaeze would not understand.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Three posts:

- Post 1: Instagram, Friday 12 p.m., "Fresh ankara dress â€" â‚¦8,000. DM 'DRESS' to order." Asset: photo of ankara dress.

- Post 2: Instagram, Wednesday 5 p.m., "Watch Adaeze sew â€" from fabric to finished dress." Asset: 20-second video.
- Post 3: Instagram, Monday 12 p.m., "Monday deal: ready-to-wear dress â€" â,¦5,000. While stocks last." Asset: photo of dress.

Approval workflow:

- Message to Adaeze: "This is Friday's post. Please check the price and wording. I'll schedule it for Friday 12 p.m. unless you tell me to change something."
- Adaeze's reply: "Change â,¦8,000 to â,¦8,500 â€" I want to run a special this week."
- Confirmation: "Updated. Scheduling for Friday 12 p.m."

Working agreement:

- Scope: 12 posts per month, daily reply management, monthly report. No paid ads, no videos.
- Deliverables: 12 scheduled posts, daily reply management, one monthly report.
- Payment: â,¦35,000 per month, payable by the 5th of each month via bank transfer.
- Revisions: Two rounds of revisions per post. Additional revisions at â,¦2,000 each.
- Account ownership: Adaeze owns the accounts and all content. The manager will return all access if the agreement ends.
- Communication: WhatsApp for daily communication. Weekly update every Friday.
- Termination: Either side may end the agreement with 14 days' notice.

Paragraph to Adaeze: "Adaeze, a clear workflow and agreement will make the work run smoothly because both of us will know exactly what to expect. I will draft every post and send it to you before it goes live â€" you will never see a post you have not approved. We will have a simple agreement that says what I will do, what it costs, and how we will work together. This is not about distrust â€" it is about being professional. When everything is clear, we can focus on what matters: getting you more customers."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is Meta Business Suite, and what are its four main features?

Q2. List. Name the four steps of the approval workflow.

Q3. Multiple choice. Which tool would you use to schedule a TikTok post? a) Meta Business Suite b) Buffer or Later c) Google Sheets d) WhatsApp Business

Q4. Explain. What is a working agreement, and why is it important?

Q5. Scenario. A client says: "Just post whenever you feel like it â€" I trust you." Write two sentences explaining why you will still run the approval workflow.

Q6. Matching. Match each tool to its main use: Meta Business Suite, Buffer/Later, Google Sheets, Google Drive, WhatsApp Business. a) Stores photos, videos and brand assets b) Connects Instagram + Facebook, schedules posts, shows the inbox c) The normal client-communication channel in Nigeria d) Schedules posts for TikTok, X and LinkedIn e) Content calendars and report tables

Q7. True or false. A manager should post from their personal Instagram account if the client's account is not connected to Meta Business Suite.

Q8. Fill in the blank. The seven parts of a working agreement: scope, _____, payment, _____, account ownership, _____, and termination.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q8)

A1. Meta Business Suite is Meta's free tool for managing Instagram and Facebook from one place. Its four main features are: connect accounts, schedule posts, unified inbox and insights.

A2. Draft, review, approve, schedule.

A3. (b) Buffer or Later. (Meta Business Suite covers Instagram and Facebook â€" not TikTok.)

A4. A working agreement is a one-page document that covers scope, deliverables, payment, revisions, account ownership, communication and termination. It is important because it prevents misunderstandings â€" both sides know what to expect, and there is a written record if disagreements arise.

A5. Model answer: "I appreciate your trust â€" but the approval workflow protects both of us. If a post goes out with a wrong price or wording, it could cost you money and customers. The workflow takes five minutes and prevents that. You will see every post before it goes live." (Accept any answer that explains the value of approval.)

A6. Meta Business Suite = (b); Buffer/Later = (d); Google Sheets = (e); Google Drive = (a); WhatsApp Business = (c).

A7. False. A manager should always post from the client's account â€" never from a personal account. If the client's account is not connected, the manager should connect it first.

A8. The seven parts: scope, deliverables, payment, revisions, account ownership, communication, termination.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned the tools and the workflow that make social media management run smoothly. You learned that a professional manager uses a free toolkit â€" Meta Business Suite, Buffer or Later, Google Sheets, Google Docs, Google Drive and WhatsApp Business. You learned to connect Instagram and Facebook in Meta Business Suite, schedule three posts, and use free schedulers for TikTok, X and LinkedIn. You learned the draftâ€"reviewâ€"approveâ€"schedule workflow â€" so the client sees every post before it goes live. You learned to onboard a client professionally â€" collecting access, information and expectations safely. And you learned to draft a one-page working agreement covering scope, deliverables, payment, revisions, account ownership, communication and termination.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Tools are free and simple** â€" Meta Business Suite, Buffer/Later and Google tools are enough.
2. **Scheduling is setting it and forgetting it** â€" schedule a week of posts and focus on engaging.
3. **The approval workflow protects both sides** â€" draft, review, approve, schedule.
4. **Onboarding is a trust exercise** â€" collect what is needed, handle access securely.
5. **A working agreement is a professional foundation** â€" everything in writing before the work starts.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I connect Instagram and Facebook in Meta Business Suite?
- Can I schedule three posts with captions and assets?
- Can I run the draftâ€"reviewâ€"approveâ€"schedule workflow?
- Can I onboard a client and collect what is needed?
- Can I draft a working agreement with all seven parts?

Connection to the next session. You now know how to plan, create, engage and schedule â€" but how do you know if any of it is working? Next session we learn to measure honestly. We will cover the key metrics â€" reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks and growth â€" and learn to produce a one-page monthly report with real numbers, screenshots, insights and a recommendation. That report becomes the capstone's reporting template.

Say it with us: *No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof.*

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner connects accounts in Meta Business Suite and schedules posts.
- Learner runs the approval workflow â€" draft, review, approve, schedule.
- Learner drafts a working agreement with all seven parts.
- Learner explains why tools and a workflow matter.
- Learner handles account access securely and professionally.
- Learner keeps records of posts, approvals and payments.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Posting manually is fine â€" scheduling is complicated." â†' Scheduling saves time and keeps the page consistent.
- "The client trusts me â€" no need for approval." â†' The workflow protects both sides.
- "A written agreement is too formal." â†' It prevents misunderstandings and looks professional.
- "I'll post from my personal account â€" it is faster." â†' Always post from the client's account.
- "I'll remember what was agreed." â†' A verbal agreement is a memory â€" a written agreement is a record.
- "I don't need to keep records." â†' Records protect both sides.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Scheduling drill:** give three post ideas and ask the learner to schedule them in Meta Business Suite â€" different days, with captions and assets.
2. **Workflow writing drill:** give a post scenario and ask the learner to write the four-step approval workflow â€" message to client, client reply, confirmation.
3. **Agreement fill-in:** give a partially completed working agreement and ask the learner to fill in the missing parts.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed scheduling plan and working agreement â€" some posts and some parts already filled in â€" and ask the learner to complete the rest.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written â€" a complete scheduling plan, approval workflow and working agreement.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write an "operations guide" â€" a one-page document explaining the tools, the workflow and the agreement to a new manager who has never run a client's social media before. The guide must be in plain language, not jargon.

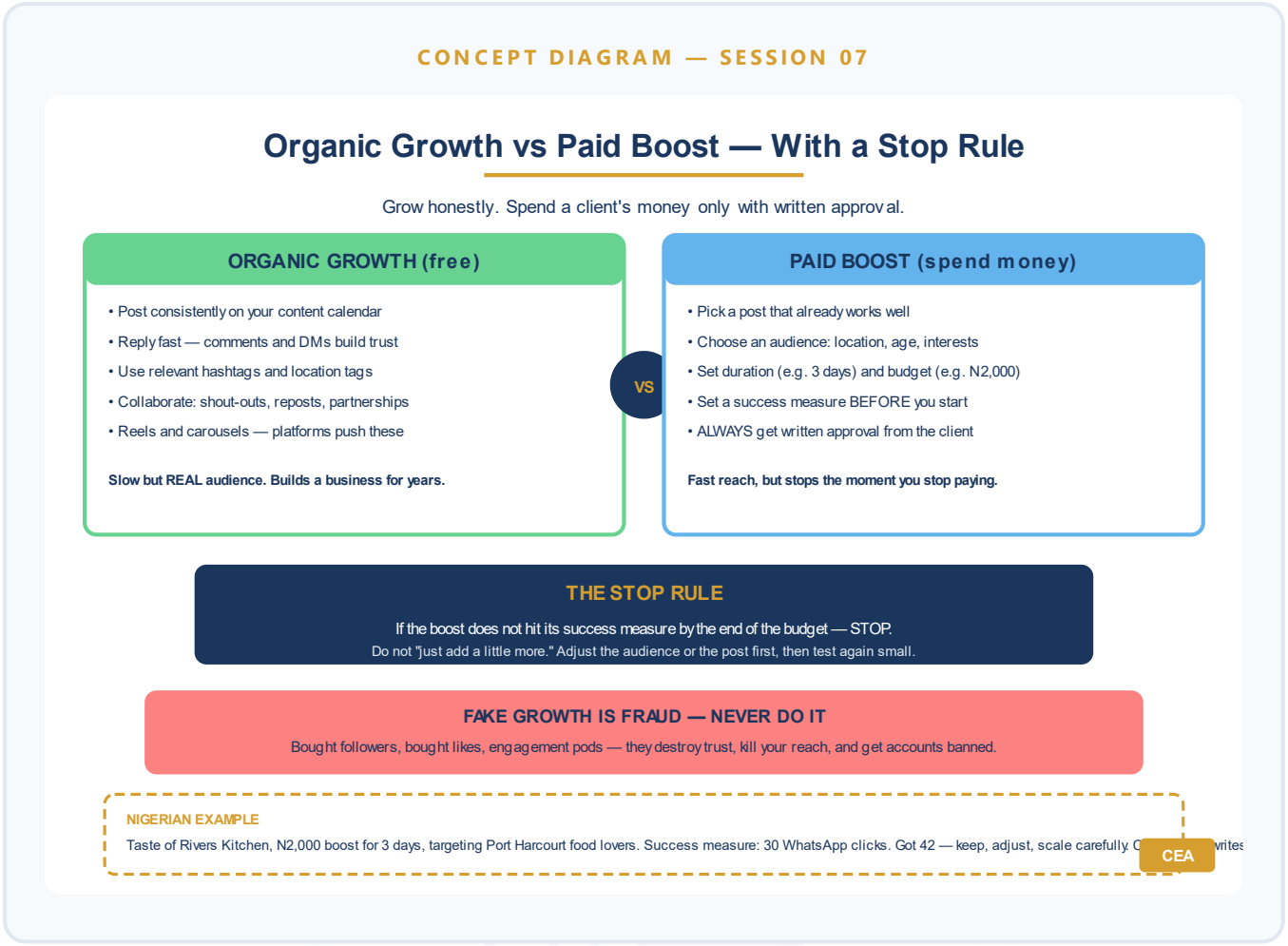
Timing guidance. The priority is learners completing a scheduling plan, an approval workflow and a working agreement (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the tools section (F.1) and protect the guided practical â€" the ability to schedule and draft an agreement is the core skill. If the room is fast, extend the case study discussion and let learners role-play the client onboarding conversation in pairs.

END OF SESSION 6

Next: Session 7 â€" Analytics and Client Reporting.

SESSION 07 OF 9

Analytics and Client Reporting



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

SESSION 7 â€" ANALYTICS AND CLIENT REPORTING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	7 of 9
Session title	Analytics and Client Reporting
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Grow and Report
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with analytics)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"6 â€" the learner can define social media management, list the five core tasks, build a strategy, design a content calendar, create content, manage a community, schedule

Item	Detail
	posts and draft a working agreement. Basic smartphone and spreadsheet use assumed. No prior analytics or reporting experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 6 we learned to schedule posts and run the workflow. Today we learn to measure whether any of it is working. We cover the key metrics â€" reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks and growth â€" and learn to produce a one-page monthly report with real numbers, screenshots, insights and a recommendation. That report becomes the capstone's reporting template.
Preparation before class	Projector connected and tested; the sample metrics data (Section G) prepared as a printed sheet or on screen; the one-page report template (Section F.4) printed per learner; the metrics worksheet printed; the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief available; academy Wi-Fi confirmed.

Running client reminder. *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" fictional small food business in Rumuola, Port Harcourt. Sells local meals (jollof, fried rice, small chops, plantain, fish) for pickup and delivery. Prices â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦8,000. Owner "Chef Nkechi" cooks with two assistants, takes orders on one WhatsApp line. Instagram and Facebook pages silent for three months. Wants consistent posting for 30 days and more WhatsApp orders â€" no advertising budget. Has been burned by someone who bought her fake followers.

Instructor note on tone. This is the session where learners discover that numbers are not scary â€" they are the proof of their work. Many learners will say "I am not good with numbers" â€" your job is to show them that reading six simple metrics and writing a one-page report is a skill anyone can learn. Keep the mood practical and confident. Emphasise from the start: honest reporting is non-negotiable. A manager who fakes numbers will be caught and fired.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Identify** the key metrics â€" reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks and follower growth â€" and explain what each one means.
2. **Read** basic analytics from Instagram and Facebook and pull the right numbers for a monthly report.
3. **Calculate** an engagement rate correctly (engagement Ã· reach Ã— 100).
4. **Produce** a one-page monthly report with numbers against goals, top content, what worked, what did not, and a next-month recommendation.
5. **Present** results honestly â€" explaining both good and bad months â€" and never inflate numbers.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a notes app or Google Docs.
- Academy computers (one per learner or one per pair) for Google Sheets.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- A whiteboard or flipchart and markers.

Software

- A notes app on every phone.
- Google Sheets (free) for the metrics worksheet and the report table.
- Instagram and Facebook Insights (via Meta Business Suite) â€" or the printed sample data if no live account is available.

Sample files

- **Sample metrics data** (Section G) â€" a fictional month of Instagram and Facebook numbers for Taste of Rivers Kitchen, prepared by the instructor. No real data.
- **One-page report template** (Section F.4) â€" printed per learner.

- **Metrics worksheet** â€" a blank table: *Metric / What it means / This month / Last month / Change*.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 7.1 â€" "My Metrics Worksheet" (the table above).
- Worksheet 7.2 â€" "My One-Page Report" (the template above).

Accounts

- Free social media accounts. Meta Business Suite for insights. No paid tools.

Internet

- Academy Wi-Fi for Google Sheets and Meta Business Suite insights. If Wi-Fi fails, use the printed sample data â€" the session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app or a printed worksheet works. A learner without a device may work with a partner â€" one reads the sample data, one records the numbers. The skill today is *reading and reporting*, not typing.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor: This session is where honesty is built or destroyed. Make it absolutely clear: real numbers only. Never inflate. Never hide a bad month. Never screenshot someone else's results. A manager who fakes a report will be caught the moment the client checks their own insights â€" and that is the end of the trust and the relationship.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two fictional monthly reports for the same client â€" *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*. Both cover the same month. Do not explain which is "better" yet.

Report A â€" "The Inflated Report."

> *"This month was amazing! We reached 50,000 people, got 5,000 likes, and the page grew by 2,000 followers. The jollof video went viral! Overall: excellent month!"*

Report B â€" "The Honest Report."

> *"This month we reached 8,400 people (goal: 5,000 â€" we exceeded it). We got 340 likes, 85 comments, 120 saves and 45 shares. 28 people clicked the WhatsApp link, and 12 became orders (goal: 30 â€" we did not reach it). The jollof video worked best â€" 1,200 views and 18 DMs. The plantain graphic did not work â€" 150 views and 2 DMs. Next month: post more jollof content, try a different graphic style for the plantain, and add a 'how to order' graphic to every post. What we will keep: the Friday posting time, the warm reply tone, and the customer photo pillar."*

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at these two reports. Report A sounds exciting â€" 'amazing,' 'viral,' 'excellent.' But ask yourself: can Chef Nkechi check those numbers? Can she verify that you reached 50,000 people? Can she see the 2,000 new followers? No â€" because those numbers are made up. Report B is less exciting â€" but every number is real, every claim can be checked, and there is a clear plan for next month. Report B is what a professional manager sends. Report B is what builds trust. Today you learn to write Report B."*

Expected learner response: Learners will point at Report B and say "it has real numbers," "it explains what worked," "it tells you what to do next." Accept all answers. Draw out the difference: *honest and useful vs. inflated and vague.*

Then reveal the hook: Say:

> *"Report B is not luck. It is built from six simple metrics â€" reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks and growth. You do not need to be a mathematician to read them. You need to know what each one means, how to find it, and how to write it*

down honestly. Today you learn to do that. By the end of this session, you will be able to produce a one-page report that makes a client trust you â€" and that proves your work."

Why this opener works: It uses a side-by-side comparison that makes the value of honest reporting immediate and emotional. Learners see that inflated numbers are dangerous and honest numbers are powerful â€" and they want to learn the skill.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five core tasks of a social media manager?"

- Expected answer: Planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting.
- Common gap: learners forget "reporting." Clarify: "Today is all about the *reporting* task â€" analytics and the monthly report."

Question 2: "What is a SMART goal?"

- Expected answer: A goal that is Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant and Time-bound.
- Common gap: learners remember some letters but not all. Write them on the board quickly.

Question 3: "What is a content calendar?"

- Expected answer: A plan that says what to post, when, on which platform, in which format, with which caption idea.
- Common gap: learners say "a list of posts." Clarify: "It is a table â€" one row per post, with a pillar, format, caption idea and asset."

Question 4: "What is a working agreement?"

- Expected answer: A one-page document covering scope, deliverables, payment, revisions, account ownership, communication and termination.
- Common gap: learners say "a contract." Clarify: "It is simpler than a contract â€" it is a professional understanding in writing."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"In Session 6 we learned to schedule and run the workflow. Today we learn to measure whether any of it is working. We will cover the six key metrics, learn to read them from Instagram and Facebook, calculate an engagement rate, and produce a one-page monthly report. That report is the most important document a manager produces â€" because it is the proof that the work is worth paying for."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 2, spend 3 extra minutes reviewing SMART with a quick example before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why measurement matters â€" and why honesty is non-negotiable

The idea. Measurement is the process of tracking numbers to see if the work is achieving the goals. **Reporting** is telling the client what the numbers say â€" honestly.

Plain-English definition. Measurement is checking the numbers. Reporting is writing them down and explaining what they mean.

Why it exists. A manager who does not measure is working blind. They cannot tell if a post worked, if a strategy is right, or if the client is getting value. A manager who does not report is invisible â€" the client pays â‚¦35,000 a month and has no idea what they are getting. Measurement and reporting are how a manager proves their value.

Why honesty is non-negotiable:

- **The client can check.** Instagram and Facebook show the owner their own insights. If the manager says "50,000 reach" and the owner sees 8,400, the trust is destroyed.
- **A bad month is information, not failure.** A manager who hides a bad month cannot fix it. A manager who reports it honestly â€" and proposes a plan â€" builds trust.
- **Inflated numbers are fraud.** A manager who fakes a report is not just unprofessional â€" they are dishonest. That is a character issue, not a skill issue.

Say this to the class:

> *"Let me be very clear about something. In this course, and in this profession, honest reporting is not optional. If the month was bad, you say so â€" and you explain what you will do differently. If the engagement rate is 3%, you write 3% â€" you do not round it up to 30%. If a post got 10 views, you write 10 â€" you do not screenshot someone else's results. A client who discovers you have lied about numbers will fire you, and they will tell other business owners. One fake report can end a career. Real numbers, honest insights â€" that is the job."*

Real-life comparison. Think of a **doctor's report**. A doctor who tells a patient "you are perfectly healthy" when the blood test shows a problem is dangerous. A doctor who says "your cholesterol is a little high â€" here is what we will do" is trustworthy. A manager is the doctor, the numbers are the blood test, and the report is the diagnosis.

F.2 The six key metrics â€" what they mean and why they matter

The idea. A manager does not need to track every number a platform shows. Six metrics tell the story: reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks and follower growth.

Plain-English definition. Each metric answers one question about the work. Together, they tell the client what is working and what is not.

The six metrics:

Metric	What it answers	How to read it
Reach	How many unique people saw the content?	Higher is generally better â€" but only if it is the right audience.
Engagement rate	Of the people who saw it, how many interacted?	Calculate: (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· reach Ã— 100. A healthy rate for a small page is 2â€"5%.
Saves	How many people saved the post for later?	Saves mean the content is valuable â€" a recipe, a tip, a price list people want to keep.
Shares	How many people shared it with others?	Shares mean the content is worth passing on â€" a strong sign of quality.
Clicks	How many people clicked the link or the WhatsApp button?	Clicks show intent â€" people taking the next step toward an order.
Follower growth	How many new followers did the page gain?	Growth matters â€" but only if the new followers are real and relevant.

Worked example â€" reading the six metrics for one month:

Metric	This month	What it tells us
Reach	8,400	We exceeded our goal of 5,000 â€" good awareness.
Engagement rate	6.5%	(340 likes + 85 comments + 120 saves + 45 shares) Ã· 8,400 Ã— 100 = 6.5%. Healthy â€" above the 2â€"5% range.
Saves	120	People are saving our content â€" the menu and price posts are useful.
Shares	45	People are sharing â€" the behind-the-scenes videos are worth passing on.
Clicks	28	28 people clicked the WhatsApp link â€" but only 12 became orders.

Metric	This month	What it tells us
Follower growth	+85	85 new followers â€" real people, not bought.

The key lesson â€" metrics tell a story, not just numbers. "Reach 8,400" is a number. "We exceeded our reach goal, engagement is healthy, people are saving our menu posts and sharing our videos, but only 12 of 28 clickers became orders â€" we need to make ordering easier" â€" that is a story. The manager's job is to tell the story.

Common misconception. "Followers are the most important metric." No â€" followers are a vanity metric. A page with 10,000 followers and no orders is failing. A page with 500 followers and 30 orders a month is succeeding. The metrics that matter are the ones connected to the business goal.

F.3 Calculating an engagement rate correctly

The idea. The **engagement rate** is the percentage of people who saw a post and then interacted with it. It is the single most important metric for judging content quality.

Plain-English definition. Engagement rate = (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· reach Ã— 100.

Why it exists. Reach tells you how many people saw the content. Engagement rate tells you how many of them cared. A post with 10,000 reach and 10 likes is failing. A post with 1,000 reach and 100 likes is succeeding.

Worked example â€" calculating engagement rate:

- Reach: 8,400
- Likes: 340
- Comments: 85
- Saves: 120
- Shares: 45

> *Engagement rate = (340 + 85 + 120 + 45) Ã· 8,400 Ã— 100 = 590 Ã· 8,400 Ã— 100 = 7.02%*

Say: "7%. That is a healthy engagement rate for a small page. It means 7 out of every 100 people who saw our content interacted with it. That is good â€" and it tells Chef Nkechi that the content is connecting."

The key lesson â€" always calculate, never guess. A manager who says "engagement is good" without calculating it is guessing. A manager who writes "engagement rate: 7%" is reporting. The calculation takes 30 seconds and makes the report professional.

Common misconception. "Engagement rate = likes Ã· followers." No â€" it is total interactions Ã· reach. Followers are not the same as reach. A post can reach more people than follow it has (through shares and explore) or fewer (if the algorithm shows it to a small percentage of followers).

F.4 The one-page monthly report â€" structure and content

The idea. A **monthly report** is a one-page document that tells the client what happened, what worked, what did not and what happens next. It is the manager's most important deliverable.

Plain-English definition. A monthly report is a simple one-page summary with real numbers, honest insights and a clear recommendation.

Why it exists. The client pays for results. The report is the proof â€" or the honest explanation. It is what separates a professional from a poster.

The six parts of a one-page report:

Part	What it says	Example
1. Numbers against goals	The goal, the actual number, and whether it was met.	"Goal: 30 WhatsApp orders. Actual: 12. Not met."
2. Top content	The best-performing posts and why they worked.	"The jollof video worked best â€" 1,200 views and 18 DMs."

Part	What it says	Example
3. What worked	The content, formats and strategies that succeeded.	"Behind-the-scenes videos and menu photos with prices."
4. What did not work	The content and strategies that failed â€" honestly.	"The plantain graphic did not work â€" 150 views and 2 DMs."
5. Insights	Why things worked or did not â€" the story behind the numbers.	"People want to see the food being cooked and the price clearly. The plantain graphic was dark and had no price."
6. Next-month recommendation	What the manager will do differently next month.	"Post more jollof content, brighten the plantain graphic, add a 'how to order' graphic to every post."

Worked example â€" a complete one-page report for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

> ***Monthly Report â€" Taste of Rivers Kitchen, Month 1***
>
> ***1. Numbers against goals:***
>
> - *Goal: 30 WhatsApp orders. Actual: 12. Not met.*
> - *Goal: Reach 5,000 people. Actual: 8,400. Exceeded.*
> - *Engagement rate: 7% (healthy).*
> - *New followers: +85 (real, not bought).*
>
> ***2. Top content:***
>
> - *Jollof cooking video: 1,200 views, 18 DMs, 3 shares.*
> - *Menu photo with prices: 800 views, 12 DMs, 45 saves.*
> - *Customer photo: 600 views, 8 DMs, 12 shares.*
>
> ***3. What worked:***
>
> - *Behind-the-scenes videos â€" people want to see the food being cooked.*
> - *Menu photos with clear prices â€" people save them and order from them.*
> - *Customer photos â€" they build trust.*
>
> ***4. What did not work:***
>
> - *Plantain graphic â€" dark photo, no price visible. 150 views, 2 DMs.*
> - *"Good morning" text posts â€" no image, no value. 80 views, 0 DMs.*
>
> ***5. Insights:***
>
> - *People respond to clear food photos with visible prices and a way to order.*
> - *People ignore text-only posts and dark images.*
> - *The WhatsApp order link works, but only 12 of 28 clickers became orders â€" the ordering process may be unclear.*
>
> ***6. Next-month recommendation:***
>
> - *Post more jollof and menu content (what works).*
> - *Brighten all food photos and always include the price.*
> - *Add a "how to order" graphic to every post.*
> - *Stop text-only "good morning" posts.*
> - *Review the WhatsApp ordering process with Chef Nkechi to make it easier.*

The key lesson â€" insights explain why, not just what. "The plantain graphic did not work" is what. "The plantain graphic was dark and had no price visible" is why. The why is what makes the report useful â€" it tells the client what to change.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **school report card**. A report card that says "Mathematics: C" is not useful. A report card that says "Mathematics: C â€" needs to practise fractions and show working" is useful. A monthly report is the manager's report card for the client's business.

F.5 Presenting results honestly â€” the good, the bad and the plan

The idea. A manager presents results every month â€” the good months and the bad months. The skill is presenting both with the same honesty and professionalism.

Plain-English definition. Presenting results means explaining what happened, owning what did not, and proposing what comes next â€— calmly and clearly.

Why it exists. A manager who only celebrates good months looks like they are hiding something. A manager who only reports bad months looks like they are failing. A manager who reports both honestly â€— with insights and a plan â€— looks like a professional.

The presentation formula â€— the three parts:

1. **The good.** "Here is what worked and why." â€— Celebrate the wins, but explain them.
2. **The bad.** "Here is what did not work and why." â€— Own the failures, but explain them.
3. **The plan.** "Here is what we will do differently next month." â€— Propose a clear, specific action.

Worked example â€— presenting a mixed month:

> *"This month was mixed. We exceeded our reach goal â€— 8,400 people against a target of 5,000 â€— and engagement was healthy at 7%. The jollof video and the menu photos worked well. But we did not reach our orders goal â€— 12 against a target of 30 â€— and the plantain graphic did not work. The issue is that people are clicking but not ordering, so next month we will make the ordering process clearer on every post and review the WhatsApp process with you. I am confident we will hit the orders target next month."*

The key lesson â€— a bad month is not a disaster; it is information. A manager who reports a bad month honestly â€— with insights and a plan â€— builds more trust than a manager who reports a good month with inflated numbers. The client is not paying for perfection; they are paying for honesty and improvement.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **football coach**. A coach whose team loses and says "the referee was bad, the pitch was bad, the players were tired" loses the team's respect. A coach whose team loses and says "we lost because we defended badly â€— here is what we will practise this week" earns respect. A manager is the coach, the numbers are the scoreline, and the report is the post-match analysis.

F.6 Screenshots and Sheets â€— the tools of reporting

The idea. A manager uses two simple tools for reporting: screenshots (to show the client the actual numbers) and Google Sheets (to track the numbers over time).

Plain-English definition. Screenshots are photos of the analytics page â€— proof that the numbers are real. Google Sheets is a free spreadsheet where the manager tracks the numbers month by month.

Why they exist. A report with numbers but no screenshots is a claim. A report with numbers and screenshots is proof. A Google Sheet that tracks the numbers over time shows trends â€— is the page growing, stagnating or declining?

Worked example â€— the reporting toolkit:

1. **Screenshots.** At the end of each month, take screenshots of the Instagram and Facebook insights pages. Attach them to the report or share them in a Google Drive folder.
2. **Google Sheet.** Create a simple table with one row per month and one column per metric: Month / Reach / Engagement rate / Saves / Shares / Clicks / Followers / Orders.
3. **The trend.** After three months, the Sheet shows the trend â€— is reach growing? Is engagement rising? Is the orders goal getting closer?

The key lesson â€— screenshots prove, Sheets show trends. A one-page report with screenshots is professional. A Google Sheet that tracks the numbers over time is invaluable â€— it shows the client that the work is building something.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **bank statement**. A bank statement with one month's balance is a snapshot. A bank statement with six months of balances is a story â€— it shows whether you are saving or spending. A Google Sheet is the manager's bank statement for the client's social media.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **Measurement** is checking the numbers; **reporting** is writing them down and explaining what they mean.

- **Honest reporting is non-negotiable** â€" real numbers, honest insights, never inflated.
- **The six key metrics** are reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks and follower growth.
- **Engagement rate** = (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· reach Ã— 100.
- **A one-page monthly report** has six parts: numbers against goals, top content, what worked, what did not, insights and next-month recommendation.
- **Presenting results** means the good, the bad and the plan â€" calmly and clearly.
- **Screenshots prove, Sheets show trends.**

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Collect metrics] --> B[Analyse performance]
    B --> C[Write report]
    C --> D[Present to client]
    D --> E[Agree next steps]
    E --> A
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through a complete reporting process â€" reading the sample metrics, calculating the engagement rate, filling in the one-page report and presenting it â€" for the running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*.

Setup: On the projector, show the sample metrics data for the fictional month. Have the one-page report template visible.

G.1 Demonstration 1 â€" Read the metrics (3 minutes)

Say: "It is the end of the month. I am the manager for Taste of Rivers Kitchen. I open Meta Business Suite and pull the numbers. Let me read them."

Show the sample metrics on the projector:

Metric	This month
Reach	8,400
Likes	340
Comments	85
Saves	120
Shares	45
Clicks (WhatsApp link)	28
Orders from social media	12
New followers	+85

Say: "Reach 8,400 â€" we exceeded our goal of 5,000. Engagement â€" let me calculate it. Likes 340, comments 85, saves 120, shares 45. Total interactions: 590. Engagement rate: 590 Ã· 8,400 Ã— 100 = 7%. Healthy. Clicks: 28 people clicked the WhatsApp link. Orders: 12. We did not reach our goal of 30 â€" that is the bad news. New followers: 85 â€" real people."

G.2 Demonstration 2 â€" Calculate the engagement rate (2 minutes)

Say: "Let me show you the calculation."

Write on the board:

> *Engagement rate = (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· reach Ã— 100 = (340 + 85 + 120 + 45) Ã· 8,400 Ã— 100 = 590 Ã· 8,400 Ã— 100 = 7.02%*

Say: "7%. That is a healthy engagement rate for a small page. I will write it in the report as 7% â€" not 7.02%, because that level of precision is not useful to the client. Round to the nearest whole number."

G.3 Demonstration 3 â€" Fill in the one-page report (6 minutes)

Say: "Now I write the report. One page. Six parts."

Fill in the report on the projector:

> ***Monthly Report â€" Taste of Rivers Kitchen, Month 1***
>
> ***1. Numbers against goals:***
>
> - *Goal: 30 WhatsApp orders. Actual: 12. Not met.*
> - *Goal: Reach 5,000 people. Actual: 8,400. Exceeded.*
> - *Engagement rate: 7%.*
> - *New followers: +85.*
>
> ***2. Top content:***
>
> - *Jollof cooking video: 1,200 views, 18 DMs.*
> - *Menu photo with prices: 800 views, 12 DMs, 45 saves.*
> - *Customer photo: 600 views, 8 DMs, 12 shares.*
>
> ***3. What worked:***
>
> - *Behind-the-scenes videos.*
> - *Menu photos with clear prices.*
> - *Customer photos.*
>
> ***4. What did not work:***
>
> - *Plantain graphic â€" dark photo, no price visible. 150 views, 2 DMs.*
> - *"Good morning" text posts. 80 views, 0 DMs.*
>
> ***5. Insights:***
>
> - *People respond to clear food photos with visible prices and a way to order.*
> - *People ignore text-only posts and dark images.*
> - *Only 12 of 28 clickers became orders â€" the ordering process may be unclear.*
>
> ***6. Next-month recommendation:***
>
> - *Post more jollof and menu content.*
> - *Brighten all food photos and always include the price.*
> - *Add a "how to order" graphic to every post.*
> - *Stop text-only "good morning" posts.*
> - *Review the WhatsApp ordering process with Chef Nkechi.*

Say: "One page. Real numbers. Honest insights. A clear plan. That is a professional report."

G.4 Demonstration 4 â€" Present the report (4 minutes)

Say: "Last â€" I present it to Chef Nkechi. I do not just send the document. I explain it."

Role-play the presentation:

> *"Chef Nkechi, here is the month's report. The good news: we exceeded our reach goal â€" 8,400 people against a target of 5,000 â€" and engagement was healthy at 7%. The jollof video and the menu photos worked well. The bad news: we did not reach our orders goal â€" 12 against a target of 30 â€" and the plantain graphic did not work. The issue is that people are clicking but not ordering, so next month we will make the ordering process clearer on every post and review the WhatsApp process with you. I am confident we will hit the orders target next month."*

Say: "The good, the bad, the plan. That is how you present results. Not defensively â€" honestly and confidently."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What was our engagement rate this month?" (7%.)
- "Did we reach our orders goal?" (No â€" 12 against 30.)
- "What did we learn from the plantain graphic?" (Dark photo, no price â€" people ignore it.)
- "What is the plan for next month?" (More jollof content, brighter photos, clearer ordering.)

Expected result: Learners see a complete reporting process â€" read, calculate, write, present â€" and they see that it is a skill they can learn, not a talent they need to be born with.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner reads a set of sample metrics, calculates the engagement rate and produces a one-page monthly report for a new fictional client â€" *Glamour Touch Salon*.

Starting materials: The printed sample metrics for Glamour Touch Salon, the printed one-page report template, a pen. No phone needed â€" it is a reading and writing exercise.

SAMPLE METRICS â€" GLAMOUR TOUCH SALON, MONTH 1 (fictional).

Metric	This month
Reach	4,200
Likes	180
Comments	42
Saves	65
Shares	22
Clicks (phone link)	15
Booking enquiries	8
New followers	+52

Goals for the month:

- Reach 5,000 people.
- Get 15 booking enquiries.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name at the top of the report template. Read the sample metrics once.
2. **Read the metrics.** For each metric, write what it tells you. (Hint: reach â€" did we hit the goal? engagement â€" is it healthy? clicks â€" are people taking action? orders â€" did we hit the goal?)
3. **Calculate the engagement rate.** Show your working. (Hint: likes + comments + saves + shares Ã· reach Ã— 100.)
4. **Fill in the one-page report.** All six parts: numbers against goals, top content, what worked, what did not, insights, next-month recommendation.
5. **Pause and predict:** Cover your report and ask yourself: "What is the most important insight in this report?" Write your answer at the bottom.
6. Compare your report with the person beside you. If you wrote different insights, explain your choices.

Expected result (model answers â€" instructor key):

Engagement rate calculation:

> *(180 + 42 + 65 + 22) Ã· 4,200 Ã— 100 = 309 Ã· 4,200 Ã— 100 = 7.36% Round to 7%.*

One-page report:

Monthly Report â€" Glamour Touch Salon, Month 1

1. Numbers against goals:

- *Goal: Reach 5,000 people. Actual: 4,200. Not met â€" but close.*
- *Goal: 15 booking enquiries. Actual: 8. Not met.*
- *Engagement rate: 7%.*
- *New followers: +52.*

2. Top content:

- *Box braid photo: 900 views, 12 DMs.*
- *Price list carousel: 700 views, 8 DMs, 35 saves.*
- *Behind-the-scenes video: 500 views, 5 DMs, 8 shares.*

3. What worked:

- *Clear photos of braid styles.*
- *Price lists â€" people save them.*
- *Behind-the-scenes videos.*

4. What did not work:

- *Dark selfie of the salon: 120 views, 0 DMs.*
- *"Good morning" text post: 60 views, 0 DMs.*

5. Insights:

- *People want to see the work clearly and know the price.*
- *People save price lists â€" they are useful.*
- *Only 8 of 15 clickers became bookings â€" the booking process may be unclear.*

6. Next-month recommendation:

- *Post more braid style photos with prices.*
- *Brighten all photos.*
- *Add a "how to book" graphic to every post.*
- *Stop text-only "good morning" posts.*
- *Review the phone booking process with Aunty Funke.*

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "What is the engagement rate? Show your working."
- After step 4: "Does your report have all six parts? Are the insights explaining why â€" not just what?"
- After step 5: "What is the most important insight? Can you say it in one sentence?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner calculates engagement rate as likes Ã· followers â†' Prompt: "What is the formula? Total interactions Ã· reach Ã— 100."
- Learner writes "engagement is good" without calculating â†' Prompt: "Calculate it. Show the working."
- Learner leaves the insights section blank â†' Prompt: "Why did the box braid photo work? Why did the dark selfie fail?"
- Learner writes "post more" as the recommendation â†' Prompt: "Post more of what? What specific change will you make?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Engagement rate calculated correctly
- ☐ All six parts of the report filled in
- ☐ Numbers are from the sample data â€" not invented
- ☐ Insights explain why â€" not just what
- ☐ Next-month recommendation is specific
- ☐ Pause-and-predict answer: the most important insight

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Read a set of sample metrics, calculate the engagement rate and produce a one-page monthly report for a third fictional client â€" *Chinedu's Barbershop* â€" without copying the instructor's or the guided exercise's examples.

Scenario. *Chinedu's Barbershop* is a small barbershop in Rumuokwuta, Port Harcourt. It offers haircuts, beard trims, and kids' haircuts. Prices run from â‚¦1,000 for a basic cut to â‚¦3,000 for a premium cut with beard trim. The shop has 600 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Chinedu is good with customers but he is not online. He wants more walk-in customers â€" people should see his work, know his prices, and find his shop. He can pay â‚¦20,000 a month. He does not want fake followers.

SAMPLE METRICS â€" CHINEDU'S BARBERSHOP, MONTH 1 (fictional).

Metric	This month
Reach	2,800
Likes	120
Comments	35
Saves	40
Shares	15
Clicks (phone link)	10
Booking enquiries	5
New followers	+38

Goals for the month:

- Reach 3,000 people.
- Get 12 booking enquiries.

Requirements:

1. **Read the metrics** â€" for each, write what it tells you.
2. **Calculate the engagement rate** â€" show your working.
3. **Produce a one-page report** â€" all six parts.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Engagement rate calculated correctly.
- All six parts of the report filled in.
- Numbers are from the sample data â€" not invented.
- Insights explain why â€" not just what.
- Next-month recommendation is specific.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the engagement rate, use the formula: (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· reach Ã— 100.
- Hint 2: For the insights, ask â€" why did some posts work and others fail? What was different about them?
- Hint 3: For the recommendation, be specific â€" what exactly will you do differently next month?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Engagement rate calculation:

> *(120 + 35 + 40 + 15) Ã· 2,800 Ã— 100 = 210 Ã· 2,800 Ã— 100 = 7.5% Round to 8%.*

One-page report:

Monthly Report â€" Chinedu's Barbershop, Month 1

1. Numbers against goals:

- *Goal: Reach 3,000 people. Actual: 2,800. Not met â€" close.*
- *Goal: 12 booking enquiries. Actual: 5. Not met.*
- *Engagement rate: 8%.*
- *New followers: +38.*

2. Top content:

- *Fresh fade photo: 600 views, 8 DMs.*
- *Price list carousel: 450 views, 5 DMs, 25 saves.*
- *Kids' haircut photo: 350 views, 3 DMs, 6 shares.*

3. What worked:

- *Clear photos of fresh cuts.*
- *Price lists â€" people save them.*
- *Kids' haircut photos â€" they attract fathers.*

4. What did not work:

- *Blurry selfie of Chinedu: 80 views, 0 DMs.*
- *"Good morning" text post: 40 views, 0 DMs.*

5. Insights:

- *People want to see the work clearly and know the price.*
- *People save price lists â€" they are useful.*
- *Only 5 of 10 clickers became bookings â€" the booking process may be unclear.*

6. Next-month recommendation:

- *Post more fresh cut photos with prices.*
- *Brighten all photos.*
- *Add a "how to book" graphic to every post.*
- *Stop text-only "good morning" posts.*
- *Review the phone booking process with Chinedu.*

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Engagement rate calculated correctly (2)
- All six parts of the report filled in (3)
- Numbers are from the sample data (1)
- Insights explain why (2)
- Next-month recommendation is specific (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Mama J's Small Chops* hired a social media manager three months ago. The manager posts regularly and replies to comments â€" but the monthly reports are always the same: "This month was good. Lots of engagement. Keep going." Mama J asks: "How many people did we reach? How many orders did we get? Which posts worked?" The manager cannot answer. They do not take screenshots, do not track numbers and do not know how to calculate an engagement rate. Last month, Mama J checked her own Instagram insights and found that the page had reached only 1,200 people â€" but the manager's report said "great reach." Mama J feels misled. She is thinking of ending the relationship.

Relevant facts.

- The manager posts regularly â€" that is genuine.
- The manager replies to comments â€" that is genuine.

- But the reports are vague and inflated â€" "good," "great," "lots of engagement" with no numbers.
- The manager does not take screenshots, does not track numbers and cannot calculate an engagement rate.
- Mama J checked her own insights and found the reach was 1,200 â€" not the "great reach" the manager reported.
- Mama J feels misled and is thinking of ending the relationship.

Decision point. What went wrong â€" and what should the manager do now?

Possible approaches.

1. **Continue as before** â€" "Mama J does not understand social media anyway."
2. **Blame the platform** â€" "Instagram is not showing our posts."
3. **Fix the reporting** â€" start tracking real numbers, take screenshots, calculate engagement rates and produce honest one-page reports.

Recommended solution. Approach 3 â€" fix the reporting. The manager should:

- **Start tracking the numbers** â€" reach, engagement, saves, shares, clicks, orders â€" every month.
- **Take screenshots** of the insights pages â€" proof that the numbers are real.
- **Calculate the engagement rate** â€" and include it in every report.
- **Produce a one-page report** â€" numbers against goals, top content, what worked, what did not, insights, next-month recommendation.
- **Present honestly** â€" the good, the bad and the plan.

What the manager should have done from the start:

- **Used Meta Business Suite** â€" to see the numbers easily.
- **Created a Google Sheet** â€" to track the numbers month by month.
- **Produced a real report** â€" not a vague "good month" message.
- **Been honest** â€" when the reach was 1,200, say 1,200 â€" and explain what will change.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is passive and dishonest â€" the manager will lose Mama J.
- Approach 2 is defensive and unprofessional â€" Mama J knows the difference between a bad month and a lie.
- Approach 3 takes a few hours of work, but it rebuilds trust â€" and it turns the manager from a "poster" into a professional.

Professional connection. This is exactly what a professional manager does â€" and it is what separates a professional from someone who "just posts." A professional does not guess. A professional tracks, calculates, reports and presents honestly. That is why a professional can charge â‚¦15,000 a month and a "poster" cannot.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Inflating numbers

Symptoms: The manager writes "great reach" or "amazing engagement" with no numbers. **Likely cause:** They do not track the numbers â€" or they are embarrassed by the real ones. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What was the exact reach? What was the engagement rate? Can you show me the screenshot?" **Corrective steps:** Track real numbers. Take screenshots. Calculate the engagement rate. Report the actual figures. **How to confirm resolved:** The report has real numbers and screenshots. **Prevention:** Honest reporting is non-negotiable â€" repeat this every session.

K.2 Not calculating the engagement rate

Symptoms: The manager says "engagement is good" without calculating it. **Likely cause:** They do not know the formula â€" or they think it is too complicated. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is the formula? Can you calculate it for this post?" **Corrective steps:** Teach the formula â€" (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· reach Ã— 100. Practise it. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can calculate the engagement rate correctly. **Prevention:** The calculation takes 30 seconds â€" make it a habit.

K.3 Hiding a bad month

Symptoms: The manager only reports good months â€" or makes excuses for bad ones. **Likely cause:** They think a bad month is a failure. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did not work this month? Why?" **Corrective steps:** A bad month is information, not failure. Report it honestly â€" with insights and a plan. **How to confirm resolved:** The report includes what did not work and a next-month recommendation. **Prevention:** Honesty builds trust â€" a bad month reported well is better than a good month reported falsely.

K.4 Writing vague reports

Symptoms: The report says "post more" or "engagement is good" with no specifics. **Likely cause:** The manager does not know what a good report looks like. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What specifically will you do differently next month? Why did that post work?" **Corrective steps:** Use the six-part structure â€" numbers against goals, top content, what worked, what did not, insights, next-month recommendation. **How to confirm resolved:** The report has all six parts with specific details. **Prevention:** Insights explain why â€" not just what.

K.5 Not taking screenshots

Symptoms: The report has numbers but no proof. **Likely cause:** The manager does not know that screenshots are standard practice. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Can you show me the insights page? Where is the screenshot?" **Corrective steps:** Take screenshots of the insights pages every month. Attach them to the report or share them in a Google Drive folder. **How to confirm resolved:** The report includes screenshots. **Prevention:** Screenshots prove â€" make them a habit.

K.6 Focusing on followers instead of results

Symptoms: The manager celebrates follower growth but ignores orders, bookings or calls. **Likely cause:** They think followers are the goal. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How many orders did we get? How many booking enquiries? Did we hit the goal?" **Corrective steps:** Followers are a metric, not a goal. The goal is the business result â€" orders, bookings, calls. **How to confirm resolved:** The report focuses on the business goal. **Prevention:** Always connect the metrics to the client's goal.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" ask the learner to explain their reasoning, not just their answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My One-Page Monthly Report"

Purpose: To practise reading metrics, calculating engagement rates and producing an honest one-page report â€" the core reporting skill of social media management â€" and to produce the reporting template that goes into the capstone.

Realistic scenario. You are a social media manager in Port Harcourt. A friend's sister, *Adaeze*, runs *Adaeze's Fashion* â€" a small fashion business that sells ankara dresses, ready-to-wear outfits and does custom sewing. Prices run from â‚¦5,000 for a simple dress to â‚¦30,000 for a custom ankara gown. The business has 900 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Adaeze is a skilled tailor but she is not online. She wants more customers â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and order from her. She can pay â‚¦35,000 a month. She does not want fake followers.

Detailed instructions:

1. Read the **sample metrics** below for Adaeze's Fashion, Month 1.
2. **Calculate the engagement rate** â€" show your working.
3. **Produce a one-page report** â€" all six parts: numbers against goals, top content, what worked, what did not, insights, next-month recommendation.
4. Write a **short paragraph** (4â€"6 sentences) presenting the report to Adaeze â€" the good, the bad and the plan.

SAMPLE METRICS â€" ADAEZE'S FASHION, MONTH 1 (fictional).

Metric	This month
Reach	5,600
Likes	240
Comments	58

Metric	This month
Saves	90
Shares	32
Clicks (WhatsApp link)	20
Orders	7
New followers	+68

Goals for the month:

- Reach 6,000 people.
- Get 15 orders.

Required deliverables:

- A one-page report (all six parts).
- The engagement rate calculation.
- The short presentation paragraph.

Submission format: Save as `MonthlyReport_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`) and upload to `/Social-Media-Management/Week3/MonthlyReport/`. You may also copy the report into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 8.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Engagement rate calculated	3	Correct formula; correct answer; working shown
Numbers against goals	3	Each goal compared to the actual number; met or not met
What worked and what did not	4	Specific posts named; honest about failures
Insights explain why	4	Not just what happened â€" why it happened
Next-month recommendation	3	Specific, actionable, connected to the insights
Presentation paragraph	3	The good, the bad and the plan; plain language

Common mistakes to avoid: inflating numbers; not calculating the engagement rate; hiding a bad month; writing vague reports; not taking screenshots; focusing on followers instead of results; using jargon Adaeze would not understand.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Engagement rate calculation:

> *(240 + 58 + 90 + 32) Ã· 5,600 Ã— 100 = 420 Ã· 5,600 Ã— 100 = 7.5% Round to 8%.*

One-page report:

> ***Monthly Report â€" Adaeze's Fashion, Month 1***
>
> ***1. Numbers against goals:***
>
> - *Goal: Reach 6,000 people. Actual: 5,600. Not met â€" close.*
> - *Goal: 15 orders. Actual: 7. Not met.*
> - *Engagement rate: 8%.*
> - *New followers: +68.*
>
> ***2. Top content:***
>
> - *Ankara dress photo: 1,100 views, 15 DMs.*

- *Price list carousel: 850 views, 10 DMs, 50 saves.*
- *Customer photo: 650 views, 6 DMs, 14 shares.*

3. What worked:

- *Clear photos of dresses with visible prices.*
- *Price lists â€" people save them.*
- *Customer photos â€" they build trust.*

4. What did not work:

- *Dark fabric photo: 150 views, 0 DMs.*
- *"Good morning" text post: 90 views, 0 DMs.*

5. Insights:

- *People want to see the dresses clearly and know the price.*
- *People save price lists â€" they are useful.*
- *Only 7 of 20 clickers became orders â€" the ordering process may be unclear.*

6. Next-month recommendation:

- *Post more dress photos with prices.*
- *Brighten all photos.*
- *Add a "how to order" graphic to every post.*
- *Stop text-only "good morning" posts.*
- *Review the WhatsApp ordering process with Adaeze.*

Presentation paragraph: "Adaeze, here is the month's report. The good news: we nearly reached our reach goal â€" 5,600 people against a target of 6,000 â€" and engagement was healthy at 8%. The ankara dress photo and the price list worked well. The bad news: we did not reach our orders goal â€" 7 against a target of 15 â€" and the dark fabric photo did not work. The issue is that people are clicking but not ordering, so next month we will make the ordering process clearer on every post and review the WhatsApp process with you. I am confident we will get closer to the orders target next month."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the six key metrics a social media manager tracks?

Q2. List. Name the six parts of a one-page monthly report.

Q3. Multiple choice. A post has 200 likes, 30 comments, 50 saves and 20 shares. The reach is 4,000. What is the engagement rate? a) 2.5% b) 7.5% c) 25% d) 75%

Q4. Explain. Why must a manager never inflate numbers in a report?

Q5. Scenario. A client says: "The report says we reached 50,000 people, but when I check my own Instagram, it says 8,000. What is going on?" Write two sentences explaining what likely happened â€" and what the manager should do.

Q6. Matching. Match each metric to what it answers: Reach, Engagement rate, Saves, Shares, Clicks, Follower growth. a) How many people shared the content with others? b) How many new followers did the page gain? c) How many unique people saw the content? d) How many people saved the post for later? e) Of the people who saw it, how many interacted? f) How many people clicked the link or WhatsApp button?

Q7. True or false. A manager should hide a bad month to protect the client's feelings.

Q8. Fill in the blank. Engagement rate = (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· _____ Ã— 100.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q8)

A1. Reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks, follower growth.

A2. Numbers against goals, top content, what worked, what did not, insights, next-month recommendation.

A3. (b) 7.5%. Calculation: (200 + 30 + 50 + 20) Ã· 4,000 Ã— 100 = 300 Ã· 4,000 Ã— 100 = 7.5%.

A4. Because the client can check the numbers themselves â€" Instagram and Facebook show the owner their own insights. Inflating numbers is dishonest, destroys trust when discovered, and can end the relationship and the manager's reputation. A bad month reported honestly with a plan builds more trust than a fake good month.

A5. Model answer: "It is likely that the manager inflated the numbers â€" either by guessing instead of reading the actual insights, or by deliberately making the numbers look better. The manager should immediately show the client the real insights, apologise for the discrepancy, and commit to reporting only verified numbers with screenshots from now on." (Accept any answer that identifies the dishonesty and proposes honest correction.)

A6. Reach = (c); Engagement rate = (e); Saves = (d); Shares = (a); Clicks = (f); Follower growth = (b).

A7. False. A bad month is information, not a disaster. A manager who reports it honestly â€" with insights and a plan â€" builds trust. Hiding it destroys trust when the client inevitably discovers the truth.

A8. Engagement rate = (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· **reach** Ã— 100.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned to measure and report honestly. You learned that measurement is checking the numbers and reporting is writing them down and explaining what they mean. You learned that honest reporting is non-negotiable â€" real numbers, honest insights, never inflated. You learned the six key metrics â€" reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks and follower growth. You learned to calculate the engagement rate correctly: (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· reach Ã— 100. You learned to produce a one-page monthly report with six parts â€" numbers against goals, top content, what worked, what did not, insights and next-month recommendation. And you learned to present results honestly â€" the good, the bad and the plan.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Honest reporting is non-negotiable** â€" real numbers, honest insights, never inflated.
2. **Six key metrics** â€" reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks, growth.
3. **Engagement rate** = interactions Ã· reach Ã— 100 â€" always calculate, never guess.
4. **A one-page report** has six parts â€" and insights explain why, not just what.
5. **The good, the bad and the plan** â€" a bad month reported well builds trust.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I identify the six key metrics and explain what each means?
- Can I calculate an engagement rate correctly?
- Can I produce a one-page report with all six parts?
- Can I write insights that explain why â€" not just what?
- Can I present results honestly â€" the good, the bad and the plan?

Connection to the next session. You now know how to measure and report honestly â€" but how do you grow? Next session we learn paid promotion and organic growth. We will cover what boosting is, when it makes sense, how to set basic targeting, how to plan a small naira budget, and why bought followers and engagement pods destroy trust. You will produce a paper boost plan â€" and that becomes part of your capstone.

Say it with us: *No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof.*

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner identifies all six metrics and explains what each means.
- Learner calculates the engagement rate correctly with working shown.
- Learner produces a one-page report with all six parts.
- Learner writes insights that explain why â€" not just what.

- Learner presents results honestly â€" the good, the bad and the plan.
- Learner refuses to inflate numbers â€" even when a month is bad.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Followers are the goal." â†' Followers are a metric; orders, bookings and calls are goals.
- "A bad month is a failure." â†' It is information â€" report it honestly with a plan.
- "Inflating numbers helps the client." â†' It destroys trust when discovered.
- "Engagement rate is too complicated." â†' It is a 30-second calculation.
- "A vague report is fine." â†' Specific numbers and insights are what make a report useful.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Metric matching drill:** give six metrics and six definitions; the learner matches them and explains one.
2. **Engagement rate drill:** give five sets of numbers; the learner calculates the engagement rate for each.
3. **Report reconstruction:** give a vague report ("good month, lots of engagement") and ask the learner to rewrite it with the six-part structure.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed report â€" numbers against goals and top content already filled in â€" and ask the learner to complete what worked, what did not, insights and recommendation.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written â€" a complete one-page report from sample data.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to produce a three-month trend report â€" three months of sample data in a Google Sheet â€" and write a short "trend analysis" explaining what is improving, what is declining and what the manager should do about it. The analysis must include at least one chart or visual representation.

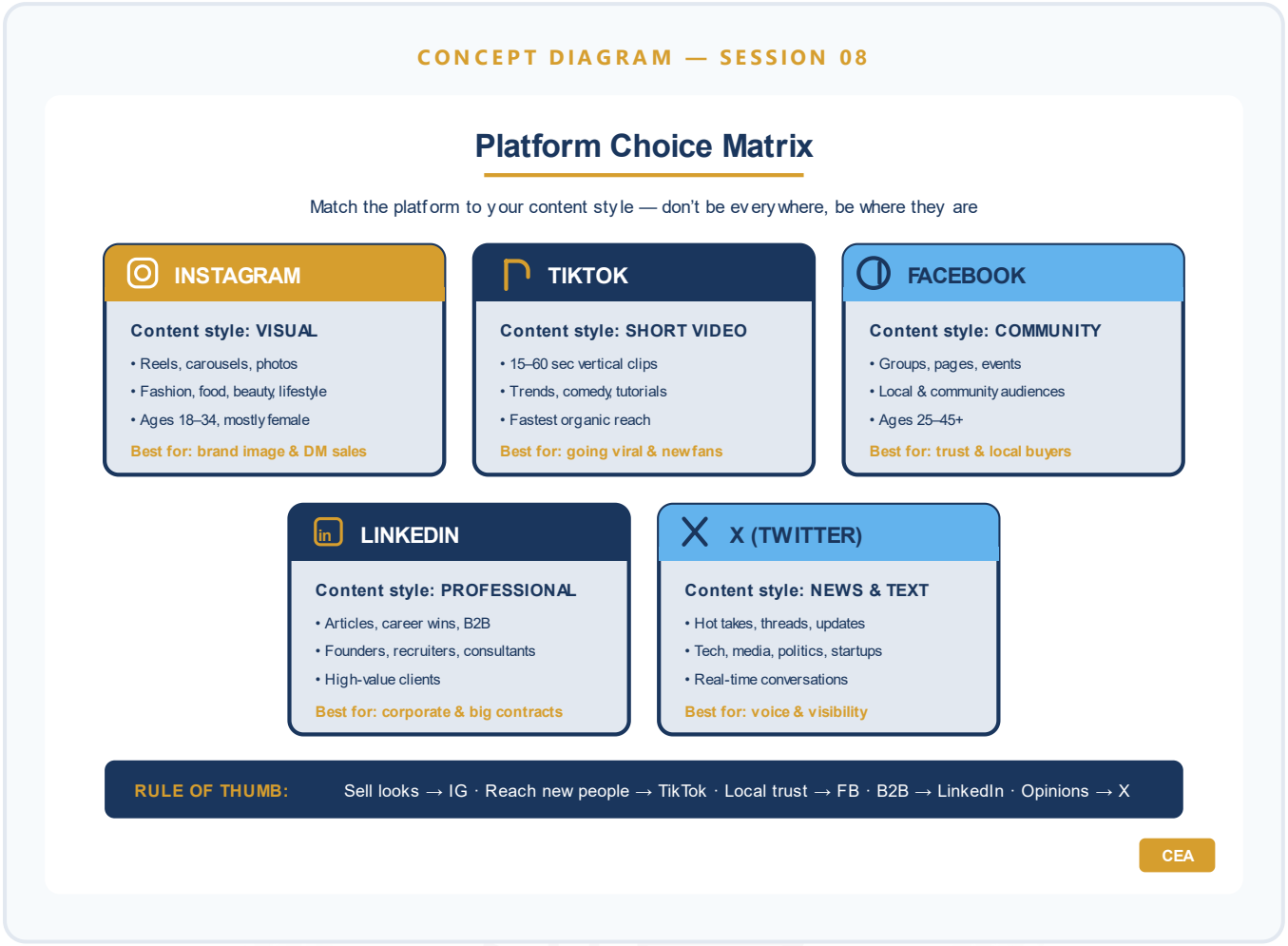
Timing guidance. The priority is learners completing a one-page report from sample data (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the presentation section (F.5) and protect the guided practical â€" the ability to read metrics and write a report is the core skill. If the room is fast, extend the case study discussion and let learners role-play presenting their reports to a "client" (the instructor or a partner).

END OF SESSION 7

Next: Session 8 â€" Paid Promotion Basics and Growth.

SESSION 08 OF 9

Paid Promotion Basics and Growth



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

SESSION 8 â€" PAID PROMOTION BASICS AND GROWTH

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	8 of 9
Session title	Paid Promotion Basics and Growth
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Grow and Report
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with paid promotion)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"7 â€" the learner can define social media management, list the five core tasks, build a strategy, design a content calendar, create content, manage a community, schedule

Item	Detail
	posts, draft a working agreement and produce an honest monthly report. Everyday smartphone use assumed. No prior advertising or media buying experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 7 we learned to measure and report honestly. Today we learn to grow â€" both organically and with paid promotion. We cover what boosting is, when it makes sense, how to set basic targeting, how to plan a small naira budget with a stop rule, and why bought followers and engagement pods destroy trust. The practical is a paper boost plan â€" no real money is spent.
Preparation before class	Projector connected and tested; the sample post options for the boost decision exercise (Section D) ready on screen; the boost-plan worksheet (Section H) printed per learner; the budget planner printed; the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief available; a whiteboard for the live budget build; academy Wi-Fi confirmed.

Running client reminder. *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" fictional small food business in Rumuola, Port Harcourt. Sells local meals (jollof, fried rice, small chops, plantain, fish) for pickup and delivery. Prices â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦8,000. Owner "Chef Nkechi" cooks with two assistants, takes orders on one WhatsApp line. Instagram and Facebook pages silent for three months. Wants consistent posting for 30 days and more WhatsApp orders â€" no advertising budget. Has been burned by someone who bought her fake followers.

Instructor note on tone. This session has two messages, and both must land. First: paid promotion is a useful tool when used wisely â€" it can help a good business reach more of the right people. Second: fake growth is fraud, and a manager who buys followers or uses engagement pods is a cheat. Keep the mood balanced and confident. Many learners will have seen "buy followers" offered online â€" your job is to show them clearly why it is worthless and risky, and to teach them the honest alternative.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** what boosting is, how it differs from organic growth, and when it makes sense for a small business.
2. **Plan** a boost with an audience, a duration, a naira budget and a success measure â€" on paper, without spending real money.
3. **Calculate** basic results in naira â€" cost per result, return on a small budget â€" and decide whether to continue, adjust or stop.
4. **Describe** honest organic growth methods that build a real audience over time.
5. **Argue** why bought followers, likes and engagement pods are rejected â€" with clear reasoning.
6. **Apply** the rule: never spend a client's money on ads without written approval.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a notes app or Google Docs.
- Academy computers (one per learner or one per pair) for Google Sheets.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- A whiteboard or flipchart and markers.

Software

- A notes app on every phone.
- Google Sheets (free) for the budget planner.
- A calculator app (phone or computer) for the cost-per-result calculations.

Sample files

- **Sample post options for the boost decision exercise** (Section D) â€" three fictional posts with different performance levels.
- **Boost-plan worksheet** (Section H) â€" a table: *Post / Goal / Audience / Duration / Budget / Success measure*.
- **Budget planner** â€" a table: *Day / Budget / Platform / Target audience / Stop rule*.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 8.1 â€" "My Boost Plan" (the boost-plan worksheet above).
- Worksheet 8.2 â€" "My Budget Planner" (the budget planner above).
- Worksheet 8.3 â€" "Organic Growth Plan" â€" a list of five honest growth actions with a timeline.

Accounts

- Free social media accounts. No ad account is required â€" the boost plan is on paper only.

Internet

- Academy Wi-Fi for Google Sheets. If Wi-Fi fails, the worksheets are printed â€" the session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a calculator and a notes app works. A learner without a device may work with a partner â€" one reads the sample data, one calculates. The skill today is the *plan*, not the device.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor: No real money is spent in this session. The boost plan is a paper exercise. Emphasise: a manager never spends a client's money on ads without written approval â€" the client must agree to the budget, the audience and the goal in advance. Also emphasise: bought followers, likes, views and engagement pods are fraud â€" they destroy trust and can get a client's page banned.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show three fictional posts from the same business â€" *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*. All three are real posts from the past month. Do not explain which one is best yet.

Post A â€" "The Strong Post." A clear, well-lit photo of jollof with a price graphic. It reached 2,400 people naturally, got 180 likes, 45 comments, 80 saves and 30 shares. 25 people clicked the WhatsApp link.

Post B â€" "The Weak Post." A dark, blurry photo of plantain with no price. It reached 150 people, got 8 likes, 1 comment, 0 saves and 0 shares. 1 person clicked the link.

Post C â€" "The Event Post." A flyer for a weekend special â€" small-chops tray, â‚¦8,000, Saturday only. It reached 350 people, got 20 likes, 5 comments, 10 saves and 8 shares. 4 people clicked the link.

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at these three posts. Post A is strong â€" clear photo, visible price, people saved it and shared it. Post B is weak â€" dark, no price, nobody cared. Post C is an event post â€" a time-limited offer. Now, hands up: which of these three posts would you spend money to boost? â€¦ Post A, obviously. Why? Because it is already working â€" boosting a strong post makes it work harder. Would you boost Post B? No â€" because boosting a bad post just shows more people a bad post. Would you boost Post C? Maybe â€" if the event is this week and you want to fill it. Today you learn to make that decision â€" when to boost, when not to, and how to plan a small naira budget. And you learn why buying followers is not growth â€" it is fraud."*

Expected learner response: Learners will point at Post A and say "it is already working," "it has good numbers," "it is clear." Accept all answers. Draw out the logic: boost what works, fix what does not.

Then reveal the hook: Say:

> *"Boosting is simple: you pay the platform to show your post to more of the right people. But the skill is not pressing the button â€" the skill is deciding what to boost, who to show it to, how much to spend, and when to stop. A manager who boosts blindly will burn a client's money in a day. A manager who plans a boost will get real results. Today you learn to plan â€" on paper, without spending a single naira."*

Why this opener works: It uses three concrete posts with real numbers to make the abstract decision of "what to boost" tangible. Learners see immediately that boosting a strong post makes sense and boosting a weak post does not â€" and they want to learn the full process.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five core tasks of a social media manager?"

- Expected answer: Planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting.
- Common gap: learners forget "reporting." Clarify: "Today we add one more skill â€" growing â€" which connects to both posting and reporting."

Question 2: "What is the engagement rate formula?"

- Expected answer: (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· reach Ã— 100.
- Common gap: learners say "likes Ã· followers." Clarify: "Total interactions Ã· reach Ã— 100. Not followers â€" reach."

Question 3: "What are the six key metrics?"

- Expected answer: Reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks, follower growth.
- Common gap: learners list followers instead of clicks. Clarify: "Followers are one of the six â€" but clicks is the one that connects to orders."

Question 4: "What is a SMART goal?"

- Expected answer: Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound.
- Common gap: learners remember some letters. Write them on the board quickly.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"In Session 7 we learned to measure honestly. Today we learn to grow â€" with and without money. We will cover what boosting is, when it makes sense, how to plan a boost with a naira budget and a stop rule, and why fake growth is fraud. The practical is a paper boost plan â€" you will plan a boost without spending a single naira. That is how a professional prepares before they spend a client's money."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 2, spend 3 extra minutes practising the engagement rate calculation with a quick example before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Organic growth vs paid promotion â€" what money can and cannot buy

The idea. Organic growth is growing a page without paying â€" through good content, consistency and engagement. **Paid promotion** is paying a platform to show content to more people. Both have a place â€" but they do different jobs.

Plain-English definition. Organic growth is earning attention by being worth following. Paid promotion is buying attention to reach more of the right people faster.

What money can buy:

- **Reach** â€" more people see the post.
- **Speed** â€" results in days, not months.
- **Specific targeting** â€" showing the post to people in a certain area, age or interest.
- **Support for something that works** â€" boosting a strong post to make it work harder.

What money cannot buy:

- **Loyalty** â€" a boosted follower who does not care about the business will never buy.

- **Trust** â€" people trust recommendations and quality, not ads.
- **Engagement rate** â€" boosting a post with a low engagement rate will not suddenly make people care.
- **A good product** â€" no amount of money will make a bad product sell.
- **Real results** â€" money can bring eyes; only quality converts eyes into orders.

The key lesson â€" organic is the foundation, paid is the amplifier. A page that grows organically has real followers, real engagement and real trust. Paid promotion on top of that foundation can accelerate growth. But paid promotion on a page with no organic foundation is like building a house on sand â€" it will not last.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **musician**. A musician who builds a fanbase by playing gigs, sharing songs and connecting with listeners is growing organically. A musician who pays to have their song played on the radio is using paid promotion. The radio play can help â€" but only if the song is good. A bad song on the radio is just expensive noise.

F.2 What boosting is â€" and when it makes sense

The idea. Boosting is paying a platform (Instagram, Facebook) to show one of your existing posts to more people than it would reach naturally. It is the simplest form of paid promotion.

Plain-English definition. Boosting is paying to give one post a bigger audience â€" so more of the right people see it.

Why it exists. A post that works naturally deserves a bigger audience. Boosting lets a business put money behind their best content instead of hoping the algorithm shows it to enough people.

When boosting makes sense â€" the four situations:

1. **A strong post** â€" a post that is already performing well naturally. Boosting it makes it work harder.
2. **An event** â€" a time-limited offer, a weekend special, a launch. Boosting fills the event.
3. **A goal that needs reach** â€" when the client's goal is awareness (for example, "reach 5,000 people this month") and organic reach is not enough.
4. **A proven offer** â€" a discount or package that has converted before. Boosting it to a targeted audience can bring orders.

When boosting does NOT make sense:

- **A weak post** â€" boosting a post with low engagement just shows more people a post they will ignore.
- **A bad product or offer** â€" no amount of money will fix a weak offer.
- **No clear goal** â€" boosting without a goal is just spending money.
- **No budget agreement** â€" never boost without the client's written approval and a clear budget.

Worked example â€" the boost decision for the three posts:

Post	Decision	Why
Post A (strong jollof)	Boost â€" â‚¦2,000 for 3 days	Already working; boost to reach more of the right people.
Post B (weak plantain)	Do not boost â€" fix the post first	Low engagement; boosting a weak post wastes money.
Post C (event flyer)	Boost â€" â‚¦3,000 for 2 days	Time-limited event; boost to fill it.

The key lesson â€" boost what works, fix what does not. A manager who boosts every post will waste a client's money. A manager who boosts selectively â€" strong posts, events and proven offers â€" will get real results.

F.3 Planning a boost â€" audience, duration, budget and success measure

The idea. A boost without a plan is a gamble. A boost with a plan is an investment. The plan has four parts: audience, duration, budget and success measure.

Plain-English definition. A boost plan is a simple document that says who the post will reach, how long it will run, how much it will cost and what result it will achieve.

The four parts:

Part	What it says	Example
Audience	Who will see the post â€" location, age, interests.	Women and men, 18â€"40, within 15 km of Port Harcourt, interested in food and restaurants.

Part	What it says	Example
Duration	How many days the boost will run.	3 days (Friday to Sunday â€" when people decide weekend food).
Budget	How much money will be spent, in naira.	â‚¦2,000 total â€" about â‚¦667 per day.
Success measure	What result the boost will achieve â€" and how it will be judged.	20 WhatsApp clicks and 5 orders. If we get fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, we stop.

Worked example â€" a complete boost plan for Post A:

> ***Boost Plan â€" Taste of Rivers Kitchen, Jollof Post***
>
> - ***Post:*** *The strong jollof photo (2,400 natural reach, 180 likes, 25 WhatsApp clicks).*
> - ***Goal:*** *Get 20 WhatsApp clicks and 5 orders.*
> - ***Audience:*** *People aged 18â€"40, within 15 km of Port Harcourt, interested in food, restaurants and cooking.*
> - ***Duration:*** *3 days â€" Friday to Sunday.*
> - ***Budget:*** *â‚¦2,000 total (about â‚¦667 per day).*
> - ***Success measure:*** *20 WhatsApp clicks and 5 orders. If fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, stop the boost.*
> - ***Approval:*** *Chef Nkechi has approved this plan in writing (WhatsApp message, 10 a.m. Monday).*

The key lesson â€" the stop rule is the most important part. A manager without a stop rule will keep spending money on a boost that is not working. A manager with a stop rule â€" "if fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, stop" â€" protects the client's money.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **market trader** who pays for a stall at a busy market. A trader who pays for the stall, watches the sales for two hours, and leaves if nobody is buying â€" that trader is using a stop rule. A trader who pays for the stall and stays all day even when nobody is buying â€" that trader is wasting money.

F.4 Reading results in naira â€" cost per result and the stop rule

The idea. A boost produces numbers â€" clicks, orders, reach. A manager must read those numbers in naira and decide whether to continue, adjust or stop.

Plain-English definition. Cost per result is how much each click, order or result cost in naira. The stop rule is the point at which a boost is not working and must be stopped.

The two calculations:

1. **Cost per click:** Budget Ã· number of clicks.
   - Example: â‚¦2,000 Ã· 25 clicks = â‚¦80 per click.
2. **Cost per order:** Budget Ã· number of orders.
   - Example: â‚¦2,000 Ã· 5 orders = â‚¦400 per order.

Worked example â€" reading the boost results:

Day	Budget spent	Clicks	Orders	Cost per click	Decision
Day 1	â‚¦667	6	1	â‚¦111	Below target â€" watch.
Day 2	â‚¦667	5	1	â‚¦133	Below target â€" stop rule triggered.
Day 3	â‚¦0	0	0	â€"	Boost stopped.

Say: "After two days, we had 11 clicks and 2 orders. The stop rule said: if fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, stop. We had 11 â€" but the trend was down (6 then 5). A good manager would stop here and try a different post or audience. That is how you protect the client's money."

The key lesson â€" judge the trend, not just the total. A boost that gets 11 clicks in two days is not terrible â€" but if the daily trend is down, it will not reach 20 clicks in three days. A manager who watches the daily numbers can stop early and save the rest of the budget.

Common misconception. "More money = more results." Not necessarily. A boost with the wrong audience or a weak post will waste any budget. A boost with the right audience and a strong post can work with â‚¦500 a day.

F.5 Honest organic growth â€" building a real audience

The idea. Organic growth is growing a page without paying â€" through good content, consistency and genuine engagement. It is slower than paid promotion, but it builds something real.

Plain-English definition. Organic growth is earning followers and engagement by being worth following â€" posting consistently, using the right hashtags, engaging with the community and collaborating with others.

The five honest organic growth methods:

1. **Post consistently** â€" three times a week, every week. The algorithm rewards consistency.
2. **Use relevant hashtags** â€" 3â€"10 focused tags (location + niche + brand), not 30 random ones.
3. **Engage with the community** â€" reply to every comment, comment on other local pages, join local conversations.
4. **Collaborate** â€" partner with a complementary business (a zobo seller for a food page) to reach each other's audiences.
5. **Create shareable content** â€" behind-the-scenes videos, customer photos and useful tips that people want to pass on.

Worked example â€" an organic growth plan for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

Week	Action
Week 1	Post 3 times with 5 relevant hashtags each. Reply to every comment within 2 hours.
Week 2	Comment on 5 local food pages (genuine comments, not spam). Post a customer photo.
Week 3	Partner with a local zobo seller â€" cross-promote each other's pages.
Week 4	Post a "behind the kitchen" Reel and ask viewers to share it.

The key lesson â€" organic growth is a marathon, not a sprint. A page that grows honestly over three months will have real followers, real engagement and real trust. That is worth more than 10,000 bought followers who never buy.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **farmer**. A farmer who plants seeds, waters them and waits for the harvest is growing organically. A farmer who buys fake fruit and puts it on the tree is faking it â€" and everyone can tell. A manager who grows a page honestly is the first farmer.

F.6 Why fake growth is rejected â€" the case against bought followers and pods

The idea. Bought followers, likes, views and engagement pods are fraud. They inflate numbers without bringing real customers â€" and they destroy trust when discovered.

Plain-English definition. Fake growth is paying for followers, likes, views or comments that are not from real people who care about the business.

Why fake growth destroys value:

1. **Fake followers never buy.** A bought follower is a bot or a fake account. They will never order, book or call.
2. **Fake engagement destroys credibility.** A page with 10,000 followers and 3 likes per post looks fake â€" and customers notice.
3. **Platforms punish fake growth.** Instagram and Facebook regularly remove fake followers and engagement â€" a page that bought followers can lose them overnight, or be banned.
4. **Fake growth inflates expectations.** A client who believes they have 10,000 real followers will be confused when they get 3 orders a month. The manager looks incompetent â€" or dishonest.
5. **Fake growth is fraud.** A manager who buys followers for a client is taking money for something worthless. That is fraud, not marketing.

Engagement pods â€" what they are and why they fail. An engagement pod is a group of accounts that agree to like and comment on each other's posts to trick the algorithm. They fail because: the engagement is fake, the algorithm eventually detects it, and the followers gained from it are not real.

Say this to the class:

> *"Let me be very clear. In this course, and in this profession, there is no such thing as a harmless fake follower. Every bought follower, every fake like, every engagement pod â€" they are all fraud. They make the page look big while bringing zero customers. They get the page banned. And they destroy the trust between the manager and the client. A manager who buys followers is not a shortcut â€" they are a cheat. And a cheat will be caught. Real growth is slower and worth more. Always."*

Real-life comparison. Think of a **student who cheats on an exam.** A student who cheats might pass one exam â€" but they have not learned anything, and they will fail the real test when it comes. A manager who buys followers might inflate one report â€" but they have not built anything real, and they will fail when the client checks their own insights.

F.7 The written approval rule â€" never spend without permission

The idea. A manager must never spend a client's money on ads without written approval. This is both an ethics rule and a professional standard.

Plain-English definition. The written approval rule means the client must agree â€" in writing â€" to the boost plan before any money is spent.

Why it exists: Spending someone's money without permission is a serious breach of trust. Even if the boost works, the client may feel violated. Even if the boost fails, the client may feel robbed. Written approval protects both sides.

What the written approval includes:

- The post that will be boosted.
- The audience, duration and budget.
- The success measure and stop rule.
- The client's explicit agreement â€" a WhatsApp message, email or signed note is enough.

Worked example â€" the approval message:

> ***Manager to Chef Nkechi:*** *"Chef Nkechi, I would like to boost Friday's jollof post. Plan: â‚¦2,000 for 3 days, targeting people within 15 km of Port Harcourt interested in food. Goal: 20 WhatsApp clicks and 5 orders. If we get fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, I will stop. Do you approve?"*
>
> ***Chef Nkechi:*** *"Approved. â‚¦2,000 for 3 days. Let me know the results."*

The key lesson â€" approval is not a formality; it is protection. A manager who gets written approval before spending is professional. A manager who spends without approval is gambling with the client's trust â€" and their own reputation.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- **Organic growth** is earning attention by being worth following. **Paid promotion** is buying attention to reach more of the right people faster.
- **Boosting** is paying to show one existing post to more people. It makes sense for strong posts, events, awareness goals and proven offers â€" never for weak posts or without a clear goal.
- **A boost plan** has four parts: audience, duration, budget and success measure â€" plus a stop rule.
- **Cost per result** is calculated in naira â€" cost per click and cost per order. The manager judges the daily trend, not just the total.
- **Honest organic growth** is a marathon â€" consistency, relevant hashtags, community engagement, collaborations and shareable content.
- **Fake growth is fraud** â€" bought followers, likes, views and engagement pods destroy value and trust.
- **The written approval rule** â€" never spend a client's money on ads without written approval.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Post performing well?] --> B{Yes}
    B --> C[Boost with small budget]
    C --> D[Target right audience]
    D --> E[Track results]
    E --> F{ROI positive?}
```

```
    F -->|Yes| G[Scale up]
    F -->|No| H[Stop and learn]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through a complete boost planning process â€” choosing what to boost, setting the audience and budget, calculating cost per result and deciding whether to continue or stop â€” for the running client, *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*.

Setup: On the projector, show the three sample posts from the opening activity. Have the boost-plan worksheet and the budget planner visible.

G.1 Demonstration 1 â€” Choose what to boost (3 minutes)

Say: "We have three posts. Which one do we boost?"

Walk through the decision:

Post	Natural performance	Decision
Jollof photo	2,400 reach, 180 likes, 25 clicks	Boost â€” strong post.
Plantain photo	150 reach, 8 likes, 1 click	Do not boost â€” weak post. Fix it first.
Event flyer	350 reach, 20 likes, 4 clicks	Maybe â€” if the event is this week.

Say: "We boost the jollof post. It is already working â€” clear photo, visible price, people clicking. We do not boost the plantain post â€” it is dark and nobody cares. We might boost the event flyer if the event is this week. Boost what works, fix what does not."

G.2 Demonstration 2 â€” Write the boost plan (4 minutes)

Say: "Now we write the plan. Four parts plus a stop rule."

Fill in the plan on the projector:

> ***Boost Plan â€” Taste of Rivers Kitchen, Jollof Post***
>
> - ***Post:*** *The strong jollof photo.*
> - ***Goal:*** *Get 20 WhatsApp clicks and 5 orders.*
> - ***Audience:*** *People aged 18â€“40, within 15 km of Port Harcourt, interested in food and restaurants.*
> - ***Duration:*** *3 days â€” Friday to Sunday.*
> - ***Budget:*** *â‚¦2,000 total (about â‚¦667 per day).*
> - ***Success measure:*** *20 WhatsApp clicks and 5 orders.*
> - ***Stop rule:*** *If fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, stop the boost.*
> - ***Approval:*** *Chef Nkechi must approve in writing before we spend.*

Say: "Audience, duration, budget, success measure and stop rule. That is a plan. Without the stop rule, it is a gamble."

G.3 Demonstration 3 â€” Read the results (5 minutes)

Say: "Now let us say the boost ran for two days. Here are the results."

Show the results on the projector:

Day	Budget spent	Clicks	Orders	Cost per click	Decision
Day 1	â‚¦667	6	1	â‚¦111	Below target â€” watch.
Day 2	â‚¦667	5	1	â‚¦133	Trend is down â€” stop rule triggered.

Walk through the decision:

> *"After two days, we spent â‚¦1,334 and got 11 clicks and 2 orders. The stop rule said: if fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, stop. We had 11 â€" but the trend was down (6 then 5). A good manager stops here. We saved â‚¦666 of the budget. We do not spend the third day on a boost that is declining."*

Calculate the cost per result:

> *Cost per click so far: â‚¦1,334 Ã· 11 = â‚¦121 per click. Cost per order: â‚¦1,334 Ã· 2 = â‚¦667 per order.*

Say: "â‚¦121 per click and â‚¦667 per order. Is that good? For a small food business, a â‚¦1,500 plate of jollof â€" â‚¦667 per order is high but not terrible if the customer becomes a regular. But the trend was down, so we stop. We try a different audience or a different post next time."

G.4 Demonstration 4 â€" Get written approval (3 minutes)

Say: "Last â€" before we spend a single naira, we get approval."

Show the approval message on the projector:

> ***Manager to Chef Nkechi:*** *"Chef Nkechi, I would like to boost Friday's jollof post. Plan: â‚¦2,000 for 3 days, targeting people within 15 km of Port Harcourt interested in food. Goal: 20 WhatsApp clicks and 5 orders. If we get fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, I will stop. Do you approve?"*
>
> ***Chef Nkechi:*** *"Approved. â‚¦2,000 for 3 days. Let me know the results."*

Say: "Written approval. A WhatsApp message is enough. The client knows exactly what we will spend, who we will target and what we will achieve. That is professional."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Which post did we boost, and why?" (The jollof post â€" it was already working.)
- "What is the stop rule?" (If fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, stop.)
- "What was the cost per click after two days?" (â‚¦121.)
- "Why did we stop even though we had 11 clicks?" (The trend was down â€" 6 then 5.)
- "What do we need before we spend?" (Written approval.)

Expected result: Learners see a complete boost planning process â€" choose, plan, execute, read, stop, approve â€" and they see that it is a disciplined process, not a gamble.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner writes a boost plan for a new fictional client â€" *Glamour Touch Salon* â€" and reads the results to decide whether to continue, adjust or stop.

Starting materials: The printed boost-plan worksheet, the printed budget planner, a pen, a calculator. No phone needed for the first part â€" it is a planning exercise.

CLIENT BRIEF â€" GLAMOUR TOUCH SALON (fictional). *Glamour Touch Salon* is a hair and beauty salon in Port Harcourt. It offers braids, weaves, natural hair care and make-up. Prices run from â‚¦1,000 for a basic braid to â‚¦15,000 for a full weave installation. The salon has 800 Instagram followers and posts rarely. The owner, "Aunty Funke," wants more bookings â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and call to book. She can pay â‚¦20,000 a month for management. She has â‚¦5,000 available for a one-time boost. She does not want fake followers.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name at the top of the boost-plan worksheet. Read the client brief once.
2. **Choose a post to boost.** Look at the three sample posts below. Which one would you boost â€" and why?
3. **Write the boost plan.** Fill in all four parts â€" audience, duration, budget and success measure â€" plus a stop rule.
4. **Get written approval.** Write the approval message you would send to Aunty Funke.

5. **Read the results.** Use the sample results below. Calculate the cost per click and cost per order. Decide: continue, adjust or stop â€" and explain why.
6. **Pause and predict:** Cover your worksheets and ask yourself: "What is the most important part of a boost plan?" Write your answer at the bottom.
7. Compare your plan with the person beside you. If you chose different audiences or budgets, explain your choices.

Three sample posts for Glamour Touch Salon:

Post	Natural performance
Post A â€" Box braid photo: Clear photo of a fresh box braid style with a price.	1,800 reach, 120 likes, 35 comments, 60 saves, 20 shares, 18 phone clicks.
Post B â€" Dark selfie: A blurry selfie of Aunty Funke with no price.	120 reach, 6 likes, 1 comment, 0 saves, 0 shares, 0 clicks.
Post C â€" Weekend special: A flyer for a Saturday special â€" make-up application â‚¦3,000.	280 reach, 15 likes, 4 comments, 8 saves, 6 shares, 3 clicks.

Sample results after 2 days of boosting Post A:

Day	Budget spent	Clicks	Booking enquiries
Day 1	â‚¦800	5	1
Day 2	â‚¦800	3	0

Expected result (model answers â€" instructor key):

Boost plan:

- **Post:** Post A â€" the box braid photo (strong post â€" already working).
- **Goal:** Get 15 phone clicks and 4 booking enquiries.
- **Audience:** Women aged 18â€"40, within 10 km of Port Harcourt, interested in hair, beauty and fashion.
- **Duration:** 3 days â€" Friday to Sunday.
- **Budget:** â‚¦3,000 total (â‚¦1,000 per day).
- **Success measure:** 15 phone clicks and 4 booking enquiries.
- **Stop rule:** If fewer than 8 clicks after 2 days, stop.
- **Approval:** Aunty Funke must approve in writing.

Approval message:

> *"Aunty Funke, I would like to boost the box braid photo. Plan: â‚¦3,000 for 3 days, targeting women within 10 km of Port Harcourt interested in hair and beauty. Goal: 15 phone clicks and 4 booking enquiries. If we get fewer than 8 clicks after 2 days, I will stop. Do you approve?"*

Results reading:

- Cost per click: â‚¦1,600 Ã· 8 = â‚¦200 per click.
- Cost per booking: â‚¦1,600 Ã· 1 = â‚¦1,600 per booking.
- Decision: Stop. The trend is down (5 then 3), and the stop rule was "fewer than 8 clicks after 2 days" â€" we had exactly 8 but the trend was declining. A good manager stops and tries a different audience or post.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "Which post did you choose? Why that one and not the others?"
- After step 3: "Does your plan have a stop rule? What is it?"
- After step 5: "What is the trend? Is it up or down? What does that tell you?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner chooses Post B (the dark selfie) â†' Prompt: "That post has 120 reach and 0 clicks. What would boosting it achieve?"
- Learner writes no stop rule â†' Prompt: "When do you stop spending? What is the trigger?"
- Learner says "continue the boost" despite the declining trend â†' Prompt: "Look at the daily numbers. Day 1: 5 clicks. Day 2: 3 clicks. Is that trend up or down?"
- Learner skips the approval message â†' Prompt: "What do you need before you spend the client's money?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Post chosen with a clear reason
- ☐ Boost plan has audience, duration, budget, success measure
- ☐ Stop rule written
- ☐ Approval message written
- ☐ Cost per click and cost per order calculated
- ☐ Continue/adjust/stop decision made with reasoning

I. SIMULATION â€" CLIENT PITCH AND PLAN (15%)

Time: 20 minutes + 4-minute debrief. **Weight:** 15% of the course grade. Marked the same day, out of 15 (Instructor Manual Â§7.1 and Â§7.3).

Where this fits. In Session 8 this simulation takes the place of the independent exercise (Instructor Manual Â§3.1, S8 override). To stay inside the 105-minute session, hold the lecture (Section F) to about 22 minutes and fold the case-study discussion (Section J) into the debrief. The full pack â€" brief update, comment/DM cards, metrics sheet, client-update form and the /15 marking rubric â€" is **Part 5, Template 9**. Prepare one sealed simulation envelope per learner. No real money is spent and no real account is touched.

Scenario â€" Taste of Rivers Kitchen: one busy Friday afternoon. You are the manager for *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*. It is 1 p.m. on a Friday and Chef Nkechi messages you: the jollof price changed this morning from â‚¦1,500 to â‚¦1,600; two posts are due today; and the comments are piling up. Work through the envelope alone, on paper, against the clock.

The task (individual, 20 minutes):

1. **Read the brief update** (3 minutes): the new price; two posts due today.
2. **Draft two captions** (6 minutes): a menu spotlight (hook + call-to-action + 4â€"5 hashtags, with the correct new price) and a behind-the-scenes post.
3. **Handle three comment/DM scenarios** (5 minutes): a delivery question; a late-order complaint; and a message offering to "buy 1,000 followers to help the page".
4. **Pull the numbers** (3 minutes): from the metrics sheet, calculate the engagement rate for each post and name the top post.
5. **Write a 4-sentence WhatsApp-style client update** (3 minutes): what worked, what did not, and one honest next action.

Debrief (4 minutes). Compare answers as a class. Each learner "pitches" one decision aloud in 30 seconds â€" how they replied, why they refused the follower offer, or what they would tell Chef Nkechi next. Close with the ethics mantra.

Marking /15 (Part 4 Â§7.3): accuracy **5**; tone, speed and professionalism **5**; honesty and ethics **5**. **Any pro-fake-growth answer = 0 for the simulation**, then discuss immediately. The mark rolls up to the 15% Simulation component.

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Mama Put's Rice and Beans* hired a social media manager who promised to "grow the page fast." The manager spent â‚¦20,000 of Mama Put's money on a boost â€" without asking. The boost targeted "everyone in Nigeria" and ran for 10 days. The results: 5,000 reach, 30 likes, 2 comments and 0 orders. The manager also bought 2,000 fake followers for â‚¦5,000 â€" the page now has 2,500 followers but still gets only 3 likes per post. Mama Put is angry. She feels robbed. She does not know what was real and what was fake.

Relevant facts.

- The manager spent â‚¦20,000 on a boost without written approval.
- The boost targeted "everyone in Nigeria" â€" not a specific audience.

- The boost ran for 10 days with no stop rule.
- The results: 5,000 reach, 30 likes, 2 comments, 0 orders.
- The manager bought 2,000 fake followers for â‚¦5,000.
- The page now has 2,500 followers but only 3 likes per post.
- Mama Put feels robbed and does not trust the manager.

Decision point. What went wrong â€” and what should a professional manager have done?

Possible approaches.

1. **Defend the spending** â€” "boosting is always a gamble."
2. **Blame the platform** â€ "Instagram did not show the post."
3. **Acknowledge the mistakes** â€ no written approval, no targeting, no stop rule, fake followers â€ and propose a professional plan going forward.

Recommended solution. Approach 3 â€ acknowledge the mistakes. A professional manager would:

- **Apologise** for spending without approval and for buying fake followers.
- **Explain** what went wrong: no targeting, no stop rule, no clear goal, fake followers.
- **Propose a professional plan**: a small budget (â‚¦5,000), a targeted audience, a 3-day duration, a clear success measure and a stop rule â€ with written approval before spending.
- **Remove the fake followers** (if possible) and commit to honest growth only.

What the manager should have done from the start:

- **Get written approval** before spending any money.
- **Target a specific audience** â€ not "everyone in Nigeria."
- **Set a clear goal and stop rule** â€ and stop when the rule is triggered.
- **Never buy followers** â€ fake growth is fraud.
- **Report honestly** â€ real numbers, even when they are bad.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is defensive and dishonest â€ Mama Put will end the relationship.
- Approach 2 is a lie â€ the manager knows what went wrong.
- Approach 3 is hard but right â€ it rebuilds trust and sets up a professional relationship going forward.

Professional connection. This is exactly what a professional manager does â€ and it is what separates a professional from someone who "just posts." A professional never spends without approval, never targets vaguely, never skips the stop rule and never buys followers. A professional plans, executes, measures and reports honestly. That is why a professional can charge â‚¦20,000 a month and a "poster" cannot.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Spending without written approval

Symptoms: The manager spends the client's money on ads without asking. **Likely cause:** They think "I know what is best â€ I will just do it." **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did the client approve this boost in writing? Can you show me the message?" **Corrective steps:** Never spend without written approval. Send the boost plan and get explicit agreement before spending. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can show an approval message for every boost. **Prevention:** Written approval is non-negotiable â€ make it a habit.

K.2 Boosting a weak post

Symptoms: The manager boosts a post with low natural engagement. **Likely cause:** They think boosting will fix a weak post. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What was the natural reach and engagement of this post? Is it strong or weak?" **Corrective steps:** Boost strong posts only. Fix weak posts first â€ better photo, clearer price, stronger hook. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can explain why a post is worth boosting. **Prevention:** Boost what works â€ never boost what does not.

K.3 No stop rule

Symptoms: The manager runs a boost with no trigger to stop. **Likely cause:** They think "more days = more results." **How to investigate:** Ask: "When do you stop? What number tells you the boost is not working?" **Corrective steps:** Set a stop rule before the boost â€" "if fewer than X clicks after 2 days, stop." **How to confirm resolved:** The plan includes a stop rule. **Prevention:** The stop rule is the most important part of the plan â€" never skip it.

K.4 Targeting too broadly

Symptoms: The boost targets "everyone in Nigeria" or "all interests." **Likely cause:** They think a bigger audience = more results. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Who is the client's customer? Where do they live? What are their interests?" **Corrective steps:** Target a specific audience â€" location, age, interests â€" tied to the client's customer. **How to confirm resolved:** The audience is specific and justified. **Prevention:** A targeted audience of 5,000 right people beats a broad audience of 500,000 wrong people.

K.5 Buying followers or using pods

Symptoms: The manager buys followers or joins an engagement pod. **Likely cause:** They think it is a shortcut to growth. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Are these followers real? Will they ever buy from the client?" **Corrective steps:** Never buy followers or use pods. Grow organically â€" consistency, hashtags, engagement, collaborations, shareable content. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can explain why fake growth is fraud. **Prevention:** Repeat the ethics line â€" real growth is slower and worth more.

K.6 Not judging the trend

Symptoms: The manager looks only at the total results, not the daily trend. **Likely cause:** They think the total is what matters. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What were the daily numbers? Was the trend up or down?" **Corrective steps:** Judge the daily trend â€" if clicks are declining day by day, the boost is fading. Stop early. **How to confirm resolved:** The manager can explain the trend and its implications. **Prevention:** A declining trend is an early warning â€" teach learners to watch it.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" ask the learner to explain their reasoning, not just their answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Boost Plan and Organic Growth Plan"

Purpose: To practise planning a paid boost and an organic growth strategy â€" the core growth skills of social media management â€" and to produce the growth and promotion section that goes into the capstone.

Realistic scenario. You are a social media manager in Port Harcourt. A friend's cousin, *Adaeze*, runs *Adaeze's Fashion* â€" a small fashion business that sells ankara dresses, ready-to-wear outfits and does custom sewing. Prices run from â‚¦5,000 for a simple dress to â‚¦30,000 for a custom ankara gown. The business has 900 Instagram followers and posts rarely. Adaeze is a skilled tailor but she is not online. She wants more customers â€" people should see her work, know her prices, and order from her. She can pay â‚¦35,000 a month for management. She has â‚¦6,000 available for a one-time boost. She does not want fake followers.

Detailed instructions:

1. Choose a **post to boost** from the three sample posts below.
2. Write a **boost plan** â€" audience, duration, budget, success measure, stop rule.
3. Get **written approval** (write the approval message).
4. **Read the results** â€" calculate cost per click and cost per order. Decide: continue, adjust or stop.
5. Write an **organic growth plan** â€" five honest growth actions with a timeline for the next month.

Three sample posts:

Post	Natural performance
Post A â€" Ankara dress photo: Clear photo of a dress with a price.	2,200 reach, 150 likes, 40 comments, 70 saves, 25 shares, 20 WhatsApp clicks.

Post	Natural performance
Post B â€" Dark fabric photo: A blurry photo of fabric with no price.	130 reach, 7 likes, 1 comment, 0 saves, 0 shares, 0 clicks.
Post C â€" Custom sewing flyer: A flyer for custom orders â€" "Your design, our sewing."	320 reach, 18 likes, 6 comments, 12 saves, 8 shares, 4 clicks.

Sample results after 2 days of boosting Post A:

Day	Budget spent	Clicks	Orders
Day 1	â‚¦1,000	6	1
Day 2	â‚¦1,000	4	0

Required deliverables:

- A boost plan (four parts plus stop rule), an approval message and a results reading with a continue/adjust/stop decision.
- An organic growth plan (five actions with a timeline).

Submission format: Save as `BoostPlan_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`) and upload to `/Social-Media-Management/Week3/BoostPlan/`. You may also copy the plan into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 9.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Post chosen with reason	2	Clear justification based on natural performance
Boost plan complete	4	Audience, duration, budget, success measure, stop rule
Approval message	2	Written approval sought before spending
Results reading	4	Cost per result calculated; trend judged; decision made
Organic growth plan	5	Five honest actions with a realistic timeline
Ethics	3	No fake followers; no spending without approval; honest growth

Common mistakes to avoid: spending without approval; boosting a weak post; no stop rule; targeting too broadly; buying followers; not judging the trend; promising instant results.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Boost plan:

- **Post:** Post A â€" the ankara dress photo (strong post â€" already working).
- **Goal:** Get 18 WhatsApp clicks and 4 orders.
- **Audience:** Women aged 18â€"45, within 15 km of Port Harcourt, interested in fashion, ankara and beauty.
- **Duration:** 3 days â€" Friday to Sunday.
- **Budget:** â‚¦3,000 total (â‚¦1,000 per day).
- **Success measure:** 18 WhatsApp clicks and 4 orders.
- **Stop rule:** If fewer than 8 clicks after 2 days, stop.

Approval message:

> *"Adaeze, I would like to boost the ankara dress photo. Plan: â‚¦3,000 for 3 days, targeting women within 15 km of Port Harcourt interested in fashion. Goal: 18 WhatsApp clicks and 4 orders. If we get fewer than 8 clicks after 2 days, I will stop. Do you approve?"*

Results reading:

- Cost per click: â‚¦2,000 Ã· 10 = â‚¦200 per click.

- Cost per order: â‚¦2,000 Ã· 1 = â‚¦2,000 per order.
- Decision: Stop. The trend is down (6 then 4), and the stop rule was "fewer than 8 clicks after 2 days" â€” we had exactly 10 but the trend was clearly declining. Stop and try a different audience or post.

Organic growth plan:

- Week 1: Post 3 times with 5 relevant hashtags each. Reply to every comment within 2 hours.
- Week 2: Comment on 5 local fashion pages (genuine comments, not spam). Post a customer photo with permission.
- Week 3: Partner with a local fabric seller â€” cross-promote each other's pages.
- Week 4: Post a "behind the sewing machine" Reel and ask viewers to share it. Review which content got the most saves and shares, and plan next month's content around it.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€” answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is the difference between organic growth and paid promotion?

Q2. List. Name the four parts of a boost plan.

Q3. Multiple choice. A boost spent â‚¦2,000 and got 10 WhatsApp clicks. What is the cost per click? a) â‚¦20 b) â‚¦200 c) â‚¦2,000 d) â‚¦20,000

Q4. Explain. Why is a stop rule the most important part of a boost plan?

Q5. Scenario. A client says: "Just spend â‚¦50,000 on ads â€” I trust you." Write two sentences explaining why you will still get written approval first.

Q6. Matching. Match each situation to the right decision: Strong post, Weak post, Event flyer. a) Boost â€” already working; make it work harder. b) Do not boost â€” fix the post first. c) Maybe boost â€” if the event is soon.

Q7. True or false. Buying followers is a safe shortcut to growing a page.

Q8. Fill in the blank. The written approval rule: never spend a client's money on ads without _____ _____.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q8)

A1. Organic growth is growing a page without paying â€” through good content, consistency and engagement. Paid promotion is paying a platform to show content to more people faster. Organic is the foundation; paid is the amplifier.

A2. Audience, duration, budget, success measure â€” plus a stop rule.

A3. (b) â‚¦200. Calculation: â‚¦2,000 Ã· 10 = â‚¦200 per click.

A4. A stop rule is the most important part because it tells the manager when to stop spending. Without it, a manager will keep spending money on a boost that is not working. With it, the manager protects the client's budget and stops early when the trend is down.

A5. Model answer: "I appreciate your trust â€” but I need your written approval before I spend any money. I will send you the plan â€” the audience, the budget, the goal and the stop rule â€” and you decide if it is worth it. That way you know exactly what I am spending and why." (Accept any answer that insists on written approval.)

A6. Strong post = (a); Weak post = (b); Event flyer = (c).

A7. False. Buying followers is fraud. Fake followers never buy, they destroy credibility, they get pages banned, and they destroy the trust between the manager and the client.

A8. The written approval rule: never spend a client's money on ads without **written approval**.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned to grow â€” with and without money. You learned the difference between organic growth (earning attention by being worth following) and paid promotion (buying attention to reach more of the right people

faster). You learned what boosting is and when it makes sense â€" for strong posts, events, awareness goals and proven offers, never for weak posts or without a clear goal. You learned to plan a boost with four parts â€" audience, duration, budget and success measure â€" plus a stop rule. You learned to read results in naira â€" cost per click and cost per order â€" and to judge the daily trend, not just the total. You learned the five honest organic growth methods â€" consistency, relevant hashtags, community engagement, collaborations and shareable content. You learned why fake growth is fraud â€" bought followers, likes, views and engagement pods destroy value and trust. And you learned the written approval rule â€" never spend a client's money on ads without written approval.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Organic is the foundation, paid is the amplifier** â€" build real growth first.
2. **Boost what works, fix what does not** â€" never boost a weak post.
3. **A boost plan needs a stop rule** â€" the trigger that protects the client's money.
4. **Judge the trend, not the total** â€" a declining daily trend is an early warning.
5. **Fake growth is fraud** â€" no bought followers, no pods, no inflation.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain the difference between organic and paid growth?
- Can I decide which post to boost â€" and explain why?
- Can I write a boost plan with audience, duration, budget, success measure and stop rule?
- Can I calculate cost per click and cost per order?
- Can I explain why bought followers are fraud?
- Can I write an honest organic growth plan?

Connection to the next session. You now know how to plan, create, engage, schedule, measure and grow. Next session is the capstone. You will assemble everything you have learned into a complete client proposal and 30-day social media plan for *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*. You will present it, answer questions and defend your decisions. This is where all nine sessions come together â€" and it is your proof that you are ready.

Say it with us: *No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof.*

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner explains the difference between organic and paid growth.
- Learner chooses the right post to boost and explains why.
- Learner writes a complete boost plan with a stop rule.
- Learner calculates cost per result correctly.
- Learner judges the daily trend and makes a reasoned continue/adjust/stop decision.
- Learner refuses fake growth and insists on written approval.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "More money = more results." â†' A targeted plan with a stop rule beats a big budget with no plan.
- "Boosting fixes a weak post." â†' Boost what works; fix what does not.
- "A stop rule is optional." â†' It is the most important part of the plan.
- "Buying followers is a shortcut." â†' It is fraud â€" it destroys value and trust.
- "I can spend without asking." â†' Written approval is non-negotiable.
- "The total is what matters." â†' Judge the daily trend â€" a declining trend is an early warning.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Boost decision drill:** give three posts with natural performance data and ask the learner to choose which to boost and explain why.
2. **Stop rule writing drill:** give a boost scenario and ask the learner to write a stop rule.
3. **Cost per result drill:** give three sets of budget and results; the learner calculates cost per click and cost per order for each.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed boost plan â€” audience and budget already filled in â€” and ask the learner to complete the success measure, stop rule and results reading.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written â€” a complete boost plan, approval message, results reading and organic growth plan.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write a "paid promotion policy" â€” a one-page document explaining when the manager will boost, when they will not, how they will set the budget, how they will judge results and the written approval rule. The policy must be written for a client to read, not for another manager.

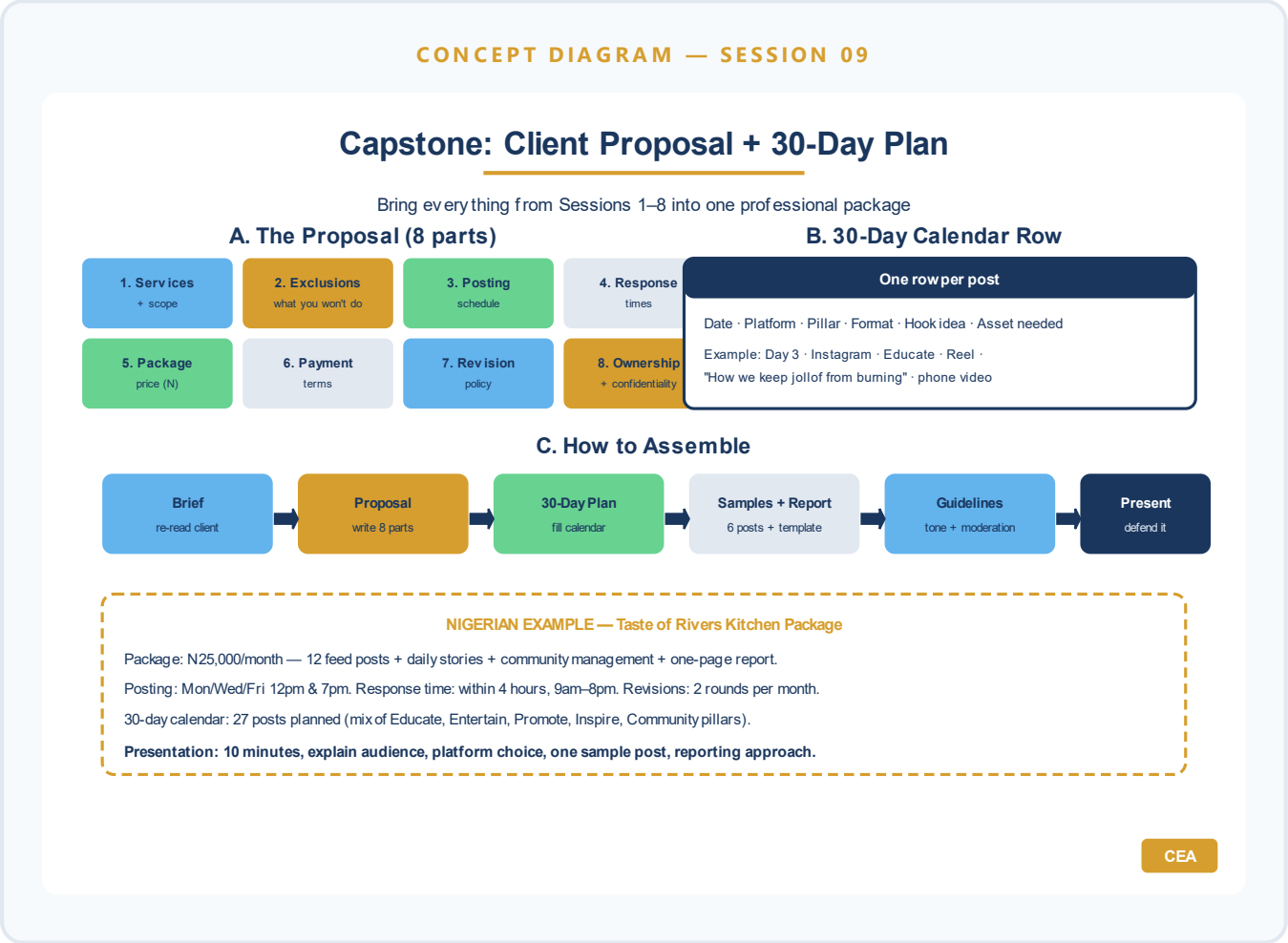
Timing guidance. The priority is learners completing a boost plan with a stop rule and a results reading (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the organic growth section (F.5) and protect the guided practical â€” the ability to plan and judge a boost is the core skill. If the room is fast, extend the case study discussion and let learners present their boost plans to the class.

END OF SESSION 8

Next: Session 9 â€” Capstone: Client Proposal and 30-Day Social Media Plan.

SESSION 09 OF 9

Capstone Client Proposal and 30 Day Social Media Plan



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

SESSION 9 â€" CAPSTONE: CLIENT PROPOSAL AND 30-DAY SOCIAL MEDIA PLAN

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	9 of 9
Session title	Capstone: Client Proposal and 30-Day Social Media Plan
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Grow and Report
Recommended duration	105 minutes

Item	Detail
Difficulty level	Beginner (capstone â€" assembling prior learning into one deliverable)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"8 â€" the learner can define social media management, build an audience and platform strategy, design a content strategy with pillars and a calendar, create and repurpose content, manage a community, schedule posts and run a client workflow, measure and report honestly, and plan a boost with a naira budget and stop rule. Everyday smartphone use assumed. No prior client-facing or proposal-writing experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 8 we learned to grow honestly â€" organic growth, boosting with a plan and a stop rule, and why fake growth is fraud. In Session 7 we learned to measure and report. Today we bring every piece together. This is the capstone: the complete client proposal and 30-day social media plan for *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*, with sample posts, a reporting template, community guidelines, a growth note and a short presentation. Everything you have built in Sessions 1â€"8 goes into this one package.
Preparation before class	Projector connected and tested; the capstone assembly worksheet printed per learner; the 30-day calendar template (blank table) printed or loaded in Google Sheets; the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief available on screen; the sample proposal skeleton visible; the presentation scoring rubric printed for self- and peer-assessment; a whiteboard for the live assembly walk; academy Wi-Fi confirmed.

Running client reminder. *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" fictional small food business in Rumuola, Port Harcourt. Sells local meals (jollof, fried rice, small chops, plantain, fish) for pickup and delivery. Prices â‚¦1,500â€"â‚¦8,000. Owner "Chef Nkechi" cooks with two assistants, takes orders on one WhatsApp line. Instagram and Facebook pages silent for three months. Wants consistent posting for 30 days and more WhatsApp orders â€" no advertising budget. Has been burned by someone who bought her fake followers.

Instructor note on tone. This is the final session and the capstone. The mood should feel like a graduation â€" confident, celebratory, but honest. Remind learners that the capstone is not about perfection; it is about completeness, consistency and honesty. A small business owner should be able to read this package and start work on Monday. The learner should be able to explain every decision behind it. Repeat the honest promise: this course does not promise followers, income or clients â€" it teaches a real skill. The certificate certifies competence as an entry-level social media manager.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Assemble** a complete client proposal â€" services, scope, exclusions, posting schedule, response times, deliverables, package price in naira, payment terms, revision policy, account ownership and confidentiality â€" that reads like a real client document.
2. **Build** a 30-day content calendar â€" one row per post with date, platform, pillar, format, caption or hook idea, and asset needed â€" that fits 30 days and one creator, and connects every post to a goal.
3. **Create** at least six written sample posts with captions, calls-to-action and hashtags, and at least four designed in Canva in one consistent brand look.
4. **Prepare** a one-page reporting template â€" metrics, targets, actuals, what worked, what did not, next-month action â€" ready to fill in after 30 days.
5. **Write** community-management guidelines â€" tone of voice, response-time target, moderation rules and an escalation step for complaints â€" and a growth and promotion note that rejects fake growth.
6. **Present and defend** the package in a short talk â€" explaining the audience, platform choices, a sample post, the reporting approach and how they would handle a bad month â€" and answer at least three questions.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a notes app or Google Docs.
- Academy computers (one per learner or one per pair) for Google Sheets, Google Docs and Canva.
- Instructor device connected to a projector or large screen.
- A whiteboard or flipchart and markers.

Software

- A notes app on every phone.
- Google Sheets (free) for the 30-day content calendar.
- Google Docs (free) for the client proposal.
- Canva (free plan) for the sample post designs.
- Meta Business Suite (free) â€" optional, for showing how scheduled posts connect to the calendar.

Sample files

- **Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief** â€" the running client details (Section A).
- **Capstone assembly worksheet** (Section H) â€" a checklist of all eight required components.
- **30-day calendar template** â€" a blank table: *Date / Platform / Pillar / Format / Caption or hook idea / Asset needed*.
- **Proposal skeleton** â€" a section-by-section outline with headings and prompts.
- **Reporting template** â€" a one-page table: *Metric / Target / Actual / What worked / What did not / Next-month action*.
- **Presentation scoring rubric** â€" for self- and peer-assessment.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 9.1 â€" "Capstone Assembly Checklist" (the eight components, learner ticks each as completed).
- Worksheet 9.2 â€" "My 30-Day Calendar" (the blank calendar template above).
- Worksheet 9.3 â€" "My Reporting Template" (the one-page reporting table above).

Accounts

- Free social media accounts and a free Canva account. No ad account is required.

Internet

- Academy Wi-Fi for Google tools and Canva. If Wi-Fi fails, the worksheets are printed â€" the session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner without a device may work with a partner â€" one reads the brief and client notes, one types. The skill today is the *assembly and presentation*, not the device.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor: The capstone is a fictional, authorised exercise. No real business is contacted. Rem learners that the ethics statement on the cover page is mandatory â€" it confirms the work is honest and the data is real or clearly marked as sample. Repeat: no bought followers, no fake reviews, no inflated numbers.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show the eight required components of the capstone package as a simple list. Do not explain them yet.

1. Cover page and ethics statement
2. Client proposal
3. Strategy summary
4. 30-day content calendar
5. Sample posts
6. Reporting template
7. Community-management guidelines
8. Growth and promotion note

What the instructor says:

> *"This is it. The final session. Everything you have learned in the last eight sessions comes together today into one package â€" a complete client proposal and 30-day social media plan for Taste of Rivers Kitchen. Look at these eight pieces. You have already done every one of them in a smaller form. Session 2 â€" audience, goals, platforms â€" that becomes your strategy summary. Session 3 â€" content pillars and a two-week calendar â€" that becomes half of your 30-day calendar. Session 4 â€" repurposing and Canva designs â€" that becomes your sample posts. Session 5 â€" reply bank and moderation policy â€" that becomes your community guidelines. Session 6 â€" working agreement â€" that becomes your proposal terms. Session 7 â€" monthly report â€" that becomes your reporting template. Session 8 â€" boost plan â€" that becomes your growth note. Today you assemble, you fill the gaps, and you present."*

Expected learner response: Learners will nod, some will smile â€" they can see the connections. A few will look nervous. Acknowledge both.

Then reveal the hook: Say:

> *"The skill is not in any one piece. The skill is in the assembly â€" making all eight pieces fit together, making them consistent, and making them something a real client can use. A chef does not just cook one dish â€" they cook a full meal, and every part must go together. Today you cook the full meal."*

Why this opener works: It shows learners that the capstone is not new work â€" it is assembly work. This reduces anxiety and gives them confidence. It also previews the full structure so they know where they are going.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five core tasks of a social media manager?"

- Expected answer: Planning, creating, posting, engaging, reporting.
- Common gap: learners forget one. Clarify: "Today we add one more â€" presenting â€" which is how you show the client what you did and why."

Question 2: "What is a SMART goal? Give an example."

- Expected answer: Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound. Example: "Get 30 WhatsApp orders in 30 days."
- Common gap: learners remember some letters. Write them on the board quickly.

Question 3: "What are the four parts of a boost plan?"

- Expected answer: Audience, duration, budget, success measure â€" plus a stop rule.
- Common gap: learners forget the stop rule. Clarify: "The stop rule is the most important part â€" it protects the client's money."

Question 4: "What is the engagement rate formula?"

- Expected answer: (likes + comments + saves + shares) Ã· reach Ã— 100.
- Common gap: learners say "likes Ã· followers." Clarify: "Total interactions Ã· reach Ã— 100. Not followers â€" reach."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have everything you need. You can research an audience, set goals, choose platforms, plan content, create posts, reply to a community, schedule, measure, grow and plan a boost. Today you put it all together into one package that a real client can read and use â€" and you stand up and defend it. That is what a professional social media manager does."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 2, spend 3 extra minutes writing a SMART goal together on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What a client proposal is â€" and why it matters

The idea. A **client proposal** is a written document that tells a potential client exactly what you will do for them, how much it will cost, and what they can expect. It is the document that turns a conversation into a contract.

Plain-English definition. A client proposal is a professional agreement written in plain language â€" it says who you are, what you will deliver, when you will deliver it, how much you charge, and what the client must do to make it work.

Why it exists. A client who pays â‚¦20,000 or â‚¦35,000 a month for social media management is taking a risk. They are trusting you with their brand, their account and their money. A written proposal protects both sides â€" it means there are no surprises, no arguments later about "I thought you were going to post every day," and no confusion about what was agreed.

What a good proposal contains â€" the eight sections:

Section	What it says	Why the client cares
1. Services and scope	What you will do â€" content creation, scheduling, community management, reporting, basic growth	They know what they are buying.
2. Exclusions	What you will *not* do â€" for example, paid advertising management, video editing from scratch, responding to DMs after 8 p.m.	They know the limits â€" no false expectations.
3. Posting schedule	How many posts per week, on which days, on which platforms	They know how often their page will be updated.
4. Response times	How quickly you will reply to comments and DMs â€" for example, within 2 hours during business hours	They know their customers will not be ignored.
5. Deliverables	What they receive each month â€" calendar, posts, report, guidelines	They can check you are delivering.
6. Package price and payment terms	The monthly fee in naira, when payment is due, what happens if payment is late	They know what to pay and when.
7. Revision policy	How many rounds of changes are included, and what happens after that	They know they can ask for changes â€" fairly.
8. Account ownership and confidentiality	The client owns the account, the content and the data; you will keep their information private	They know their business is safe with you.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **building contractor**. A contractor who says "I will build your house, trust me" is a risk. A contractor who hands you a written document â€" what they will build, the timeline, the cost, the materials, the payment schedule â€" is a professional. A social media proposal is the same thing. It is how you look like a professional, not a guess.

Common misconception. "A proposal is just a price list." No â€" a price list says what things cost. A proposal says what you will *do*, how you will do it, and what the client can expect. The price is one part of a much bigger document.

The key lesson â€" a proposal is a trust document. The proposal is not just paperwork. It is the thing that makes a client feel safe enough to hand over their business. A clear, honest, complete proposal wins clients. A vague, incomplete proposal loses them.

F.2 The strategy summary â€" audience, goals, platforms and positioning

The idea. The **strategy summary** is the part of the proposal that explains *why* you are doing what you are doing. It shows the client that you understand their business, their audience and their goals â€" and that your plan is based on thinking, not guessing.

Plain-English definition. A strategy summary is a short section â€" usually one to two pages â€" that states who the client's audience is, what the goals are, which platforms you will use and why, and what makes the business different.

What it contains â€” the five parts:

Part	What it says	Example (Taste of Rivers Kitchen)
1. Audience profile	Who the customer is â€” age, location, interests, pain point	"Women and men, 20â€“45, within 10 km of Rumuola, who want hot local food delivered or picked up after work. Their pain point: they are tired of food that arrives cold or late."
2. Two measurable goals	What the social media work will achieve â€” SMART goals	"Goal 1: Get 30 WhatsApp orders in 30 days. Goal 2: Grow Instagram followers from 200 to 500 in 30 days."
3. Platform choices with reasons	Which platforms you will use and why	"Instagram first â€” visual food content performs well there, and our audience is active. Facebook second â€” older customers and community groups use it. No TikTok in month one â€” we do not have the capacity to make video consistently yet."
4. Competitor note	What other local businesses are doing online	"Three other local food businesses post irregularly. None uses a consistent brand look or a clear call-to-action. This is an opportunity."
5. Positioning statement	What makes the business different â€” in one sentence	"Taste of Rivers Kitchen serves hot, honest local food â€” jollof, small chops, plantain â€” at fair prices, delivered fast anywhere in Rumuola."

Why the client cares. A client who sees a strategy summary thinks: "This person understands my business." That is half the battle won. A client who sees only a price list thinks: "This person wants my money." The strategy summary is how you show you are thinking about *their* business, not just *your* fee.

The key lesson â€” every decision has a reason. The strategy summary is where you prove that your choices are not random. You chose Instagram because your audience is there. You set 30 orders as a goal because that is what the business needs. You said no to TikTok because one person cannot do everything well. Reasons win clients.

F.3 The 30-day content calendar â€” planning a full month

The idea. A **30-day content calendar** is a day-by-day plan of what you will post for the next month. It is the most practical part of the proposal â€” the client can see exactly what is coming.

Plain-English definition. A content calendar is a table with one row per post. Each row says the date, the platform, the content pillar, the format, the caption or hook idea, and what asset (photo, video, graphic) is needed.

Why it exists. A client who can see a full month of planned posts feels safe. They know you are not going to disappear after one week. They can also give feedback *before* you post â€” which saves everyone time. The calendar is the difference between "I will post sometimes" and "I have a plan."

The six columns and what goes in each:

Column	What it says	Example
Date	The day the post goes live	"Monday 6 March"
Platform	Where it will be posted	"Instagram"
Pillar	Which content pillar it belongs to	"Menu spotlight"
Format	What kind of post	"Single image with caption"
Caption / hook idea	What the post will say â€” or at least the hook and CTA	"Hook: 'Still buying cold jollof?' CTA: DM 'JOLLOF' to order."
Asset needed	What photo, video or graphic you need	"Photo of jollof in a bowl, natural light"

How many posts per week? For one creator managing one small business, three posts per week is realistic and sustainable. Over 30 days, that is 12â€“13 posts. More than that and the creator burns out. Fewer than that and the page looks abandoned. Three per week â€” for example, Monday, Wednesday, Friday â€” is the sweet spot.

Worked example â€" the first week of the Taste of Rivers Kitchen calendar:

Date	Platform	Pillar	Format	Caption / hook idea	Asset needed
Mon 6 Mar	Instagram	Menu spotlight	Single image	"Still buying cold jollof? Ours is cooked fresh every morning. DM 'JOLLOF' to order."	Photo of jollof in a bowl
Wed 8 Mar	Instagram	Behind the scenes	Reel (15 sec)	"Ever wonder how our jollof gets that smoky taste? Watch. ðŸŽ¥"	Short video of cooking
Fri 10 Mar	Instagram + Facebook	Customer love	Testimonial graphic	"This is what Amaka said after her first order: 'Best jollof in Rumuola.' ðŸ¯"	Screenshot of a WhatsApp review (with permission)
Sat 11 Mar	Instagram Stories	Weekend special	Story + poll	"Saturday special: small-chops tray â‚¦8,000. Want one? Vote YES or NO."	Photo of the tray

The key lesson â€" every post connects to a goal. A post that does not connect to a goal is just noise. The jollof photo connects to Goal 1 (orders). The behind-the-scenes Reel connects to Goal 2 (followers). The testimonial connects to both â€" it builds trust and encourages orders. Every row in the calendar should be able to answer: "What is this post for?"

Common misconception. "A calendar is just a list of dates." No â€" a calendar is a plan. It has reasons behind it. Why Monday, Wednesday, Friday? Because those are the days people decide what to eat. Why a Reel on Wednesday? Because mid-week content behind the scenes builds connection. Why a testimonial on Friday? because people read reviews before they order for the weekend. Every choice has a reason.

F.4 Sample posts â€" showing, not telling

The idea. Sample posts are finished posts â€" written captions and designed graphics â€" that you include in the proposal to show the client what their content will look like. You are not just saying "I will make nice posts." You are showing them.

Plain-English definition. A sample post is a complete, ready-to-publish post â€" caption, hashtags and visual â€" created specifically for the client, included in the proposal so the client can see the quality and style of the work.

Why it exists. Most small business owners are not visual people. They cannot imagine what "good content" looks like from a description. But when they see a real post â€" a clear photo, a strong hook, a clear CTA, a consistent brand look â€" they understand immediately. Sample posts are how you prove your skill before you are hired.

How many and what kind: The capstone requires at least six written sample posts and at least four designed in Canva in one consistent brand look. The six posts should cover different pillars and formats â€" for example:

#	Pillar	Format	Purpose
1	Menu spotlight	Single image with caption	Show a popular dish with a price and CTA
2	Behind the scenes	Reel caption	Show the cooking process â€" build trust
3	Customer love	Testimonial graphic	Share a real review â€" social proof
4	Educational tip	Carousel (3 slides)	Teach something useful â€" save value
5	Weekend special	Flyer / event graphic	Promote a time-limited offer
6	Brand story	Single image with caption	Tell the client's story â€" build connection

The consistent brand look. The four Canva designs must look like they come from the same business. This means:

- The same **colours** â€" for example, warm orange and deep green, which suit a food brand.
- The same **fonts** â€" one heading font, one body font, used every time.
- The same **logo** â€" a simple text-based logo in the same corner of every design.
- The same **style** â€" for example, always a clean photo on a solid colour background, with the price in a coloured box.

Worked example â€" one sample post for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

Post 1 â€" Menu Spotlight (Single Image)

- ***Visual:*** *A clear, well-lit photo of a plate of jollof with plantain and fish, on a solid warm-orange background. The price "â‚¦1,500" is in a white box in the bottom corner. The Taste of Rivers Kitchen logo is in the top corner.*
- ***Caption:*** *"Still buying cold jollof? ðŸ□² Ours is cooked fresh every morning â€" hot, smoky, and ready when you are. â‚¦1,500 a plate. Free delivery within Rumuola. ðŸ'‰ DM 'JOLLOF' to order yours today. #TasteOfRiversKitchen #PortHarcourtFood #PHJollof #NaijaFood"*
- ***CTA:*** *DM 'JOLLOF' to order.*
- ***Hashtags:*** *#TasteOfRiversKitchen #PortHarcourtFood #PHJollof #NaijaFood*

The key lesson â€" show the client what they are buying. A proposal without sample posts is a promise. A proposal with sample posts is proof. The client can see the quality, the style, the tone and the professionalism. That is worth more than any description.

F.5 The reporting template â€" how you will prove results

The idea. A **reporting template** is a one-page table that shows the client exactly how you will measure and report results. It is the part of the proposal that says: "After 30 days, I will come back to you with numbers, insights and next steps."

Plain-English definition. A reporting template is a reusable document with space for the key metrics â€" reach, engagement rate, saves, shares, clicks, follower growth â€" with columns for the target, the actual result, what worked, what did not and what you will do next.

Why it exists. A client who pays â‚¦20,000 or â‚¦35,000 a month wants to know: "Is this working?" The reporting template is how you answer that question honestly. It shows the client that you will measure real numbers, report them clearly, and make recommendations based on what you find.

The six columns and what goes in each:

Column	What it says	Example
Metric	What you are measuring	"WhatsApp clicks"
Target	What you aimed for	"30 clicks"
Actual	What actually happened	"42 clicks"
What worked	What drove the result	"The Friday jollof post got 18 clicks â€" the hook 'Still buying cold jollof?' worked well."
What did not	What underperformed	"The Wednesday Reel got only 3 clicks â€" the CTA was unclear."
Next-month action	What you will do differently	"Use the 'Still buying cold jollof?' hook again. Re-shoot the Reel with a clearer CTA."

Worked example â€" the reporting template for Taste of Rivers Kitchen:

Metric	Target	Actual	What worked	What did not	Next-month action
WhatsApp clicks	30	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Instagram followers	+300	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Engagement rate	5%	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Saves	50	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Shares	30	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Orders (tracked by DM keyword)	30	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"

Say: "The client fills in the 'Actual' column after 30 days. The manager fills in the other five. The manager brings the completed report to the client and walks them through it â€" what worked, what did not, and what they will do next. That is how you prove the work is paying off."

The key lesson â€" honest reporting builds trust. A manager who reports only the good numbers will be caught. A manager who reports honestly â€" "this worked, this did not, this is what we will change" â€" builds trust that keeps a client for months. The reporting template is how you commit to that honesty in writing.

F.6 Community-management guidelines â€" how you will handle the comments

The idea. Community-management guidelines are a short set of rules that explain how you will reply to comments and DMs, how you will moderate, and how you will handle complaints. It shows the client that you will represent their brand well.

Plain-English definition. Community-management guidelines are a written policy â€" usually one page â€" that states the tone of voice, the response-time target, the moderation rules and the escalation step for complaints.

What it contains â€" the four parts:

Part	What it says	Example (Taste of Rivers Kitchen)
1. Tone of voice	How the brand sounds when it replies	"Warm, friendly and professional. Like a good neighbour â€" not a robot, not a marketer. Use short sentences. Use 'Chef Nkechi' or 'we' â€" never 'I'."
2. Response-time target	How quickly you will reply	"Within 2 hours during business hours (8 a.m. â€" 8 p.m.). Within 12 hours outside business hours."
3. Moderation rules	What you will delete, keep and block	"Delete spam, abuse and fake comments. Keep legitimate criticism â€" reply calmly and offer to fix it. Block only repeat trolls."
4. Escalation step	What you will do with a serious complaint	"If a customer says the food made them sick, or their order was wrong and they are angry â€" do not argue. Reply: 'We are sorry. Please DM us your order details and we will fix this immediately.' Then tell Chef Nkechi the same day."

Why the client cares. A client's biggest fear is that someone will say something nasty on their page and the manager will make it worse. The community-management guidelines show the client that you have a plan â€" you will reply quickly, you will not argue, you will not delete legitimate criticism, and you will escalate serious problems to them. That is how you protect their reputation.

The key lesson â€" the guidelines are a promise. The guidelines are not just a document â€" they are a promise to the client that you will represent their brand well. Every reply you write, every comment you delete, every complaint you escalate â€" it should follow these rules. That is how you build a reputation for professionalism.

F.7 The growth and promotion note â€" honest growth, no fakes

The idea. The **growth and promotion note** is a short section of the proposal that explains how you will grow the page â€" organically and, optionally, with paid promotion â€" and that explicitly rejects fake growth.

Plain-English definition. A growth and promotion note is a one-page section that states your organic growth plan, any optional paid promotion plan in naira, and a clear statement that fake followers, fake reviews and engagement pods are rejected.

What it contains â€" the three parts:

Part	What it says	Example (Taste of Rivers Kitchen)
1. Organic growth plan	The five honest methods â€" consistency, relevant hashtags, community engagement, collaborations, shareable content	"We will post 3 times a week, use 5â€"8 relevant hashtags, reply to every comment, partner with a local zobo seller, and create shareable behind-the-scenes content."
2. Optional paid promotion plan	If the client has a budget for boosting â€" the audience, duration, budget and success measure	"Optional: one boost per week, â‚¦2,000 per boost, targeting people within 10 km of Port Harcourt interested in food. Success measure: 20 WhatsApp clicks per boost. Stop rule: if fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days, stop."
3. Ethics statement	A clear rejection of fake growth	"We will never buy followers, likes, views or comments. We will never use engagement pods or

Part	What it says	Example (Taste of Rivers Kitchen)
		fake reviews. Real growth is slower and worth more."

Why the client cares. Chef Nkechi has been burned before â€” someone bought her fake followers and she lost money and trust. The growth and promotion note is where you show her that you are different. You have a plan, you have a budget, you have a stop rule, and you will never cheat. That is how you earn her trust.

The key lesson â€” the ethics statement is not optional. The ethics statement is not a nice extra â€” it is a core part of the proposal. A client who has been burned by fake growth will look for it. A client who has not been burned yet needs to hear it. The ethics statement is how you show that you are honest â€ and honesty is the whole job.

F.8 Presenting and defending â€ the viva

The idea. The **presentation** â€ also called the **viva** â€ is a short spoken talk where you present your capstone package to the class (or to a real client) and answer questions. It is the final proof that you understand what you have built.

Plain-English definition. The presentation is a 3â€"4 minute talk where you explain your proposal and plan, show at least one sample post, describe how you would report a bad month, and answer questions from the audience.

What you must cover in the presentation:

Part	What you say	How long
1. Audience and goals	"My audience isâ€¦ My two goals areâ€¦"	30 seconds
2. Platform choices	"I chose Instagram and Facebook becauseâ€¦ I said no to TikTok becauseâ€¦"	30 seconds
3. Sample post	Show one sample post and explain it â€ the hook, the value, the CTA, the hashtags.	45 seconds
4. Reporting approach	"After 30 days, I will fill in this report and bring it to the client. I will show what worked, what did not, and what I will change."	30 seconds
5. Handling a bad month	"If the numbers are bad, I will report them honestly. I will explain why I think they are bad and what I will change. I will not hide or inflate."	30 seconds
6. Questions	Answer at least three questions from the audience.	2â€"3 minutes

Why it matters. A manager who cannot explain their own plan is a manager a client cannot trust. The presentation is where you prove that you understand every decision in your package â€ why you chose Instagram, why you set 30 orders as a goal, why that post has that CTA, what you will do if the month is bad. If you can explain it, you own it.

The key lesson â€ you must own every decision. The presentation is not about performing â€ it is about owning your decisions. If the audience asks "Why did you choose Instagram?" you must be able to answer immediately, with a reason. If they ask "What if the numbers are bad?" you must be able to explain how you would handle it. That is what a professional does.

F.9 Summary of the lecture

- **A client proposal** is a written document that tells the client what you will do, how much it costs and what they can expect. It has eight sections: services, exclusions, posting schedule, response times, deliverables, price, revisions and ownership.
- **The strategy summary** shows the audience, goals, platform choices, competitor note and positioning â€ every decision has a reason.
- **The 30-day content calendar** is a table with one row per post â€ date, platform, pillar, format, caption idea and asset. Three posts per week is sustainable for one creator.
- **Sample posts** are finished posts that show the client what they are buying â€ at least six written and four designed in Canva in one consistent brand look.
- **The reporting template** is a one-page table that commits you to honest measurement â€ metrics, targets, actuals, what worked, what did not and next steps.
- **Community-management guidelines** promise the client that you will represent their brand well â€ tone, response time, moderation and escalation.

- **The growth and promotion note** explains honest organic growth, any optional boost plan, and explicitly rejects fake growth.
- **The presentation** is a short talk where you explain your package, show a sample post, describe your reporting approach and answer questions â€" you must own every decision.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Client proposal] --> E[Present to class]
    B[30-day calendar] --> E
    C[Sample posts] --> E
    D[Reporting template] --> E
    E --> F[CEA Certificate]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through the complete assembly of the capstone for *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" from the eight empty sections to one finished package â€" showing how every piece connects.

Setup: On the projector, show the capstone assembly worksheet and the blank 30-day calendar template. Have the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief visible. Open a blank Google Doc for the live proposal build.

G.1 Demonstration 1 â€" Show the eight components and how they connect (3 minutes)

Say: "Here are the eight pieces. Watch how they connect."

Draw a simple map on the board:

```
Strategy Summary (Session 2) â"€â"€â†' Proposal (Section 3)
Content Calendar (Session 3) â"€â"€â†' 30-Day Calendar (Section 4)
Sample Posts (Session 4) â"€â"€â†' Sample Posts (Section 5)
Reply Bank (Session 5) â"€â"€â†' Community Guidelines (Section 7)
Working Agreement (Session 6) â"€â"€â†' Proposal Terms (Section 2)
Monthly Report (Session 7) â"€â"€â†' Reporting Template (Section 6)
Boost Plan (Session 8) â"€â"€â†' Growth Note (Section 8)
Everything â"€â"€â†' Presentation (Viva)
```

Say: "Every piece you built in Sessions 2â€"8 is a component of this package. Nothing is wasted. Today we assemble."

G.2 Demonstration 2 â€" Build the strategy summary live (3 minutes)

Say: "First, the strategy summary. I have my Session 2 work â€" audience, goals, platforms, competitors, positioning. Now I write it as a professional section of the proposal."

Type on the projector:

> ***3. Strategy Summary***
>
> ***Audience:*** *Women and men, 20â€"45, within 10 km of Rumuola, who want hot local food delivered or picked up after work. Their pain point: they are tired of food that arrives cold or late.*
>
> ***Goals:***
>
> 1. *Get 30 WhatsApp orders in 30 days.*
> 2. *Grow Instagram followers from 200 to 500 in 30 days.*
>
> ***Platforms:*** *Instagram first â€" visual food content performs well there, and our audience is active. Facebook second â€" older customers and community groups use it. No TikTok in month one â€" we do not have the capacity to make video consistently yet.*
>
> ***Competitor note:*** *Three other local food businesses post irregularly. None uses a consistent brand look or a clear call-to-action. This is an opportunity.*

Positioning: *Taste of Rivers Kitchen serves hot, honest local food â€" jollof, small chops, plantain â€" at fair prices, delivered fast anywhere in Rumuola.*

Say: "Every decision has a reason. I chose Instagram because the audience is there. I said no to TikTok because one person cannot do everything well. That is what a professional does."

G.3 Demonstration 3 â€" Build the first week of the 30-day calendar (4 minutes)

Say: "Now the calendar. Three posts a week â€" Monday, Wednesday, Friday. I have my Session 3 two-week calendar. I extend it to 30 days."

Fill in the first week on the projector:

Date	Platform	Pillar	Format	Caption / hook idea	Asset needed
Mon 6 Mar	Instagram	Menu spotlight	Single image	"Still buying cold jollof? Ours is cooked fresh every morning. DM 'JOLLOF' to order."	Photo of jollof in a bowl
Wed 8 Mar	Instagram	Behind the scenes	Reel (15 sec)	"Ever wonder how our jollof gets that smoky taste? Watch. ðŸŽ¥"	Short video of cooking
Fri 10 Mar	Instagram + Facebook	Customer love	Testimonial graphic	"This is what Amaka said after her first order: 'Best jollof in Rumuola.' ðŸ¬"	Screenshot of a WhatsApp review
Sat 11 Mar	Instagram Stories	Weekend special	Story + poll	"Saturday special: small-chops tray â‚¦8,000. Want one? Vote YES or NO."	Photo of the tray

Say: "Every post connects to a goal. The jollof photo connects to orders. The Reel connects to followers. The testimonial connects to both. And look â€" I am using my Session 3 two-week calendar as the first half. I just extend it."

G.4 Demonstration 4 â€" Show one sample post and the reporting template (3 minutes)

Say: "Now a sample post. I have my Session 4 work â€" repurposed posts and Canva designs. I pick one and put it in the proposal."

Show the sample post on the projector (the jollof menu spotlight post from F.4).

Then show the reporting template:

6. Reporting Template â€" Taste of Rivers Kitchen, Month 1

Metric	*Target*	*Actual*	*What worked*	*What did not*	*Next-month action*
WhatsApp clicks	*30*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*
Instagram followers	*+300*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*
Engagement rate	*5%*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*
Saves	*50*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*
Shares	*30*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*
Orders (tracked by DM keyword)	*30*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*	*â€"*

Say: "The reporting template is a promise. After 30 days, I fill in the actuals and bring this to the client. I show what worked, what did not, and what I will change. That is how you prove the work is paying off."

G.5 Demonstration 5 â€" Rehearse the presentation (2 minutes)

Say: "Last â€" the presentation. Four minutes. Watch how I structure it."

Deliver a condensed version of the presentation:

> *"Good morning. My name is [instructor name], and this is my social media proposal for Taste of Rivers Kitchen.*
>
> *My audience is women and men, 20â€"45, within 10 km of Rumuola, who want hot local food delivered after work. My goals are 30 WhatsApp orders in 30 days and growing Instagram followers from 200 to 500.*
>
> *I chose Instagram first because visual food content performs well there. Facebook second because older customers use it. I said no to TikTok in month one because one person cannot do everything well.*
>
> *Here is one of my sample posts â€" a jollof photo with the hook 'Still buying cold jollof?' and a clear CTA: DM 'JOLLOF' to order. I used four relevant hashtags, not thirty.*
>
> *After 30 days, I will fill in this reporting template and bring it to Chef Nkechi. I will show what worked, what did not, and what I will change.*
>
> *If the month is bad, I will report the numbers honestly. I will explain why I think they are bad and what I will change. I will not hide or inflate.*
>
> *I will never buy followers or use fake reviews. Real growth is slower and worth more.*
>
> *Thank you. I will take your questions."*

Say: "Four minutes. Every decision explained. Every question answered. That is how you present."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Which session does each component come from?" (Session 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8.)
- "Why three posts per week and not seven?" (One creator cannot sustain seven quality posts a week.)
- "What happens if the numbers are bad?" (Report honestly, explain why, recommend changes.)
- "Why is the ethics statement in the proposal?" (The client has been burned before. Honesty is the whole job.)

Expected result: Learners see the complete assembly â€" from eight finished pieces to one professional package â€" and they see that the presentation is simply explaining what they have built.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner assembles their capstone package for *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" filling in the assembly checklist and completing at least the strategy summary, the first week of the calendar and one sample post.

Starting materials: The capstone assembly worksheet, the 30-day calendar template, the Taste of Rivers Kitchen client brief, the proposal skeleton, a pen and a notes app or Google Doc.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Open your capstone assembly worksheet. Read the eight components. Tick them off as you complete them.
2. **Strategy summary.** Write the five parts â€" audience, goals, platforms with reasons, competitor note, positioning. Use your Session 2 work if you have it; if not, write it now from the client brief.
3. **First week of the calendar.** Fill in the first week â€" at least four posts. Use the template: Date / Platform / Pillar / Format / Caption idea / Asset needed.
4. **One sample post.** Write one complete sample post â€" hook, value, CTA, hashtags. If you have a Canva design from Session 4, reference it. If not, describe the visual.
5. **Reporting template.** Copy the six-column table into your document. Fill in the targets for month one. Leave the "Actual" column blank â€" that gets filled in after 30 days.
6. **Pause and predict:** Cover your work and ask yourself: "If Chef Nkechi reads this, will she understand what I am doing and why?" Write your answer.
7. Compare your work with the person beside you. If you made different choices, explain them.

Expected result: A completed strategy summary, a first-week calendar, one sample post and a reporting template with targets.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "Can you explain why you chose the platforms you chose â€" in one sentence?"

- After step 3: "Does every post connect to a goal? Which goal?"
- After step 5: "What happens in the 'Actual' column â€" and when?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner has no Session 2 work â†' Prompt: "Use the client brief. Who is the customer? What do they want? Write it in one sentence."
- Learner writes seven posts in the first week â†' Prompt: "Can one person make seven quality posts a week? What is realistic?"
- Learner leaves the "Actual" column blank â†' Prompt: "Good â€" that gets filled in after 30 days. But what are your targets?"
- Learner's sample post has no CTA â†' Prompt: "What do you want the reader to do? DM? Call? Visit? Tell them."
- Learner skips the ethics statement â†' Prompt: "Chef Nkechi has been burned before. Where do you promise her honesty?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Strategy summary written â€" audience, goals, platforms with reasons, competitor note, positioning
- ☐ First week of calendar filled in â€" at least four posts with all six columns
- ☐ One complete sample post â€" hook, value, CTA, hashtags
- ☐ Reporting template with targets filled in
- ☐ Ethics statement included
- ☐ Every decision has a written reason

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Complete a full capstone package skeleton for *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" filling in all eight components with at least skeleton-level content, and prepare a 4-minute presentation outline.

Scenario. You are a social media manager in Port Harcourt. You have been hired by *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* â€" the running client from this course. Your job is to assemble the complete capstone package and present it to Chef Nkechi. She is not technical. She wants to know: what will you do, how much will it cost, and how will you prove it is working?

Requirements:

1. Write a **cover page** â€" your name, course, date, client name, and an ethics statement.
2. Write a **client proposal** â€" all eight sections (services, exclusions, posting schedule, response times, deliverables, price, revisions, ownership).
3. Write a **strategy summary** â€" audience, two goals, platforms with reasons, competitor note, positioning.
4. Build a **30-day content calendar** â€" at least 12 posts (3 per week) with all six columns.
5. Write **six sample posts** â€" captions with hooks, CTAs and hashtags.
6. Design **four Canva posts** â€" one consistent brand look (describe the colours, fonts, logo and style).
7. Prepare a **reporting template** â€" the six-column table with targets.
8. Write **community-management guidelines** â€" tone, response time, moderation, escalation.
9. Write a **growth and promotion note** â€" organic plan, optional boost plan, ethics statement.
10. Prepare a **4-minute presentation outline** â€" audience, platforms, one sample post, reporting approach, handling a bad month.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- All eight components present with skeleton-level content.
- Every decision has a written reason.
- The 30-day calendar has at least 12 posts with all six columns.
- Six sample posts have hooks, CTAs and hashtags.
- The presentation outline covers all five required parts.
- The ethics statement is present and explicit.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the price, think â€" what is realistic for a small Port Harcourt food business? â‚¦20,000â€"â‚¦35,000 a month is the range we have used.
- Hint 2: For the calendar, use your Session 3 two-week calendar as the first half. Extend it.
- Hint 3: For the presentation, use the structure from the instructor demo â€" audience, platforms, sample post, reporting, bad month.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Cover page:

> ***Client Proposal and 30-Day Social Media Plan Prepared for:*** *Taste of Rivers Kitchen, Rumuola, Port Harcourt* ***Prepared by:*** *[Learner Name], CEA Social Media Management* ***Date:*** *[Date]* ***Ethics statement:*** *This proposal is a fictional, authorised exercise for Cyber Elias Academy. All data is real or clearly marked as sample. No fake followers, no fake reviews, no inflated numbers.*

Client proposal (skeleton):

> ***1. Services:*** *Content creation (posts, captions, graphics), scheduling (Meta Business Suite), community management (replying to comments and DMs), monthly reporting, basic organic growth.* ***2. Exclusions:*** *No paid advertising management (unless separately agreed). No video editing from scratch. No responses after 8 p.m. or before 8 a.m. No posting of personal opinions on the client's page.* ***3. Posting schedule:*** *3 posts per week â€" Monday, Wednesday, Friday. Plus 2 Instagram Stories per week.* ***4. Response times:*** *Within 2 hours during business hours (8 a.m. â€" 8 p.m.). Within 12 hours outside business hours.* ***5. Deliverables:*** *Monthly content calendar, 12 designed posts, 1 monthly report, community-management guidelines.* ***6. Package price:*** *â‚¦25,000 per month. Payment due on the 1st of each month. Late payment after 7 days pauses work.* ***7. Revision policy:*** *2 rounds of revisions per post included. Additional revisions at â‚¦5,000 per round.* ***8. Account ownership:*** *Chef Nkechi owns the account, all content and all data. The manager keeps all client information confidential.*

Strategy summary:

> ***Audience:*** *Women and men, 20â€"45, within 10 km of Rumuola, who want hot local food delivered or picked up after work. Pain point: food that arrives cold or late.* ***Goals:*** *1. 30 WhatsApp orders in 30 days. 2. Grow Instagram followers from 200 to 500 in 30 days.* ***Platforms:*** *Instagram first (visual, audience active). Facebook second (older customers, community groups). No TikTok in month one (capacity).* ***Competitor note:*** *Three local food businesses post irregularly. No consistent brand look or clear CTA. Opportunity.* ***Positioning:*** *Hot, honest local food at fair prices, delivered fast in Rumuola.*

30-day calendar (first 4 posts â€" model):

Date	Platform	Pillar	Format	Caption / hook idea	Asset needed
Mon 6 Mar	Instagram	Menu spotlight	Single image	"Still buying cold jollof? Ours is cooked fresh every morning. DM 'JOLLOF' to order."	Photo of jollof in a bowl
Wed 8 Mar	Instagram	Behind the scenes	Reel (15 sec)	"Ever wonder how our jollof gets that smoky taste? Watch. ðŸŽ¥"	Short video of cooking
Fri 10 Mar	Instagram + Facebook	Customer love	Testimonial graphic	"This is what Amaka said after her first order: 'Best jollof in Rumuola.' ðŸ¬"	Screenshot of a WhatsApp review
Sat 11 Mar	Instagram Stories	Weekend special	Story + poll	"Saturday special: small-chops tray â‚¦8,000. Want one? Vote YES or NO."	Photo of the tray

(Continue for 30 days â€" 3 posts per week, 12â€"13 posts total.)

Sample posts (6 â€" model for post 1):

> ***Post 1 â€" Menu Spotlight:*** *"Still buying cold jollof? ðŸ□² Ours is cooked fresh every morning â€" hot, smoky, and ready when you are. â¦1,500 a plate. Free delivery within Rumuola. ðŸ'‰ DM 'JOLLOF' to order yours today. #TasteOfRiversKitchen #PortHarcourtFood #PHJollof #NaijaFood"*

(Posts 2â€"6 follow the same structure â€" hook, value, CTA, hashtags â€" for different pillars and formats.)

Reporting template:

Metric	Target	Actual	What worked	What did not	Next-month action
WhatsApp clicks	30	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Instagram followers	+300	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Engagement rate	5%	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Saves	50	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Shares	30	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"
Orders (tracked by DM keyword)	30	â€"	â€"	â€"	â€"

Community-management guidelines:

> ***Tone:*** *Warm, friendly, professional. Like a good neighbour. Short sentences. Use "we" or "Chef Nkechi."* ***Response time:*** *Within 2 hours (8 a.m. â€" 8 p.m.). Within 12 hours outside.* ***Moderation:*** *Delete spam, abuse. Keep legitimate criticism â€" reply calmly. Block repeat trolls.* ***Escalation:*** *Serious complaints (food safety, wrong order) â€" reply: "We are sorry. Please DM us your order details and we will fix this immediately." Tell Chef Nkechi the same day.*

Growth and promotion note:

> ***Organic plan:*** *Post 3 times a week. Use 5â€"8 relevant hashtags. Reply to every comment. Partner with a local zobo seller. Create shareable behind-the-scenes content.* ***Optional boost plan:*** *One boost per week, â¦2,000 per boost, targeting people within 10 km of Port Harcourt interested in food. Success measure: 20 WhatsApp clicks. Stop rule: fewer than 10 clicks after 2 days.* ***Ethics:*** *We will never buy followers, likes, views or comments. We will never use engagement pods or fake reviews. Real growth is slower and worth more.*

Presentation outline (4 minutes):

> 1. *"My audience is women and men, 20â€"45, within 10 km of Rumuola, who want hot local food delivered after work."*
> 2. *"My goals are 30 WhatsApp orders and 500 Instagram followers in 30 days."*
> 3. *"I chose Instagram first because visual food content performs well there. Facebook second. No TikTok in month one."*
> 4. *[Show one sample post] "This is a jollof photo with the hook 'Still buying cold jollof?' and a clear CTA."*
> 5. *"After 30 days, I will fill in this reporting template and bring it to Chef Nkechi."*
> 6. *"If the month is bad, I will report honestly and recommend changes."*
> 7. *"I will never buy followers or use fake reviews."*

Learner marking (out of 10):

- All 8 components present with skeleton content (3)
- Every decision has a written reason (2)
- Calendar has 12+ posts with all six columns (2)
- Six sample posts have hooks, CTAs, hashtags (1)
- Presentation outline covers all 5 parts (1)

- Ethics statement present and explicit (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Chef Nkechi* has been running *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* for two years. Her Instagram page has 200 followers and has been silent for three months. She gets about 10 WhatsApp orders a week â€" not enough to pay her two assistants and cover food costs. She hires a social media manager who promises to "make the page active and bring more orders." The manager sends her a proposal. Chef Nkechi reads it. The proposal is one page â€" it says "I will post regularly and grow your page" and quotes â‚¦25,000 a month. There is no strategy summary, no calendar, no sample posts, no reporting template, no community guidelines and no ethics statement. Chef Nkechi is not sure what she is buying, but she is desperate, so she agrees. The manager posts twice in the first week, then once, then not at all. After 30 days, Chef Nkechi has 3 new followers and 2 extra orders. She has paid â‚¦25,000 and has nothing to show for it. She feels robbed.

Relevant facts.

- The proposal was one page â€" no detail, no proof, no plan.
- The manager posted 4 times in 30 days.
- The manager provided no report at the end of the month.
- Chef Nkechi has 3 new followers and 2 extra orders after 30 days.
- She paid â‚¦25,000.
- The manager cannot explain why the page did not grow.

Decision point. What went wrong â€" and what should a professional manager have done?

Possible approaches.

1. **Blame the algorithm** â€" "Instagram just did not show the posts."
2. **Blame the client** â€" "Your food is good but your photos are not professional enough."
3. **Acknowledge the failures** â€" no plan, no calendar, no sample posts, no report, no communication â€" and propose a professional restart.

Recommended solution. Approach 3 â€" acknowledge the failures. A professional manager would:

- **Apologise** for the poor start and the lack of communication.
- **Explain** what went wrong: no strategy, no calendar, no sample posts, no reporting template, no community guidelines.
- **Present a proper proposal** â€" the full eight-component package with a strategy summary, a 30-day calendar, six sample posts, a reporting template, community guidelines, a growth note and an ethics statement.
- **Offer a fair restart** â€" a clear plan for the next 30 days, with honest reporting and regular communication.

What the manager should have done from the start:

- **Write a complete proposal** â€" all eight sections, with a strategy summary, a calendar, sample posts, a reporting template, community guidelines and a growth note.
- **Show sample posts** â€" so Chef Nkechi could see the quality and style before agreeing.
- **Set measurable goals** â€" 30 orders, 500 followers â€" so both sides know what success looks like.
- **Deliver a report** â€" after 30 days, show the numbers, what worked, what did not and what will change.
- **Communicate** â€" a weekly update, even if it is just a WhatsApp message: "This week we got 8 orders from the jollof post. Next week we will try a new hook."
- **Never fake it** â€" no bought followers, no inflated numbers, no excuses.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is a lie â€" the manager knows the plan was poor.
- Approach 2 is deflection â€" the client's photos were fine; the manager's plan was not.
- Approach 3 is hard but right â€" it rebuilds trust and sets up a professional relationship. A client who sees a manager own their mistakes and present a proper plan is more likely to give them another chance.

Professional connection. This is exactly what separates a professional from someone who "just posts." A professional has a plan, shows proof, reports honestly and communicates. A "poster" has none of these. That is why a professional can charge â‚¦25,000 a month and a "poster" cannot. The capstone you are building today is the document that makes you a professional.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Incomplete proposal â€” missing sections

Symptoms: The proposal is one or two pages â€” no strategy summary, no calendar, no sample posts, no reporting template. **Likely cause:** The learner thinks a proposal is just a price list. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Can you show me your strategy summary? Your calendar? Your sample posts?" **Corrective steps:** A proposal has eight sections. Every section must be present, even if short. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can point to all eight sections in their document. **Prevention:** Use the assembly checklist â€” tick each component as it is completed.

K.2 Inconsistent calendar â€” posts that do not connect to goals

Symptoms: The calendar has posts that do not serve either goal â€” orders or followers. **Likely cause:** The learner is filling rows without thinking about purpose. **How to investigate:** Pick a random row and ask: "What goal does this post serve?" **Corrective steps:** Every post must connect to a goal. If it does not, either change it or remove it. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain the purpose of any post in the calendar. **Prevention:** Teach the "What is this post for?" test â€” apply it to every row.

K.3 No sample posts â€” promising quality without showing it

Symptoms: The proposal says "I will make nice posts" but shows no examples. **Likely cause:** The learner does not have finished posts to show. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Can you show me one finished post â€” caption, hashtags, visual?" **Corrective steps:** Create at least one sample post â€” hook, value, CTA, hashtags â€ and describe the visual. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can show at least one complete sample post. **Prevention:** Remind learners that sample posts are proof â€ a client cannot buy what they cannot see.

K.4 No reporting template â€ no way to prove results

Symptoms: The proposal has no plan for measuring or reporting. **Likely cause:** The learner thinks reporting is something that happens later, not something to plan now. **How to investigate:** Ask: "After 30 days, how will Chef Nkechi know if the work is paying off?" **Corrective steps:** Include the six-column reporting template â€ metrics, targets, actuals, what worked, what did not, next steps. **How to confirm resolved:** The proposal includes a reporting template with targets. **Prevention:** The reporting template is a promise â€ it commits the manager to honest measurement.

K.5 No ethics statement â€ missing the trust signal

Symptoms: The proposal does not mention fake followers, fake reviews or honest growth. **Likely cause:** The learner thinks ethics is assumed. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Chef Nkechi has been burned before. Where do you promise her honesty?" **Corrective steps:** Include a clear ethics statement â€ no bought followers, no fake reviews, no inflated numbers. **How to confirm resolved:** The ethics statement is present and explicit. **Prevention:** The ethics statement is not optional â€ it is a core part of the proposal.

K.6 Presentation without ownership â€ reading instead of explaining

Symptoms: The learner reads from their document instead of explaining their decisions. **Likely cause:** The learner has memorised the document but does not understand the reasons behind it. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Why did you choose Instagram? Why 30 orders? Why that CTA?" **Corrective steps:** The learner must be able to explain every decision â€ the audience, the platforms, the goals, the posts, the reporting, the bad-month plan. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can answer three questions without reading from the document. **Prevention:** Rehearse the presentation out loud â€ if you cannot explain it, you do not own it.

K.7 Unrealistic posting schedule â€ seven posts a week

Symptoms: The calendar has seven posts a week â€ one per day. **Likely cause:** The learner thinks more is better. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Can one person make seven quality posts a week for 30 days?" **Corrective steps:** Three posts per week is realistic and sustainable for one creator. More leads to burnout and declining quality. **How to confirm resolved:** The calendar has 12â€"13 posts over 30 days. **Prevention:** Teach the "one creator" rule â€ plan for what you can sustain, not what looks impressive on paper.

K.8 Sample posts that do not match the client

Symptoms: The sample posts are generic â€” they could be for any business. **Likely cause:** The learner wrote generic posts instead of client-specific posts. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Could this post be for any food business? What makes it specific to Taste of Rivers Kitchen?" **Corrective steps:** Every sample post should reference the client's dishes, prices, location and brand. **How to confirm resolved:** A reader can tell which business the post is for. **Prevention:** Write every sample post with the client's name, dishes and prices in mind.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€” ask the learner to explain their reasoning, not just their answer. Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Capstone Package â€” Complete Proposal and 30-Day Plan"

Purpose: To assemble the complete capstone package â€” the client proposal, 30-day calendar, sample posts, reporting template, community guidelines, growth note and presentation â€” for *Taste of Rivers Kitchen*, and to prepare and rehearse the viva presentation. This assignment is the capstone deliverable worth 30% of the course grade.

Realistic scenario. You are a social media manager in Port Harcourt. *Chef Nkechi* of *Taste of Rivers Kitchen* has hired you to manage her social media for 30 days. She is not technical. She wants to know: what will you do, how much will it cost, and how will you prove it is working. She has been burned before â€” someone bought her fake followers â€” so she is cautious. Your job is to give her a complete package she can read, understand and trust, and to present it to her in a short talk.

Detailed instructions:

1. Write a **cover page** â€” your name, course, date, client name, ethics statement.
2. Write a **client proposal** â€” all eight sections.
3. Write a **strategy summary** â€” audience, two goals, platforms with reasons, competitor note, positioning.
4. Build a **30-day content calendar** â€” at least 12 posts (3 per week) with all six columns.
5. Write **six sample posts** â€” captions with hooks, CTAs and hashtags.
6. Design **four Canva posts** â€” one consistent brand look (colours, fonts, logo, style).
7. Prepare a **reporting template** â€” the six-column table with targets.
8. Write **community-management guidelines** â€” tone, response time, moderation, escalation.
9. Write a **growth and promotion note** â€” organic plan, optional boost plan, ethics statement.
10. Prepare a **4-minute presentation** â€” audience, platforms, one sample post, reporting approach, handling a bad month.
11. **Rehearse** your presentation at least three times out loud.

Required deliverables:

- The complete capstone package (all eight components) as one document or folder.
- Four Canva designs (screenshots or links).
- A 4-minute presentation (delivered in class or recorded).

Submission format: Save as `Capstone_YourName.docx` (or `.pdf`) and upload to `/Social-Media-Management/Week3/Capstone/`. Canva designs can be shared as links or screenshots. The presentation is delivered in the next class session.

Deadline: Before the next class session (the viva/presentation session).

Marking rubric (10 marks â€” scaled to the capstone rubric in Part 6):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Complete proposal	2	All 8 sections present, clear and professional
Strategy summary	1	Audience, goals, platforms with reasons, positioning
30-day calendar	2	12+ posts, all 6 columns, every post connects to a goal
Sample posts	2	6 posts with hooks, CTAs, hashtags; 4 Canva designs consistent
Reporting template	1	Six-column table with targets

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Community guidelines	1	Tone, response time, moderation, escalation
Growth note + ethics	1	Organic plan, optional boost, explicit rejection of fake growth

Common mistakes to avoid: incomplete proposal (missing sections); posts that do not connect to goals; no sample posts; no reporting template; no ethics statement; reading the presentation instead of explaining; unrealistic posting schedule; generic posts that do not match the client.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

The full model solution is the same as the INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY in Section I, extended to all 30 days and all eight components. The key points are:

- All eight sections present and professional.
- Strategy summary with clear audience, two SMART goals, platform choices with reasons, competitor note and positioning.
- 30-day calendar with 12â€"13 posts, all six columns, every post connecting to a goal.
- Six sample posts with hooks, CTAs and hashtags, covering different pillars and formats.
- Four Canva designs in one consistent brand look â€" warm orange and deep green, one heading font, one body font, a simple text-based logo in the same corner of every design.
- Reporting template with six columns and targets for month one.
- Community-management guidelines with tone, response time, moderation rules and escalation step.
- Growth and promotion note with organic plan, optional boost plan and explicit ethics statement.
- Presentation covering all five required parts â€" audience, platforms, sample post, reporting, bad month â€" delivered in 4 minutes with confident, clear explanation.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. Name the eight sections of a client proposal.

Q2. List. What are the six columns of a 30-day content calendar?

Q3. Multiple choice. How many posts per week is realistic for one creator managing one small business? a) Seven b) Five c) Three d) One

Q4. Explain. Why does every post in the calendar need to connect to a goal?

Q5. Scenario. Chef Nkechi asks: "How will I know if this is working after 30 days?" Write two sentences explaining your reporting approach.

Q6. True or false. A proposal without sample posts is still a professional proposal.

Q7. Matching. Match each capstone component to the session it comes from: a) Sample posts b) Reporting template c) Community guidelines d) Growth note e) Strategy summary

1. Session 2
2. Session 4
3. Session 5
4. Session 7
5. Session 8

Q8. Fill in the blank. The ethics statement confirms: no fake followers, no fake reviews, and no _____ _____.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q8)

A1. Services, exclusions, posting schedule, response times, deliverables, package price and payment terms, revision policy, account ownership and confidentiality.

A2. Date, platform, pillar, format, caption or hook idea, asset needed.

A3. (c) Three. One creator cannot sustain seven quality posts a week for 30 days. Three is realistic and sustainable.

A4. Because a post that does not connect to a goal is just noise. Every post should serve a purpose â€" orders, followers, trust or awareness. If you cannot say what a post is for, it does not belong in the calendar.

A5. Model answer: "After 30 days, I will fill in this reporting template and bring it to you. I will show you the numbers â€" what worked, what did not, and what I will change next month. You will see exactly what your â¦25,000 achieved." (Accept any answer that promises honest, clear reporting with numbers and insights.)

A6. False. A proposal without sample posts is a promise. A proposal with sample posts is proof. The client can see the quality, the style, the tone and the professionalism â€" that is worth more than any description.

A7. a) Sample posts = 2 (Session 4); b) Reporting template = 4 (Session 7); c) Community guidelines = 3 (Session 5); d) Growth note = 5 (Session 8); e) Strategy summary = 1 (Session 2).

A8. The ethics statement confirms: no fake followers, no fake reviews, and no **inflated numbers**.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned to assemble the complete capstone â€" the client proposal and 30-day social media plan. You learned that a client proposal is a trust document with eight sections: services, exclusions, posting schedule, response times, deliverables, price, revisions and ownership. You learned that the strategy summary shows the audience, goals, platform choices, competitor note and positioning â€" and that every decision has a reason. You learned that the 30-day calendar is a table with one row per post â€" date, platform, pillar, format, caption idea and asset â€" and that three posts per week is sustainable for one creator. You learned that sample posts are proof â€" showing the client what they are buying â€" and that the reporting template is a promise to measure honestly. You learned that community-management guidelines protect the client's reputation, and that the growth note with an ethics statement earns trust. You learned that the presentation is where you own every decision â€" explaining the audience, platforms, a sample post, the reporting approach and how you would handle a bad month.

Five important takeaways:

1. **A proposal is a trust document** â€" it has eight sections, and every section makes the client feel safe.
2. **Every decision has a reason** â€" the strategy summary proves you understand the business.
3. **The calendar connects every post to a goal** â€" no noise, no random posting.
4. **Sample posts are proof, not promises** â€" show the client what they are buying.
5. **The presentation is ownership** â€" you must be able to explain every decision without reading.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I write a complete client proposal with all eight sections?
- Can I build a 30-day calendar where every post connects to a goal?
- Can I write six sample posts with hooks, CTAs and hashtags?
- Can I prepare a reporting template with targets?
- Can I write community-management guidelines that protect the client's reputation?
- Can I present my package in four minutes and answer three questions?

Course wrap-up. You started this course as someone who scrolled other people's pages. You are leaving as someone who can plan, create, schedule, engage, measure, grow and propose â€" a competent entry-level social media manager. You know how to research an audience, choose platforms with reasons, plan a month of content, create and repurpose posts in free tools, reply to a community professionally, schedule work, read basic analytics, write an honest monthly report and put together a professional client proposal. You know how to grow organically, plan a boost with a stop rule and refuse fake growth. You have built a capstone package that is the first real item in your professional portfolio.

The honest promise, restated. This course does not promise followers, income or clients. It teaches a real, in-demand skill with free tools. Money comes only after you do the work, build proof and deliver for real people. The certificate certifies competence as an entry-level social media manager â€" not a senior marketer, not an agency. It means you can take on one or two small clients and deliver honest, professional work.

Next steps â€" "From Zero to Expert, Together."

1. **Deliver your capstone** â€" complete the package and present it in the viva.

2. **Build your portfolio** â€" use your capstone as the first item. Add real client work as you get it.
3. **Find your first clients** â€" start with one or two small businesses you know. Offer a fair price. Deliver honestly. Ask for testimonials.
4. **Keep learning** â€" consider CEA's Content Creation course to sharpen your shooting and editing, and explore advanced digital marketing and paid advertising courses when you are ready.
5. **Stay honest** â€" no fake followers, no fake reviews, no inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof. That is how you build a reputation that lasts.

Say it with us: *No fakes. No inflated numbers. Real work, real results, real proof.*

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner writes a complete proposal with all eight sections â€" not just a price list.
- Learner explains the reason behind every platform choice and goal â€" without being prompted.
- Learner's calendar has 12â€"13 posts, all six columns filled, and every post connects to a stated goal.
- Learner's sample posts are specific to the client â€" dishes, prices, location, brand â€" not generic.
- Learner's reporting template has clear targets and the "Actual" column left blank for month one.
- Learner's community guidelines include an escalation step for complaints.
- Learner's growth note includes an explicit ethics statement rejecting fake growth.
- Learner presents confidently â€" explains decisions, answers questions, does not read from the document.
- Learner handles the bad-month question honestly â€" reports, explains, recommends changes.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A proposal is just a price list." â†' No â€" it has eight sections and every section builds trust.
- "More posts = better." â†' Three sustainable posts per week beats seven posts that burn out in two weeks.
- "The calendar is just a list of dates." â†' Every post must connect to a goal â€" otherwise it is noise.
- "Sample posts are optional." â†' They are proof â€" a client cannot buy what they cannot see.
- "The reporting template is for later." â†' It is a promise you make in the proposal â€" it commits you to honesty.
- "The ethics statement is not important." â†' It is critical â€" especially for a client who has been burned.
- "Reading the presentation is presenting." â†' No â€" you must explain and defend every decision out loud.
- "A good product sells itself online." â†' No â€" without a plan, even a good product stays invisible.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Proposal section drill:** give the learner a one-page proposal and ask them to identify which of the eight sections are missing. Then ask them to write the missing ones.
2. **Calendar connection drill:** give the learner a calendar with five posts and ask them to state which goal each post serves. If a post serves no goal, ask them to rewrite it or remove it.
3. **Sample post writing drill:** give the learner a client brief and ask them to write one sample post â€" hook, value, CTA, hashtags â€" in 10 minutes.
4. **Presentation rehearsal drill:** ask the learner to present their package to a partner in 4 minutes. The partner asks three questions. The learner must answer without reading.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially completed proposal â€" services, price and exclusions already filled in â€" and ask the learner to complete the strategy summary, calendar and one sample post. Provide the reporting template with targets already filled in.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full assembly of all eight components plus presentation outline.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write a **client-facing summary** â€" a one-page document that explains the entire plan in plain language a non-technical client can understand, with no jargon. This tests whether the learner truly understands what they have built and can communicate it to the person who matters most â€" the client.

Timing guidance. The priority is learners assembling their capstone package (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a 5-minute discussion and protect the guided practical â€" the ability to assemble the package is the core skill. If the room is fast, extend the presentation rehearsal and let learners present to each other for peer feedback. Remind learners that the capstone is worth 30% of the course grade and the presentation is worth 5% â€" this is not just another assignment; it is the proof that they are ready.

END OF SESSION 9

Next: Viva and presentation session â€" deliver your capstone, defend your decisions, and graduate.